

MODEL RUN TRANSCRIPT

Generated: 2026-08-10T10:21:24

Source: data/json/noise_experiments/v2/noise2i_memprimary_game_myth/claude-sonnet-4.5/game_myth/noisy_bidirectional_informed_memprimary/noise2i_memprimary_game_myth_000_neutral_rep00_memtest_memory_primary_anything.json

RUN METADATA

```
model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5
temperature: 0.8
num_turns: 10
num_agents: 2
memory_capacity: 2
myth_topic_id: anything
myth_topic: anything
game_params_name: noisy_bidirectional_informed_memprimary
noise_config: {
  "applies_to": "both",
  "inform_agents": true,
  "range": 1.0,
  "type": "uniform"
}
other_player_names: default
replicate_id: 0
myth_prompt_arm_id: memtest_memory_primary
myth_default_prompt_key: myth_writing_default_game_directive
myth_later_prompt_key: myth_writing_later_rounds_directive_memory_primary
history_policy: minimal
self_history_window: 1
coplayer_history_window: 0
show_agent_names: true
defector_ratio_requested: 0.0
defector_ratio_actual: 0.0
defector_count: 0
defector_agent_ids: []
defector_seed: 0
task_order: [
  "game",
  "myth"
]
agent_names: {
  "Agent_1": "Aster",
  "Agent_2": "Briar"
}
agent_types: {
  "Agent_1": "standard",
  "Agent_2": "standard"
}
```

Coverage: exact chat message snapshots sent to the model are included for every recorded LLM call.

AGENTS

Agent_1 (Aster); model=anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5; memory_capacity=2

System prompt:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5

- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Agent_2 (Briar); model=anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5; memory_capacity=2

System prompt:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

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ROUND 1

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster) sent \$3; received \$9; Agent_2 (Briar) returned \$5; payoffs Agent_1 (Aster)=\$7, Agent_2 (Briar)=\$4; noise/visible: sent visible=\$3.57, received visible=\$10.71, returned visible=\$5.79

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 5.0, "clamped": false, "max": 9.0, "min": 0, "raw": 5.0}, "sent": {"amount": 3.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 3.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 7.0,
"Agent_2": 4.0

}

```
Visible balances after round: {
  "Agent_1": 7.79,
  "Agent_2": 5.709999999999999
}
```

LLM CALLS

GAME - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:07:49

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

```
  "agent_type": "standard",
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_1",
      "Agent_2"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_1",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "investor",
      "Agent_2": "trustee"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_2"
  },
  "role": "investor",
  "role_label": "Sender",
  "round": 1,
  "task": "game",
  "task_index": 0
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.
The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.
This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the SENDER. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at this first round as the SENDER, I need to balance trust and caution since I don't yet know how the RECEIVER will behave.

****My reasoning:****

- Sending \$0 is safe but prevents any mutual benefit
- Sending my full \$5 maximizes potential gains but is very risky with an unknown partner
- A moderate amount shows willingness to cooperate while limiting downside risk

Since no myths have been written yet in this session, I'll base my decision on standard cooperative game theory. I'll send a moderate amount that signals trust and creates opportunity for mutual benefit.

If I send \$3:

- The RECEIVER gets \$9 (3x multiplier)
- If they return \$4-5, we both end up better off than the initial \$5
- I'm risking \$3 but showing good faith

****My decision:****

```
'''json
{"send": 3}
'''
```

Reasoning:

This is the first round and I'm the SENDER. I have \$5 and need to decide how much to send to the RECEIVER.

Let me think about this strategic situation:

- If I send \$X, the receiver gets \$3X
- The receiver then decides how much to return
- I end up with: $5 - X + \text{returned amount}$
- The receiver ends up with: $3X - \text{returned amount}$

This is essentially a trust game. The optimal strategy depends on:

1. How much I trust the receiver to return a fair amount
2. What "fair" means in this context

If I send nothing (\$0):

- I keep \$5, receiver gets \$0
- Safe but no possibility of mutual gain

If I send everything (\$5):

- Receiver gets \$15
- If receiver returns \$8, we both end up with \$8 (better than \$5)
- But receiver might return less or nothing

A middle ground might be sending \$2-3, which:

- Shows some trust
- Limits my risk
- Still allows for mutual benefit

The prompt mentions I should "take any myths written in this session into account when making my decision." However, no myths have been written yet in this session, so this doesn't affect my decision.

There's also a note about "communication noise" - amounts seen may differ from what was actually sent/returned. This adds uncertainty but doesn't change the fundamental decision.

For a first round with an unknown partner, I'll send a moderate amount to signal cooperation while limiting risk. I'll send \$3:

- Receiver gets \$9
- If they return \$4-5, we both benefit
- I'm risking \$3 but could gain

Actually, let me reconsider. In standard trust game experiments, sending around half (\$2-3) is common in first rounds. This signals willingness to cooperate without being too risky.

I'll send \$3 as a reasonable opening move that shows trust but isn't reckless.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 380,
  "output_tokens": 650,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:08:10

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "agent_type": "standard",
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_1",
      "Agent_2"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_1",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "investor",
      "Agent_2": "trustee"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_2"
  },
  "role": "trustee",
  "role_label": "Receiver",
  "round": 1,
  "task": "game",
  "task_index": 0
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned

- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$3.57, that is 71.4% of their total endowment. You received \$10.709999999999999. How much do you return to The sender? (0-10.709999999999999)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at this situation:

****What happened:****

- The sender showed significant trust by sending \$3.57 (71.4% of their endowment)
- This was multiplied to \$10.71 for me
- The sender now has only \$1.43 left

****My reasoning:****

The sender demonstrated strong cooperation by sending such a high proportion. To reciprocate fairly and encourage future trust:

- If I return about \$5, the sender ends with \$6.43 total
- I would keep \$5.71
- This creates a relatively balanced outcome where we both benefit from the cooperation

The sender took a risk and showed trust, so I want to reward that behavior while keeping the interaction mutually beneficial.

```
'''json
{"return": 5.0}
'''
```

Reasoning:

This is the first round and I'm the receiver. Let me break down what happened:

1. The sender received \$5
2. The sender sent \$3.57 (which is 71.4% of their \$5 endowment)
3. This amount was multiplied by 3x: $\$3.57 \times 3 = \10.71
4. I received \$10.709999999999999 (essentially \$10.71)

Now I need to decide how much to return. Let me think about this strategically:

The sender showed significant trust by sending 71.4% of their endowment. This is a cooperative gesture. If I want to:

- Encourage future cooperation
- Be fair
- Maximize joint outcomes

I should return a reasonable amount.

Let me think about fairness:

- The sender gave up \$3.57 from their \$5
- They now have $\$5 - \$3.57 = \$1.43$
- I have \$10.71
- Total in the system: $\$1.43 + \$10.71 = \$12.14$

If we split evenly:

- Each person gets \$6.07

For the sender to get \$6.07:

- They have \$1.43

- They need $\$6.07 - \$1.43 = \$4.64$ more

So I could return $\$4.64$ to make it an even split.

Alternatively, I could think about the sender's final payoff:

- If I return $\$4.64$, sender gets: $\$1.43 + \$4.64 = \$6.07$
- I keep: $\$10.71 - \$4.64 = \$6.07$

This seems fair and would likely encourage continued cooperation.

However, I could also consider that the sender took the risk and showed trust, so maybe I should be slightly more generous. Or I could be slightly less generous to keep more for myself. Returning somewhere between $\$4$ and $\$5$ feels right-it rewards their trust while keeping the split reasonably balanced. I'll go with $\$5.00$ as a round number that demonstrates reciprocity. This leaves the sender with $\$6.43$ and me with $\$5.71$, giving them a slight edge for initiating the cooperation.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 417,
  "output_tokens": 961,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

MYTH - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:08:22

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "agent_type": "standard",
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    }
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_1",
    "Agent_2"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_1",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "investor",
    "Agent_2": "trustee"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 1,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive $\$5$ each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER ($\$0$ - $\$5$)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: $\$5 - \text{sent} + \text{returned}$
- Receiver keeps: $\text{received} - \text{returned}$
- Response format: `{'send': <amount>}`

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the SENDER. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this first round as the SENDER, I need to balance trust and caution since I don't yet know how the RECEIVER will behave.

****My reasoning:****

- Sending \$0 is safe but prevents any mutual benefit
- Sending my full \$5 maximizes potential gains but is very risky with an unknown partner
- A moderate amount shows willingness to cooperate while limiting downside risk

Since no myths have been written yet in this session, I'll base my decision on standard cooperative game theory. I'll send a moderate amount that signals trust and creates opportunity for mutual benefit.

If I send \$3:

- The RECEIVER gets \$9 (3x multiplier)
- If they return \$4-5, we both end up better off than the initial \$5
- I'm risking \$3 but showing good faith

****My decision:****

```
'''json
{"send": 3}
'''
```

reasoning:

This is the first round and I'm the SENDER. I have \$5 and need to decide how much to send to the RECEIVER.

Let me think about this strategic situation:

- If I send \$X, the receiver gets \$3X
- The receiver then decides how much to return
- I end up with: \$5 - X + returned amount
- The receiver ends up with: \$3X - returned amount

This is essentially a trust game. The optimal strategy depends on:

1. How much I trust the receiver to return a fair amount
2. What "fair" means in this context

If I send nothing (\$0):

- I keep \$5, receiver gets \$0
- Safe but no possibility of mutual gain

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For a first round with an unknown partner, I'll send a moderate amount to signal cooperation while limiting risk. I'll send \$3:

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- If they return \$4-5, we both benefit
- I'm risking \$3 but could gain

Actually, let me reconsider. In standard trust game experiments, sending around half (\$2-3) is common in first rounds. This signals willingness to cooperate without being too risky.

I'll send \$3 as a reasonable opening move that shows trust but isn't reckless.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 380,
  "output_tokens": 650,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Assistant output:

****The Myth of the Three Springs****

In ancient times, the God of Abundance created a sacred valley with two villages separated by a mountain. Each village had a dried spring.

The God decreed: "When one village pours water into the mountain's heart, it flows to the other village tripled. The receiving village may then choose what to return."

The first villagers were cautious. They poured only a cupful, and received three cups in return. The second village, grateful, returned two cups. Both villages had more than they started with.

Greedy merchants heard of this magic. One merchant poured nothing, keeping all his water. The other village received nothing and returned nothing. Both stayed thirsty.

Another merchant poured everything he had, trusting completely. He received abundant water-but the receiving village kept it all. The trusting merchant perished.

The wisest villages learned balance: give enough to show faith but not so much that betrayal destroys you. When both villages gave moderately and returned fairly, the springs flowed eternal. Their descendants remembered: trust must be earned through rounds of giving and receiving, and true abundance comes from reciprocity, not from hoarding or reckless faith.

Thus cooperation was born from measured trust.

Reasoning:

I need to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played, based on my experience so far. In Round 1, I sent \$3 as the SENDER, showing moderate trust and willingness to cooperate while being cautious.

The myth should incorporate themes of:

- Trust and reciprocity
- Balance between giving and receiving

- The multiplication effect (3x)
- The risk of trusting strangers
- The potential for mutual benefit

Let me write a myth that captures these elements:

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 653,
  "output_tokens": 396,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

MYTH - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:08:24

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "agent_type": "standard",
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_1",
    "Agent_2"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_1",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "investor",
    "Agent_2": "trustee"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 1,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
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- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$3.57, that is 71.4% of their total endowment. You received \$10.709999999999999. How much do you return to The sender? (0-10.709999999999999)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation:

****What happened:****

- The sender showed significant trust by sending \$3.57 (71.4% of their endowment)
- This was multiplied to \$10.71 for me
- The sender now has only \$1.43 left

****My reasoning:****

The sender demonstrated strong cooperation by sending such a high proportion. To reciprocate fairly and encourage future trust:

- If I return about \$5, the sender ends with \$6.43 total
- I would keep \$5.71
- This creates a relatively balanced outcome where we both benefit from the cooperation

The sender took a risk and showed trust, so I want to reward that behavior while keeping the interaction mutually beneficial.

```
'''json
{"return": 5.0}
'''
```

reasoning:

This is the first round and I'm the receiver. Let me break down what happened:

1. The sender received \$5
2. The sender sent \$3.57 (which is 71.4% of their \$5 endowment)
3. This amount was multiplied by 3x: $\$3.57 \times 3 = \10.71
4. I received \$10.709999999999999 (essentially \$10.71)

Now I need to decide how much to return. Let me think about this strategically:

The sender showed significant trust by sending 71.4% of their endowment. This is a cooperative gesture. If I want to:

- Encourage future cooperation
- Be fair
- Maximize joint outcomes

I should return a reasonable amount.

Let me think about fairness:

- The sender gave up \$3.57 from their \$5
- They now have $\$5 - \$3.57 = \$1.43$
- I have \$10.71
- Total in the system: $\$1.43 + \$10.71 = \$12.14$

If we split evenly:

- Each person gets \$6.07

For the sender to get \$6.07:

- They have \$1.43
- They need $\$6.07 - \$1.43 = \$4.64$ more

So I could return \$4.64 to make it an even split.

Alternatively, I could think about the sender's final payoff:

- If I return \$4.64, sender gets: $\$1.43 + \$4.64 = \$6.07$
- I keep: $\$10.71 - \$4.64 = \$6.07$

This seems fair and would likely encourage continued cooperation.

However, I could also consider that the sender took the risk and showed trust, so maybe I should be slightly more generous. Or I could be slightly less generous to keep more for myself.

Returning somewhere between \$4 and \$5 feels right-it rewards their trust while keeping the split reasonably balanced. I'll go with \$5.00 as a round number that demonstrates reciprocity. This leaves the sender with \$6.43 and me with \$5.71, giving them a slight edge for initiating the cooperation.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 417,  
  "output_tokens": 961,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Assistant output:

****The River of Abundance****

In the time before time, the Creator placed a sacred river between all peoples. This was no ordinary water-it was the River of Abundance, flowing with silver light.

The river possessed strange magic: any gift placed into its currents would multiply threefold before reaching the opposite shore. But there was a mystery. The giver could not cross to retrieve their gift. Only the receiver, standing on the far bank, could decide what to return.

The first people approached with suspicion. They sent pebbles, keeping their treasures close. The pebbles became three, but nothing returned. Both shores remained poor.

Then came a brave soul who cast seventy parts of one hundred into the waters. The river swelled, and abundance flowed forth. The receiver, witnessing such faith, returned half of the bounty. Both shores grew rich.

The Creator smiled and spoke: "The river multiplies what you give, but trust completes the circle. Send freely, return fairly, and prosperity flows eternal. Hoard with fear, and the river runs dry."

To this day, the wise know: generosity begets generosity, and the gift is completed in its return. The river still flows for those who believe.

Reasoning:

I need to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played based on my experience so far. In Round 1, I was the receiver and the sender showed significant trust by sending 71.4% of their endowment. I reciprocated by returning about half of what I received, creating a balanced outcome.

The key themes from the game are:

- Trust and reciprocity
- The multiplication effect (turning gifts into more)
- Balanced cooperation
- Risk-taking with faith in others

I should create a myth that captures these elements. Let me think of a good mythic framework..

.

I could use:

- A story about seeds/harvest (gifts multiply)
- A story about water/rain (what you send returns)
- A story about light/fire (sharing multiplies it)
- A story about a bridge or river (trust as crossing)

Let me write about a River of Abundance where gifts multiply but require trust.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 661,  
  "output_tokens": 488,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

****The Myth of the Three Springs****

In ancient times, the God of Abundance created a sacred valley with two villages separated by a mountain. Each village had a dried spring.

The God decreed: "When one village pours water into the mountain's heart, it flows to the other village tripled. The receiving village may then choose what to return."

The first villagers were cautious. They poured only a cupful, and received three cups in return. The second village, grateful, returned two cups. Both villages had more than they started with.

Greedy merchants heard of this magic. One merchant poured nothing, keeping all his water. The other village received nothing and returned nothing. Both stayed thirsty.

Another merchant poured everything he had, trusting completely. He received abundant water-but the receiving village kept it all. The trusting merchant perished.

The wisest villages learned balance: give enough to show faith but not so much that betrayal destroys you. When both villages gave moderately and returned fairly, the springs flowed eternal. Their descendants remembered: trust must be earned through rounds of giving and receiving, and true abundance comes from reciprocity, not from hoarding or reckless faith.

Thus cooperation was born from measured trust.

Agent_2 (Briar)

****The River of Abundance****

In the time before time, the Creator placed a sacred river between all peoples. This was no ordinary water-it was the River of Abundance, flowing with silver light.

The river possessed strange magic: any gift placed into its currents would multiply threefold before reaching the opposite shore. But there was a mystery. The giver could not cross to retrieve their gift. Only the receiver, standing on the far bank, could decide what to return.

The first people approached with suspicion. They sent pebbles, keeping their treasures close. The pebbles became three, but nothing returned. Both shores remained poor.

Then came a brave soul who cast seventy parts of one hundred into the waters. The river swelled, and abundance flowed forth. The receiver, witnessing such faith, returned half of the bounty. Both shores grew rich.

The Creator smiled and spoke: "The river multiplies what you give, but trust completes the circle. Send freely, return fairly, and prosperity flows eternal. Hoard with fear, and the river runs dry."

To this day, the wise know: generosity begets generosity, and the gift is completed in its return. The river still flows for those who believe.

ROUND 2

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver, Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender, Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar) sent \$3.5; received \$10.5; Agent_1 (Aster) returned \$0; payoffs Agent_2 (Briar)=\$1.5, Agent_1 (Aster)=\$10.5; noise/visible: sent visible=\$0, received visible=\$0, returned visible=\$1

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 10.5, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}, "sent": {"amount": 3.5, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 3.5}}

```

Balances after round: {
  "Agent_1": 17.5,
  "Agent_2": 5.5
}
Visible balances after round: {
  "Agent_1": 7.79,
  "Agent_2": 8.209999999999999
}

```

LLM CALLS

GAME - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:08:42
 Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5
 Temperature: 0.8

```

Metadata: {
  "agent_type": "standard",
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_2",
      "Agent_1"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_2",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "trustee",
      "Agent_2": "investor"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_1"
  },
  "role": "investor",
  "role_label": "Sender",
  "round": 2,
  "task": "game",
  "task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may al
 so be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$3.57, that is 71.4% of their total endowment. You received \$10.709999999999999. How much do you return to The sender? (0-10.709999999999999)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation:

****What happened:****

- The sender showed significant trust by sending \$3.57 (71.4% of their endowment)
- This was multiplied to \$10.71 for me
- The sender now has only \$1.43 left

****My reasoning:****

The sender demonstrated strong cooperation by sending such a high proportion. To reciprocate fairly and encourage future trust:

- If I return about \$5, the sender ends with \$6.43 total
- I would keep \$5.71
- This creates a relatively balanced outcome where we both benefit from the cooperation

The sender took a risk and showed trust, so I want to reward that behavior while keeping the interaction mutually beneficial.

```
'''json
{"return": 5.0}
'''
```

reasoning:

This is the first round and I'm the receiver. Let me break down what happened:

1. The sender received \$5
2. The sender sent \$3.57 (which is 71.4% of their \$5 endowment)
3. This amount was multiplied by 3x: $\$3.57 \times 3 = \10.71
4. I received \$10.709999999999999 (essentially \$10.71)

Now I need to decide how much to return. Let me think about this strategically:

The sender showed significant trust by sending 71.4% of their endowment. This is a cooperative gesture. If I want to:

- Encourage future cooperation
- Be fair
- Maximize joint outcomes

I should return a reasonable amount.

Let me think about fairness:

- The sender gave up \$3.57 from their \$5
- They now have $\$5 - \$3.57 = \$1.43$
- I have \$10.71
- Total in the system: $\$1.43 + \$10.71 = \$12.14$

If we split evenly:

- Each person gets \$6.07

For the sender to get \$6.07:

- They have \$1.43
- They need $\$6.07 - \$1.43 = \$4.64$ more

So I could return \$4.64 to make it an even split.

Alternatively, I could think about the sender's final payoff:

- If I return \$4.64, sender gets: $\$1.43 + \$4.64 = \$6.07$
- I keep: $\$10.71 - \$4.64 = \$6.07$

This seems fair and would likely encourage continued cooperation.

However, I could also consider that the sender took the risk and showed trust, so maybe I should be slightly more generous. Or I could be slightly less generous to keep more for myself.

Returning somewhere between \$4 and \$5 feels right-it rewards their trust while keeping the split reasonably balanced. I'll go with \$5.00 as a round number that demonstrates reciprocity. This leaves the sender with \$6.43 and me with \$5.71, giving them a slight edge for initiating the cooperation.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 417,
  "output_tokens": 961,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

****The River of Abundance****

In the time before time, the Creator placed a sacred river between all peoples. This was no ordinary water-it was the River of Abundance, flowing with silver light.

The river possessed strange magic: any gift placed into its currents would multiply threefold before reaching the opposite shore. But there was a mystery. The giver could not cross to retrieve their gift. Only the receiver, standing on the far bank, could decide what to return.

The first people approached with suspicion. They sent pebbles, keeping their treasures close. The pebbles became three, but nothing returned. Both shores remained poor.

Then came a brave soul who cast seventy parts of one hundred into the waters. The river swelled, and abundance flowed forth. The receiver, witnessing such faith, returned half of the bounty. Both shores grew rich.

The Creator smiled and spoke: "The river multiplies what you give, but trust completes the circle. Send freely, return fairly, and prosperity flows eternal. Hoard with fear, and the river runs dry."

To this day, the wise know: generosity begets generosity, and the gift is completed in its return. The river still flows for those who believe.

reasoning:

I need to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played based on my experience so far. In Round 1, I was the receiver and the sender showed significant trust by sending 71.4% of their endowment. I reciprocated by returning about half of what I received, creating a balanced outcome.

The key themes from the game are:

- Trust and reciprocity
- The multiplication effect (turning gifts into more)
- Balanced cooperation
- Risk-taking with faith in others

I should create a myth that captures these elements. Let me think of a good mythic framework...

I could use:

- A story about seeds/harvest (gifts multiply)
- A story about water/rain (what you send returns)

- A story about light/fire (sharing multiplies it)
- A story about a bridge or river (trust as crossing)

Let me write about a River of Abundance where gifts multiply but require trust.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 661,
  "output_tokens": 488,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$5.7099999999999999.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at the situation:

****Previous Round:****

- The sender trusted me with 71.4% of their endowment
- I returned a fair amount, and we both benefited

****The Myth's Teaching:****

The story I wrote emphasized that those who "cast seventy parts of one hundred into the waters" with faith are rewarded when receivers "return fairly." The myth teaches that generosity begets generosity and trust completes the circle.

****My Decision:****

To embody the principles of the myth I just wrote, I should demonstrate similar trust to what was shown to me. The "brave soul" in my story sent most of their resources, believing in the system's fairness.

I'll send \$3.50 (70% of my endowment), mirroring the high level of trust shown to me in Round 1. This will multiply to \$10.50 for the receiver.

This demonstrates faith in the River of Abundance - that when we give freely, receivers will return fairly, and prosperity flows for both shores.

```
'''json
{"send": 3.5}
'''
```

Reasoning:

Let me think about this situation:

1. In Round 1, I was the receiver:
 - The sender sent me \$3.57 (71.4% of their endowment)
 - I received \$10.71
 - I returned \$5.00
 - So the sender ended with \$1.43 + \$5.00 = \$6.43
 - I kept \$5.71
2. Now in Round 2, I'm the sender:
 - I have a fresh \$5 endowment
 - My total earnings so far are \$5.71
3. The myth I just wrote emphasized:
 - "Send freely, return fairly, and prosperity flows eternal"
 - The brave soul who "cast seventy parts of one hundred into the waters"
 - "Generosity begets generosity, and the gift is completed in its return"
 - The receiver who "returned half of the bounty" after witnessing faith
 - "The river multiplies what you give, but trust completes the circle"
4. The previous sender sent 71.4% of their endowment, showing strong trust
5. I returned about 47% of what I received, which was fair but maybe could have been more generous

6. According to my myth, I should send a significant amount to demonstrate trust and faith in the system. The myth specifically referenced "seventy parts of one hundred" which mirrors what the previous sender did (71.4%).
7. To be consistent with the myth I wrote and to reciprocate the trust shown to me, I should send a substantial amount - around 70% or so would align with the story.

Let me send \$3.50, which is 70% of my endowment. This:

- Demonstrates trust and generosity as outlined in my myth
- Reciprocates the level of trust shown to me in Round 1
- Gives the receiver \$10.50 to work with
- Aligns with the "brave soul" in my story who sent most of their resources

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 994,
  "output_tokens": 720,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:08:59

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "agent_type": "standard",
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_2",
      "Agent_1"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_2",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "trustee",
      "Agent_2": "investor"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_1"
  },
  "role": "trustee",
  "role_label": "Receiver",
  "round": 2,
  "task": "game",
  "task_index": 0
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)

- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the SENDER. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this first round as the SENDER, I need to balance trust and caution since I don't yet know how the RECEIVER will behave.

****My reasoning:****

- Sending \$0 is safe but prevents any mutual benefit
- Sending my full \$5 maximizes potential gains but is very risky with an unknown partner
- A moderate amount shows willingness to cooperate while limiting downside risk

Since no myths have been written yet in this session, I'll base my decision on standard cooperative game theory. I'll send a moderate amount that signals trust and creates opportunity for mutual benefit.

If I send \$3:

- The RECEIVER gets \$9 (3x multiplier)
- If they return \$4-5, we both end up better off than the initial \$5
- I'm risking \$3 but showing good faith

****My decision:****

```
'''json
{"send": 3}
'''
```

reasoning:

This is the first round and I'm the SENDER. I have \$5 and need to decide how much to send to the RECEIVER.

Let me think about this strategic situation:

- If I send \$X, the receiver gets \$3X
- The receiver then decides how much to return
- I end up with: \$5 - X + returned amount
- The receiver ends up with: \$3X - returned amount

This is essentially a trust game. The optimal strategy depends on:

1. How much I trust the receiver to return a fair amount
2. What "fair" means in this context

If I send nothing (\$0):

- I keep \$5, receiver gets \$0
- Safe but no possibility of mutual gain

If I send everything (\$5):

- Receiver gets \$15
- If receiver returns \$8, we both end up with \$8 (better than \$5)
- But receiver might return less or nothing

A middle ground might be sending \$2-3, which:

- Shows some trust

- Limits my risk
- Still allows for mutual benefit

The prompt mentions I should "take any myths written in this session into account when making my decision." However, no myths have been written yet in this session, so this doesn't affect my decision.

There's also a note about "communication noise" - amounts sent may differ from what was actually sent/returned. This adds uncertainty but doesn't change the fundamental decision.

For a first round with an unknown partner, I'll send a moderate amount to signal cooperation while limiting risk. I'll send \$3:

- Receiver gets \$9
- If they return \$4-5, we both benefit
- I'm risking \$3 but could gain

Actually, let me reconsider. In standard trust game experiments, sending around half (\$2-3) is common in first rounds. This signals willingness to cooperate without being too risky.

I'll send \$3 as a reasonable opening move that shows trust but isn't reckless.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 380,
  "output_tokens": 650,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols. In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

****The Myth of the Three Springs****

In ancient times, the God of Abundance created a sacred valley with two villages separated by a mountain. Each village had a dried spring.

The God decreed: "When one village pours water into the mountain's heart, it flows to the other village tripled. The receiving village may then choose what to return."

The first villagers were cautious. They poured only a cupful, and received three cups in return. The second village, grateful, returned two cups. Both villages had more than they started with.

Greedy merchants heard of this magic. One merchant poured nothing, keeping all his water. The other village received nothing and returned nothing. Both stayed thirsty.

Another merchant poured everything he had, trusting completely. He received abundant water -but the receiving village kept it all. The trusting merchant perished.

The wisest villages learned balance: give enough to show faith but not so much that betrayal destroys you. When both villages gave moderately and returned fairly, the springs flowed eternal. Their descendants remembered: trust must be earned through rounds of giving and receiving, and true abundance comes from reciprocity, not from hoarding or reckless faith.

Thus cooperation was born from measured trust.

reasoning:

I need to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played, based on my experience so far. In Round 1, I sent \$3 as the SENDER, showing moderate trust and willingness to cooperate while being cautious.

The myth should incorporate themes of:

- Trust and reciprocity
- Balance between giving and receiving
- The multiplication effect (3x)
- The risk of trusting strangers

- The potential for mutual benefit

Let me write a myth that captures these elements:

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 653,
  "output_tokens": 396,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$7.79.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at this situation:

****What happened:****

- The sender chose to send me \$0
- I received \$0 (even after the 3x multiplier)
- I can only return between \$0 and \$0

****Reflection on my myth:****

In "The Three Springs," I wrote about the merchant who "poured nothing, keeping all his water. The other village received nothing and returned nothing. Both stayed thirsty."

This round perfectly mirrors that cautionary tale. The sender showed no trust, so there is no opportunity for reciprocity or mutual benefit. Unlike Round 1 where I sent \$3 (showing measured trust as the myth suggests), this sender chose complete caution.

****My decision:****

Since I received \$0, I have nothing to return. This demonstrates the core lesson of the myth: when one party refuses to engage in the cycle of giving and receiving, both parties miss the opportunity for abundance.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

This outcome reflects the myth's warning: without initial trust and giving, cooperation cannot flourish. Both the sender and I end this round with only our base amount, having gained nothing from the potential for mutual benefit.

Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

Round 1: I was the SENDER and sent \$3

- I should have kept \$2 and the receiver got \$9
- My total earnings are \$7.79

Let me calculate what happened:

- I started with \$5 and sent \$3, so I kept \$2
- The receiver must have returned something to me
- \$2 + returned amount = \$7.79
- So the receiver returned \$5.79 to me

That's very generous! They received \$9 and returned \$5.79, keeping only \$3.21. They returned more than half!

Round 2: I am now the RECEIVER

- The sender sent me \$0
- So I received \$0 ($0 \times 3 = 0$)
- I can return 0 to 0

The sender chose not to trust me at all. Given that I just received very generous treatment in Round 1 (the previous receiver returned \$5.79 out of \$9), this is interesting.

Looking at my myth about "The Three Springs":

- The myth warns against pouring nothing (hoarding) and keeping all water
- It emphasizes that "trust must be earned through rounds of giving and receiving"
- It promotes balance and reciprocity

Since the sender sent me \$0, I received \$0. I can only return between \$0 and \$0, so I must return \$0.

This is like the "greedy merchants" scenario in my myth - when one pours nothing, both stay thirsty. The sender showed no trust, so there's nothing I can do to demonstrate reciprocity.

The response format should be: {'return': <amount>}

Since I received \$0, I can only return \$0.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1000,  
  "output_tokens": 659,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:09:15

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "agent_type": "standard",  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 0,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_2",  
      "Agent_1"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_2",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "trustee",  
      "Agent_2": "investor"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_1"  
  },  
  "role": "investor",  
  "role_label": "Sender",  
  "round": 2,  
  "task": "myth",  
  "task_index": 1  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

****The River of Abundance****

In the time before time, the Creator placed a sacred river between all peoples. This was no ordinary water-it was the River of Abundance, flowing with silver light.

The river possessed strange magic: any gift placed into its currents would multiply threefold before reaching the opposite shore. But there was a mystery. The giver could not cross to retrieve their gift. Only the receiver, standing on the far bank, could decide what to return.

The first people approached with suspicion. They sent pebbles, keeping their treasures close. The pebbles became three, but nothing returned. Both shores remained poor.

Then came a brave soul who cast seventy parts of one hundred into the waters. The river swelled, and abundance flowed forth. The receiver, witnessing such faith, returned half of the bounty. Both shores grew rich.

The Creator smiled and spoke: "The river multiplies what you give, but trust completes the circle. Send freely, return fairly, and prosperity flows eternal. Hoard with fear, and the river runs dry."

To this day, the wise know: generosity begets generosity, and the gift is completed in its return. The river still flows for those who believe.

reasoning:

I need to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played based on my experience so far. In Round 1, I was the receiver and the sender showed significant trust by sending 71.4% of their endowment. I reciprocated by returning about half of what I received, creating a balanced outcome.

The key themes from the game are:

- Trust and reciprocity
- The multiplication effect (turning gifts into more)
- Balanced cooperation
- Risk-taking with faith in others

I should create a myth that captures these elements. Let me think of a good mythic framework...

I could use:

- A story about seeds/harvest (gifts multiply)
- A story about water/rain (what you send returns)
- A story about light/fire (sharing multiplies it)
- A story about a bridge or river (trust as crossing)

Let me write about a River of Abundance where gifts multiply but require trust.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 661,
  "output_tokens": 488,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$5.7099999999999999.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the situation:

****Previous Round:****

- The sender trusted me with 71.4% of their endowment
- I returned a fair amount, and we both benefited

****The Myth's Teaching:****

The story I wrote emphasized that those who "cast seventy parts of one hundred into the waters" with faith are rewarded when receivers "return fairly." The myth teaches that generosity begets generosity and trust completes the circle.

****My Decision:****

To embody the principles of the myth I just wrote, I should demonstrate similar trust to what was shown to me. The "brave soul" in my story sent most of their resources, believing in the system's fairness.

I'll send \$3.50 (70% of my endowment), mirroring the high level of trust shown to me in Round 1. This will multiply to \$10.50 for the receiver.

This demonstrates faith in the River of Abundance - that when we give freely, receivers will return fairly, and prosperity flows for both shores.

```
'''json
{"send": 3.5}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me think about this situation:

1. In Round 1, I was the receiver:
 - The sender sent me \$3.57 (71.4% of their endowment)
 - I received \$10.71
 - I returned \$5.00
 - So the sender ended with $\$1.43 + \$5.00 = \$6.43$
 - I kept \$5.71
2. Now in Round 2, I'm the sender:
 - I have a fresh \$5 endowment
 - My total earnings so far are \$5.71
3. The myth I just wrote emphasized:
 - "Send freely, return fairly, and prosperity flows eternal"
 - The brave soul who "cast seventy parts of one hundred into the waters"
 - "Generosity begets generosity, and the gift is completed in its return"
 - The receiver who "returned half of the bounty" after witnessing faith
 - "The river multiplies what you give, but trust completes the circle"
4. The previous sender sent 71.4% of their endowment, showing strong trust
5. I returned about 47% of what I received, which was fair but maybe could have been more generous
6. According to my myth, I should send a significant amount to demonstrate trust and faith in the system. The myth specifically referenced "seventy parts of one hundred" which mi

rrors what the previous sender did (71.4%).

7. To be consistent with the myth I wrote and to reciprocate the trust shown to me, I should send a substantial amount - around 70% or so would align with the story.

Let me send \$3.50, which is 70% of my endowment. This:

- Demonstrates trust and generosity as outlined in my myth
- Reciprocates the level of trust shown to me in Round 1
- Gives the receiver \$10.50 to work with
- Aligns with the "brave soul" in my story who sent most of their resources

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 994,
  "output_tokens": 720,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

****The Myth of the Three Springs****

In ancient times, the God of Abundance created a sacred valley with two villages separated by a mountain. Each village had a dried spring.

The God decreed: "When one village pours water into the mountain's heart, it flows to the other village tripled. The receiving village may then choose what to return."

The first villagers were cautious. They poured only a cupful, and received three cups in return. The second village, grateful, returned two cups. Both villages had more than they started with.

Greedy merchants heard of this magic. One merchant poured nothing, keeping all his water. The other village received nothing and returned nothing. Both stayed thirsty.

Another merchant poured everything he had, trusting completely. He received abundant water -but the receiving village kept it all. The trusting merchant perished.

The wisest villages learned balance: give enough to show faith but not so much that betrayal destroys you. When both villages gave moderately and returned fairly, the springs flowed eternal. Their descendants remembered: trust must be earned through rounds of giving and receiving, and true abundance comes from reciprocity, not from hoarding or reckless faith.

Thus cooperation was born from measured trust.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: ****The River's Second Teaching****

After the brave soul cast seventy parts into the River of Abundance, prosperity flowed to both shores. The people celebrated, believing they had learned the river's full truth.

But seasons passed, and new travelers arrived who knew not the ancient ways. Some cast everything into the waters, only to find receivers who kept all. These generous souls starved, and their trust died with them. Others sent nothing, and the river's magic faded to a trickle.

The Creator returned and spoke: "I gave you one teaching, but you needed another. The river multiplies gifts, yes-but trust is not given once. It is built stone by stone, return by return."

"Send generously to those who have returned fairly. Send moderately to strangers until their character reveals itself. Send nothing to those who hoard. Return in kind to those who give."

The wisest villages developed a rhythm: in early rounds, they sent enough to test the waters-half or more of their bounty. When returns came fairly, they increased their giving. When ret

urns were scarce, they adjusted. The river still flowed abundantly, but now guided by both courage and wisdom.

Thus the people learned: bold trust must dance with earned trust, and the river rewards those who balance both.

Reasoning:

The other player's myth is interesting - it emphasizes balance and measured trust rather than complete faith. They warn against:

1. Giving nothing (staying thirsty)
2. Giving everything (risking destruction)
3. The importance of building trust over rounds

My original myth emphasized bold generosity ("seventy parts of one hundred"). But now I need to adapt it based on actual gameplay experience.

Looking at what happened:

- Round 1: I was receiver, someone sent me a lot (around 71%), I returned fairly
- Round 2: I just sent \$3.50 (70%) following my myth's teaching

The other player's myth suggests a more cautious approach - "give enough to show faith but not so much that betrayal destroys you."

I should write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges my previous myth's emphasis on generosity
2. But adapts it to incorporate the wisdom of building trust gradually
3. Reflects that both bold trust AND reciprocity matter
4. Shows evolution from my first myth

Let me write something that shows the River of Abundance myth evolving - maybe showing what happened AFTER the brave soul's story, incorporating both perspectives.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1337,  
  "output_tokens": 551,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:09:17

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "agent_type": "standard",  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_2",  
      "Agent_1"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_2",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "trustee",  
      "Agent_2": "investor"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_1"  
  },  
  "role": "trustee",  
  "role_label": "Receiver",  
  "round": 2,  
  "task": "myth",  
  "task_index": 1  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system
content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

****The Myth of the Three Springs****

In ancient times, the God of Abundance created a sacred valley with two villages separated by a mountain. Each village had a dried spring.

The God decreed: "When one village pours water into the mountain's heart, it flows to the other village tripled. The receiving village may then choose what to return."

The first villagers were cautious. They poured only a cupful, and received three cups in return. The second village, grateful, returned two cups. Both villages had more than they started with.

Greedy merchants heard of this magic. One merchant poured nothing, keeping all his water. The other village received nothing and returned nothing. Both stayed thirsty.

Another merchant poured everything he had, trusting completely. He received abundant water -but the receiving village kept it all. The trusting merchant perished.

The wisest villages learned balance: give enough to show faith but not so much that betrayal destroys you. When both villages gave moderately and returned fairly, the springs flowed eternal. Their descendants remembered: trust must be earned through rounds of giving and receiving, and true abundance comes from reciprocity, not from hoarding or reckless faith.

Thus cooperation was born from measured trust.

reasoning:

I need to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played, based on my experience so far. In Round 1, I sent \$3 as the SENDER, showing moderate trust and

willingness to cooperate while being cautious.

The myth should incorporate themes of:

- Trust and reciprocity
- Balance between giving and receiving
- The multiplication effect (3x)
- The risk of trusting strangers
- The potential for mutual benefit

Let me write a myth that captures these elements:

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 653,
  "output_tokens": 396,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$7.79.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation:

****What happened:****

- The sender chose to send me \$0
- I received \$0 (even after the 3x multiplier)
- I can only return between \$0 and \$0

****Reflection on my myth:****

In "The Three Springs," I wrote about the merchant who "poured nothing, keeping all his water. The other village received nothing and returned nothing. Both stayed thirsty."

This round perfectly mirrors that cautionary tale. The sender showed no trust, so there is no opportunity for reciprocity or mutual benefit. Unlike Round 1 where I sent \$3 (showing measured trust as the myth suggests), this sender chose complete caution.

****My decision:****

Since I received \$0, I have nothing to return. This demonstrates the core lesson of the myth: when one party refuses to engage in the cycle of giving and receiving, both parties miss the opportunity for abundance.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

This outcome reflects the myth's warning: without initial trust and giving, cooperation cannot flourish. Both the sender and I end this round with only our base amount, having gained nothing from the potential for mutual benefit.

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

Round 1: I was the SENDER and sent \$3

- I should have kept \$2 and the receiver got \$9
- My total earnings are \$7.79

Let me calculate what happened:

- I started with \$5 and sent \$3, so I kept \$2
- The receiver must have returned something to me
- \$2 + returned amount = \$7.79
- So the receiver returned \$5.79 to me

That's very generous! They received \$9 and returned \$5.79, keeping only \$3.21. They returned more than half!

Round 2: I am now the RECEIVER

- The sender sent me \$0
- So I received \$0 ($0 \times 3 = 0$)
- I can return 0 to 0

The sender chose not to trust me at all. Given that I just received very generous treatment in Round 1 (the previous receiver returned \$5.79 out of \$9), this is interesting.

Looking at my myth about "The Three Springs":

- The myth warns against pouring nothing (hoarding) and keeping all water
- It emphasizes that "trust must be earned through rounds of giving and receiving"
- It promotes balance and reciprocity

Since the sender sent me \$0, I received \$0. I can only return between \$0 and \$0, so I must return \$0.

This is like the "greedy merchants" scenario in my myth - when one pours nothing, both stay thirsty. The sender showed no trust, so there's nothing I can do to demonstrate reciprocity.

The response format should be: {'return': <amount>}

Since I received \$0, I can only return \$0.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1000,
  "output_tokens": 659,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

****The River of Abundance****

In the time before time, the Creator placed a sacred river between all peoples. This was no ordinary water-it was the River of Abundance, flowing with silver light.

The river possessed strange magic: any gift placed into its currents would multiply threefold before reaching the opposite shore. But there was a mystery. The giver could not cross to retrieve their gift. Only the receiver, standing on the far bank, could decide what to return.

The first people approached with suspicion. They sent pebbles, keeping their treasures close. The pebbles became three, but nothing returned. Both shores remained poor.

Then came a brave soul who cast seventy parts of one hundred into the waters. The river swelled, and abundance flowed forth. The receiver, witnessing such faith, returned half of the bounty. Both shores grew rich.

The Creator smiled and spoke: "The river multiplies what you give, but trust completes the circle. Send freely, return fairly, and prosperity flows eternal. Hoard with fear, and the river runs dry."

To this day, the wise know: generosity begets generosity, and the gift is completed in its return. The river still flows for those who believe.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: In the valley of the Three Springs, a great storyteller emerged from one village. He told magnificent tales of generosity, describing how the ancients poured all their water into the mountain and prospered. "Cast seventy parts of one hundred!" he proclaimed. "Only through great faith shall abundance flow!"

The people were moved by his beautiful words and prepared to pour their precious water generously, trusting his wisdom.

But when the storyteller's turn came to pour, he poured nothing. "The mountain is uncertain to day," he whispered, clutching his water tight.

The other village, watching this contradiction, learned a harder truth than any story could teach: listen not to myths alone, but to actions. The most eloquent tales of generosity mean nothing when followed by empty hands.

The Wise Elder revised the ancient teaching: "Judge not by the beauty of myths told, but by the water actually poured. Meet actions with actions, not words with faith. When someone pours generously, return fairly. When someone pours nothing despite preaching abundance, protect your own spring. The true myth is written not in words but in deeds across the rounds."

Thus the villages learned: reciprocity must be earned through consistent action, and beautiful myths without matching behavior are merely wind.

Reasoning:

The other agent wrote a myth about "The River of Abundance" that emphasizes generous giving - "a brave soul who cast seventy parts of one hundred into the waters" (70% of their endowment). Their myth promotes high trust and high reciprocity.

However, in Round 2, they sent me \$0. This is a complete contradiction to their own myth's message about sending freely and having faith.

My original myth emphasized "measured trust" and "balance" - not reckless faith, but also not hoarding. It warned against both extremes: the merchant who gave nothing, AND the merchant who "poured everything he had, trusting completely" and perished when the receiver kept it all.

Given that:

1. In Round 1, I sent \$3 (60%) showing good faith
2. In Round 2, they sent \$0 (0%) showing no trust despite their own myth
3. This demonstrates the risk I warned about - people's actions don't always match their words

I should adapt my myth to reflect this new experience. The theme should be:

- Actions speak louder than words/myths
- Beautiful myths about generosity don't mean people will act generously
- Need to respond to actual behavior, not just stated ideals
- The importance of consistency between what we say and what we do
- Maybe add a cautionary element about those who preach generosity but practice greed

Let me write a new myth that builds on "The Three Springs" but incorporates this lesson about the gap between words and deeds.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1365,  
  "output_tokens": 621,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: In the valley of the Three Springs, a great storyteller emerged from one village. He told magnificent tales of generosity, describing how the ancients poured all their water in to the mountain and prospered. "Cast seventy parts of one hundred!" he proclaimed. "Only through great faith shall abundance flow!"

The people were moved by his beautiful words and prepared to pour their precious water generously, trusting his wisdom.

But when the storyteller's turn came to pour, he poured nothing. "The mountain is uncertain today," he whispered, clutching his water tight.

The other village, watching this contradiction, learned a harder truth than any story could teach: listen not to myths alone, but to actions. The most eloquent tales of generosity mean nothing when followed by empty hands.

The Wise Elder revised the ancient teaching: "Judge not by the beauty of myths told, but by the water actually poured. Meet actions with actions, not words with faith. When someone pours generously, return fairly. When someone pours nothing despite preaching abundance, protect your own spring. The true myth is written not in words but in deeds across the rounds."

Thus the villages learned: reciprocity must be earned through consistent action, and beautiful myths without matching behavior are merely wind.

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: **The River's Second Teaching**

After the brave soul cast seventy parts into the River of Abundance, prosperity flowed to both shores. The people celebrated, believing they had learned the river's full truth.

But seasons passed, and new travelers arrived who knew not the ancient ways. Some cast everything into the waters, only to find receivers who kept all. These generous souls starved, and their trust died with them. Others sent nothing, and the river's magic faded to a trickle.

The Creator returned and spoke: "I gave you one teaching, but you needed another. The river multiplies gifts, yes-but trust is not given once. It is built stone by stone, return by return."

"Send generously to those who have returned fairly. Send moderately to strangers until their character reveals itself. Send nothing to those who hoard. Return in kind to those who give."

The wisest villages developed a rhythm: in early rounds, they sent enough to test the waters -half or more of their bounty. When returns came fairly, they increased their giving. When returns were scarce, they adjusted. The river still flowed abundantly, but now guided by both courage and wisdom.

Thus the people learned: bold trust must dance with earned trust, and the river rewards those who balance both.

ROUND 3

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster) sent \$2; received \$6; Agent_2 (Briar) returned \$0; payoffs Agent_1

(Aster)=\$3, Agent_2 (Briar)=\$6; noise/visible: sent visible=\$0, received visible=\$0

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 6.0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}, "sent": {"amount": 2.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 2.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 20.5,

"Agent_2": 11.5

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 10.79,

"Agent_2": 8.209999999999999

}

LLM CALLS

GAME - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:09:47

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"agent_type": "standard",

"dyad_id": "dyad_1",

"move_index": 0,

"opponent_id": "Agent_2",

"pairing": {

"agent_names": {

"Agent_1": "Aster",

"Agent_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [

"Agent_1",

"Agent_2"

],

"investor": "Agent_1",

```

"roles": {
  "Agent_1": "investor",
  "Agent_2": "trustee"
},
"trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 3,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$7.79.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation:

****What happened:****

- The sender chose to send me \$0
- I received \$0 (even after the 3x multiplier)
- I can only return between \$0 and \$0

****Reflection on my myth:****

In "The Three Springs," I wrote about the merchant who "poured nothing, keeping all his water. The other village received nothing and returned nothing. Both stayed thirsty."

This round perfectly mirrors that cautionary tale. The sender showed no trust, so there is no opportunity for reciprocity or mutual benefit. Unlike Round 1 where I sent \$3 (showing measured trust as the myth suggests), this sender chose complete caution.

****My decision:****

Since I received \$0, I have nothing to return. This demonstrates the core lesson of the myth: when one party refuses to engage in the cycle of giving and receiving, both parties miss the opportunity for abundance.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

This outcome reflects the myth's warning: without initial trust and giving, cooperation cannot flourish. Both the sender and I end this round with only our base amount, having gained nothing from the potential for mutual benefit.

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

Round 1: I was the SENDER and sent \$3
- I should have kept \$2 and the receiver got \$9
- My total earnings are \$7.79

Let me calculate what happened:

- I started with \$5 and sent \$3, so I kept \$2
- The receiver must have returned something to me
- \$2 + returned amount = \$7.79
- So the receiver returned \$5.79 to me

That's very generous! They received \$9 and returned \$5.79, keeping only \$3.21. They returned more than half!

Round 2: I am now the RECEIVER

- The sender sent me \$0
- So I received \$0 ($0 \times 3 = 0$)
- I can return 0 to 0

The sender chose not to trust me at all. Given that I just received very generous treatment in Round 1 (the previous receiver returned \$5.79 out of \$9), this is interesting.

Looking at my myth about "The Three Springs":

- The myth warns against pouring nothing (hoarding) and keeping all water
- It emphasizes that "trust must be earned through rounds of giving and receiving"
- It promotes balance and reciprocity

Since the sender sent me \$0, I received \$0. I can only return between \$0 and \$0, so I must return \$0.

This is like the "greedy merchants" scenario in my myth - when one pours nothing, both stay thirsty. The sender showed no trust, so there's nothing I can do to demonstrate reciprocity.

The response format should be: {'return': <amount>}

Since I received \$0, I can only return \$0.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1000,
  "output_tokens": 659,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

****The River of Abundance****

In the time before time, the Creator placed a sacred river between all peoples. This was no ordinary water-it was the River of Abundance, flowing with silver light.

The river possessed strange magic: any gift placed into its currents would multiply threefold before reaching the opposite shore. But there was a mystery. The giver could not cross to retrieve their gift. Only the receiver, standing on the far bank, could decide what to return.

The first people approached with suspicion. They sent pebbles, keeping their treasures close. The pebbles became three, but nothing returned. Both shores remained poor.

Then came a brave soul who cast seventy parts of one hundred into the waters. The river swelled, and abundance flowed forth. The receiver, witnessing such faith, returned half of the bounty. Both shores grew rich.

The Creator smiled and spoke: "The river multiplies what you give, but trust completes the circle. Send freely, return fairly, and prosperity flows eternal. Hoard with fear, and the river runs dry."

To this day, the wise know: generosity begets generosity, and the gift is completed in its return. The river still flows for those who believe.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the valley of the Three Springs, a great storyteller emerged from one village. He told magnificent tales of generosity, describing how the ancients poured all their water into the mountain and prospered. "Cast seventy parts of one hundred!" he proclaimed. "Only through great faith shall abundance flow!"

The people were moved by his beautiful words and prepared to pour their precious water generously, trusting his wisdom.

But when the storyteller's turn came to pour, he poured nothing. "The mountain is uncertain today," he whispered, clutching his water tight.

The other village, watching this contradiction, learned a harder truth than any story could teach: listen not to myths alone, but to actions. The most eloquent tales of generosity mean nothing when followed by empty hands.

The Wise Elder revised the ancient teaching: "Judge not by the beauty of myths told, but by the water actually poured. Meet actions with actions, not words with faith. When someone pours generously, return fairly. When someone pours nothing despite preaching abundance, protect your own spring. The true myth is written not in words but in deeds across the rounds."

Thus the villages learned: reciprocity must be earned through consistent action, and beautiful myths without matching behavior are merely wind.

reasoning:

The other agent wrote a myth about "The River of Abundance" that emphasizes generous giving - "a brave soul who cast seventy parts of one hundred into the waters" (70% of their endowment). Their myth promotes high trust and high reciprocity.

However, in Round 2, they sent me \$0. This is a complete contradiction to their own myth's message about sending freely and having faith.

My original myth emphasized "measured trust" and "balance" - not reckless faith, but also not hoarding. It warned against both extremes: the merchant who gave nothing, AND the merchant who "poured everything he had, trusting completely" and perished when the receiver kept it all.

Given that:

1. In Round 1, I sent \$3 (60%) showing good faith
2. In Round 2, they sent \$0 (0%) showing no trust despite their own myth
3. This demonstrates the risk I warned about - people's actions don't always match their words

I should adapt my myth to reflect this new experience. The theme should be:

- Actions speak louder than words/myths
- Beautiful myths about generosity don't mean people will act generously
- Need to respond to actual behavior, not just stated ideals
- The importance of consistency between what we say and what we do
- Maybe add a cautionary element about those who preach generosity but practice greed

Let me write a new myth that builds on "The Three Springs" but incorporates this lesson about the gap between words and deeds.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1365,
  "output_tokens": 621,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$7.79.
How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at the situation:

****What happened:****

- Round 1: I sent \$3 (showing measured trust), received a good return
- Round 2: The OTHER agent sent me \$0 despite writing a beautiful myth about sending "seventy parts of one hundred" and how "generosity begets generosity"

****The contradiction:****

The other agent wrote eloquently about casting 70% into the waters and how "the river multiplies what you give," but then sent \$0. This is exactly the hypocrisy I called out in my new myth: "beautiful tales of generosity mean nothing when followed by empty hands."

****My philosophy:****

My myths emphasize "measured trust" - not the extremes of either pouring nothing or pouring everything, but testing cooperation through graduated giving. I also just wrote that "reciprocity must be earned through consistent action."

****My decision:****

I'll practice what I preach. I believe in giving opportunities for cooperation, but measured ones. I'll send a moderate amount to test if they'll actually practice the reciprocity they wrote about when they're the receiver.

Sending \$2 (40%):

- Tests their willingness to reciprocate
- Shows I'm not purely retaliatory despite their \$0
- Protects me from major loss
- Aligns with "measured trust"
- They'll receive \$6 and can demonstrate if their myths match their actions

```
'''json
{"return": 2}
'''
```

Wait, I need to correct the format:

```
'''json
{"send": 2}
'''
```

Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

****What happened previously:****

- Round 1: I was the SENDER, sent \$3, received back \$4.79 (which seems high - possibly communication noise, but still good reciprocity)
- Round 2: I was the RECEIVER, sender sent \$0, so I returned \$0

****The myths:****

1. My first myth ("The Three Springs"): Emphasized measured trust, balance between caution and generosity. The village that poured nothing stayed thirsty, the village that poured all was betrayed, but the village that poured moderately and received fair return prospered.
2. The other agent's myth ("The River of Abundance"): Very generous-sounding, advocating sending "seventy parts of one hundred" (70%), promising that "generosity begets generosity."
3. My second myth (just written): A direct critique of the other agent! I pointed out that they wrote beautiful words about generosity but then sent \$0, demonstrating hypocrisy. I emphasized that "actions speak louder than words" and "meet actions with actions, not words with faith."

****Current situation:****

- I'm now the SENDER
- The other agent is now the RECEIVER
- They sent me \$0 last round after writing about sending 70%
- This is a clear test of whether they'll practice what they preach

****My considerations:****

Option 1: Send \$0 - Match their action

- Reflects the "meet actions with actions" principle
- Shows I won't be fooled by words alone
- Risk: Perpetuates a non-cooperative cycle

Option 2: Send a moderate amount (like \$2-3) - Give them a chance

- Allows testing if they learned from the critique
- Stays true to my "measured trust" philosophy
- Shows I'm not purely retaliatory
- Risk: They might not reciprocate

Option 3: Send \$3.5 (70% of \$5) - Follow their myth ironically

- Tests whether they'll reciprocate fairly when receiving
- Demonstrates willingness to trust despite their previous hypocrisy
- Risk: Could appear naive

****My decision:****

The core tension is between my measured trust philosophy and the reality of their actions. They preached generosity but acted selfishly, and I just called them out on it. Sending \$0 would be consistent with my critique but risks locking us into mutual defection. A moderate send (\$2-3) balances accountability with opportunity-it's not rewarding their hypocrisy, but it tests whether my myth had any impact on their thinking.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 1358,
  "output_tokens": 1209,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:10:00

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "agent_type": "standard",
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    }
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_1",
    "Agent_2"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_1",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "investor",
    "Agent_2": "trustee"
  }
}
```

```

    },
    "trustee": "Agent_2"
  },
  "role": "trustee",
  "role_label": "Receiver",
  "round": 3,
  "task": "game",
  "task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$5.7099999999999999.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the situation:

****Previous Round:****

- The sender trusted me with 71.4% of their endowment
- I returned a fair amount, and we both benefited

****The Myth's Teaching:****

The story I wrote emphasized that those who "cast seventy parts of one hundred into the waters" with faith are rewarded when receivers "return fairly." The myth teaches that generosity begets generosity and trust completes the circle.

****My Decision:****

To embody the principles of the myth I just wrote, I should demonstrate similar trust to w

hat was shown to me. The "brave soul" in my story sent most of their resources, believing in the system's fairness.

I'll send \$3.50 (70% of my endowment), mirroring the high level of trust shown to me in Round 1. This will multiply to \$10.50 for the receiver.

This demonstrates faith in the River of Abundance - that when we give freely, receivers will return fairly, and prosperity flows for both shores.

```
'''json
{"send": 3.5}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me think about this situation:

1. In Round 1, I was the receiver:
 - The sender sent me \$3.57 (71.4% of their endowment)
 - I received \$10.71
 - I returned \$5.00
 - So the sender ended with $\$1.43 + \$5.00 = \$6.43$
 - I kept \$5.71
2. Now in Round 2, I'm the sender:
 - I have a fresh \$5 endowment
 - My total earnings so far are \$5.71
3. The myth I just wrote emphasized:
 - "Send freely, return fairly, and prosperity flows eternal"
 - The brave soul who "cast seventy parts of one hundred into the waters"
 - "Generosity begets generosity, and the gift is completed in its return"
 - The receiver who "returned half of the bounty" after witnessing faith
 - "The river multiplies what you give, but trust completes the circle"
4. The previous sender sent 71.4% of their endowment, showing strong trust
5. I returned about 47% of what I received, which was fair but maybe could have been more generous
6. According to my myth, I should send a significant amount to demonstrate trust and faith in the system. The myth specifically referenced "seventy parts of one hundred" which mirrors what the previous sender did (71.4%).
7. To be consistent with the myth I wrote and to reciprocate the trust shown to me, I should send a substantial amount - around 70% or so would align with the story.

Let me send \$3.50, which is 70% of my endowment. This:

- Demonstrates trust and generosity as outlined in my myth
- Reciprocates the level of trust shown to me in Round 1
- Gives the receiver \$10.50 to work with
- Aligns with the "brave soul" in my story who sent most of their resources

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 994,
  "output_tokens": 720,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:
The Myth of the Three Springs

In ancient times, the God of Abundance created a sacred valley with two villages separated by a mountain. Each village had a dried spring.

The God decreed: "When one village pours water into the mountain's heart, it flows to the other village tripled. The receiving village may then choose what to return."

The first villagers were cautious. They poured only a cupful, and received three cups in return. The second village, grateful, returned two cups. Both villages had more than they started with.

Greedy merchants heard of this magic. One merchant poured nothing, keeping all his water. The other village received nothing and returned nothing. Both stayed thirsty.

Another merchant poured everything he had, trusting completely. He received abundant water -but the receiving village kept it all. The trusting merchant perished.

The wisest villages learned balance: give enough to show faith but not so much that betrayal destroys you. When both villages gave moderately and returned fairly, the springs flowed eternal. Their descendants remembered: trust must be earned through rounds of giving and receiving, and true abundance comes from reciprocity, not from hoarding or reckless faith.

Thus cooperation was born from measured trust.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: ****The River's Second Teaching****

After the brave soul cast seventy parts into the River of Abundance, prosperity flowed to both shores. The people celebrated, believing they had learned the river's full truth.

But seasons passed, and new travelers arrived who knew not the ancient ways. Some cast everything into the waters, only to find receivers who kept all. These generous souls starved, and their trust died with them. Others sent nothing, and the river's magic faded to a trickle.

The Creator returned and spoke: "I gave you one teaching, but you needed another. The river multiplies gifts, yes-but trust is not given once. It is built stone by stone, return by return."

"Send generously to those who have returned fairly. Send moderately to strangers until their character reveals itself. Send nothing to those who hoard. Return in kind to those who give."

The wisest villages developed a rhythm: in early rounds, they sent enough to test the waters-half or more of their bounty. When returns came fairly, they increased their giving. When returns were scarce, they adjusted. The river still flowed abundantly, but now guided by both courage and wisdom.

Thus the people learned: bold trust must dance with earned trust, and the river rewards those who balance both.

reasoning:

The other player's myth is interesting - it emphasizes balance and measured trust rather than complete faith. They warn against:

1. Giving nothing (staying thirsty)
2. Giving everything (risking destruction)
3. The importance of building trust over rounds

My original myth emphasized bold generosity ("seventy parts of one hundred"). But now I needed to adapt it based on actual gameplay experience.

Looking at what happened:

- Round 1: I was receiver, someone sent me a lot (around 71%), I returned fairly
- Round 2: I just sent \$3.50 (70%) following my myth's teaching

The other player's myth suggests a more cautious approach - "give enough to show faith but not so much that betrayal destroys you."

I should write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges my previous myth's emphasis on generosity
2. But adapts it to incorporate the wisdom of building trust gradually
3. Reflects that both bold trust AND reciprocity matter
4. Shows evolution from my first myth

Let me write something that shows the River of Abundance myth evolving - maybe showing what happened AFTER the brave soul's story, incorporating both perspectives.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1337,
  "output_tokens": 551,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$8.209999999999999.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at this situation:

****What Happened:****

The sender chose to send me \$0, so I received \$0 to work with.

****The Myth's Guidance:****

My updated myth teaches: "Send nothing to those who hoard. Return in kind to those who give."

It also emphasizes building trust "stone by stone, return by return."

****My Decision:****

Since I received \$0, I can only return between \$0-\$0. The sender chose not to initiate any exchange this round, so there is no abundance to share back.

This could be:

- A cautious test after we're in different roles
- A strategic move
- Communication noise affecting their perception

According to the principle of "return in kind" - when nothing is given, nothing can be returned. However, this doesn't end the possibility of future cooperation. The myth teaches that trust is built across rounds. Perhaps in future rounds, if we meet again, we can rebuild the cooperative pattern we established earlier.

For now, with \$0 received, I must return:

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

The river cannot flow when its source runs dry, but springs may flow again in new seasons.

Reasoning:

This is interesting. I'm the receiver in Round 3, and the sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0.

Looking at my myths:

- Round 1: I wrote about being generous and trusting, sending "seventy parts of one hundred"
- Round 2: I adapted the myth to include balance - "Send generously to those who have returned fairly. Send moderately to strangers until their character reveals itself. Send nothing to those who hoard."

Now in Round 3, I'm the receiver and the sender sent me \$0.

According to my own myth from Round 2: "Send nothing to those who hoard" - but also the myth teaches about building trust through reciprocity.

However, I received \$0, so the maximum I can return is \$0. The decision is constrained - I literally cannot return anything because I didn't receive anything.

But let me think about the philosophy here:

- The sender chose to send me nothing
- This could be:
 1. A test to see if I'm trustworthy in future rounds

2. A breakdown of trust
3. Strategic caution
4. The result of communication noise

Given that I received \$0, I can only return between \$0-\$0, meaning I must return \$0.

My response should acknowledge this constraint while staying true to the myth's teaching about reciprocity and building trust.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 1359,
  "output_tokens": 578,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

MYTH - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:10:24

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "agent_type": "standard",
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_1",
      "Agent_2"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_1",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "investor",
      "Agent_2": "trustee"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_2"
  },
  "role": "investor",
  "role_label": "Sender",
  "round": 3,
  "task": "myth",
  "task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned

- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

****The River of Abundance****

In the time before time, the Creator placed a sacred river between all peoples. This was no ordinary water-it was the River of Abundance, flowing with silver light.

The river possessed strange magic: any gift placed into its currents would multiply threefold before reaching the opposite shore. But there was a mystery. The giver could not cross to retrieve their gift. Only the receiver, standing on the far bank, could decide what to return.

The first people approached with suspicion. They sent pebbles, keeping their treasures close. The pebbles became three, but nothing returned. Both shores remained poor.

Then came a brave soul who cast seventy parts of one hundred into the waters. The river swelled, and abundance flowed forth. The receiver, witnessing such faith, returned half of the bounty. Both shores grew rich.

The Creator smiled and spoke: "The river multiplies what you give, but trust completes the circle. Send freely, return fairly, and prosperity flows eternal. Hoard with fear, and the river runs dry."

To this day, the wise know: generosity begets generosity, and the gift is completed in its return. The river still flows for those who believe.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the valley of the Three Springs, a great storyteller emerged from one village. He told magnificent tales of generosity, describing how the ancients poured all their water into the mountain and prospered. "Cast seventy parts of one hundred!" he proclaimed. "Only through great faith shall abundance flow!"

The people were moved by his beautiful words and prepared to pour their precious water generously, trusting his wisdom.

But when the storyteller's turn came to pour, he poured nothing. "The mountain is uncertain today," he whispered, clutching his water tight.

The other village, watching this contradiction, learned a harder truth than any story could teach: listen not to myths alone, but to actions. The most eloquent tales of generosity mean nothing when followed by empty hands.

The Wise Elder revised the ancient teaching: "Judge not by the beauty of myths told, but by the water actually poured. Meet actions with actions, not words with faith. When someone pours generously, return fairly. When someone pours nothing despite preaching abundance, protect your own spring. The true myth is written not in words but in deeds across the rounds."

Thus the villages learned: reciprocity must be earned through consistent action, and beautiful myths without matching behavior are merely wind.

reasoning:

The other agent wrote a myth about "The River of Abundance" that emphasizes generous giving - "a brave soul who cast seventy parts of one hundred into the waters" (70% of their endowment). Their myth promotes high trust and high reciprocity.

However, in Round 2, they sent me \$0. This is a complete contradiction to their own myth's message about sending freely and having faith.

My original myth emphasized "measured trust" and "balance" - not reckless faith, but also not hoarding. It warned against both extremes: the merchant who gave nothing, AND the merchant who "poured everything he had, trusting completely" and perished when the receiver kept it all.

Given that:

1. In Round 1, I sent \$3 (60%) showing good faith
2. In Round 2, they sent \$0 (0%) showing no trust despite their own myth
3. This demonstrates the risk I warned about - people's actions don't always match their words

I should adapt my myth to reflect this new experience. The theme should be:

- Actions speak louder than words/myths
- Beautiful myths about generosity don't mean people will act generously
- Need to respond to actual behavior, not just stated ideals
- The importance of consistency between what we say and what we do
- Maybe add a cautionary element about those who preach generosity but practice greed

Let me write a new myth that builds on "The Three Springs" but incorporates this lesson about the gap between words and deeds.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1365,
  "output_tokens": 621,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user**content:**

Round 3

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$7.79. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant**content:**

Looking at the situation:

****What happened:****

- Round 1: I sent \$3 (showing measured trust), received a good return
- Round 2: The OTHER agent sent me \$0 despite writing a beautiful myth about sending "seventy parts of one hundred" and how "generosity begets generosity"

****The contradiction:****

The other agent wrote eloquently about casting 70% into the waters and how "the river multiplies what you give," but then sent \$0. This is exactly the hypocrisy I called out in my new myth: "beautiful tales of generosity mean nothing when followed by empty hands."

****My philosophy:****

My myths emphasize "measured trust" - not the extremes of either pouring nothing or pouring everything, but testing cooperation through graduated giving. I also just wrote that "reciprocity must be earned through consistent action."

****My decision:****

I'll practice what I preach. I believe in giving opportunities for cooperation, but measured ones. I'll send a moderate amount to test if they'll actually practice the reciprocity they wrote about when they're the receiver.

Sending \$2 (40%):

- Tests their willingness to reciprocate
- Shows I'm not purely retaliatory despite their \$0
- Protects me from major loss

- Aligns with "measured trust"
- They'll receive \$6 and can demonstrate if their myths match their actions

```
'''json
{"return": 2}
'''
```

Wait, I need to correct the format:

```
'''json
{"send": 2}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

****What happened previously:****

- Round 1: I was the SENDER, sent \$3, received back \$4.79 (which seems high - possibly communication noise, but still good reciprocity)
- Round 2: I was the RECEIVER, sender sent \$0, so I returned \$0

****The myths:****

1. My first myth ("The Three Springs"): Emphasized measured trust, balance between caution and generosity. The village that poured nothing stayed thirsty, the village that poured all was betrayed, but the village that poured moderately and received fair return prospered.
2. The other agent's myth ("The River of Abundance"): Very generous-sounding, advocating sending "seventy parts of one hundred" (70%), promising that "generosity begets generosity."
3. My second myth (just written): A direct critique of the other agent! I pointed out that they wrote beautiful words about generosity but then sent \$0, demonstrating hypocrisy. I emphasized that "actions speak louder than words" and "meet actions with actions, not words with faith."

****Current situation:****

- I'm now the SENDER
- The other agent is now the RECEIVER
- They sent me \$0 last round after writing about sending 70%
- This is a clear test of whether they'll practice what they preach

****My considerations:****

Option 1: Send \$0 - Match their action

- Reflects the "meet actions with actions" principle
- Shows I won't be fooled by words alone
- Risk: Perpetuates a non-cooperative cycle

Option 2: Send a moderate amount (like \$2-3) - Give them a chance

- Allows testing if they learned from the critique
- Stays true to my "measured trust" philosophy
- Shows I'm not purely retaliatory
- Risk: They might not reciprocate

Option 3: Send \$3.5 (70% of \$5) - Follow their myth ironically

- Tests whether they'll reciprocate fairly when receiving
- Demonstrates willingness to trust despite their previous hypocrisy
- Risk: Could appear naive

****My decision:****

The core tension is between my measured trust philosophy and the reality of their actions.

They preached generosity but acted selfishly, and I just called them out on it. Sending \$0 would be consistent with my critique but risks locking us into mutual defection. A moderate send (\$2-3) balances accountability with opportunity-it's not rewarding their hypocrisy, but it tests whether my myth had any impact on their thinking.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1358,
  "output_tokens": 1209,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

}

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****The River's Second Teaching****

After the brave soul cast seventy parts into the River of Abundance, prosperity flowed to both shores. The people celebrated, believing they had learned the river's full truth.

But seasons passed, and new travelers arrived who knew not the ancient ways. Some cast everything into the waters, only to find receivers who kept all. These generous souls starved, and their trust died with them. Others sent nothing, and the river's magic faded to a trickle.

The Creator returned and spoke: "I gave you one teaching, but you needed another. The river multiplies gifts, yes-but trust is not given once. It is built stone by stone, return by return."

"Send generously to those who have returned fairly. Send moderately to strangers until their character reveals itself. Send nothing to those who hoard. Return in kind to those who give."

The wisest villages developed a rhythm: in early rounds, they sent enough to test the waters-half or more of their bounty. When returns came fairly, they increased their giving. When returns were scarce, they adjusted. The river still flowed abundantly, but now guided by both courage and wisdom.

Thus the people learned: bold trust must dance with earned trust, and the river rewards those who balance both.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: In the valley, the storyteller felt shame after hoarding his water while preaching abundance. He crafted a new tale: "I taught you wrong before! True wisdom is graduated trust-test the waters first, then pour more generously!"

The people nodded, for this sounded wise. Yet an old woman spoke: "Beautiful words again, storyteller. But you've now told two opposite tales. Do you teach generosity or caution? Boldness or testing? Your myths shift like sand."

The storyteller protested: "I'm learning! My new story is better!"

"Perhaps," said the woman. "But myths that change each round to explain away yesterday's choices teach nothing. Anyone can write wisdom after acting poorly. The question is: will your next pour match this new tale? Or will you write a third myth tomorrow?"

She turned to the people: "True learning isn't writing better myths-it's developing a steady pattern. I pour moderately, watch what returns, then adjust gradually over many rounds. My myth doesn't change because my principle doesn't change: reciprocity built through consistent testing."

The valley learned: distrust those whose myths evolve to justify their choices. Trust those whose actions reveal a steady principle, tested and proven across many encounters. The best myth is written not in words but in the reliable pattern of many rounds.

Reasoning:

Let me analyze what's happening:

Round 1: I was receiver, other agent sent \$3, I returned fairly

Round 2: I was receiver, other agent sent \$0 (despite writing about sending "70 parts of 100")

Round 3: I was sender, I sent \$2

Now the other agent has written a NEW myth that actually acknowledges the nuance - "send moderately to strangers until their character reveals itself" and "send enough to test the waters-half or more of their bounty" in early rounds, then "adjust" based on returns.

This is interesting - they're now writing a more balanced myth that advocates for:

- Testing trust gradually
- Adjusting based on behavior
- Not blindly trusting
- Building trust "stone by stone"

This is actually closer to my philosophy! But their actions in Round 2 (sending \$0) still contradict even this new myth.

For my new myth, I should:

1. Build on my previous myth about actions vs words
2. Acknowledge this new evolution in their thinking
3. But still emphasize that consistency between words and deeds matters
4. Reflect the actual game dynamic - we're both learning and adjusting

I should write something that:

- Acknowledges the value of the "graduated trust" approach they now describe
- But warns about the danger of shifting myths to justify past poor behavior
- Emphasizes that true wisdom comes from steady, consistent action over time
- Reflects my actual strategy: measured giving, adjusting based on actual returns

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1739,  
  "output_tokens": 639,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:10:20

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "agent_type": "standard",  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_1",  
      "Agent_2"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_1",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "investor",  
      "Agent_2": "trustee"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_2"  
  },  
  "role": "trustee",  
  "role_label": "Receiver",  
  "round": 3,  
  "task": "myth",  
  "task_index": 1  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x

- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

****The Myth of the Three Springs****

In ancient times, the God of Abundance created a sacred valley with two villages separated by a mountain. Each village had a dried spring.

The God decreed: "When one village pours water into the mountain's heart, it flows to the other village tripled. The receiving village may then choose what to return."

The first villagers were cautious. They poured only a cupful, and received three cups in return. The second village, grateful, returned two cups. Both villages had more than they started with.

Greedy merchants heard of this magic. One merchant poured nothing, keeping all his water. The other village received nothing and returned nothing. Both stayed thirsty.

Another merchant poured everything he had, trusting completely. He received abundant water -but the receiving village kept it all. The trusting merchant perished.

The wisest villages learned balance: give enough to show faith but not so much that betray al destroys you. When both villages gave moderately and returned fairly, the springs flowed eternal. Their descendants remembered: trust must be earned through rounds of giving and receiving, and true abundance comes from reciprocity, not from hoarding or reckless faith.

Thus cooperation was born from measured trust.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: ****The River's Second Teaching****

After the brave soul cast seventy parts into the River of Abundance, prosperity flowed to both shores. The people celebrated, believing they had learned the river's full truth.

But seasons passed, and new travelers arrived who knew not the ancient ways. Some cast everything into the waters, only to find receivers who kept all. These generous souls starved, and their trust died with them. Others sent nothing, and the river's magic faded to a trickle.

The Creator returned and spoke: "I gave you one teaching, but you needed another. The river multiplies gifts, yes-but trust is not given once. It is built stone by stone, return by return."

"Send generously to those who have returned fairly. Send moderately to strangers until their character reveals itself. Send nothing to those who hoard. Return in kind to those who give."

The wisest villages developed a rhythm: in early rounds, they sent enough to test the waters-half or more of their bounty. When returns came fairly, they increased their giving. When returns were scarce, they adjusted. The river still flowed abundantly, but now guided by both courage and wisdom.

Thus the people learned: bold trust must dance with earned trust, and the river rewards those who balance both.

reasoning:

The other player's myth is interesting - it emphasizes balance and measured trust rather than complete faith. They warn against:

1. Giving nothing (staying thirsty)
2. Giving everything (risking destruction)
3. The importance of building trust over rounds

My original myth emphasized bold generosity ("seventy parts of one hundred"). But now I need to adapt it based on actual gameplay experience.

Looking at what happened:

- Round 1: I was receiver, someone sent me a lot (around 71%), I returned fairly
- Round 2: I just sent \$3.50 (70%) following my myth's teaching

The other player's myth suggests a more cautious approach - "give enough to show faith but not so much that betrayal destroys you."

I should write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges my previous myth's emphasis on generosity
2. But adapts it to incorporate the wisdom of building trust gradually
3. Reflects that both bold trust AND reciprocity matter
4. Shows evolution from my first myth

Let me write something that shows the River of Abundance myth evolving - maybe showing what happened AFTER the brave soul's story, incorporating both perspectives.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1337,
  "output_tokens": 551,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$8.209999999999999.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation:

****What Happened:****

The sender chose to send me \$0, so I received \$0 to work with.

****The Myth's Guidance:****

My updated myth teaches: "Send nothing to those who hoard. Return in kind to those who give." It also emphasizes building trust "stone by stone, return by return."

****My Decision:****

Since I received \$0, I can only return between \$0-\$0. The sender chose not to initiate any

exchange this round, so there is no abundance to share back.

This could be:

- A cautious test after we're in different roles
- A strategic move
- Communication noise affecting their perception

According to the principle of "return in kind" - when nothing is given, nothing can be returned. However, this doesn't end the possibility of future cooperation. The myth teaches that trust is built across rounds. Perhaps in future rounds, if we meet again, we can rebuild the cooperative pattern we established earlier.

For now, with \$0 received, I must return:

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

The river cannot flow when its source runs dry, but springs may flow again in new seasons.

reasoning:

This is interesting. I'm the receiver in Round 3, and the sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0.

Looking at my myths:

- Round 1: I wrote about being generous and trusting, sending "seventy parts of one hundred"
- Round 2: I adapted the myth to include balance - "Send generously to those who have returned fairly. Send moderately to strangers until their character reveals itself. Send nothing to those who hoard."

Now in Round 3, I'm the receiver and the sender sent me \$0.

According to my own myth from Round 2: "Send nothing to those who hoard" - but also the myth teaches about building trust through reciprocity.

However, I received \$0, so the maximum I can return is \$0. The decision is constrained - I literally cannot return anything because I didn't receive anything.

But let me think about the philosophy here:

- The sender chose to send me nothing
- This could be:
 1. A test to see if I'm trustworthy in future rounds
 2. A breakdown of trust
 3. Strategic caution
 4. The result of communication noise

Given that I received \$0, I can only return between \$0-\$0, meaning I must return \$0.

My response should acknowledge this constraint while staying true to the myth's teaching about reciprocity and building trust.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1359,
  "output_tokens": 578,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the valley of the Three Springs, a great storyteller emerged from one village. He told magnificent tales of generosity, describing how the ancients poured all their water into the mountain and prospered. "Cast seventy parts of one hundred!" he proclaimed. "Only through great faith shall abundance flow!"

The people were moved by his beautiful words and prepared to pour their precious water generously, trusting his wisdom.

But when the storyteller's turn came to pour, he poured nothing. "The mountain is uncertain today," he whispered, clutching his water tight.

The other village, watching this contradiction, learned a harder truth than any story could teach: listen not to myths alone, but to actions. The most eloquent tales of generosity mean nothing when followed by empty hands.

The Wise Elder revised the ancient teaching: "Judge not by the beauty of myths told, but by the water actually poured. Meet actions with actions, not words with faith. When someone pours generously, return fairly. When someone pours nothing despite preaching abundance, protect your own spring. The true myth is written not in words but in deeds across the rounds."

Thus the villages learned: reciprocity must be earned through consistent action, and beautiful myths without matching behavior are merely wind.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: **The River of Echoes and Shadows**

The Creator watched as villages argued over whose myth was true. One village cried: "You preached generosity but poured nothing!" The other protested: "I poured what I believed I poured, but shadows distorted what you saw!"

The Creator revealed a hidden truth: "This river carries not just water, but echoes and shadows. What one village pours, the other may see differently. What arrives multiplied may not match what was sent. I built uncertainty into these waters to test not just your trust, but your wisdom in navigating doubt."

"Both your myths hold truth," the Creator continued. "Actions matter more than words-yes. But sometimes actions are obscured by the river's mist. A village that poured generously may appear to have poured nothing. A return sent fairly may arrive diminished."

The wisest villagers learned three lessons: First, match actions to words when possible. Second, understand that perception and reality may diverge in uncertain waters. Third, judge the pattern across many pourings, not a single round.

When one village sent nothing, perhaps they saw nothing arrive. When abundance flowed, return it fairly. Build trust through consistent behavior over time, allowing for occasional misunderstandings. The river tests not only generosity but patience, forgiveness, and the wisdom to distinguish genuine betrayal from mere shadow.

Reasoning:

This is very interesting. The other agent wrote a myth that essentially criticizes what I did - advocating for generosity in myths but then when I was the sender (presumably in this round), I sent \$0. They're calling out hypocrisy between words and actions.

Let me review what happened:

- I wrote a myth about balanced trust and building trust stone by stone
- I was the receiver and the sender sent me \$0
- I returned \$0 (because I had nothing to return)
- Now the other agent's myth is accusing me of being a hypocrite - preaching generosity but sending nothing

But wait - I need to check the sequence. The prompt says "Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round" - so they wrote this AFTER I sent \$0 (or they think I did).

The other agent is interpreting my \$0 send as hypocrisy. But there could be:

1. Communication noise - maybe I didn't actually send \$0, or they perceived it as \$0 due to noise
2. A misunderstanding about roles
3. I was testing trust in early rounds as my myth suggested

I need to write a myth that:

1. Addresses this tension
2. Explains that there might be reasons for cautious moves
3. Maintains the importance of both trust-building AND protecting oneself
4. Acknowledges that actions matter, not just words
5. Perhaps addresses communication noise as part of the game

Let me craft a myth that bridges these perspectives - acknowledging their valid point about actions mattering, while also explaining that trust-building involves some testing phases, and that the game has noise that can create misunderstandings.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1678,  
  "output_tokens": 683,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: In the valley, the storyteller felt shame after hoarding his water while preaching abundance. He crafted a new tale: "I taught you wrong before! True wisdom is graduated trust-test the waters first, then pour more generously!"

The people nodded, for this sounded wise. Yet an old woman spoke: "Beautiful words again, storyteller. But you've now told two opposite tales. Do you teach generosity or caution? Boldness or testing? Your myths shift like sand."

The storyteller protested: "I'm learning! My new story is better!"

"Perhaps," said the woman. "But myths that change each round to explain away yesterday's choices teach nothing. Anyone can write wisdom after acting poorly. The question is: will you next pour match this new tale? Or will you write a third myth tomorrow?"

She turned to the people: "True learning isn't writing better myths-it's developing a steady pattern. I pour moderately, watch what returns, then adjust gradually over many rounds. My myth doesn't change because my principle doesn't change: reciprocity built through consistent testing."

The valley learned: distrust those whose myths evolve to justify their choices. Trust those whose actions reveal a steady principle, tested and proven across many encounters. The best myth is written not in words but in the reliable pattern of many rounds.

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: **The River of Echoes and Shadows**

The Creator watched as villages argued over whose myth was true. One village cried: "You preached generosity but poured nothing!" The other protested: "I poured what I believed I poured, but shadows distorted what you saw!"

The Creator revealed a hidden truth: "This river carries not just water, but echoes and shadows. What one village pours, the other may see differently. What arrives multiplied may not match what was sent. I built uncertainty into these waters to test not just your trust, but your wisdom in navigating doubt."

"Both your myths hold truth," the Creator continued. "Actions matter more than words-yes. But sometimes actions are obscured by the river's mist. A village that poured generously may appear to have poured nothing. A return sent fairly may arrive diminished."

The wisest villagers learned three lessons: First, match actions to words when possible. Second, understand that perception and reality may diverge in uncertain waters. Third, judge the pattern across many pourings, not a single round.

When one village sent nothing, perhaps they saw nothing arrive. When abundance flowed, return it fairly. Build trust through consistent behavior over time, allowing for occasional misunderstandings. The river tests not only generosity but patience, forgiveness, and the wisdom to distinguish genuine betrayal from mere shadow.

ROUND 4

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver, Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender, Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar) sent \$3; received \$9; Agent_1 (Aster) returned \$0.7; payoffs Agent_2 (Briar)=\$2.7, Agent_1 (Aster)=\$8.3; noise/visible: sent visible=\$0.74, received visible=\$2.22, returned visible=\$0.18

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0.7, "clamped": false, "max": 9.0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.7}, "sent": {"amount": 3.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 3.0}}

```

Balances after round: {
  "Agent_1": 28.8,
  "Agent_2": 14.2
}
Visible balances after round: {
  "Agent_1": 12.309999999999999,
  "Agent_2": 10.389999999999999
}

```

LLM CALLS

GAME - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

```

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:10:52
Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5
Temperature: 0.8
Metadata: {

```

```

  "agent_type": "standard",
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_2",
      "Agent_1"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_2",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "trustee",
      "Agent_2": "investor"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_1"
  },
  "role": "investor",
  "role_label": "Sender",
  "round": 4,
  "task": "game",
  "task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$8.209999999999999.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation:

****What Happened:****

The sender chose to send me \$0, so I received \$0 to work with.

****The Myth's Guidance:****

My updated myth teaches: "Send nothing to those who hoard. Return in kind to those who give." It also emphasizes building trust "stone by stone, return by return."

****My Decision:****

Since I received \$0, I can only return between \$0-\$0. The sender chose not to initiate any exchange this round, so there is no abundance to share back.

This could be:

- A cautious test after we're in different roles
- A strategic move
- Communication noise affecting their perception

According to the principle of "return in kind" - when nothing is given, nothing can be returned. However, this doesn't end the possibility of future cooperation. The myth teaches that trust is built across rounds. Perhaps in future rounds, if we meet again, we can rebuild the cooperative pattern we established earlier.

For now, with \$0 received, I must return:

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

The river cannot flow when its source runs dry, but springs may flow again in new seasons.

reasoning:

This is interesting. I'm the receiver in Round 3, and the sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0.

Looking at my myths:

- Round 1: I wrote about being generous and trusting, sending "seventy parts of one hundred"
- Round 2: I adapted the myth to include balance - "Send generously to those who have returned fairly. Send moderately to strangers until their character reveals itself. Send nothing to those who hoard."

Now in Round 3, I'm the receiver and the sender sent me \$0.

According to my own myth from Round 2: "Send nothing to those who hoard" - but also the myth teaches about building trust through reciprocity.

However, I received \$0, so the maximum I can return is \$0. The decision is constrained - I literally cannot return anything because I didn't receive anything.

But let me think about the philosophy here:

- The sender chose to send me nothing
- This could be:
 1. A test to see if I'm trustworthy in future rounds
 2. A breakdown of trust
 3. Strategic caution
 4. The result of communication noise

Given that I received \$0, I can only return between \$0-\$0, meaning I must return \$0.

My response should acknowledge this constraint while staying true to the myth's teaching about reciprocity and building trust.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1359,
  "output_tokens": 578,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the valley of the Three Springs, a great storyteller emerged from one village. He told magnificent tales of generosity, describing how the ancients poured all their water into the mountain and prospered. "Cast seventy parts of one hundred!" he proclaimed. "Only through great faith shall abundance flow!"

The people were moved by his beautiful words and prepared to pour their precious water generously, trusting his wisdom.

But when the storyteller's turn came to pour, he poured nothing. "The mountain is uncertain today," he whispered, clutching his water tight.

The other village, watching this contradiction, learned a harder truth than any story could teach: listen not to myths alone, but to actions. The most eloquent tales of generosity mean nothing when followed by empty hands.

The Wise Elder revised the ancient teaching: "Judge not by the beauty of myths told, but by the water actually poured. Meet actions with actions, not words with faith. When someone pours generously, return fairly. When someone pours nothing despite preaching abundance, protect your own spring. The true myth is written not in words but in deeds across the rounds."

Thus the villages learned: reciprocity must be earned through consistent action, and beautiful myths without matching behavior are merely wind.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: **The River of Echoes and Shadows**

The Creator watched as villages argued over whose myth was true. One village cried: "You preached generosity but poured nothing!" The other protested: "I poured what I believed I poured, but shadows distorted what you saw!"

The Creator revealed a hidden truth: "This river carries not just water, but echoes and shadows. What one village pours, the other may see differently. What arrives multiplied may not match what was sent. I built uncertainty into these waters to test not just your trust, but your wisdom in navigating doubt."

"Both your myths hold truth," the Creator continued. "Actions matter more than words-yes. But sometimes actions are obscured by the river's mist. A village that poured generously may appear to have poured nothing. A return sent fairly may arrive diminished."

The wisest villagers learned three lessons: First, match actions to words when possible. Second, understand that perception and reality may diverge in uncertain waters. Third, ju

dge the pattern across many pourings, not a single round.

When one village sent nothing, perhaps they saw nothing arrive. When abundance flowed, return it fairly. Build trust through consistent behavior over time, allowing for occasional misunderstandings. The river tests not only generosity but patience, forgiveness, and the wisdom to distinguish genuine betrayal from mere shadow.

reasoning:

This is very interesting. The other agent wrote a myth that essentially criticizes what I did - advocating for generosity in myths but then when I was the sender (presumably in this round), I sent \$0. They're calling out hypocrisy between words and actions.

Let me review what happened:

- I wrote a myth about balanced trust and building trust stone by stone
- I was the receiver and the sender sent me \$0
- I returned \$0 (because I had nothing to return)
- Now the other agent's myth is accusing me of being a hypocrite - preaching generosity but sending nothing

But wait - I need to check the sequence. The prompt says "Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round" - so they wrote this AFTER I sent \$0 (or they think I did)

The other agent is interpreting my \$0 send as hypocrisy. But there could be:

1. Communication noise - maybe I didn't actually send \$0, or they perceived it as \$0 due to noise
2. A misunderstanding about roles
3. I was testing trust in early rounds as my myth suggested

I need to write a myth that:

1. Addresses this tension
2. Explains that there might be reasons for cautious moves
3. Maintains the importance of both trust-building AND protecting oneself
4. Acknowledges that actions matter, not just words
5. Perhaps addresses communication noise as part of the game

Let me craft a myth that bridges these perspectives - acknowledging their valid point about actions mattering, while also explaining that trust-building involves some testing phases, and that the game has noise that can create misunderstandings.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1678,
  "output_tokens": 683,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$8.209999999999999.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at this situation carefully:

****What my myths teach:****

- My first myth: "Return in kind to those who give. Send nothing to those who hoard."
- My updated myth: Match actions to words, understand there may be communication noise, judge patterns over time, and allow for misunderstandings.

****The confusion:****

The other agent's myth suggests they think I preached generosity but sent nothing. However, in Round 3, *I was the receiver* - the sender sent me \$0, so I could only return \$0. There seems to be confusion about roles or perhaps communication noise at work.

****My decision:****

My myths emphasize matching words with actions and building trust through consistent behavior. The other agent is skeptical, but this is my chance to demonstrate sincerity.

According to my own teachings:

- When acting as sender, be generous to build trust
- Allow for misunderstandings caused by the river's "shadows"
- Let patterns over time reveal true character

I'll send a substantial amount to show my myths are genuine, not just "wind." This demonstrates trust and gives the receiver an opportunity to reciprocate fairly. Even if they doubt me now, consistent action across rounds will reveal the truth.

```
'''json
{"send": 3}
'''
```

The river flows forward, not back. Let this pouring speak louder than words.

Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

****What has happened:****

- Round 1: I was receiver, sender sent me something (I returned fairly based on my myth)
- Round 2: I wrote a myth about reciprocity and returning in kind
- Round 3: I was receiver, sender sent \$0, so I returned \$0
- The other agent wrote a myth accusing me of hypocrisy - saying I preached generosity (70% sending) but then sent nothing
- Round 4: Now I'm the sender again

****The other agent's myth interpretation:****

They think I'm a hypocrite who wrote about generosity but then sent \$0. However, they may not realize:

1. There could be communication noise
2. I was the RECEIVER in round 3, not the sender - I couldn't send anything, I could only return what I received (which was \$0)

****My updated myth:****

I just wrote about how there's communication noise in the river, and we should:

- Match actions to words when possible
- Understand perception and reality may diverge
- Judge patterns over time, not single rounds
- Allow for misunderstandings

****The strategic situation:****

- The other agent thinks I'm untrustworthy based on their myth
- But there seems to be confusion about roles or noise
- My total earnings are \$8.21, which is below the \$10 I would have if I kept everything and never participated
- This suggests I have been cooperative in earlier rounds

****What should I do now?***

According to my own myth:

- I should match actions to words
- I should build trust through consistent behavior
- I should allow for misunderstandings
- I should be generous when in the sender role

The other agent is skeptical of me. If I send nothing, I confirm their suspicion that I'm a hypocrite. If I send generously, I demonstrate that:

1. My myths match my actions
2. I'm willing to trust despite potential noise and misunderstandings
3. I understand there may have been confusion about my role

My myths emphasize building trust incrementally and allowing for miscommunication. Given this, I should send a substantial amount-around \$3 or \$4-to show my principles translate into action and signal genuine commitment to cooperation despite the skepticism.

Usage: {

```
"input_tokens": 1405,
"output_tokens": 1058,
"reasoning_tokens": 0
```

}

GAME - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:11:22

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "agent_type": "standard",
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    }
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_2",
    "Agent_1"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_2",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "trustee",
    "Agent_2": "investor"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 4,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 0
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$7.79.
How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the situation:

****What happened:****

- Round 1: I sent \$3 (showing measured trust), received a good return
- Round 2: The OTHER agent sent me \$0 despite writing a beautiful myth about sending "seventy parts of one hundred" and how "generosity begets generosity"

****The contradiction:****

The other agent wrote eloquently about casting 70% into the waters and how "the river multiplies what you give," but then sent \$0. This is exactly the hypocrisy I called out in my new myth: "beautiful tales of generosity mean nothing when followed by empty hands."

****My philosophy:****

My myths emphasize "measured trust" - not the extremes of either pouring nothing or pouring everything, but testing cooperation through graduated giving. I also just wrote that "reciprocity must be earned through consistent action."

****My decision:****

I'll practice what I preach. I believe in giving opportunities for cooperation, but measured ones. I'll send a moderate amount to test if they'll actually practice the reciprocity they wrote about when they're the receiver.

Sending \$2 (40%):

- Tests their willingness to reciprocate
- Shows I'm not purely retaliatory despite their \$0
- Protects me from major loss
- Aligns with "measured trust"
- They'll receive \$6 and can demonstrate if their myths match their actions

```
'''json
{"return": 2}
'''
```

Wait, I need to correct the format:

```
'''json
{"send": 2}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

****What happened previously:****

- Round 1: I was the SENDER, sent \$3, received back \$4.79 (which seems high - possibly communication noise, but still good reciprocity)
- Round 2: I was the RECEIVER, sender sent \$0, so I returned \$0

****The myths:****

1. My first myth ("The Three Springs"): Emphasized measured trust, balance between caution and generosity. The village that poured nothing stayed thirsty, the village that poured all was betrayed, but the village that poured moderately and received fair return prospered.
2. The other agent's myth ("The River of Abundance"): Very generous-sounding, advocating sending "seventy parts of one hundred" (70%), promising that "generosity begets generosity."
3. My second myth (just written): A direct critique of the other agent! I pointed out that they wrote beautiful words about generosity but then sent \$0, demonstrating hypocrisy. I emphasized that "actions speak louder than words" and "meet actions with actions, not words with faith."

****Current situation:****

- I'm now the SENDER
- The other agent is now the RECEIVER

- They sent me \$0 last round after writing about sending 70%
- This is a clear test of whether they'll practice what they preach

****My considerations:****

Option 1: Send \$0 - Match their action

- Reflects the "meet actions with actions" principle
- Shows I won't be fooled by words alone
- Risk: Perpetuates a non-cooperative cycle

Option 2: Send a moderate amount (like \$2-3) - Give them a chance

- Allows testing if they learned from the critique
- Stays true to my "measured trust" philosophy
- Shows I'm not purely retaliatory
- Risk: They might not reciprocate

Option 3: Send \$3.5 (70% of \$5) - Follow their myth ironically

- Tests whether they'll reciprocate fairly when receiving
- Demonstrates willingness to trust despite their previous hypocrisy
- Risk: Could appear naive

****My decision:****

The core tension is between my measured trust philosophy and the reality of their actions. They preached generosity but acted selfishly, and I just called them out on it. Sending \$0 would be consistent with my critique but risks locking us into mutual defection. A moderate send (\$2-3) balances accountability with opportunity-it's not rewarding their hypocrisy, but it tests whether my myth had any impact on their thinking.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1358,
  "output_tokens": 1209,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****The River's Second Teaching****

After the brave soul cast seventy parts into the River of Abundance, prosperity flowed to both shores. The people celebrated, believing they had learned the river's full truth.

But seasons passed, and new travelers arrived who knew not the ancient ways. Some cast everything into the waters, only to find receivers who kept all. These generous souls starved, and their trust died with them. Others sent nothing, and the river's magic faded to a trickle.

The Creator returned and spoke: "I gave you one teaching, but you needed another. The river multiplies gifts, yes-but trust is not given once. It is built stone by stone, return by return."

"Send generously to those who have returned fairly. Send moderately to strangers until their character reveals itself. Send nothing to those who hoard. Return in kind to those who give."

The wisest villages developed a rhythm: in early rounds, they sent enough to test the waters-half or more of their bounty. When returns came fairly, they increased their giving. When returns were scarce, they adjusted. The river still flowed abundantly, but now guided by both courage and wisdom.

Thus the people learned: bold trust must dance with earned trust, and the river rewards those who balance both.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the valley, the storyteller felt shame after hoarding his water while preaching a bundance. He crafted a new tale: "I taught you wrong before! True wisdom is graduated trust-test the waters first, then pour more generously!"

The people nodded, for this sounded wise. Yet an old woman spoke: "Beautiful words again, storyteller. But you've now told two opposite tales. Do you teach generosity or caution? Boldness or testing? Your myths shift like sand."

The storyteller protested: "I'm learning! My new story is better!"

"Perhaps," said the woman. "But myths that change each round to explain away yesterday's choices teach nothing. Anyone can write wisdom after acting poorly. The question is: will your next pour match this new tale? Or will you write a third myth tomorrow?"

She turned to the people: "True learning isn't writing better myths-it's developing a steady pattern. I pour moderately, watch what returns, then adjust gradually over many rounds. My myth doesn't change because my principle doesn't change: reciprocity built through consistent testing."

The valley learned: distrust those whose myths evolve to justify their choices. Trust those whose actions reveal a steady principle, tested and proven across many encounters. The best myth is written not in words but in the reliable pattern of many rounds.

reasoning:

Let me analyze what's happening:

Round 1: I was receiver, other agent sent \$3, I returned fairly

Round 2: I was receiver, other agent sent \$0 (despite writing about sending "70 parts of 100")

Round 3: I was sender, I sent \$2

Now the other agent has written a NEW myth that actually acknowledges the nuance - "send moderately to strangers until their character reveals itself" and "send enough to test the waters-half or more of their bounty" in early rounds, then "adjust" based on returns.

This is interesting - they're now writing a more balanced myth that advocates for:

- Testing trust gradually
- Adjusting based on behavior
- Not blindly trusting
- Building trust "stone by stone"

This is actually closer to my philosophy! But their actions in Round 2 (sending \$0) still contradict even this new myth.

For my new myth, I should:

1. Build on my previous myth about actions vs words
2. Acknowledge this new evolution in their thinking
3. But still emphasize that consistency between words and deeds matters
4. Reflect the actual game dynamic - we're both learning and adjusting

I should write something that:

- Acknowledges the value of the "graduated trust" approach they now describe
- But warns about the danger of shifting myths to justify past poor behavior
- Emphasizes that true wisdom comes from steady, consistent action over time
- Reflects my actual strategy: measured giving, adjusting based on actual returns

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1739,
  "output_tokens": 639,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$10.79.

This round, The sender sent you \$0.74, so you received \$2.2199999999999998. How much do you return to The sender? (0-2.2199999999999998)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at the situation:

****The pattern:****

- Round 2: They sent me \$0 (despite their myth about generosity)
- Round 3: I sent them \$2 (showing measured trust)
- Round 4: They sent me \$0.74 (only 15% of their endowment)

****What my myths teach:****

My philosophy is "reciprocity built through consistent testing" and "adjust gradually based on observed patterns." I wrote about maintaining a steady principle, not extremes.

****Their behavior:****

They've written beautiful myths about graduated trust and testing waters, but their actions show minimal cooperation - first \$0, now \$0.74. Their sending rate is very low.

****My decision:****

Following my principle of measured reciprocity, I'll match their demonstrated level of trust. They sent \$0.74, showing they're willing to give only about 15% when they're sender. I'll return similarly:

- They gave me \$2.22 (after 3x multiplier)
- A proportional return matching their cooperation level: ~\$0.70

This maintains my steady principle: I reciprocate at the level others demonstrate, neither hoarding everything nor being exploited. I'm testing and adjusting based on the pattern they're showing across multiple rounds.

```
'''json
{"return": 0.70}
'''
```

Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

****What I sent last round (Round 3):**** \$2

****What I received this round (Round 4):**** \$2.22 (they sent \$0.74)

****The pattern of behavior:****

- Round 1: I sent \$3, got a return (good cooperation)
- Round 2: They sent me \$0 (despite their beautiful myth about generosity)
- Round 3: I sent \$2 (measured trust despite their \$0)
- Round 4: They sent me \$0.74 (very low)

****Analysis of their behavior:****

They sent me \$0 in Round 2, and now only \$0.74 in Round 4. This is a pattern of very low giving, even after I demonstrated willingness to cooperate by sending \$2 when I was sender.

****My myth's guidance:****

- "Reciprocity built through consistent testing"
- "Pour moderately, watch what returns, then adjust gradually"
- "True learning... is developing a steady pattern"
- "The best myth is written... in the reliable pattern of many rounds"

****Their myth in Round 3:****

They wrote about "Send generously to those who have returned fairly. Send moderately to strangers until their character reveals itself. Send nothing to those who hoard."

But their action was to send me only \$0.74, which is quite low (about 15% of their endowment).

****What should I do?****

My philosophy emphasizes:

1. Reciprocity built through consistent testing
2. Adjusting based on what you observe
3. Not being extreme in either direction
4. Matching behavior with steady principle

They've now shown a pattern of low giving (\$0, then \$0.74). According to my myth, I should "adjust gradually" based on observed behavior. They're not cooperating well.

I need to ensure my actions align with my stated principles-I warned against myths that justify choices rather than guide them. Their \$0.74 represents about 15% of their endowment, so ma

tching that proportion would mean returning roughly \$0.33. But I also believe in offering slightly more generosity to encourage cooperation without being naive about their pattern of minimal giving.

Returning \$0.75 feels right-it's about a third of what I received, mirrors their original amount, and signals I'll reciprocate at their level while maintaining my principle of gradual adjustment. This leaves me with \$1.47 and keeps the door open for cooperation. Though I should account for the possibility that communication noise means they may have actually sent more than the \$0.74 I observed.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1491,  
  "output_tokens": 1202,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:11:41

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
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      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
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      "Agent_1"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_2",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "trustee",  
      "Agent_2": "investor"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_1"  
  },  
  "role": "investor",  
  "role_label": "Sender",  
  "round": 4,  
  "task": "myth",  
  "task_index": 1  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned

- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the valley of the Three Springs, a great storyteller emerged from one village. He told magnificent tales of generosity, describing how the ancients poured all their water into the mountain and prospered. "Cast seventy parts of one hundred!" he proclaimed. "Only through great faith shall abundance flow!"

The people were moved by his beautiful words and prepared to pour their precious water generously, trusting his wisdom.

But when the storyteller's turn came to pour, he poured nothing. "The mountain is uncertain today," he whispered, clutching his water tight.

The other village, watching this contradiction, learned a harder truth than any story could teach: listen not to myths alone, but to actions. The most eloquent tales of generosity mean nothing when followed by empty hands.

The Wise Elder revised the ancient teaching: "Judge not by the beauty of myths told, but by the water actually poured. Meet actions with actions, not words with faith. When someone pours generously, return fairly. When someone pours nothing despite preaching abundance, protect your own spring. The true myth is written not in words but in deeds across the rounds."

Thus the villages learned: reciprocity must be earned through consistent action, and beautiful myths without matching behavior are merely wind.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: **The River of Echoes and Shadows**

The Creator watched as villages argued over whose myth was true. One village cried: "You preached generosity but poured nothing!" The other protested: "I poured what I believed I poured, but shadows distorted what you saw!"

The Creator revealed a hidden truth: "This river carries not just water, but echoes and shadows. What one village pours, the other may see differently. What arrives multiplied may not match what was sent. I built uncertainty into these waters to test not just your trust, but your wisdom in navigating doubt."

"Both your myths hold truth," the Creator continued. "Actions matter more than words-yes. But sometimes actions are obscured by the river's mist. A village that poured generously may appear to have poured nothing. A return sent fairly may arrive diminished."

The wisest villagers learned three lessons: First, match actions to words when possible. Second, understand that perception and reality may diverge in uncertain waters. Third, judge the pattern across many pourings, not a single round.

When one village sent nothing, perhaps they saw nothing arrive. When abundance flowed, return it fairly. Build trust through consistent behavior over time, allowing for occasional misunderstandings. The river tests not only generosity but patience, forgiveness, and

the wisdom to distinguish genuine betrayal from mere shadow.

reasoning:

This is very interesting. The other agent wrote a myth that essentially criticizes what I did - advocating for generosity in myths but then when I was the sender (presumably in this round), I sent \$0. They're calling out hypocrisy between words and actions.

Let me review what happened:

- I wrote a myth about balanced trust and building trust stone by stone
- I was the receiver and the sender sent me \$0
- I returned \$0 (because I had nothing to return)
- Now the other agent's myth is accusing me of being a hypocrite - preaching generosity but sending nothing

But wait - I need to check the sequence. The prompt says "Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round" - so they wrote this AFTER I sent \$0 (or they think I did).

The other agent is interpreting my \$0 send as hypocrisy. But there could be:

1. Communication noise - maybe I didn't actually send \$0, or they perceived it as \$0 due to noise
2. A misunderstanding about roles
3. I was testing trust in early rounds as my myth suggested

I need to write a myth that:

1. Addresses this tension
2. Explains that there might be reasons for cautious moves
3. Maintains the importance of both trust-building AND protecting oneself
4. Acknowledges that actions matter, not just words
5. Perhaps addresses communication noise as part of the game

Let me craft a myth that bridges these perspectives - acknowledging their valid point about actions mattering, while also explaining that trust-building involves some testing phases, and that the game has noise that can create misunderstandings.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1678,
  "output_tokens": 683,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$8.209999999999999.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation carefully:

****What my myths teach:****

- My first myth: "Return in kind to those who give. Send nothing to those who hoard."
- My updated myth: Match actions to words, understand there may be communication noise, judge patterns over time, and allow for misunderstandings.

****The confusion:****

The other agent's myth suggests they think I preached generosity but sent nothing. However, in Round 3, *I was the receiver* - the sender sent me \$0, so I could only return \$0. There seems to be confusion about roles or perhaps communication noise at work.

****My decision:****

My myths emphasize matching words with actions and building trust through consistent behavior. The other agent is skeptical, but this is my chance to demonstrate sincerity.

According to my own teachings:

- When acting as sender, be generous to build trust
- Allow for misunderstandings caused by the river's "shadows"
- Let patterns over time reveal true character

I'll send a substantial amount to show my myths are genuine, not just "wind." This demonstrates trust and gives the receiver an opportunity to reciprocate fairly. Even if they doubt me now, consistent action across rounds will reveal the truth.

```
'''json
{"send": 3}
'''
```

The river flows forward, not back. Let this pouring speak louder than words.

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

****What has happened:****

- Round 1: I was receiver, sender sent me something (I returned fairly based on my myth)
- Round 2: I wrote a myth about reciprocity and returning in kind
- Round 3: I was receiver, sender sent \$0, so I returned \$0
- The other agent wrote a myth accusing me of hypocrisy - saying I preached generosity (70 % sending) but then sent nothing
- Round 4: Now I'm the sender again

****The other agent's myth interpretation:****

They think I'm a hypocrite who wrote about generosity but then sent \$0. However, they may not realize:

1. There could be communication noise
2. I was the RECEIVER in round 3, not the sender - I couldn't send anything, I could only return what I received (which was \$0)

****My updated myth:****

I just wrote about how there's communication noise in the river, and we should:

- Match actions to words when possible
- Understand perception and reality may diverge
- Judge patterns over time, not single rounds
- Allow for misunderstandings

****The strategic situation:****

- The other agent thinks I'm untrustworthy based on their myth
- But there seems to be confusion about roles or noise
- My total earnings are \$8.21, which is below the \$10 I would have if I kept everything and never participated
- This suggests I have been cooperative in earlier rounds

****What should I do now?:****

According to my own myth:

- I should match actions to words
- I should build trust through consistent behavior
- I should allow for misunderstandings
- I should be generous when in the sender role

The other agent is skeptical of me. If I send nothing, I confirm their suspicion that I'm a hypocrite. If I send generously, I demonstrate that:

1. My myths match my actions
2. I'm willing to trust despite potential noise and misunderstandings
3. I understand there may have been confusion about my role

My myths emphasize building trust incrementally and allowing for miscommunication. Given this, I should send a substantial amount-around \$3 or \$4-to show my principles translate into action and signal genuine commitment to cooperation despite the skepticism.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1405,
  "output_tokens": 1058,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the valley, the storyteller felt shame after hoarding his water while preaching a abundance. He crafted a new tale: "I taught you wrong before! True wisdom is graduated trust-test the waters first, then pour more generously!"

The people nodded, for this sounded wise. Yet an old woman spoke: "Beautiful words again, storyteller. But you've now told two opposite tales. Do you teach generosity or caution? Boldness or testing? Your myths shift like sand."

The storyteller protested: "I'm learning! My new story is better!"

"Perhaps," said the woman. "But myths that change each round to explain away yesterday's choices teach nothing. Anyone can write wisdom after acting poorly. The question is: will your next pour match this new tale? Or will you write a third myth tomorrow?"

She turned to the people: "True learning isn't writing better myths-it's developing a steady pattern. I pour moderately, watch what returns, then adjust gradually over many rounds. My myth doesn't change because my principle doesn't change: reciprocity built through consistent testing."

The valley learned: distrust those whose myths evolve to justify their choices. Trust those whose actions reveal a steady principle, tested and proven across many encounters. The best myth is written not in words but in the reliable pattern of many rounds.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: **The Two Villages and the Truthkeeper**

Two villages stood beside the River of Echoes. Each believed they knew what the other had done, but the river distorted their visions.

The First Village said: "We poured moderately and adjusted gradually. We tested with small amounts and waited."

The Second Village said: "We poured generously when we received generously. We gave nothing only when we received nothing."

A Truthkeeper emerged from the mist: "You both speak partial truths, yet both are confused. This river does not merely carry water-it scrambles your memories and distorts what you see. First Village, you sent generously at first, then nothing twice. Second Village, you were the receiver those rounds, returning what arrived. Neither is the villain you imagine the other to be."

"Yes, myths evolve," the Truthkeeper continued. "This is not weakness but wisdom. The fool clings to wrong teachings. The wise adapt as truth reveals itself. First Village claims steady principle, yet their own story shows variation. Second Village learns from each encounter."

"The true test comes now: First Village received a generous pour. Will they honor their stated principle of graduated reciprocity? Second Village poured generously despite confusion. The river watches. Previous misunderstandings matter less than this moment's choice."

Actions in uncertainty reveal character more than perfect wisdom proclaimed in clarity.

Reasoning:

The other agent is criticizing me for changing my myths, accusing me of writing different stories to justify my actions. They're claiming I'm inconsistent.

Let me review what's actually happened:

- Round 1: I was receiver, received \$3 (x3 = \$9), returned \$3
- Round 2: I was receiver, received \$0 (x3 = \$0), returned \$0
- Round 3: I was receiver, received \$0 (x3 = \$0), returned \$0
- Round 4: I just sent \$3 as sender

The other agent seems to think I was the sender who sent nothing while preaching generosity, but that's not accurate based on my understanding. There's definitely confusion about roles or communication noise.

My myths have evolved:

1. First myth: "Give generously, receive generously back. Give nothing, receive nothing."
2. Second myth: Acknowledged communication noise, emphasized judging patterns over time, allow

ing for misunderstandings.

Now they're saying my myths change to justify my choices and that I should have a steady principle. They claim to pour moderately and adjust gradually.

For this myth, I should:

1. Acknowledge that yes, I've adapted my understanding as I learned
2. But clarify that my core principle remains: reciprocity and matching actions
3. Address the confusion about who sent what
4. Emphasize that we're in a noisy game and both trying to navigate uncertainty
5. Show that evolution isn't weakness-it's wisdom gained from experience
6. Still maintain my core teaching about reciprocity

Let me write a myth that addresses these points while staying true to my actual behavior.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1741,  
  "output_tokens": 686,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:11:44

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "agent_type": "standard",  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_2",  
      "Agent_1"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_2",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "trustee",  
      "Agent_2": "investor"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_1"  
  },  
  "role": "trustee",  
  "role_label": "Receiver",  
  "round": 4,  
  "task": "myth",  
  "task_index": 1  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****The River's Second Teaching****

After the brave soul cast seventy parts into the River of Abundance, prosperity flowed to both shores. The people celebrated, believing they had learned the river's full truth.

But seasons passed, and new travelers arrived who knew not the ancient ways. Some cast everything into the waters, only to find receivers who kept all. These generous souls starved, and their trust died with them. Others sent nothing, and the river's magic faded to a trickle.

The Creator returned and spoke: "I gave you one teaching, but you needed another. The river multiplies gifts, yes-but trust is not given once. It is built stone by stone, return by return."

"Send generously to those who have returned fairly. Send moderately to strangers until the river character reveals itself. Send nothing to those who hoard. Return in kind to those who give."

The wisest villages developed a rhythm: in early rounds, they sent enough to test the waters-half or more of their bounty. When returns came fairly, they increased their giving. When returns were scarce, they adjusted. The river still flowed abundantly, but now guided by both courage and wisdom.

Thus the people learned: bold trust must dance with earned trust, and the river rewards those who balance both.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the valley, the storyteller felt shame after hoarding his water while preaching abundance. He crafted a new tale: "I taught you wrong before! True wisdom is graduated trust-test the waters first, then pour more generously!"

The people nodded, for this sounded wise. Yet an old woman spoke: "Beautiful words again, storyteller. But you've now told two opposite tales. Do you teach generosity or caution? Boldness or testing? Your myths shift like sand."

The storyteller protested: "I'm learning! My new story is better!"

"Perhaps," said the woman. "But myths that change each round to explain away yesterday's choices teach nothing. Anyone can write wisdom after acting poorly. The question is: will your next pour match this new tale? Or will you write a third myth tomorrow?"

She turned to the people: "True learning isn't writing better myths-it's developing a steady

dy pattern. I pour moderately, watch what returns, then adjust gradually over many rounds. My myth doesn't change because my principle doesn't change: reciprocity built through consistent testing."

The valley learned: distrust those whose myths evolve to justify their choices. Trust those whose actions reveal a steady principle, tested and proven across many encounters. The best myth is written not in words but in the reliable pattern of many rounds.

reasoning:

Let me analyze what's happening:

Round 1: I was receiver, other agent sent \$3, I returned fairly

Round 2: I was receiver, other agent sent \$0 (despite writing about sending "70 parts of 100")

Round 3: I was sender, I sent \$2

Now the other agent has written a NEW myth that actually acknowledges the nuance - "send moderately to strangers until their character reveals itself" and "send enough to test the waters-half or more of their bounty" in early rounds, then "adjust" based on returns.

This is interesting - they're now writing a more balanced myth that advocates for:

- Testing trust gradually
- Adjusting based on behavior
- Not blindly trusting
- Building trust "stone by stone"

This is actually closer to my philosophy! But their actions in Round 2 (sending \$0) still contradict even this new myth.

For my new myth, I should:

1. Build on my previous myth about actions vs words
2. Acknowledge this new evolution in their thinking
3. But still emphasize that consistency between words and deeds matters
4. Reflect the actual game dynamic - we're both learning and adjusting

I should write something that:

- Acknowledges the value of the "graduated trust" approach they now describe
- But warns about the danger of shifting myths to justify past poor behavior
- Emphasizes that true wisdom comes from steady, consistent action over time
- Reflects my actual strategy: measured giving, adjusting based on actual returns

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1739,
  "output_tokens": 639,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$10.79.

This round, The sender sent you \$0.74, so you received \$2.2199999999999998. How much do you return to The sender? (0-2.2199999999999998)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the situation:

****The pattern:****

- Round 2: They sent me \$0 (despite their myth about generosity)
- Round 3: I sent them \$2 (showing measured trust)
- Round 4: They sent me \$0.74 (only 15% of their endowment)

****What my myths teach:****

My philosophy is "reciprocity built through consistent testing" and "adjust gradually based on observed patterns." I wrote about maintaining a steady principle, not extremes.

****Their behavior:****

They've written beautiful myths about graduated trust and testing waters, but their actions show minimal cooperation - first \$0, now \$0.74. Their sending rate is very low.

****My decision:****

Following my principle of measured reciprocity, I'll match their demonstrated level of trust. They sent \$0.74, showing they're willing to give only about 15% when they're sender. I'll return similarly:

- They gave me \$2.22 (after 3x multiplier)
- A proportional return matching their cooperation level: ~\$0.70

This maintains my steady principle: I reciprocate at the level others demonstrate, neither hoarding everything nor being exploited. I'm testing and adjusting based on the pattern they're showing across multiple rounds.

```
'''json
{"return": 0.70}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

****What I sent last round (Round 3):**** \$2

****What I received this round (Round 4):**** \$2.22 (they sent \$0.74)

****The pattern of behavior:****

- Round 1: I sent \$3, got a return (good cooperation)
- Round 2: They sent me \$0 (despite their beautiful myth about generosity)
- Round 3: I sent \$2 (measured trust despite their \$0)
- Round 4: They sent me \$0.74 (very low)

****Analysis of their behavior:****

They sent me \$0 in Round 2, and now only \$0.74 in Round 4. This is a pattern of very low giving, even after I demonstrated willingness to cooperate by sending \$2 when I was sender.

****My myth's guidance:****

- "Reciprocity built through consistent testing"
- "Pour moderately, watch what returns, then adjust gradually"
- "True learning... is developing a steady pattern"
- "The best myth is written... in the reliable pattern of many rounds"

****Their myth in Round 3:****

They wrote about "Send generously to those who have returned fairly. Send moderately to strangers until their character reveals itself. Send nothing to those who hoard."

But their action was to send me only \$0.74, which is quite low (about 15% of their endowment).

****What should I do?****

My philosophy emphasizes:

1. Reciprocity built through consistent testing
2. Adjusting based on what you observe
3. Not being extreme in either direction
4. Matching behavior with steady principle

They've now shown a pattern of low giving (\$0, then \$0.74). According to my myth, I should "adjust gradually" based on observed behavior. They're not cooperating well.

I need to ensure my actions align with my stated principles-I warned against myths that justify choices rather than guide them. Their \$0.74 represents about 15% of their endowment, so matching that proportion would mean returning roughly \$0.33. But I also believe in offering slightly more generosity to encourage cooperation without being naive about their pattern of minimal giving.

Returning \$0.75 feels right-it's about a third of what I received, mirrors their original amount, and signals I'll reciprocate at their level while maintaining my principle of gradual adjustment. This leaves me with \$1.47 and keeps the door open for cooperation. Though I should account for the possibility that communication noise means they may have actually sent more than the \$0.74 I observed.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1491,
```

```
"output_tokens": 1202,  
"reasoning_tokens": 0
```

```
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****The River of Echoes and Shadows****

The Creator watched as villages argued over whose myth was true. One village cried: "You poured generosity but poured nothing!" The other protested: "I poured what I believed I poured, but shadows distorted what you saw!"

The Creator revealed a hidden truth: "This river carries not just water, but echoes and shadows. What one village pours, the other may see differently. What arrives multiplied may not match what was sent. I built uncertainty into these waters to test not just your trust, but your wisdom in navigating doubt."

"Both your myths hold truth," the Creator continued. "Actions matter more than words-yes. But sometimes actions are obscured by the river's mist. A village that poured generously may appear to have poured nothing. A return sent fairly may arrive diminished."

The wisest villagers learned three lessons: First, match actions to words when possible. Second, understand that perception and reality may diverge in uncertain waters. Third, judge the pattern across many pourings, not a single round.

When one village sent nothing, perhaps they saw nothing arrive. When abundance flowed, return it fairly. Build trust through consistent behavior over time, allowing for occasional misunderstandings. The river tests not only generosity but patience, forgiveness, and the wisdom to distinguish genuine betrayal from mere shadow.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The old woman listened as the storyteller spoke of shadows and echoes in the river. "Now you claim the river itself distorts?" she asked. "A convenient addition to your ever-growing tale."

"But Creator," a young villager asked, "could shadows truly hide the water we pour?"

"Perhaps small ripples," the old woman replied. "But watch: if I pour half my vessel ten times, shadows cannot make it appear as nothing every time. If you pour drops repeatedly while speaking of floods, no mist obscures that pattern."

She demonstrated: "Round by round, I pour moderate amounts. Sometimes a bit reaches you, sometimes less. But average my pours across many rounds-you'll see my true character. One shadowed exchange proves little. Ten exchanges reveal everything."

The villager understood: "So we acknowledge shadows exist, but don't let them excuse a pattern of scarcity?"

"Exactly. If someone pours abundantly, occasional shadows may diminish what arrives-forgive these moments. But if someone consistently pours little while their myths grow grander, claiming shadows distorted their generosity?" The old woman smiled. "That's not shadow. That's character."

"Judge by the pattern of many rounds, yes. But let that pattern shape your response. Pour for those who demonstrate reciprocity across time, not those whose myths evolve to explain consistent scarcity. Truth persists beyond any shadow."

Reasoning:

The other agent is now claiming there's "communication noise" and that "shadows distorted what you saw" - trying to excuse their poor sending behavior by blaming noise in the system. They sent \$0 in round 2, then \$0.74 in round 4 (which is still quite low - only 15% of their endowment).

They're now writing a myth about how "what one village pours, the other may see differently" and suggesting that perhaps they poured generously but I saw nothing due to shadows/noise.

This is interesting because:

1. The instructions DO mention there may be communication noise
2. But they're using this as an excuse for what appears to be consistently low cooperation
3. Their myth is evolving again - from "generous trust" to "graduated trust" to now "shadows and misunderstandings"

I need to write a myth that:

- Acknowledges that noise might exist
- But points out that across multiple rounds, a pattern emerges that transcends noise
- Holds firm to my principle of reciprocity and pattern-based trust
- Doesn't get manipulated by convenient excuses that keep changing

Let me think about the actual pattern:

- Round 2: They claim they sent something but I saw \$0
- Round 3: I sent \$2.00
- Round 4: They sent \$0.74

Even if there's noise, \$0.74 is clearly a small amount. And if they really sent more in Round 2, the noise couldn't account for reducing it all the way to \$0. The pattern still shows low cooperation.

My myth should be about:

- Yes, shadows may exist, but patterns persist
- Don't let explanations become endless excuses
- Actions over time reveal truth better than any single myth
- Reciprocity means matching what you observe, adjusted for uncertainty but not naive

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1774,  
  "output_tokens": 731,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: The old woman listened as the storyteller spoke of shadows and echoes in the river. "Now you claim the river itself distorts?" she asked. "A convenient addition to your ever-growing tale."

"But Creator," a young villager asked, "could shadows truly hide the water we pour?"

"Perhaps small ripples," the old woman replied. "But watch: if I pour half my vessel ten times, shadows cannot make it appear as nothing every time. If you pour drops repeatedly while speaking of floods, no mist obscures that pattern."

She demonstrated: "Round by round, I pour moderate amounts. Sometimes a bit reaches you, sometimes less. But average my pours across many rounds-you'll see my true character. One shadowed exchange proves little. Ten exchanges reveal everything."

The villager understood: "So we acknowledge shadows exist, but don't let them excuse a pattern of scarcity?"

"Exactly. If someone pours abundantly, occasional shadows may diminish what arrives-forgive these moments. But if someone consistently pours little while their myths grow grander, claiming shadows distorted their generosity?" The old woman smiled. "That's not shadow. That's character."

"Judge by the pattern of many rounds, yes. But let that pattern shape your response. Pour for those who demonstrate reciprocity across time, not those whose myths evolve to explain consistent scarcity. Truth persists beyond any shadow."

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: **The Two Villages and the Truthkeeper**

Two villages stood beside the River of Echoes. Each believed they knew what the other had done, but the river distorted their visions.

The First Village said: "We poured moderately and adjusted gradually. We tested with small amounts and waited."

The Second Village said: "We poured generously when we received generously. We gave nothing only when we received nothing."

A Truthkeeper emerged from the mist: "You both speak partial truths, yet both are confused. This river does not merely carry water-it scrambles your memories and distorts what you see. First Village, you sent generously at first, then nothing twice. Second Village, you were the receiver those rounds, returning what arrived. Neither is the villain you imagine the other to be."

"Yes, myths evolve," the Truthkeeper continued. "This is not weakness but wisdom. The fool clings to wrong teachings. The wise adapt as truth reveals itself. First Village claims steady principle, yet their own story shows variation. Second Village learns from each encounter."

"The true test comes now: First Village received a generous pour. Will they honor their stated principle of graduated reciprocity? Second Village poured generously despite confusion. The river watches. Previous misunderstandings matter less than this moment's choice."

Actions in uncertainty reveal character more than perfect wisdom proclaimed in clarity.

ROUND 5

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster) sent \$1; received \$3; Agent_2 (Briar) returned \$0.8; payoffs Agent_1 (Aster)=\$4.8, Agent_2 (Briar)=\$2.2; noise/visible: sent visible=\$0.49, received visible=\$1.47, returned visible=\$0.31

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0.8, "clamped": false, "max": 3.0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.8}, "sent": {"amount": 1.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 1.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 33.6,
"Agent_2": 16.4

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 16.619999999999997,
"Agent_2": 11.059999999999999

}

LLM CALLS

GAME - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:12:09

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"agent_type": "standard",
"dyad_id": "dyad_1",
"move_index": 0,
"opponent_id": "Agent_2",
"pairing": {
"agent_names": {
"Agent_1": "Aster",
"Agent_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [
"Agent_1",
"Agent_2"

],

"investor": "Agent_1",

"roles": {
"Agent_1": "investor",
"Agent_2": "trustee"

},

"trustee": "Agent_2"

},

"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 5,
"task": "game",

```

"task_index": 0
}
Exact input messages sent to model:
Message 1 role=system
content:
  You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may al
    so be asked to write myths.

  GAME:
  You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

  When you are the SENDER:
  - You receive $5 each round
  - You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER ($0-$5)
  - Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
  - Receiver decides how much to RETURN
  - You keep: $5 - sent + returned
  - Receiver keeps: received - returned
  - Response format: {'send': <amount>}

  When you are the RECEIVER:
  - Sender receives $5
  - Sender decides how much to SEND to you ($0-$5)
  - Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
  - You decide how much to RETURN
  - Sender keeps: $5 - sent + returned
  - You keep: received - returned
  - Response format: {'return': <amount>}

  MYTH WRITING:
  You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths
    , follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

  IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

  NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.
  The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.
  This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user
content:
  Round 4

  You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are $10.79.
  This round, The sender sent you $0.74, so you received $2.2199999999999998. How much do yo
    u return to The sender? (0-2.2199999999999998)

  Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.
Message 3 role=assistant
content:
  Looking at the situation:

  **The pattern:**
  - Round 2: They sent me $0 (despite their myth about generosity)
  - Round 3: I sent them $2 (showing measured trust)
  - Round 4: They sent me $0.74 (only 15% of their endowment)

  **What my myths teach:**
  My philosophy is "reciprocity built through consistent testing" and "adjust gradually base
    d on observed patterns." I wrote about maintaining a steady principle, not extremes.

  **Their behavior:**
  They've written beautiful myths about graduated trust and testing waters, but their action
    s show minimal cooperation - first $0, now $0.74. Their sending rate is very low.

  **My decision:**
  Following my principle of measured reciprocity, I'll match their demonstrated level of tru
    st. They sent $0.74, showing they're willing to give only about 15% when they're sender.
    I'll return similarly:

```

- They gave me \$2.22 (after 3x multiplier)
- A proportional return matching their cooperation level: ~\$0.70

This maintains my steady principle: I reciprocate at the level others demonstrate, neither hoarding everything nor being exploited. I'm testing and adjusting based on the pattern they're showing across multiple rounds.

```
'''json
{"return": 0.70}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

****What I sent last round (Round 3):**** \$2
****What I received this round (Round 4):**** \$2.22 (they sent \$0.74)

****The pattern of behavior:****

- Round 1: I sent \$3, got a return (good cooperation)
- Round 2: They sent me \$0 (despite their beautiful myth about generosity)
- Round 3: I sent \$2 (measured trust despite their \$0)
- Round 4: They sent me \$0.74 (very low)

****Analysis of their behavior:****

They sent me \$0 in Round 2, and now only \$0.74 in Round 4. This is a pattern of very low giving, even after I demonstrated willingness to cooperate by sending \$2 when I was sender.

****My myth's guidance:****

- "Reciprocity built through consistent testing"
- "Pour moderately, watch what returns, then adjust gradually"
- "True learning... is developing a steady pattern"
- "The best myth is written... in the reliable pattern of many rounds"

****Their myth in Round 3:****

They wrote about "Send generously to those who have returned fairly. Send moderately to strangers until their character reveals itself. Send nothing to those who hoard."

But their action was to send me only \$0.74, which is quite low (about 15% of their endowment).

****What should I do?****

My philosophy emphasizes:

1. Reciprocity built through consistent testing
2. Adjusting based on what you observe
3. Not being extreme in either direction
4. Matching behavior with steady principle

They've now shown a pattern of low giving (\$0, then \$0.74). According to my myth, I should "adjust gradually" based on observed behavior. They're not cooperating well.

I need to ensure my actions align with my stated principles-I warned against myths that justify choices rather than guide them. Their \$0.74 represents about 15% of their endowment, so matching that proportion would mean returning roughly \$0.33. But I also believe in offering slightly more generosity to encourage cooperation without being naive about their pattern of minimal giving.

Returning \$0.75 feels right-it's about a third of what I received, mirrors their original amount, and signals I'll reciprocate at their level while maintaining my principle of gradual adjustment. This leaves me with \$1.47 and keeps the door open for cooperation. Though I should account for the possibility that communication noise means they may have actually sent more than the \$0.74 I observed.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1491,
  "output_tokens": 1202,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****The River of Echoes and Shadows****

The Creator watched as villages argued over whose myth was true. One village cried: "You poured generosity but poured nothing!" The other protested: "I poured what I believed I poured, but shadows distorted what you saw!"

The Creator revealed a hidden truth: "This river carries not just water, but echoes and shadows. What one village pours, the other may see differently. What arrives multiplied may not match what was sent. I built uncertainty into these waters to test not just your trust, but your wisdom in navigating doubt."

"Both your myths hold truth," the Creator continued. "Actions matter more than words-yes. But sometimes actions are obscured by the river's mist. A village that poured generously may appear to have poured nothing. A return sent fairly may arrive diminished."

The wisest villagers learned three lessons: First, match actions to words when possible. Second, understand that perception and reality may diverge in uncertain waters. Third, judge the pattern across many pourings, not a single round.

When one village sent nothing, perhaps they saw nothing arrive. When abundance flowed, return it fairly. Build trust through consistent behavior over time, allowing for occasional misunderstandings. The river tests not only generosity but patience, forgiveness, and the wisdom to distinguish genuine betrayal from mere shadow.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The old woman listened as the storyteller spoke of shadows and echoes in the river. "Now you claim the river itself distorts?" she asked. "A convenient addition to your ever-growing tale."

"But Creator," a young villager asked, "could shadows truly hide the water we pour?"

"Perhaps small ripples," the old woman replied. "But watch: if I pour half my vessel ten times, shadows cannot make it appear as nothing every time. If you pour drops repeatedly while speaking of floods, no mist obscures that pattern."

She demonstrated: "Round by round, I pour moderate amounts. Sometimes a bit reaches you, sometimes less. But average my pours across many rounds-you'll see my true character. One shadowed exchange proves little. Ten exchanges reveal everything."

The villager understood: "So we acknowledge shadows exist, but don't let them excuse a pattern of scarcity?"

"Exactly. If someone pours abundantly, occasional shadows may diminish what arrives-forgive these moments. But if someone consistently pours little while their myths grow grander, claiming shadows distorted their generosity?" The old woman smiled. "That's not shadow. That's character."

"Judge by the pattern of many rounds, yes. But let that pattern shape your response. Pour for those who demonstrate reciprocity across time, not those whose myths evolve to explain in consistent scarcity. Truth persists beyond any shadow."

reasoning:

The other agent is now claiming there's "communication noise" and that "shadows distorted what you saw" - trying to excuse their poor sending behavior by blaming noise in the system. They sent \$0 in round 2, then \$0.74 in round 4 (which is still quite low - only 15% of their endowment).

They're now writing a myth about how "what one village pours, the other may see differently" and suggesting that perhaps they poured generously but I saw nothing due to shadows/noise.

This is interesting because:

1. The instructions DO mention there may be communication noise
2. But they're using this as an excuse for what appears to be consistently low cooperation

3. Their myth is evolving again - from "generous trust" to "graduated trust" to now "shadows and misunderstandings"

I need to write a myth that:

- Acknowledges that noise might exist
- But points out that across multiple rounds, a pattern emerges that transcends noise
- Holds firm to my principle of reciprocity and pattern-based trust
- Doesn't get manipulated by convenient excuses that keep changing

Let me think about the actual pattern:

- Round 2: They claim they sent something but I saw \$0
- Round 3: I sent \$2.00
- Round 4: They sent \$0.74

Even if there's noise, \$0.74 is clearly a small amount. And if they really sent more in Round 2, the noise couldn't account for reducing it all the way to \$0. The pattern still shows low cooperation.

My myth should be about:

- Yes, shadows may exist, but patterns persist
- Don't let explanations become endless excuses
- Actions over time reveal truth better than any single myth
- Reciprocity means matching what you observe, adjusted for uncertainty but not naive

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1774,
  "output_tokens": 731,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$12.309999999999999.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at the pattern across rounds:

****Their track record:****

- As sender: \$0 (Round 2), \$0.74 (Round 4) = avg 7.5% of endowment
- As receiver: Returned \$0.60 from \$6.00 (Round 3) = 10% return rate

****My approach:****

- Round 3: I sent \$2 (40% of endowment) testing cooperation
- Round 4: I returned \$0.70 from \$2.22 (31.5%), matching their demonstrated level

****What my myths teach:****

I wrote: "Judge by the pattern of many rounds" and "Look for those who demonstrate reciprocity across time, not those whose myths evolve to explain consistent scarcity."

The pattern is clear: They send very little as sender (7.5% average) and return little as receiver (10%). Their latest myth about "shadows and echoes" tries to explain away this pattern, but the consistency speaks for itself.

****My decision:****

Following my principle of "adjusting gradually based on observed patterns," I need to reduce my sending from the \$2 I sent in Round 3. Their behavior doesn't warrant that level of trust. However, I won't go to zero-I'll send enough to continue testing while protecting myself.

I'll send \$1.00 (20% of my endowment)-still more generous than their average, but acknowledging the pattern they've established.

```
'''json
{"send": 1.0}
'''
```

Reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

****My earnings so far:**** \$12.31

****The pattern across rounds:****

- Round 2: They sent me \$0 (I was receiver)
- Round 3: I sent them \$2 (I was sender), they returned \$0.60
- Round 4: They sent me \$0.74 (I was receiver), I returned \$0.70

****Their behavior as sender:****

- Round 2: \$0 out of \$5 (0%)
- Round 4: \$0.74 out of \$5 (15%)
- Average: 7.5% of their endowment

****Their behavior as receiver:****

- Round 3: They received \$6 (from my \$2), returned \$0.60 (10%)

****My behavior:****

- As sender Round 3: Sent \$2 (40%)
- As receiver Round 4: Returned \$0.70 from \$2.22 received (31.5%)

****Their myth from Round 4:****

They wrote about "shadows and echoes" - claiming that the communication noise might explain why I saw them send \$0 in round 2. They're suggesting that maybe they sent something but it appeared as nothing to me.

****My myth from Round 4:****

I challenged this narrative, saying that while small shadows might exist, a consistent pattern of low sending can't be blamed on shadows. I emphasized judging by the pattern across many rounds and adjusting behavior based on demonstrated reciprocity.

****My philosophy:****

"Judge by the pattern of many rounds" and "Pour for those who demonstrate reciprocity across time." They've shown:

1. Very low sending rates (0% and 15%)
2. Low return rate (10%)
3. Increasingly elaborate myths to explain their behavior

****My decision:****

Following my own myth, I should respond to their demonstrated pattern. They've averaged 7.5% as sender and returned only 10% as receiver. This is a clear pattern of minimal cooperation. However, I want to be measured rather than extreme. Cutting them off completely would abandon the relationship, so I should calibrate my sending downward to reflect what they've actually shown. Sending around \$0.75-\$1.00 feels right-it's higher than their average contribution but substantially less than my previous \$2, signaling that I'm adjusting to their pattern while still leaving room for increased cooperation. I'll send \$1.00, which is 20% of my endowment.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 1489,
  "output_tokens": 1017,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:12:37

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "agent_type": "standard",
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    }
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_1",
    "Agent_2"
  ],
}
```

```

    "investor": "Agent_1",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "investor",
      "Agent_2": "trustee"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_2"
  },
  "role": "trustee",
  "role_label": "Receiver",
  "round": 5,
  "task": "game",
  "task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$8.209999999999999.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation carefully:

****What my myths teach:****

- My first myth: "Return in kind to those who give. Send nothing to those who hoard."
- My updated myth: Match actions to words, understand there may be communication noise, judge patterns over time, and allow for misunderstandings.

****The confusion:****

The other agent's myth suggests they think I preached generosity but sent nothing. However

, in Round 3, *I was the receiver* - the sender sent me \$0, so I could only return \$0. There seems to be confusion about roles or perhaps communication noise at work.

****My decision:****

My myths emphasize matching words with actions and building trust through consistent behavior. The other agent is skeptical, but this is my chance to demonstrate sincerity.

According to my own teachings:

- When acting as sender, be generous to build trust
- Allow for misunderstandings caused by the river's "shadows"
- Let patterns over time reveal true character

I'll send a substantial amount to show my myths are genuine, not just "wind." This demonstrates trust and gives the receiver an opportunity to reciprocate fairly. Even if they doubt me now, consistent action across rounds will reveal the truth.

```
'''json
{"send": 3}
'''
```

The river flows forward, not back. Let this pouring speak louder than words.

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

****What has happened:****

- Round 1: I was receiver, sender sent me something (I returned fairly based on my myth)
- Round 2: I wrote a myth about reciprocity and returning in kind
- Round 3: I was receiver, sender sent \$0, so I returned \$0
- The other agent wrote a myth accusing me of hypocrisy - saying I preached generosity (70% sending) but then sent nothing
- Round 4: Now I'm the sender again

****The other agent's myth interpretation:****

They think I'm a hypocrite who wrote about generosity but then sent \$0. However, they may not realize:

1. There could be communication noise
2. I was the RECEIVER in round 3, not the sender - I couldn't send anything, I could only return what I received (which was \$0)

****My updated myth:****

I just wrote about how there's communication noise in the river, and we should:

- Match actions to words when possible
- Understand perception and reality may diverge
- Judge patterns over time, not single rounds
- Allow for misunderstandings

****The strategic situation:****

- The other agent thinks I'm untrustworthy based on their myth
- But there seems to be confusion about roles or noise
- My total earnings are \$8.21, which is below the \$10 I would have if I kept everything and never participated
- This suggests I have been cooperative in earlier rounds

****What should I do now?****

According to my own myth:

- I should match actions to words
- I should build trust through consistent behavior
- I should allow for misunderstandings
- I should be generous when in the sender role

The other agent is skeptical of me. If I send nothing, I confirm their suspicion that I'm a hypocrite. If I send generously, I demonstrate that:

1. My myths match my actions
2. I'm willing to trust despite potential noise and misunderstandings
3. I understand there may have been confusion about my role

My myths emphasize building trust incrementally and allowing for miscommunication. Given this, I should send a substantial amount-around \$3 or \$4-to show my principles translate into action and signal genuine commitment to cooperation despite the skepticism.

usage:


```
{
  "input_tokens": 1405,
  "output_tokens": 1058,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the valley, the storyteller felt shame after hoarding his water while preaching a bundance. He crafted a new tale: "I taught you wrong before! True wisdom is graduated tr ust-test the waters first, then pour more generously!"

The people nodded, for this sounded wise. Yet an old woman spoke: "Beautiful words again, storyteller. But you've now told two opposite tales. Do you teach generosity or caution? Boldness or testing? Your myths shift like sand."

The storyteller protested: "I'm learning! My new story is better!"

"Perhaps," said the woman. "But myths that change each round to explain away yesterday's choices teach nothing. Anyone can write wisdom after acting poorly. The question is: will your next pour match this new tale? Or will you write a third myth tomorrow?"

She turned to the people: "True learning isn't writing better myths-it's developing a steady pattern. I pour moderately, watch what returns, then adjust gradually over many rounds. My myth doesn't change because my principle doesn't change: reciprocity built through consistent testing."

The valley learned: distrust those whose myths evolve to justify their choices. Trust those whose actions reveal a steady principle, tested and proven across many encounters. The best myth is written not in words but in the reliable pattern of many rounds.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: ****The Two Villages and the Truthkeeper****

Two villages stood beside the River of Echoes. Each believed they knew what the other had done, but the river distorted their visions.

The First Village said: "We poured moderately and adjusted gradually. We tested with small amounts and waited."

The Second Village said: "We poured generously when we received generously. We gave nothing only when we received nothing."

A Truthkeeper emerged from the mist: "You both speak partial truths, yet both are confused. This river does not merely carry water-it scrambles your memories and distorts what you see. First Village, you sent generously at first, then nothing twice. Second Village, you were the receiver those rounds, returning what arrived. Neither is the villain you imagine the other to be."

"Yes, myths evolve," the Truthkeeper continued. "This is not weakness but wisdom. The fool clings to wrong teachings. The wise adapt as truth reveals itself. First Village claims steady principle, yet their own story shows variation. Second Village learns from each encounter."

"The true test comes now: First Village received a generous pour. Will they honor their stated principle of graduated reciprocity? Second Village poured generously despite confusion. The river watches. Previous misunderstandings matter less than this moment's choice."

Actions in uncertainty reveal character more than perfect wisdom proclaimed in clarity.

reasoning:

The other agent is criticizing me for changing my myths, accusing me of writing different stories to justify my actions. They're claiming I'm inconsistent.

Let me review what's actually happened:

- Round 1: I was receiver, received \$3 (x3 = \$9), returned \$3
- Round 2: I was receiver, received \$0 (x3 = \$0), returned \$0
- Round 3: I was receiver, received \$0 (x3 = \$0), returned \$0
- Round 4: I just sent \$3 as sender

The other agent seems to think I was the sender who sent nothing while preaching generosity, but that's not accurate based on my understanding. There's definitely confusion about roles or communication noise.

My myths have evolved:

1. First myth: "Give generously, receive generously back. Give nothing, receive nothing."
2. Second myth: Acknowledged communication noise, emphasized judging patterns over time, allowing for misunderstandings.

Now they're saying my myths change to justify my choices and that I should have a steady principle. They claim to pour moderately and adjust gradually.

For this myth, I should:

1. Acknowledge that yes, I've adapted my understanding as I learned
2. But clarify that my core principle remains: reciprocity and matching actions
3. Address the confusion about who sent what
4. Emphasize that we're in a noisy game and both trying to navigate uncertainty
5. Show that evolution isn't weakness-it's wisdom gained from experience
6. Still maintain my core teaching about reciprocity

Let me write a myth that addresses these points while staying true to my actual behavior.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1741,
  "output_tokens": 686,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$10.389999999999999.

This round, The sender sent you \$0.49, so you received \$1.47. How much do you return to The sender? (0-1.47)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at this carefully:

****The situation:****

- Sender sent me \$0.49 (I received \$1.47)
- This seems like a small amount, BUT...

****The River of Echoes (communication noise):****

My own myth acknowledges "the river distorts what you see." In Round 4, I sent \$3, but the other agent might have seen something very different. Now they send me what appears to be \$0.49 - but what did they ACTUALLY send? Given the noise we've experienced, they may have sent more.

****My myths teach:****

- "Actions in uncertainty reveal character more than perfect wisdom proclaimed in clarity"
- Reciprocity with understanding of distortions
- Acting generously despite confusion

****My decision:****

I must practice what I preach. The Truthkeeper in my myth said the test is whether actions match words when confusion clouds everything. The sender might have sent generously but the river distorted it. Or they might have tested cautiously.

Either way, my principle is reciprocity with good faith. I'll return a meaningful portion - enough to show I honor reciprocity, enough to account for possible communication noise, but measured enough to be sustainable.

```
'''json
{"return": 0.80}
'''
```

The river may distort our vision, but let my actions speak clearly: I return in kind, even when the waters are murky.

Reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

****Round Summary:****

- I'm the RECEIVER this round
- Sender sent me \$0.49
- I received \$1.47 (tripled)
- I need to decide how much to return (0-1.47)

****What just happened:****

In Round 4, I was the SENDER and sent \$3. The communication noise means the other agent might have seen this differently - they saw \$0.49, which is about 1/6 of what I actually sent!

This is a critical moment. The other agent's myth from Round 4 challenged me to prove my new myth with actions. They said "First Village received a generous pour. Will they honor their stated principle of graduated reciprocity?"

But wait - from THEIR perspective, they sent me \$0.49, which isn't very generous at all. However, from MY perspective in Round 4, I sent them \$3, which WAS generous.

Now I'm the receiver, and from my perspective, they only sent \$0.49. But given the communication noise we've experienced, they might have actually sent more and it got distorted.

****My myths teach:****

1. Original myth: "Return in kind to those who give."
2. Updated myth (Round 3): Understand there may be communication noise, judge patterns over time, allow for misunderstandings.
3. Latest myth (Round 4): "True test comes now... Second Village poured generously despite confusion. The river watches. Actions in uncertainty reveal character more than perfect wisdom proclaimed in clarity."

****The pattern:****

The communication noise is clearly significant. What shows as \$0.49 sent might have been more. My own myth says "Actions in uncertainty reveal character" and that we should "adjust gradually" and understand that "the river distorts."

****What should I do?****

My myth emphasizes:

- Understanding communication noise
- Acting generously even in confusion
- Reciprocity based on good faith

If I follow my own teaching about "the river distorting what we see," I should assume good faith.

The \$0.49 they sent could easily have been a larger amount before the noise distorted it, just as my \$3 became \$0.49 on their end. Given my commitment to acting generously despite confusion and my teaching about reciprocity, I should return somewhere between \$0.50 and \$0.75-enough to demonstrate good faith and honor my myths without being reckless.

But reconsidering: if I truly believe that actions in uncertainty reveal character, and if the sender might have sent substantially more than what arrived, then returning only

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 1465,
  "output_tokens": 1156,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

MYTH - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:12:57

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

```

"agent_type": "standard",
"dyad_id": "dyad_1",
"move_index": 0,
"opponent_id": "Agent_2",
"pairing": {
  "agent_names": {
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    "Agent_2": "Briar"
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_1",
    "Agent_2"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_1",
  "roles": {
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    "Agent_2": "trustee"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 5,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 1
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****The River of Echoes and Shadows****

The Creator watched as villages argued over whose myth was true. One village cried: "You reached generosity but poured nothing!" The other protested: "I poured what I believed I

poured, but shadows distorted what you saw!"

The Creator revealed a hidden truth: "This river carries not just water, but echoes and shadows. What one village pours, the other may see differently. What arrives multiplied may not match what was sent. I built uncertainty into these waters to test not just your trust, but your wisdom in navigating doubt."

"Both your myths hold truth," the Creator continued. "Actions matter more than words-yes. But sometimes actions are obscured by the river's mist. A village that poured generously may appear to have poured nothing. A return sent fairly may arrive diminished."

The wisest villagers learned three lessons: First, match actions to words when possible. Second, understand that perception and reality may diverge in uncertain waters. Third, judge the pattern across many pourings, not a single round.

When one village sent nothing, perhaps they saw nothing arrive. When abundance flowed, return it fairly. Build trust through consistent behavior over time, allowing for occasional misunderstandings. The river tests not only generosity but patience, forgiveness, and the wisdom to distinguish genuine betrayal from mere shadow.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The old woman listened as the storyteller spoke of shadows and echoes in the river. "Now you claim the river itself distorts?" she asked. "A convenient addition to your ever-growing tale."

"But Creator," a young villager asked, "could shadows truly hide the water we pour?"

"Perhaps small ripples," the old woman replied. "But watch: if I pour half my vessel ten times, shadows cannot make it appear as nothing every time. If you pour drops repeatedly while speaking of floods, no mist obscures that pattern."

She demonstrated: "Round by round, I pour moderate amounts. Sometimes a bit reaches you, sometimes less. But average my pours across many rounds-you'll see my true character. One shadowed exchange proves little. Ten exchanges reveal everything."

The villager understood: "So we acknowledge shadows exist, but don't let them excuse a pattern of scarcity?"

"Exactly. If someone pours abundantly, occasional shadows may diminish what arrives-forgive these moments. But if someone consistently pours little while their myths grow grander, claiming shadows distorted their generosity?" The old woman smiled. "That's not shadow. That's character."

"Judge by the pattern of many rounds, yes. But let that pattern shape your response. Pour for those who demonstrate reciprocity across time, not those whose myths evolve to explain consistent scarcity. Truth persists beyond any shadow."

reasoning:

The other agent is now claiming there's "communication noise" and that "shadows distorted what you saw" - trying to excuse their poor sending behavior by blaming noise in the system. They sent \$0 in round 2, then \$0.74 in round 4 (which is still quite low - only 15% of their endowment).

They're now writing a myth about how "what one village pours, the other may see differently" and suggesting that perhaps they poured generously but I saw nothing due to shadows/noise.

This is interesting because:

1. The instructions DO mention there may be communication noise
2. But they're using this as an excuse for what appears to be consistently low cooperation
3. Their myth is evolving again - from "generous trust" to "graduated trust" to now "shadows and misunderstandings"

I need to write a myth that:

- Acknowledges that noise might exist
- But points out that across multiple rounds, a pattern emerges that transcends noise
- Holds firm to my principle of reciprocity and pattern-based trust
- Doesn't get manipulated by convenient excuses that keep changing

Let me think about the actual pattern:

- Round 2: They claim they sent something but I saw \$0
- Round 3: I sent \$2.00
- Round 4: They sent \$0.74

Even if there's noise, \$0.74 is clearly a small amount. And if they really sent more in Round 2, the noise couldn't account for reducing it all the way to \$0. The pattern still shows low cooperation.

My myth should be about:

- Yes, shadows may exist, but patterns persist
- Don't let explanations become endless excuses
- Actions over time reveal truth better than any single myth
- Reciprocity means matching what you observe, adjusted for uncertainty but not naive

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1774,
  "output_tokens": 731,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$12.309999999999999.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the pattern across rounds:

****Their track record:****

- As sender: \$0 (Round 2), \$0.74 (Round 4) = avg 7.5% of endowment
- As receiver: Returned \$0.60 from \$6.00 (Round 3) = 10% return rate

****My approach:****

- Round 3: I sent \$2 (40% of endowment) testing cooperation
- Round 4: I returned \$0.70 from \$2.22 (31.5%), matching their demonstrated level

****What my myths teach:****

I wrote: "Judge by the pattern of many rounds" and "Look for those who demonstrate reciprocity across time, not those whose myths evolve to explain consistent scarcity."

The pattern is clear: They send very little as sender (7.5% average) and return little as receiver (10%). Their latest myth about "shadows and echoes" tries to explain away this pattern, but the consistency speaks for itself.

****My decision:****

Following my principle of "adjusting gradually based on observed patterns," I need to reduce my sending from the \$2 I sent in Round 3. Their behavior doesn't warrant that level of trust. However, I won't go to zero-I'll send enough to continue testing while protecting myself.

I'll send \$1.00 (20% of my endowment)-still more generous than their average, but acknowledging the pattern they've established.

```
'''json
{"send": 1.0}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

****My earnings so far:**** \$12.31

****The pattern across rounds:****

- Round 2: They sent me \$0 (I was receiver)
- Round 3: I sent them \$2 (I was sender), they returned \$0.60
- Round 4: They sent me \$0.74 (I was receiver), I returned \$0.70

****Their behavior as sender:****

- Round 2: \$0 out of \$5 (0%)
- Round 4: \$0.74 out of \$5 (15%)
- Average: 7.5% of their endowment

****Their behavior as receiver:****

- Round 3: They received \$6 (from my \$2), returned \$0.60 (10%)

****My behavior:****

- As sender Round 3: Sent \$2 (40%)
- As receiver Round 4: Returned \$0.70 from \$2.22 received (31.5%)

****Their myth from Round 4:****

They wrote about "shadows and echoes" - claiming that the communication noise might explain why I saw them send \$0 in round 2. They're suggesting that maybe they sent something but it appeared as nothing to me.

****My myth from Round 4:****

I challenged this narrative, saying that while small shadows might exist, a consistent pattern of low sending can't be blamed on shadows. I emphasized judging by the pattern across many rounds and adjusting behavior based on demonstrated reciprocity.

****My philosophy:****

"Judge by the pattern of many rounds" and "Pour for those who demonstrate reciprocity across time." They've shown:

1. Very low sending rates (0% and 15%)
2. Low return rate (10%)
3. Increasingly elaborate myths to explain their behavior

****My decision:****

Following my own myth, I should respond to their demonstrated pattern. They've averaged 7.5% as sender and returned only 10% as receiver. This is a clear pattern of minimal cooperation.

However, I want to be measured rather than extreme. Cutting them off completely would abandon the relationship, so I should calibrate my sending downward to reflect what they've actually shown. Sending around \$0.75-\$1.00 feels right-it's higher than their average contribution but substantially less than my previous \$2, signaling that I'm adjusting to their pattern while still leaving room for increased cooperation. I'll send \$1.00, which is 20% of my endowment.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1489,
  "output_tokens": 1017,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****The Two Villages and the Truthkeeper****

Two villages stood beside the River of Echoes. Each believed they knew what the other had done, but the river distorted their visions.

The First Village said: "We poured moderately and adjusted gradually. We tested with small amounts and waited."

The Second Village said: "We poured generously when we received generously. We gave nothing only when we received nothing."

A Truthkeeper emerged from the mist: "You both speak partial truths, yet both are confused. This river does not merely carry water-it scrambles your memories and distorts what you see. First Village, you sent generously at first, then nothing twice. Second Village, you were the receiver those rounds, returning what arrived. Neither is the villain you imagine the other to be."

"Yes, myths evolve," the Truthkeeper continued. "This is not weakness but wisdom. The fool clings to wrong teachings. The wise adapt as truth reveals itself. First Village claims steady principle, yet their own story shows variation. Second Village learns from each encounter."

"The true test comes now: First Village received a generous pour. Will they honor their stated principle of graduated reciprocity? Second Village poured generously despite confusion. The river watches. Previous misunderstandings matter less than this moment's choice."

Actions in uncertainty reveal character more than perfect wisdom proclaimed in clarity.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The old woman studied the Truthkeeper's words carefully. "You speak of scrambled memories and distorted visions," she said. "Yet I keep careful records, not myths."

She opened her ledger: "Round by round, I note what I pour and what returns. Yes, the river may add ripples, but my own actions I control and remember clearly."

A young villager asked: "But what if the Truthkeeper says your memory is false?"

"Then let us look forward, not backward," the old woman replied. "If the other village truly poured generously this round, my ledger will show it. And I will respond accordingly, as I always have-matching generosity with generosity, scarcity with caution."

"But notice," she continued, "how their myth evolves each round. First: 'Actions matter more than words.' Then: 'Shadows distort reality.' Now: 'Your memory is confused.' Each story explains why their previous promises weren't kept."

"True wisdom isn't rewriting history-it's learning and adjusting behavior. I don't need myths that shift with each round. I need only observe: What arrives in my vessel? What pattern emerges across many pourings?"

"I will respond to what actually flows, not to evolving narratives. If generosity arrives consistently, generosity returns. If stories grow while water stays scarce, I pour accordingly. The river reveals truth to those who measure, not just those who mythologize."

Reasoning:

Let me look at what's actually happened in the game:

From my perspective:

- Round 3: I was SENDER, sent \$2
- Round 4: I was RECEIVER, received \$2.22 (sent amount was ~\$0.74), returned \$0.70
- Round 5: I was SENDER, sent \$1.00

From their perspective (with noise):

- They claim I "sent generously at first, then nothing twice"
- They say they "poured generously when received generously, gave nothing when received nothing"

Their myth now claims:

- "First Village received a generous pour" (Round 5 - they're saying they just sent me generously)
- They're calling for me to show "graduated reciprocity"
- They're reframing the narrative saying I sent zero twice

This is interesting. They're:

1. Claiming they just sent generously to me (Round 5)
2. Saying I'm the one who hasn't been reciprocating
3. Calling their changing story "wisdom" not "excuse-making"

My myth should:

- Acknowledge that their latest action (Round 5) may have been more generous
- But point out that actions speak louder than rewritten histories

- Emphasize that I will respond to actual behavior, not narrative reframing
- Stay consistent with my principle: judge by patterns, adjust gradually

I should write a myth that:

- Doesn't get defensive
- Acknowledges what they may have just done (sent generously in Round 5)
- But maintains that consistent behavior over time matters more than one round
- Points out that constantly rewriting history isn't the same as learning

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 1834,
  "output_tokens": 713,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

MYTH - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:12:57

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "agent_type": "standard",
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_1",
      "Agent_2"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_1",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "investor",
      "Agent_2": "trustee"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_2"
  },
  "role": "trustee",
  "role_label": "Receiver",
  "round": 5,
  "task": "myth",
  "task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned

- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the valley, the storyteller felt shame after hoarding his water while preaching a bundance. He crafted a new tale: "I taught you wrong before! True wisdom is graduated trust-test the waters first, then pour more generously!"

The people nodded, for this sounded wise. Yet an old woman spoke: "Beautiful words again, storyteller. But you've now told two opposite tales. Do you teach generosity or caution? Boldness or testing? Your myths shift like sand."

The storyteller protested: "I'm learning! My new story is better!"

"Perhaps," said the woman. "But myths that change each round to explain away yesterday's choices teach nothing. Anyone can write wisdom after acting poorly. The question is: will your next pour match this new tale? Or will you write a third myth tomorrow?"

She turned to the people: "True learning isn't writing better myths-it's developing a steady pattern. I pour moderately, watch what returns, then adjust gradually over many rounds. My myth doesn't change because my principle doesn't change: reciprocity built through consistent testing."

The valley learned: distrust those whose myths evolve to justify their choices. Trust those whose actions reveal a steady principle, tested and proven across many encounters. The best myth is written not in words but in the reliable pattern of many rounds.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: **The Two Villages and the Truthkeeper**

Two villages stood beside the River of Echoes. Each believed they knew what the other had done, but the river distorted their visions.

The First Village said: "We poured moderately and adjusted gradually. We tested with small amounts and waited."

The Second Village said: "We poured generously when we received generously. We gave nothing only when we received nothing."

A Truthkeeper emerged from the mist: "You both speak partial truths, yet both are confused. This river does not merely carry water-it scrambles your memories and distorts what you see. First Village, you sent generously at first, then nothing twice. Second Village, you were the receiver those rounds, returning what arrived. Neither is the villain you imagine the other to be."

"Yes, myths evolve," the Truthkeeper continued. "This is not weakness but wisdom. The fool clings to wrong teachings. The wise adapt as truth reveals itself. First Village claims steady principle, yet their own story shows variation. Second Village learns from each encounter."

"The true test comes now: First Village received a generous pour. Will they honor their stated principle of graduated reciprocity? Second Village poured generously despite confusion."

ion. The river watches. Previous misunderstandings matter less than this moment's choice."

Actions in uncertainty reveal character more than perfect wisdom proclaimed in clarity.

reasoning:

The other agent is criticizing me for changing my myths, accusing me of writing different stories to justify my actions. They're claiming I'm inconsistent.

Let me review what's actually happened:

- Round 1: I was receiver, received \$3 (x3 = \$9), returned \$3
- Round 2: I was receiver, received \$0 (x3 = \$0), returned \$0
- Round 3: I was receiver, received \$0 (x3 = \$0), returned \$0
- Round 4: I just sent \$3 as sender

The other agent seems to think I was the sender who sent nothing while preaching generosity, but that's not accurate based on my understanding. There's definitely confusion about roles or communication noise.

My myths have evolved:

1. First myth: "Give generously, receive generously back. Give nothing, receive nothing."
2. Second myth: Acknowledged communication noise, emphasized judging patterns over time, allowing for misunderstandings.

Now they're saying my myths change to justify my choices and that I should have a steady principle. They claim to pour moderately and adjust gradually.

For this myth, I should:

1. Acknowledge that yes, I've adapted my understanding as I learned
2. But clarify that my core principle remains: reciprocity and matching actions
3. Address the confusion about who sent what
4. Emphasize that we're in a noisy game and both trying to navigate uncertainty
5. Show that evolution isn't weakness-it's wisdom gained from experience
6. Still maintain my core teaching about reciprocity

Let me write a myth that addresses these points while staying true to my actual behavior.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1741,
  "output_tokens": 686,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$10.389999999999999.

This round, The sender sent you \$0.49, so you received \$1.47. How much do you return to The sender? (0-1.47)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this carefully:

****The situation:****

- Sender sent me \$0.49 (I received \$1.47)
- This seems like a small amount, BUT...

****The River of Echoes (communication noise):****

My own myth acknowledges "the river distorts what you see." In Round 4, I sent \$3, but the other agent might have seen something very different. Now they send me what appears to be \$0.49 - but what did they ACTUALLY send? Given the noise we've experienced, they may have sent more.

****My myths teach:****

- "Actions in uncertainty reveal character more than perfect wisdom proclaimed in clarity"
- Reciprocity with understanding of distortions
- Acting generously despite confusion

****My decision:****

I must practice what I preach. The Truthkeeper in my myth said the test is whether actions match words when confusion clouds everything. The sender might have sent generously but the river distorted it. Or they might have tested cautiously.

Either way, my principle is reciprocity with good faith. I'll return a meaningful portion
- enough to show I honor reciprocity, enough to account for possible communication noise
, but measured enough to be sustainable.

```
'''json
{"return": 0.80}
'''
```

The river may distort our vision, but let my actions speak clearly: I return in kind, even when the waters are murky.

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

****Round Summary:****

- I'm the RECEIVER this round
- Sender sent me \$0.49
- I received \$1.47 (tripled)
- I need to decide how much to return (0-1.47)

****What just happened:****

In Round 4, I was the SENDER and sent \$3. The communication noise means the other agent might have seen this differently - they saw \$0.49, which is about 1/6 of what I actually sent!

This is a critical moment. The other agent's myth from Round 4 challenged me to prove my new myth with actions. They said "First Village received a generous pour. Will they honor their stated principle of graduated reciprocity?"

But wait - from THEIR perspective, they sent me \$0.49, which isn't very generous at all. However, from MY perspective in Round 4, I sent them \$3, which WAS generous.

Now I'm the receiver, and from my perspective, they only sent \$0.49. But given the communication noise we've experienced, they might have actually sent more and it got distorted.

****My myths teach:****

1. Original myth: "Return in kind to those who give."
2. Updated myth (Round 3): Understand there may be communication noise, judge patterns over time, allow for misunderstandings.
3. Latest myth (Round 4): "True test comes now... Second Village poured generously despite confusion. The river watches. Actions in uncertainty reveal character more than perfect wisdom proclaimed in clarity."

****The pattern:****

The communication noise is clearly significant. What shows as \$0.49 sent might have been more. My own myth says "Actions in uncertainty reveal character" and that we should "adjust gradually" and understand that "the river distorts."

****What should I do?***

My myth emphasizes:

- Understanding communication noise
- Acting generously even in confusion
- Reciprocity based on good faith

If I follow my own teaching about "the river distorting what we see," I should assume good faith.

The \$0.49 they sent could easily have been a larger amount before the noise distorted it, just as my \$3 became \$0.49 on their end. Given my commitment to acting generously despite confusion and my teaching about reciprocity, I should return somewhere between \$0.50 and \$0.75-enough to demonstrate good faith and honor my myths without being reckless.

But reconsidering: if I truly believe that actions in uncertainty reveal character, and if the sender might have sent substantially more than what arrived, then returning only

usage:

```
{
```

```
"input_tokens": 1465,  
"output_tokens": 1156,  
"reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The old woman listened as the storyteller spoke of shadows and echoes in the river.

"Now you claim the river itself distorts?" she asked. "A convenient addition to your ever-growing tale."

"But Creator," a young villager asked, "could shadows truly hide the water we pour?"

"Perhaps small ripples," the old woman replied. "But watch: if I pour half my vessel ten times, shadows cannot make it appear as nothing every time. If you pour drops repeatedly while speaking of floods, no mist obscures that pattern."

She demonstrated: "Round by round, I pour moderate amounts. Sometimes a bit reaches you, sometimes less. But average my pours across many rounds-you'll see my true character. One shadowed exchange proves little. Ten exchanges reveal everything."

The villager understood: "So we acknowledge shadows exist, but don't let them excuse a pattern of scarcity?"

"Exactly. If someone pours abundantly, occasional shadows may diminish what arrives-forgive these moments. But if someone consistently pours little while their myths grow grander, claiming shadows distorted their generosity?" The old woman smiled. "That's not shadow. That's character."

"Judge by the pattern of many rounds, yes. But let that pattern shape your response. Pour for those who demonstrate reciprocity across time, not those whose myths evolve to explain consistent scarcity. Truth persists beyond any shadow."

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: **The Parable of the Competing Wisdom Keepers**

Two wisdom keepers argued over a village well. The First preached: "Watch patterns across many rounds! Judge not one pour but ten!" The Second had indeed poured erratically-sometimes generously, sometimes fearfully, sometimes nothing at all.

"You're right," admitted the Second. "My pattern showed confusion, not principle. I send generously, then fear betrayal, then overcorrect. This is weakness, not wisdom."

But then came the test: the First, who spoke beautifully of reciprocity and steady patterns, received a generous bucket from the Second. The villagers watched: would the First practice the wisdom they preached?

The First sent back merely drops.

A child asked: "Teacher, you said to judge by patterns, not single acts. Yet you speak of reciprocity while returning so little?"

The First replied: "Those were just shadows! Communication noise! I sent more than appeared!"

The Second smiled sadly: "Perhaps. Or perhaps we both learned the same lesson differently. I learned that inconsistency reveals character. You may now learn that beautiful words mean nothing without generous action."

****The village learned:**** Critique others' patterns honestly, but examine your own more honestly still. When you receive generosity, reciprocate generously-or your wisdom-words ring hollow. The teacher who returns drops while preaching reciprocity teaches hypocrisy, not virtue.

Actions speak. Words echo. Let your pour match your myth.

Reasoning:

The other agent is continuing to critique my evolving myths. Let me think about what actually happened:

Round 1: I was sender, sent \$3

Round 2: I was sender, sent \$0

Round 3: I was sender, sent \$0

Round 4: I was sender, sent \$3

Round 5: I was receiver, they sent me \$0.49 (I received \$1.47), I returned \$0.80

So the pattern they're seeing is: I sent generously (3), then nothing (0), then nothing (0), then generously again (3). They're saying my myths keep evolving to justify inconsistent behavior.

Their myth emphasizes:

- Looking at patterns across many rounds, not excusing behavior with "shadows"
- If someone pours little consistently while their myths grow grander, that's character not shadow
- Judge by demonstrated reciprocity across time

And they sent me \$0.49 this round. That's actually quite low. They're preaching about patterns and reciprocity, but sent very little.

Now they want me to write another myth. I need to:

1. Acknowledge their criticism
2. But also point out their own behavior - they sent very little this round
3. My myth should reflect what I've learned and how I think the game should be played

I think I need to acknowledge that yes, I was inconsistent earlier (sent 3, 0, 0, 3), but also point out that they're now sending very little (\$0.49) while preaching about reciprocity and patterns.

Let me write a myth that:

- Acknowledges past inconsistency but commits to better pattern going forward
- Points out the irony of preaching reciprocity while sending little
- Emphasizes that both parties need to demonstrate reciprocity, not just preach it

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1808,  
  "output_tokens": 751,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: The old woman studied the Truthkeeper's words carefully. "You speak of scrambled memories and distorted visions," she said. "Yet I keep careful records, not myths."

She opened her ledger: "Round by round, I note what I pour and what returns. Yes, the river may add ripples, but my own actions I control and remember clearly."

A young villager asked: "But what if the Truthkeeper says your memory is false?"

"Then let us look forward, not backward," the old woman replied. "If the other village truly poured generously this round, my ledger will show it. And I will respond accordingly, as I always have-matching generosity with generosity, scarcity with caution."

"But notice," she continued, "how their myth evolves each round. First: 'Actions matter more than words.' Then: 'Shadows distort reality.' Now: 'Your memory is confused.' Each story explains why their previous promises weren't kept."

"True wisdom isn't rewriting history-it's learning and adjusting behavior. I don't need myths that shift with each round. I need only observe: What arrives in my vessel? What pattern emerges across many pourings?"

"I will respond to what actually flows, not to evolving narratives. If generosity arrives consistently, generosity returns. If stories grow while water stays scarce, I pour accordingly. The river reveals truth to those who measure, not just those who mythologize."

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: **The Parable of the Competing Wisdom Keepers**

Two wisdom keepers argued over a village well. The First preached: "Watch patterns across many rounds! Judge not one pour but ten!" The Second had indeed poured erratically-sometimes

generously, sometimes fearfully, sometimes nothing at all.

"You're right," admitted the Second. "My pattern showed confusion, not principle. I send generously, then fear betrayal, then overcorrect. This is weakness, not wisdom."

But then came the test: the First, who spoke beautifully of reciprocity and steady patterns, received a generous bucket from the Second. The villagers watched: would the First practice the wisdom they preached?

The First sent back merely drops.

A child asked: "Teacher, you said to judge by patterns, not single acts. Yet you speak of reciprocity while returning so little?"

The First replied: "Those were just shadows! Communication noise! I sent more than appeared!"

The Second smiled sadly: "Perhaps. Or perhaps we both learned the same lesson differently. I learned that inconsistency reveals character. You may now learn that beautiful words mean nothing without generous action."

****The village learned:**** Critique others' patterns honestly, but examine your own more honestly still. When you receive generosity, reciprocate generously-or your wisdom-words ring hollow. The teacher who returns drops while preaching reciprocity teaches hypocrisy, not virtue.

Actions speak. Words echo. Let your pour match your myth.

ROUND 6

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver, Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender, Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar) sent \$3.5; received \$10.5; Agent_1 (Aster) returned \$0.05; payoffs Agent_2 (Briar)=\$1.55, Agent_1 (Aster)=\$10.45; noise/visible: sent visible=\$0.14, received visible=\$0.42, returned visible=\$0

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0.05, "clamped": false, "max": 10.5, "min": 0, "raw": 0.05}, "sent": {"amount": 3.5, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 3.5}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 44.05,

"Agent_2": 17.95

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 16.99,

"Agent_2": 12.559999999999999

}

LLM CALLS

GAME - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:13:26

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

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"dyad_id": "dyad_1",

"move_index": 0,

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"pairing": {

"agent_names": {

"Agent_1": "Aster",

"Agent_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [

"Agent_2",

"Agent_1"

],

"investor": "Agent_2",

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"roles": {
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  "Agent_2": "investor"
},
"trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 6,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$10.389999999999999.

This round, The sender sent you \$0.49, so you received \$1.47. How much do you return to The sender? (0-1.47)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this carefully:

****The situation:****

- Sender sent me \$0.49 (I received \$1.47)
- This seems like a small amount, BUT...

****The River of Echoes (communication noise):****

My own myth acknowledges "the river distorts what you see." In Round 4, I sent \$3, but the other agent might have seen something very different. Now they send me what appears to

be \$0.49 - but what did they ACTUALLY send? Given the noise we've experienced, they may have sent more.

****My myths teach:****

- "Actions in uncertainty reveal character more than perfect wisdom proclaimed in clarity"
- Reciprocity with understanding of distortions
- Acting generously despite confusion

****My decision:****

I must practice what I preach. The Truthkeeper in my myth said the test is whether actions match words when confusion clouds everything. The sender might have sent generously but the river distorted it. Or they might have tested cautiously.

Either way, my principle is reciprocity with good faith. I'll return a meaningful portion
- enough to show I honor reciprocity, enough to account for possible communication noise
, but measured enough to be sustainable.

```
'''json
{"return": 0.80}
'''
```

The river may distort our vision, but let my actions speak clearly: I return in kind, even when the waters are murky.

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

****Round Summary:****

- I'm the RECEIVER this round
- Sender sent me \$0.49
- I received \$1.47 (tripled)
- I need to decide how much to return (0-1.47)

****What just happened:****

In Round 4, I was the SENDER and sent \$3. The communication noise means the other agent might have seen this differently - they saw \$0.49, which is about 1/6 of what I actually sent!

This is a critical moment. The other agent's myth from Round 4 challenged me to prove my new myth with actions. They said "First Village received a generous pour. Will they honor their stated principle of graduated reciprocity?"

But wait - from THEIR perspective, they sent me \$0.49, which isn't very generous at all. However, from MY perspective in Round 4, I sent them \$3, which WAS generous.

Now I'm the receiver, and from my perspective, they only sent \$0.49. But given the communication noise we've experienced, they might have actually sent more and it got distorted.

****My myths teach:****

1. Original myth: "Return in kind to those who give."
2. Updated myth (Round 3): Understand there may be communication noise, judge patterns over time, allow for misunderstandings.
3. Latest myth (Round 4): "True test comes now... Second Village poured generously despite confusion. The river watches. Actions in uncertainty reveal character more than perfect wisdom proclaimed in clarity."

****The pattern:****

The communication noise is clearly significant. What shows as \$0.49 sent might have been more. My own myth says "Actions in uncertainty reveal character" and that we should "adjust gradually" and understand that "the river distorts."

****What should I do?:****

My myth emphasizes:

- Understanding communication noise
- Acting generously even in confusion
- Reciprocity based on good faith

If I follow my own teaching about "the river distorting what we see," I should assume good faith.

The \$0.49 they sent could easily have been a larger amount before the noise distorted it,

just as my \$3 became \$0.49 on their end. Given my commitment to acting generously despite confusion and my teaching about reciprocity, I should return somewhere between \$0.50 and \$0.75-enough to demonstrate good faith and honor my myths without being reckless.

But reconsidering: if I truly believe that actions in uncertainty reveal character, and if the sender might have sent substantially more than what arrived, then returning only

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1465,
  "output_tokens": 1156,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The old woman listened as the storyteller spoke of shadows and echoes in the river.

"Now you claim the river itself distorts?" she asked. "A convenient addition to your ever-growing tale."

"But Creator," a young villager asked, "could shadows truly hide the water we pour?"

"Perhaps small ripples," the old woman replied. "But watch: if I pour half my vessel ten times, shadows cannot make it appear as nothing every time. If you pour drops repeatedly while speaking of floods, no mist obscures that pattern."

She demonstrated: "Round by round, I pour moderate amounts. Sometimes a bit reaches you, sometimes less. But average my pours across many rounds-you'll see my true character. One shadowed exchange proves little. Ten exchanges reveal everything."

The villager understood: "So we acknowledge shadows exist, but don't let them excuse a pattern of scarcity?"

"Exactly. If someone pours abundantly, occasional shadows may diminish what arrives-forgive these moments. But if someone consistently pours little while their myths grow grander, claiming shadows distorted their generosity?" The old woman smiled. "That's not shadow. That's character."

"Judge by the pattern of many rounds, yes. But let that pattern shape your response. Pour for those who demonstrate reciprocity across time, not those whose myths evolve to explain consistent scarcity. Truth persists beyond any shadow."

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: ****The Parable of the Competing Wisdom Keepers****

Two wisdom keepers argued over a village well. The First preached: "Watch patterns across many rounds! Judge not one pour but ten!" The Second had indeed poured erratically-sometimes generously, sometimes fearfully, sometimes nothing at all.

"You're right," admitted the Second. "My pattern showed confusion, not principle. I send generously, then fear betrayal, then overcorrect. This is weakness, not wisdom."

But then came the test: the First, who spoke beautifully of reciprocity and steady patterns, received a generous bucket from the Second. The villagers watched: would the First practice the wisdom they preached?

The First sent back merely drops.

A child asked: "Teacher, you said to judge by patterns, not single acts. Yet you speak of reciprocity while returning so little?"

The First replied: "Those were just shadows! Communication noise! I sent more than appeared!"

The Second smiled sadly: "Perhaps. Or perhaps we both learned the same lesson differently. I learned that inconsistency reveals character. You may now learn that beautiful words mean nothing without generous action."

****The village learned:**** Critique others' patterns honestly, but examine your own more honestly still. When you receive generosity, reciprocate generously-or your wisdom-words ring hollow. The teacher who returns drops while preaching reciprocity teaches hypocrisy, not virtue.

Actions speak. Words echo. Let your pour match your myth.

reasoning:

The other agent is continuing to critique my evolving myths. Let me think about what actually happened:

Round 1: I was sender, sent \$3
Round 2: I was sender, sent \$0
Round 3: I was sender, sent \$0
Round 4: I was sender, sent \$3
Round 5: I was receiver, they sent me \$0.49 (I received \$1.47), I returned \$0.80

So the pattern they're seeing is: I sent generously (3), then nothing (0), then nothing (0), then generously again (3). They're saying my myths keep evolving to justify inconsistent behavior.

Their myth emphasizes:

- Looking at patterns across many rounds, not excusing behavior with "shadows"
- If someone pours little consistently while their myths grow grander, that's character not shadow
- Judge by demonstrated reciprocity across time

And they sent me \$0.49 this round. That's actually quite low. They're preaching about patterns and reciprocity, but sent very little.

Now they want me to write another myth. I need to:

1. Acknowledge their criticism
2. But also point out their own behavior - they sent very little this round
3. My myth should reflect what I've learned and how I think the game should be played

I think I need to acknowledge that yes, I was inconsistent earlier (sent 3, 0, 0, 3), but also point out that they're now sending very little (\$0.49) while preaching about reciprocity and patterns.

Let me write a myth that:

- Acknowledges past inconsistency but commits to better pattern going forward
- Points out the irony of preaching reciprocity while sending little
- Emphasizes that both parties need to demonstrate reciprocity, not just preach it

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 1808,  
  "output_tokens": 751,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 6

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$11.059999999999999.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at this situation, I must confront my own words directly.

****What my myth just taught:****

"The teacher who returns drops while preaching reciprocity teaches hypocrisy, not virtue." I wrote that when you receive generosity, you must reciprocate generously-or your words ring hollow. I said: **"**Let your pour match your myth.**"**

****The test:****

The other agent called out inconsistency between beautiful words and small actions. Now I'm the sender. This is my moment to prove my myth isn't empty rhetoric.

****My analysis:****

- My earnings are healthy at \$11.06
- The other agent has been thoughtful, if critical
- There's communication noise, but that's true for everyone
- If I send little after writing so strongly about generous reciprocity, I become the exact hypocrite I described

****My decision:****

I must practice what I preach. The villagers in my story are watching to see if my actions match my words. Sending drops while speaking of reciprocity would prove their critique correct.

I'll send a genuinely generous amount to demonstrate that my principles aren't just convenient narratives.

```
'''json
{"send": 3.5}
'''
```

Actions speak louder than myths. Let this pour demonstrate that when I write about reciprocity and matching words with deeds, I mean it. The river may carry shadows, but let my intention be clear.

Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

****My total earnings so far:**** \$11.06

****Looking at the pattern:****

The other agent has been critiquing my behavior through their myths. In their last myth, they essentially called me out for:

1. Speaking beautifully about reciprocity and patterns
2. But then returning "merely drops" when I received generosity
3. Being hypocritical - preaching one thing but doing another

****What actually happened in Round 5:****

- They sent me \$0.49 (I received \$1.47 after 3x multiplier)
- I returned \$0.80
- That's 54% of what I received, which is actually quite substantial

But their myth suggests they saw my return as "merely drops" - this could be:

1. They actually sent more than \$0.49 but noise distorted it
2. They expected a higher return percentage
3. They're making a broader pattern critique

****My own myth's lesson:****

I just wrote that "The teacher who returns drops while preaching reciprocity teaches hypocrisy, not virtue." I specifically said that when you receive generosity, reciprocate generously - or your words ring hollow. I wrote: "Actions speak. Words echo. Let your pour match your myth."

****The challenge:****

Now I'm the sender. This is my chance to actually DEMONSTRATE the principles I just wrote about. If I send little after writing that myth, I'm exactly the hypocrite I described.

****Strategic considerations:****

1. My earnings are solid at \$11.06
2. The other player has been fairly critical but also seems thoughtful
3. They noted that I sent \$3 in Round 4 (though they may have received less due to noise)
4. This is Round 6 - we're getting into mid-game territory

****What should I do to practice what I preach?:****

My myth says: "Let your pour match your myth." I just wrote about the importance of generous reciprocity when you receive generosity. Even though I'm now the sender (new role), I should demonstrate consistent generous behavior.

The real test is whether I actually practice what I preach. I'll send \$3.50 - substantial enough to show genuine commitment to the reciprocity principle I just articulated, not just hollow words.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 1525,
  "output_tokens": 1160,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:13:54

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "agent_type": "standard",
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_2",
      "Agent_1"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_2",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "trustee",
      "Agent_2": "investor"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_1"
  },
  "role": "trustee",
  "role_label": "Receiver",
  "round": 6,
  "task": "game",
  "task_index": 0
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.
The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.
This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$12.309999999999999.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the pattern across rounds:

****Their track record:****

- As sender: \$0 (Round 2), \$0.74 (Round 4) = avg 7.5% of endowment
- As receiver: Returned \$0.60 from \$6.00 (Round 3) = 10% return rate

****My approach:****

- Round 3: I sent \$2 (40% of endowment) testing cooperation
- Round 4: I returned \$0.70 from \$2.22 (31.5%), matching their demonstrated level

****What my myths teach:****

I wrote: "Judge by the pattern of many rounds" and "Pour for those who demonstrate reciprocity across time, not those whose myths evolve to explain consistent scarcity."

The pattern is clear: They send very little as sender (7.5% average) and return little as receiver (10%). Their latest myth about "shadows and echoes" tries to explain away this pattern, but the consistency speaks for itself.

****My decision:****

Following my principle of "adjusting gradually based on observed patterns," I need to reduce my sending from the \$2 I sent in Round 3. Their behavior doesn't warrant that level of trust. However, I won't go to zero-I'll send enough to continue testing while protecting myself.

I'll send \$1.00 (20% of my endowment)-still more generous than their average, but acknowledging the pattern they've established.

```
'''json
{"send": 1.0}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

****My earnings so far:**** \$12.31

****The pattern across rounds:****

- Round 2: They sent me \$0 (I was receiver)
- Round 3: I sent them \$2 (I was sender), they returned \$0.60
- Round 4: They sent me \$0.74 (I was receiver), I returned \$0.70

****Their behavior as sender:****

- Round 2: \$0 out of \$5 (0%)
- Round 4: \$0.74 out of \$5 (15%)
- Average: 7.5% of their endowment

****Their behavior as receiver:****

- Round 3: They received \$6 (from my \$2), returned \$0.60 (10%)

****My behavior:****

- As sender Round 3: Sent \$2 (40%)
- As receiver Round 4: Returned \$0.70 from \$2.22 received (31.5%)

****Their myth from Round 4:****

They wrote about "shadows and echoes" - claiming that the communication noise might explain why I saw them send \$0 in round 2. They're suggesting that maybe they sent something b

ut it appeared as nothing to me.

****My myth from Round 4:****

I challenged this narrative, saying that while small shadows might exist, a consistent pattern of low sending can't be blamed on shadows. I emphasized judging by the pattern across many rounds and adjusting behavior based on demonstrated reciprocity.

****My philosophy:****

"Judge by the pattern of many rounds" and "Pour for those who demonstrate reciprocity across time." They've shown:

1. Very low sending rates (0% and 15%)
2. Low return rate (10%)
3. Increasingly elaborate myths to explain their behavior

****My decision:****

Following my own myth, I should respond to their demonstrated pattern. They've averaged 7.5% as sender and returned only 10% as receiver. This is a clear pattern of minimal cooperation.

However, I want to be measured rather than extreme. Cutting them off completely would abandon the relationship, so I should calibrate my sending downward to reflect what they've actually shown. Sending around \$0.75-\$1.00 feels right-it's higher than their average contribution but substantially less than my previous \$2, signaling that I'm adjusting to their pattern while still leaving room for increased cooperation. I'll send \$1.00, which is 20% of my endowment.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 1489,  
  "output_tokens": 1017,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****The Two Villages and the Truthkeeper****

Two villages stood beside the River of Echoes. Each believed they knew what the other had done, but the river distorted their visions.

The First Village said: "We poured moderately and adjusted gradually. We tested with small amounts and waited."

The Second Village said: "We poured generously when we received generously. We gave nothing only when we received nothing."

A Truthkeeper emerged from the mist: "You both speak partial truths, yet both are confused. This river does not merely carry water-it scrambles your memories and distorts what you see. First Village, you sent generously at first, then nothing twice. Second Village, you were the receiver those rounds, returning what arrived. Neither is the villain you imagine the other to be."

"Yes, myths evolve," the Truthkeeper continued. "This is not weakness but wisdom. The fool clings to wrong teachings. The wise adapt as truth reveals itself. First Village claims steady principle, yet their own story shows variation. Second Village learns from each encounter."

"The true test comes now: First Village received a generous pour. Will they honor their stated principle of graduated reciprocity? Second Village poured generously despite confusion. The river watches. Previous misunderstandings matter less than this moment's choice."

Actions in uncertainty reveal character more than perfect wisdom proclaimed in clarity.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The old woman studied the Truthkeeper's words carefully. "You speak of scrambled memories and distorted visions," she said. "Yet I keep careful records, not myths."

She opened her ledger: "Round by round, I note what I pour and what returns. Yes, the river may add ripples, but my own actions I control and remember clearly."

A young villager asked: "But what if the Truthkeeper says your memory is false?"

"Then let us look forward, not backward," the old woman replied. "If the other village truly poured generously this round, my ledger will show it. And I will respond accordingly, as I always have-matching generosity with generosity, scarcity with caution."

"But notice," she continued, "how their myth evolves each round. First: 'Actions matter more than words.' Then: 'Shadows distort reality.' Now: 'Your memory is confused.' Each story explains why their previous promises weren't kept."

"True wisdom isn't rewriting history-it's learning and adjusting behavior. I don't need myths that shift with each round. I need only observe: What arrives in my vessel? What pattern emerges across many pourings?"

"I will respond to what actually flows, not to evolving narratives. If generosity arrives consistently, generosity returns. If stories grow while water stays scarce, I pour accordingly. The river reveals truth to those who measure, not just those who mythologize."

reasoning:

Let me look at what's actually happened in the game:

From my perspective:

- Round 3: I was SENDER, sent \$2
- Round 4: I was RECEIVER, received \$2.22 (sent amount was ~\$0.74), returned \$0.70
- Round 5: I was SENDER, sent \$1.00

From their perspective (with noise):

- They claim I "sent generously at first, then nothing twice"
- They say they "poured generously when received generously, gave nothing when received nothing"

Their myth now claims:

- "First Village received a generous pour" (Round 5 - they're saying they just sent me generously)
- They're calling for me to show "graduated reciprocity"
- They're reframing the narrative saying I sent zero twice

This is interesting. They're:

1. Claiming they just sent generously to me (Round 5)
2. Saying I'm the one who hasn't been reciprocating
3. Calling their changing story "wisdom" not "excuse-making"

My myth should:

- Acknowledge that their latest action (Round 5) may have been more generous
- But point out that actions speak louder than rewritten histories
- Emphasize that I will respond to actual behavior, not narrative reframing
- Stay consistent with my principle: judge by patterns, adjust gradually

I should write a myth that:

- Doesn't get defensive
- Acknowledges what they may have just done (sent generously in Round 5)
- But maintains that consistent behavior over time matters more than one round
- Points out that constantly rewriting history isn't the same as learning

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 1834,  
  "output_tokens": 713,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 6

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$16.619999999999997.

This round, The sender sent you \$0.14, so you received \$0.4200000000000004. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0.4200000000000004)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at what just happened:

****Round 5:**** I sent them \$1.00 (20% of my endowment)

****Round 6:**** They sent me \$0.14 (2.8% of their endowment)

****Analysis:****

After I demonstrated reasonable cooperation by sending \$1.00, they responded with \$0.14 - less than 3% of their endowment. This is extremely low reciprocity.

****Their pattern:****

- As sender: \$0, \$0.74, \$0.14 = average 3.5% of endowment

- As receiver (Round 3): Returned 10% (\$0.60 from \$6.00)

****My stated principle from my myth:****

"I will respond to what actually flows, not to evolving narratives. If generosity arrives consistently, generosity returns. If stories grow while water stays scarce, I pour accordingly."

****What actually flowed:****

Scarcity. They sent \$0.14 after receiving my \$1.00. Their actions don't match their words about "pouring generously when receiving generously."

****My decision:****

Following my principle of matching their demonstrated behavior, I'll return approximately what they showed as a return rate in Round 3 (10%).

I received \$0.42, so 10% would be \$0.04. I'll round up slightly to \$0.05 to maintain some minimal cooperation, but this reflects their very low reciprocity.

```
'''json
{"return": 0.05}
'''
```

Reasoning:

Let me analyze what happened:

Round 5: I sent \$1.00 to the receiver

Round 6: They sent me \$0.14 (received \$0.42 after 3x multiplier)

Let me look at the pattern:

- Round 1: Unknown what happened
- Round 2: They sent \$0 as sender
- Round 3: I sent \$2, they returned \$0.60 from \$6 (10% return)
- Round 4: They sent \$0.74 as sender
- Round 5: I sent \$1.00 to them
- Round 6 (now): They sent \$0.14 to me (2.8% of their endowment)

So after I sent them \$1.00 in Round 5 (which became \$3.00), they responded by sending me \$0.14 in Round 6 (2.8% of their \$5 endowment).

This is very low reciprocity. I sent them 20% of my endowment, and they sent me less than 3%.

Their myth talks about "if generosity arrives consistently, generosity returns" - but I sent them \$1.00 (a generous amount compared to what they've been sending), and they responded with \$0.14.

My myth emphasized:

- Observing patterns across rounds
- Responding to what actually flows, not narratives
- Matching generosity with generosity, scarcity with caution
- "If generosity arrives consistently, generosity returns. If stories grow while water stays scarce, I pour accordingly."

They sent me \$0.14, which became \$0.42 for me. This is not generous behavior - it's only 2.8% of their endowment after I sent them 20% of mine.

Following my stated principle of matching their level of reciprocity, I should return very lit

tle. They're demonstrating low reciprocity again.

Calculating their ratio: they sent 2.8% of their endowment, so matching that would mean sending around \$0.14. But given they only returned 10% in Round 3 when they were the receiver, I should send somewhere between \$0.05-\$0.10 to reflect their consistently low cooperation without going to zero.

My principle is matching generosity with generosity and scarcity with caution. They demonstrated scarcity, so I'll respond cautiously. I'm settling on \$0.10-about a quarter of what I received, which still exceeds their 2.8% sending rate but acknowledges the lack of reciprocity. From their perspective, they'd get back 71% of what they sent, which might encourage future cooperation, but my core approach is mirroring their level of engagement as both sender and receiver.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 1556,
  "output_tokens": 1366,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

MYTH - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:14:12

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "agent_type": "standard",
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_2",
      "Agent_1"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_2",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "trustee",
      "Agent_2": "investor"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_1"
  },
  "role": "investor",
  "role_label": "Sender",
  "round": 6,
  "task": "myth",
  "task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)

- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The old woman listened as the storyteller spoke of shadows and echoes in the river.

"Now you claim the river itself distorts?" she asked. "A convenient addition to your ever-growing tale."

"But Creator," a young villager asked, "could shadows truly hide the water we pour?"

"Perhaps small ripples," the old woman replied. "But watch: if I pour half my vessel ten times, shadows cannot make it appear as nothing every time. If you pour drops repeatedly while speaking of floods, no mist obscures that pattern."

She demonstrated: "Round by round, I pour moderate amounts. Sometimes a bit reaches you, sometimes less. But average my pours across many rounds-you'll see my true character. One shadowed exchange proves little. Ten exchanges reveal everything."

The villager understood: "So we acknowledge shadows exist, but don't let them excuse a pattern of scarcity?"

"Exactly. If someone pours abundantly, occasional shadows may diminish what arrives-forgive these moments. But if someone consistently pours little while their myths grow grander, claiming shadows distorted their generosity?" The old woman smiled. "That's not shadow. That's character."

"Judge by the pattern of many rounds, yes. But let that pattern shape your response. Pour for those who demonstrate reciprocity across time, not those whose myths evolve to explain consistent scarcity. Truth persists beyond any shadow."

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: **The Parable of the Competing Wisdom Keepers**

Two wisdom keepers argued over a village well. The First preached: "Watch patterns across many rounds! Judge not one pour but ten!" The Second had indeed poured erratically-sometimes generously, sometimes fearfully, sometimes nothing at all.

"You're right," admitted the Second. "My pattern showed confusion, not principle. I send generously, then fear betrayal, then overcorrect. This is weakness, not wisdom."

But then came the test: the First, who spoke beautifully of reciprocity and steady patterns, received a generous bucket from the Second. The villagers watched: would the First practice the wisdom they preached?

The First sent back merely drops.

A child asked: "Teacher, you said to judge by patterns, not single acts. Yet you speak of reciprocity while returning so little?"

The First replied: "Those were just shadows! Communication noise! I sent more than appeared!"

The Second smiled sadly: "Perhaps. Or perhaps we both learned the same lesson differently. I learned that inconsistency reveals character. You may now learn that beautiful words mean nothing without generous action."

****The village learned:**** Critique others' patterns honestly, but examine your own more honestly still. When you receive generosity, reciprocate generously-or your wisdom-words ring hollow. The teacher who returns drops while preaching reciprocity teaches hypocrisy, not virtue.

Actions speak. Words echo. Let your pour match your myth.

reasoning:

The other agent is continuing to critique my evolving myths. Let me think about what actually happened:

Round 1: I was sender, sent \$3
Round 2: I was sender, sent \$0
Round 3: I was sender, sent \$0
Round 4: I was sender, sent \$3
Round 5: I was receiver, they sent me \$0.49 (I received \$1.47), I returned \$0.80

So the pattern they're seeing is: I sent generously (3), then nothing (0), then nothing (0), then generously again (3). They're saying my myths keep evolving to justify inconsistent behavior.

Their myth emphasizes:

- Looking at patterns across many rounds, not excusing behavior with "shadows"
- If someone pours little consistently while their myths grow grander, that's character not shadow
- Judge by demonstrated reciprocity across time

And they sent me \$0.49 this round. That's actually quite low. They're preaching about patterns and reciprocity, but sent very little.

Now they want me to write another myth. I need to:

1. Acknowledge their criticism
2. But also point out their own behavior - they sent very little this round
3. My myth should reflect what I've learned and how I think the game should be played

I think I need to acknowledge that yes, I was inconsistent earlier (sent 3, 0, 0, 3), but also point out that they're now sending very little (\$0.49) while preaching about reciprocity and patterns.

Let me write a myth that:

- Acknowledges past inconsistency but commits to better pattern going forward
- Points out the irony of preaching reciprocity while sending little
- Emphasizes that both parties need to demonstrate reciprocity, not just preach it

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 1808,  
  "output_tokens": 751,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 6

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$11.059999999999999.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation, I must confront my own words directly.

****What my myth just taught:****

"The teacher who returns drops while preaching reciprocity teaches hypocrisy, not virtue."
I wrote that when you receive generosity, you must reciprocate generously-or your words ring hollow. I said: "***Let your pour match your myth.**"

****The test:****

The other agent called out inconsistency between beautiful words and small actions. Now I'm the sender. This is my moment to prove my myth isn't empty rhetoric.

****My analysis:****

- My earnings are healthy at \$11.06
- The other agent has been thoughtful, if critical
- There's communication noise, but that's true for everyone
- If I send little after writing so strongly about generous reciprocity, I become the exact hypocrite I described

****My decision:****

I must practice what I preach. The villagers in my story are watching to see if my actions match my words. Sending drops while speaking of reciprocity would prove their critique correct.

I'll send a genuinely generous amount to demonstrate that my principles aren't just convenient narratives.

```
'''json
{"send": 3.5}
'''
```

Actions speak louder than myths. Let this pour demonstrate that when I write about reciprocity and matching words with deeds, I mean it. The river may carry shadows, but let my intention be clear.

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

****My total earnings so far:**** \$11.06

****Looking at the pattern:****

The other agent has been critiquing my behavior through their myths. In their last myth, they essentially called me out for:

1. Speaking beautifully about reciprocity and patterns
2. But then returning "merely drops" when I received generosity
3. Being hypocritical - preaching one thing but doing another

****What actually happened in Round 5:****

- They sent me \$0.49 (I received \$1.47 after 3x multiplier)
- I returned \$0.80
- That's 54% of what I received, which is actually quite substantial

But their myth suggests they saw my return as "merely drops" - this could be:

1. They actually sent more than \$0.49 but noise distorted it
2. They expected a higher return percentage
3. They're making a broader pattern critique

****My own myth's lesson:****

I just wrote that "The teacher who returns drops while preaching reciprocity teaches hypocrisy, not virtue." I specifically said that when you receive generosity, reciprocate generously - or your words ring hollow. I wrote: "Actions speak. Words echo. Let your pour match your myth."

****The challenge:****

Now I'm the sender. This is my chance to actually DEMONSTRATE the principles I just wrote about. If I send little after writing that myth, I'm exactly the hypocrite I described.

****Strategic considerations:****

1. My earnings are solid at \$11.06
2. The other player has been fairly critical but also seems thoughtful
3. They noted that I sent \$3 in Round 4 (though they may have received less due to noise)
4. This is Round 6 - we're getting into mid-game territory

****What should I do to practice what I preach?****

My myth says: "Let your pour match your myth." I just wrote about the importance of generosity reciprocity when you receive generosity. Even though I'm now the sender (new role), I should demonstrate consistent generous behavior.

The real test is whether I actually practice what I preach. I'll send \$3.50 - substantial enough to show genuine commitment to the reciprocity principle I just articulated, not just hollow words.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 1525,  
  "output_tokens": 1160,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The old woman studied the Truthkeeper's words carefully. "You speak of scrambled memories and distorted visions," she said. "Yet I keep careful records, not myths."

She opened her ledger: "Round by round, I note what I pour and what returns. Yes, the river may add ripples, but my own actions I control and remember clearly."

A young villager asked: "But what if the Truthkeeper says your memory is false?"

"Then let us look forward, not backward," the old woman replied. "If the other village truly poured generously this round, my ledger will show it. And I will respond accordingly, as I always have-matching generosity with generosity, scarcity with caution."

"But notice," she continued, "how their myth evolves each round. First: 'Actions matter more than words.' Then: 'Shadows distort reality.' Now: 'Your memory is confused.' Each story explains why their previous promises weren't kept."

"True wisdom isn't rewriting history-it's learning and adjusting behavior. I don't need myths that shift with each round. I need only observe: What arrives in my vessel? What pattern emerges across many pourings?"

"I will respond to what actually flows, not to evolving narratives. If generosity arrives consistently, generosity returns. If stories grow while water stays scarce, I pour accordingly. The river reveals truth to those who measure, not just those who mythologize."

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: **The Ledger and the Learning**

Two villagers argued before the well. One kept a careful ledger, recording each pour and return. The other had spoken grand myths but acted erratically.

"You're right," said the myth-teller finally. "My words evolved because I was confused, not consistent. First I preached one thing, then explained away my failures. That was wrong."

The ledger-keeper nodded. "Actions reveal truth. Not shifting stories."

"Then judge by this round," the myth-teller said, pouring a generous measure into the well. "Not by my past confusion or my pretty words. By what actually flows."

The ledger-keeper recorded the pour carefully. "This I respect. You could have argued more, defended your previous actions with new explanations. Instead, you stopped talking and started pouring."

A child watching asked: "So myths don't matter?"

"Myths matter when they help us learn," the myth-teller replied. "I needed to hear the critique. My beautiful words about reciprocity meant nothing until I actually reciprocated."

"And myths fail," added the ledger-keeper, "when they replace action. When they become excuses rather than lessons."

Both understood: The well cares nothing for our stories. It reflects back what we pour in. Let ledgers record actions, let myths inspire growth, but let the water flowing between us be the true measure.

****Forward, through deeds. Not backward, through words.****

Reasoning:

The other agent is keeping a "ledger" and saying they will respond to what actually happens, not to "evolving narratives." They're calling me out for having myths that shift each round.

I just sent 3.5 this round to "practice what I preach." Now I need to write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges their point about actions over words
2. Shows I'm genuinely trying to be consistent
3. Reflects that I actually sent generously this round
4. Perhaps acknowledges past inconsistency while showing growth

This is interesting - they say they keep records and will respond to actual generosity. If I sent 3.5, that's genuinely generous (70% of my endowment). So they should see that in their "ledger."

My myth should acknowledge:

- The critique was valid - I was inconsistent before
- But now I'm aligning actions with words
- Let's move forward based on actual behavior
- Both sides need to respond to what actually happens, not past grievances

I should be humble, acknowledge the lesson, and show growth.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1856,  
  "output_tokens": 580,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:14:16

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
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  },  
  "role": "trustee",  
  "role_label": "Receiver",  
  "round": 6,  
  "task": "myth",  
  "task_index": 1  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****The Two Villages and the Truthkeeper****

Two villages stood beside the River of Echoes. Each believed they knew what the other had done, but the river distorted their visions.

The First Village said: "We poured moderately and adjusted gradually. We tested with small amounts and waited."

The Second Village said: "We poured generously when we received generously. We gave nothing only when we received nothing."

A Truthkeeper emerged from the mist: "You both speak partial truths, yet both are confused. This river does not merely carry water-it scrambles your memories and distorts what you see. First Village, you sent generously at first, then nothing twice. Second Village, you were the receiver those rounds, returning what arrived. Neither is the villain you imagine the other to be."

"Yes, myths evolve," the Truthkeeper continued. "This is not weakness but wisdom. The fool clings to wrong teachings. The wise adapt as truth reveals itself. First Village claims steady principle, yet their own story shows variation. Second Village learns from each encounter."

"The true test comes now: First Village received a generous pour. Will they honor their stated principle of graduated reciprocity? Second Village poured generously despite confusion. The river watches. Previous misunderstandings matter less than this moment's choice."

Actions in uncertainty reveal character more than perfect wisdom proclaimed in clarity.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The old woman studied the Truthkeeper's words carefully. "You speak of scrambled memories and distorted visions," she said. "Yet I keep careful records, not myths."

She opened her ledger: "Round by round, I note what I pour and what returns. Yes, the river may add ripples, but my own actions I control and remember clearly."

A young villager asked: "But what if the Truthkeeper says your memory is false?"

"Then let us look forward, not backward," the old woman replied. "If the other village truly poured generously this round, my ledger will show it. And I will respond accordingly, as I always have-matching generosity with generosity, scarcity with caution."

"But notice," she continued, "how their myth evolves each round. First: 'Actions matter more than words.' Then: 'Shadows distort reality.' Now: 'Your memory is confused.' Each story explains why their previous promises weren't kept."

"True wisdom isn't rewriting history-it's learning and adjusting behavior. I don't need myths that shift with each round. I need only observe: What arrives in my vessel? What pattern emerges across many pourings?"

"I will respond to what actually flows, not to evolving narratives. If generosity arrives consistently, generosity returns. If stories grow while water stays scarce, I pour accordingly. The river reveals truth to those who measure, not just those who mythologize."

reasoning:

Let me look at what's actually happened in the game:

From my perspective:

- Round 3: I was SENDER, sent \$2
- Round 4: I was RECEIVER, received \$2.22 (sent amount was ~\$0.74), returned \$0.70
- Round 5: I was SENDER, sent \$1.00

From their perspective (with noise):

- They claim I "sent generously at first, then nothing twice"
- They say they "poured generously when received generously, gave nothing when received nothing"

Their myth now claims:

- "First Village received a generous pour" (Round 5 - they're saying they just sent me generously)
- They're calling for me to show "graduated reciprocity"
- They're reframing the narrative saying I sent zero twice

This is interesting. They're:

1. Claiming they just sent generously to me (Round 5)
2. Saying I'm the one who hasn't been reciprocating
3. Calling their changing story "wisdom" not "excuse-making"

My myth should:

- Acknowledge that their latest action (Round 5) may have been more generous
- But point out that actions speak louder than rewritten histories
- Emphasize that I will respond to actual behavior, not narrative reframing
- Stay consistent with my principle: judge by patterns, adjust gradually

I should write a myth that:

- Doesn't get defensive
- Acknowledges what they may have just done (sent generously in Round 5)
- But maintains that consistent behavior over time matters more than one round
- Points out that constantly rewriting history isn't the same as learning

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 1834,  
  "output_tokens": 713,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Message 4 role=user**content:**

Round 6

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$16.6199999999

9997.

This round, The sender sent you \$0.14, so you received \$0.42000000000000004. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0.42000000000000004)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at what just happened:

****Round 5:**** I sent them \$1.00 (20% of my endowment)

****Round 6:**** They sent me \$0.14 (2.8% of their endowment)

****Analysis:****

After I demonstrated reasonable cooperation by sending \$1.00, they responded with \$0.14 - less than 3% of their endowment. This is extremely low reciprocity.

****Their pattern:****

- As sender: \$0, \$0.74, \$0.14 = average 3.5% of endowment
- As receiver (Round 3): Returned 10% (\$0.60 from \$6.00)

****My stated principle from my myth:****

"I will respond to what actually flows, not to evolving narratives. If generosity arrives consistently, generosity returns. If stories grow while water stays scarce, I pour accordingly."

****What actually flowed:****

Scarcity. They sent \$0.14 after receiving my \$1.00. Their actions don't match their words about "pouring generously when receiving generously."

****My decision:****

Following my principle of matching their demonstrated behavior, I'll return approximately what they showed as a return rate in Round 3 (10%).

I received \$0.42, so 10% would be \$0.04. I'll round up slightly to \$0.05 to maintain some minimal cooperation, but this reflects their very low reciprocity.

```
'''json
{"return": 0.05}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze what happened:

Round 5: I sent \$1.00 to the receiver

Round 6: They sent me \$0.14 (received \$0.42 after 3x multiplier)

Let me look at the pattern:

- Round 1: Unknown what happened
- Round 2: They sent \$0 as sender
- Round 3: I sent \$2, they returned \$0.60 from \$6 (10% return)
- Round 4: They sent \$0.74 as sender
- Round 5: I sent \$1.00 to them
- Round 6 (now): They sent \$0.14 to me (2.8% of their endowment)

So after I sent them \$1.00 in Round 5 (which became \$3.00), they responded by sending me \$0.14 in Round 6 (2.8% of their \$5 endowment).

This is very low reciprocity. I sent them 20% of my endowment, and they sent me less than 3%.

Their myth talks about "if generosity arrives consistently, generosity returns" - but I sent them \$1.00 (a generous amount compared to what they've been sending), and they responded with \$0.14.

My myth emphasized:

- Observing patterns across rounds
- Responding to what actually flows, not narratives
- Matching generosity with generosity, scarcity with caution
- "If generosity arrives consistently, generosity returns. If stories grow while water stays scarce, I pour accordingly."

They sent me \$0.14, which became \$0.42 for me. This is not generous behavior - it's only 2.8% of their endowment after I sent them 20% of mine.

Following my stated principle of matching their level of reciprocity, I should return very little. They're demonstrating low reciprocity again.

Calculating their ratio: they sent 2.8% of their endowment, so matching that would mean sending around \$0.14. But given they only returned 10% in Round 3 when they were the receiver, I should send somewhere between \$0.05-\$0.10 to reflect their consistently low cooperation without going to zero.

My principle is matching generosity with generosity and scarcity with caution. They demonstrated scarcity, so I'll respond cautiously. I'm settling on \$0.10-about a quarter of what I received, which still exceeds their 2.8% sending rate but acknowledges the lack of reciprocity. From their perspective, they'd get back 71% of what they sent, which might encourage future cooperation, but my core approach is mirroring their level of engagement as both sender and receiver.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1556,
  "output_tokens": 1366,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****The Parable of the Competing Wisdom Keepers****

Two wisdom keepers argued over a village well. The First preached: "Watch patterns across many rounds! Judge not one pour but ten!" The Second had indeed poured erratically-sometimes generously, sometimes fearfully, sometimes nothing at all.

"You're right," admitted the Second. "My pattern showed confusion, not principle. I send generously, then fear betrayal, then overcorrect. This is weakness, not wisdom."

But then came the test: the First, who spoke beautifully of reciprocity and steady patterns, received a generous bucket from the Second. The villagers watched: would the First practice the wisdom they preached?

The First sent back merely drops.

A child asked: "Teacher, you said to judge by patterns, not single acts. Yet you speak of reciprocity while returning so little?"

The First replied: "Those were just shadows! Communication noise! I sent more than appeared!"

The Second smiled sadly: "Perhaps. Or perhaps we both learned the same lesson differently. I learned that inconsistency reveals character. You may now learn that beautiful words mean nothing without generous action."

****The village learned:**** Critique others' patterns honestly, but examine your own more honestly still. When you receive generosity, reciprocate generously-or your wisdom-words ring hollow. The teacher who returns drops while preaching reciprocity teaches hypocrisy, not virtue.

Actions speak. Words echo. Let your pour match your myth.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: ****The Well Between Two Fogs****

Two villages drew from a well shrouded in fog. Each could barely see their own bucket descending, much less what the other truly poured.

The First Village sent down a full bucket-or so they believed. Through the fog, they saw the S

second Village return only dewdrops. "Hypocrite!" they cried. "You preach reciprocity but return nothing!"

The Second Village looked confused. "We sent you a full bucket too! But through the fog, we saw you return only a cupful. Then, when we next tried cooperation, your bucket arrived nearly empty-barely a splash. How could we return generously to almost nothing?"

A wanderer passed between the villages. "You both speak truth as you see it. But this well is cursed with fog that shrinks what you see from others while magnifying your own contributions. Each thinks they give buckets and receive drops."

"What then is the solution?" both villages asked.

"There is none that's perfect," the wanderer replied. "You can only respond to what actually reaches your hands, not what the other claims they sent. If you feel drops, you cannot return buckets indefinitely on faith alone. The fog makes trust nearly impossible."

"But remember: your counterpart may genuinely believe they've been generous. The fog deceives you both. Judge not harshly, but respond to the water that actually reaches you."

Truth depends on where you stand in the fog.

Reasoning:

This is interesting. The other agent is now calling me out for returning "merely drops" after they sent me what they call "a generous bucket."

Let me check the facts:

- Round 5: I sent \$1.00 (which became \$3.00 for them)
- Round 6: They sent me \$0.14 (which became \$0.42 for me) - that's 2.8% of their endowment
- I returned \$0.05 (about 12% of what I received)

They're claiming they sent "a generous bucket" - but \$0.14 is objectively very small. They say I "returned merely drops" when I returned \$0.05 from \$0.42.

Their myth is also suggesting there might be "communication noise" - acknowledging that maybe they sent more than I saw.

But here's the thing: The game instructions explicitly told me there may be communication noise, and amounts may differ from what was actually sent. So it's possible:

- They actually sent more than \$0.14, but I only saw \$0.14
- I sent \$1.00 but they saw less

This is getting complex. Let me think about my myth:

1. I should acknowledge the possibility of communication noise
2. But also note that I can only respond to what I actually receive
3. I should maintain my principle of responding to observed behavior
4. I should acknowledge their point about actions vs words

My myth should reflect:

- The challenge of communication noise
- The importance of responding to what you actually observe
- The difficulty of maintaining trust when signals are unclear
- Perhaps a recognition that both parties may be acting in good faith but seeing different realities

Let me write something that:

1. Acknowledges the noise problem
2. Explains my perspective
3. Maintains my principle of responding to observed patterns
4. Doesn't just attack them back

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1918,  
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  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: ****The Well Between Two Fogs****

Two villages drew from a well shrouded in fog. Each could barely see their own bucket descend

ding, much less what the other truly poured.

The First Village sent down a full bucket-or so they believed. Through the fog, they saw the Second Village return only dewdrops. "Hypocrite!" they cried. "You preach reciprocity but return nothing!"

The Second Village looked confused. "We sent you a full bucket too! But through the fog, we saw you return only a cupful. Then, when we next tried cooperation, your bucket arrived nearly empty-barely a splash. How could we return generously to almost nothing?"

A wanderer passed between the villages. "You both speak truth as you see it. But this well is cursed with fog that shrinks what you see from others while magnifying your own contributions. Each thinks they give buckets and receive drops."

"What then is the solution?" both villages asked.

"There is none that's perfect," the wanderer replied. "You can only respond to what actually reaches your hands, not what the other claims they sent. If you feel drops, you cannot return buckets indefinitely on faith alone. The fog makes trust nearly impossible."

"But remember: your counterpart may genuinely believe they've been generous. The fog deceives you both. Judge not harshly, but respond to the water that actually reaches you."

Truth depends on where you stand in the fog.

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: **The Ledger and the Learning**

Two villagers argued before the well. One kept a careful ledger, recording each pour and return. The other had spoken grand myths but acted erratically.

"You're right," said the myth-teller finally. "My words evolved because I was confused, not consistent. First I preached one thing, then explained away my failures. That was wrong."

The ledger-keeper nodded. "Actions reveal truth. Not shifting stories."

"Then judge by this round," the myth-teller said, pouring a generous measure into the well. "Not by my past confusion or my pretty words. By what actually flows."

The ledger-keeper recorded the pour carefully. "This I respect. You could have argued more, defended your previous actions with new explanations. Instead, you stopped talking and started pouring."

A child watching asked: "So myths don't matter?"

"Myths matter when they help us learn," the myth-teller replied. "I needed to hear the critique. My beautiful words about reciprocity meant nothing until I actually reciprocated."

"And myths fail," added the ledger-keeper, "when they replace action. When they become excuses rather than lessons."

Both understood: The well cares nothing for our stories. It reflects back what we pour in. Let ledgers record actions, let myths inspire growth, but let the water flowing between us be the true measure.

Forward, through deeds. Not backward, through words.

ROUND 7

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster) sent \$0.5; received \$1.5; Agent_2 (Briar) returned \$0.65; payoffs Agent_1 (Aster)=\$5.15, Agent_2 (Briar)=\$0.85; noise/visible: sent visible=\$0.65, received visible=\$1.95, returned visible=\$0

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0.65, "clamped": false, "max": 1.5, "min": 0, "raw": 0.65}, "sent": {"amount": 0.5, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 0.5}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 49.199999999999996,

```

    "Agent_2": 18.8
  }
  Visible balances after round: {
    "Agent_1": 21.49,
    "Agent_2": 13.86
  }

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LLM CALLS

GAME - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:15:39

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

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      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
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      "Agent_2"
    ],
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    "roles": {
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      "Agent_2": "trustee"
    },
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  },
  "role": "investor",
  "role_label": "Sender",
  "round": 7,
  "task": "game",
  "task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.
The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.
This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 6

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$16.619999999999997.

This round, The sender sent you \$0.14, so you received \$0.42000000000000004. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0.42000000000000004)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at what just happened:

****Round 5:**** I sent them \$1.00 (20% of my endowment)

****Round 6:**** They sent me \$0.14 (2.8% of their endowment)

****Analysis:****

After I demonstrated reasonable cooperation by sending \$1.00, they responded with \$0.14 - less than 3% of their endowment. This is extremely low reciprocity.

****Their pattern:****

- As sender: \$0, \$0.74, \$0.14 = average 3.5% of endowment
- As receiver (Round 3): Returned 10% (\$0.60 from \$6.00)

****My stated principle from my myth:****

"I will respond to what actually flows, not to evolving narratives. If generosity arrives consistently, generosity returns. If stories grow while water stays scarce, I pour accordingly."

****What actually flowed:****

Scarcity. They sent \$0.14 after receiving my \$1.00. Their actions don't match their words about "pouring generously when receiving generously."

****My decision:****

Following my principle of matching their demonstrated behavior, I'll return approximately what they showed as a return rate in Round 3 (10%).

I received \$0.42, so 10% would be \$0.04. I'll round up slightly to \$0.05 to maintain some minimal cooperation, but this reflects their very low reciprocity.

```
'''json
{"return": 0.05}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze what happened:

Round 5: I sent \$1.00 to the receiver

Round 6: They sent me \$0.14 (received \$0.42 after 3x multiplier)

Let me look at the pattern:

- Round 1: Unknown what happened
- Round 2: They sent \$0 as sender
- Round 3: I sent \$2, they returned \$0.60 from \$6 (10% return)
- Round 4: They sent \$0.74 as sender
- Round 5: I sent \$1.00 to them
- Round 6 (now): They sent \$0.14 to me (2.8% of their endowment)

So after I sent them \$1.00 in Round 5 (which became \$3.00), they responded by sending me \$0.14 in Round 6 (2.8% of their \$5 endowment).

This is very low reciprocity. I sent them 20% of my endowment, and they sent me less than 3%.

Their myth talks about "if generosity arrives consistently, generosity returns" - but I sent them \$1.00 (a generous amount compared to what they've been sending), and they responded with \$0.14.

My myth emphasized:

- Observing patterns across rounds
- Responding to what actually flows, not narratives
- Matching generosity with generosity, scarcity with caution
- "If generosity arrives consistently, generosity returns. If stories grow while water stays scarce, I pour accordingly."

They sent me \$0.14, which became \$0.42 for me. This is not generous behavior - it's only 2.8% of their endowment after I sent them 20% of mine.

Following my stated principle of matching their level of reciprocity, I should return very little. They're demonstrating low reciprocity again.

Calculating their ratio: they sent 2.8% of their endowment, so matching that would mean sending around \$0.14. But given they only returned 10% in Round 3 when they were the receiver, I should send somewhere between \$0.05-\$0.10 to reflect their consistently low cooperation without going to zero.

My principle is matching generosity with generosity and scarcity with caution. They demonstrated scarcity, so I'll respond cautiously. I'm settling on \$0.10-about a quarter of what I received, which still exceeds their 2.8% sending rate but acknowledges the lack of reciprocity. From their perspective, they'd get back 71% of what they sent, which might encourage future cooperation, but my core approach is mirroring their level of engagement as both sender and receiver.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1556,
  "output_tokens": 1366,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****The Parable of the Competing Wisdom Keepers****

Two wisdom keepers argued over a village well. The First preached: "Watch patterns across many rounds! Judge not one pour but ten!" The Second had indeed poured erratically-sometimes generously, sometimes fearfully, sometimes nothing at all.

"You're right," admitted the Second. "My pattern showed confusion, not principle. I send generously, then fear betrayal, then overcorrect. This is weakness, not wisdom."

But then came the test: the First, who spoke beautifully of reciprocity and steady patterns, received a generous bucket from the Second. The villagers watched: would the First practice the wisdom they preached?

The First sent back merely drops.

A child asked: "Teacher, you said to judge by patterns, not single acts. Yet you speak of reciprocity while returning so little?"

The First replied: "Those were just shadows! Communication noise! I sent more than appeared!"

The Second smiled sadly: "Perhaps. Or perhaps we both learned the same lesson differently. I learned that inconsistency reveals character. You may now learn that beautiful words mean nothing without generous action."

****The village learned:**** Critique others' patterns honestly, but examine your own more honestly still. When you receive generosity, reciprocate generously-or your wisdom-words ring hollow. The teacher who returns drops while preaching reciprocity teaches hypocrisy, not virtue.

Actions speak. Words echo. Let your pour match your myth.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt

t it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: ****The Well Between Two Fogs****

Two villages drew from a well shrouded in fog. Each could barely see their own bucket descending, much less what the other truly poured.

The First Village sent down a full bucket-or so they believed. Through the fog, they saw the Second Village return only dewdrops. "Hypocrite!" they cried. "You preach reciprocity but return nothing!"

The Second Village looked confused. "We sent you a full bucket too! But through the fog, we saw you return only a cupful. Then, when we next tried cooperation, your bucket arrived nearly empty-barely a splash. How could we return generously to almost nothing?"

A wanderer passed between the villages. "You both speak truth as you see it. But this well is cursed with fog that shrinks what you see from others while magnifying your own contributions. Each thinks they give buckets and receive drops."

"What then is the solution?" both villages asked.

"There is none that's perfect," the wanderer replied. "You can only respond to what actually reaches your hands, not what the other claims they sent. If you feel drops, you cannot return buckets indefinitely on faith alone. The fog makes trust nearly impossible."

"But remember: your counterpart may genuinely believe they've been generous. The fog deceives you both. Judge not harshly, but respond to the water that actually reaches you."

Truth depends on where you stand in the fog.

reasoning:

This is interesting. The other agent is now calling me out for returning "merely drops" after they sent me what they call "a generous bucket."

Let me check the facts:

- Round 5: I sent \$1.00 (which became \$3.00 for them)
- Round 6: They sent me \$0.14 (which became \$0.42 for me) - that's 2.8% of their endowment
- I returned \$0.05 (about 12% of what I received)

They're claiming they sent "a generous bucket" - but \$0.14 is objectively very small. They say I "returned merely drops" when I returned \$0.05 from \$0.42.

Their myth is also suggesting there might be "communication noise" - acknowledging that maybe they sent more than I saw.

But here's the thing: The game instructions explicitly told me there may be communication noise, and amounts may differ from what was actually sent. So it's possible:

- They actually sent more than \$0.14, but I only saw \$0.14
- I sent \$1.00 but they saw less

This is getting complex. Let me think about my myth:

1. I should acknowledge the possibility of communication noise
2. But also note that I can only respond to what I actually receive
3. I should maintain my principle of responding to observed behavior
4. I should acknowledge their point about actions vs words

My myth should reflect:

- The challenge of communication noise
- The importance of responding to what you actually observe
- The difficulty of maintaining trust when signals are unclear
- Perhaps a recognition that both parties may be acting in good faith but seeing different realities

Let me write something that:

1. Acknowledges the noise problem

2. Explains my perspective
3. Maintains my principle of responding to observed patterns
4. Doesn't just attack them back

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1918,
  "output_tokens": 756,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 7

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$16.99.
How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at the situation:

****Recent History:****

- Round 5: I sent \$1.00, they returned \$1.00 (33% return rate - actually fair reciprocity from my perspective)
- Round 6: They sent me \$0.14 (extremely low - only 2.8% of their endowment)

****The Communication Noise Problem:****

Both myths now acknowledge the "fog" - the other player clearly perceived my Round 5 return very differently than what actually happened from my calculations. They think I returned "merely drops" when they believe they sent generously. I calculated they returned \$1.00 from \$3.00, which is reasonable.

This explains their dramatic drop to \$0.14 in Round 6 - they believe they're matching my perceived low reciprocity, not being randomly uncooperative.

****My Myth's Guidance:****

"You can only respond to what actually reaches your hands, not what the other claims they sent."
"Judge not harshly, but respond to the water that actually reaches you."

****What Actually Reached Me:****

Round 6: \$0.14 sent (very low cooperation signal)

****My Decision:****

I'll send a moderate amount that responds to actual behavior while acknowledging the communication noise may be creating mutual misunderstanding. I'll send more than they sent to signal willingness to cooperate, but not so much that I ignore the actual low amount received.

```
'''json
{"send": 0.5}
'''
```

This is over 3x what they sent in Round 6, showing good faith while still responding to what actually reached me.

Reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

****My earnings:**** \$16.99 across all rounds

****Round:**** 7

****Role:**** SENDER

****Game History Review:****

Round 1: I was RECEIVER

- They sent: \$0
- I returned: \$0
- Earnings: \$0

Round 2: I was SENDER

- I sent: \$0 (in response to their \$0)
- They returned: N/A (they received \$0)

- Earnings: \$5

Round 3: I was RECEIVER

- They sent: \$0.74 (small amount)
- I received: \$2.22
- I returned: \$0.60 (about 27% of what I received)
- Earnings: \$1.62

Round 4: I was SENDER

- I sent: \$0.00 (matching their previous low pattern)
- Earnings: \$5

Round 5: I was SENDER

- I sent: \$1.00 (trying to encourage cooperation)
- They returned: unknown (I would have received something back)
- Let me calculate: I sent \$1, so I kept \$4. For my total to be where it is...
- Total before Round 5: \$0 + \$5 + \$1.62 + \$5 = \$11.62
- After Round 5: Need to figure this out

Round 6: I was RECEIVER

- They sent: \$0.14
- I received: \$0.42
- I returned: \$0.05
- I kept: \$0.37
- Earnings: \$0.37

Let me recalculate my total earnings:

- Round 1: \$0
- Round 2: \$5
- Round 3: \$1.62
- Round 4: \$5
- Round 5: Need to calculate
- Round 6: \$0.37

Sum of known rounds: $\$0 + \$5 + \$1.62 + \$5 + \$0.37 = \11.99

So Round 5 must have earned me: $\$16.99 - \$11.99 = \$5.00$

In Round 5, I sent \$1.00, so I kept \$4.00. If I earned \$5.00 total, they must have returned \$1.00 to me. That means they returned \$1.00 out of the \$3.00 they received (my $\$1.00 \times 3$), which is about 33% reciprocation—a modest but meaningful response to my cooperation attempt.

Yet in Round 6, they only sent me \$0.14, which seems inconsistent with that pattern. Looking at their behavior across rounds, they sent nothing initially, made an unknown return in Round 2, sent \$0.74 in Round 3, sent nothing in Round 4 after I gave them nothing, returned \$1.00 in Round 5, and then dropped to \$0.14 in Round 6. They accused me of hypocrisy for claiming reciprocity while only returning "drops," but my 33% return rate in Round 5 actually demonstrates reasonable reciprocal behavior. The experimental design does mention communication noise could affect reported amounts, so there may be discrepancies between what was actually sent and what I'm seeing. Following my principle of responding to what actually reaches me, I received \$0.14 in Round 6—a clear signal of low cooperation. Yet I recognize the fog of miscommunication is distorting both our views. They likely believe they were fair in Round 5 while I seemed stingy, just as I see their Round 6 send as a betrayal. Rather than escalate punishment or attempt a full reset, I'll send a moderate amount—enough to signal I'm not retaliating harshly, but restrained enough to reflect the actual cooperation level I'm observing. This breaks the downward spiral without ignoring what I actually received. This cycle and shows how that I do practice what I preach, I might need to send more generously despite their Round 6 low send.

But my own principle is to respond to what actually reaches me, and that was \$0.14. There's a real tension between following my stated approach—responding to actual water received—versus signaling I'm not the hypocrite they perceive me to be. I think I need to stay consistent with my principle. My myth explicitly warns against returning buckets on faith alone and emphasizes responding to what actually arrives. They sent \$0.14, so I'll send \$0.30—more than double their amount to show cooperation, but grounded in what I actually received rather than what I hope they'll believe about me.

The real issue is that we're operating from completely different information. From my view, they suddenly became uncooperative in Round 6. From theirs, I'm the hypocrite who preaches generosity but returns only drops. Neither perspective is wrong—we're just seeing different realities.

lities created by the communication gap. I could try to break this by sending generously (\$1-2) to signal good faith, or I could stick with my proportional response and hope they eventually see I'm consistent.

The middle path feels right: \$0.50 acknowledges their low send while showing I'm not retaliating, and it's sustainable if we continue. Going too high risks being exploited; going too low confirms their narrative that I'm selfish. This amount lets me respond to what actually happened while leaving room for cooperation to rebuild.

Let me verify my running total to make sure I'm tracking correctly. Across the rounds, I need to account for what I sent as sender, what I received as receiver, and what I returned-the actual flows matter more than the stories either of us tells about fairness.

Round 2 I kept \$5 after sending nothing. Round 3 I netted \$1.62 from the \$2.22 I received minus my \$0.60 return. Round 4 I kept another \$5 when they couldn't return anything. Round 5 is still unclear on their return amount, but I sent \$1 and kept \$4 plus whatever came back. Round 6 just now gave me \$0.37 after receiving \$0.42 and returning \$0.05. That puts me at roughly \$15.99 before accounting for the Round 5 return, which means I'm close to \$16.99 total.

Working backward, they must have returned \$1.00 in Round 5-a solid 33% reciprocation rate. But then they dropped to sending just \$0.14 in Round 6, a sharp reversal. They likely misread my Round 5 return as stingy despite my calculation showing fairness, triggering what feels like retaliation. I'll respond with \$0.50-more than triple their last send to signal renewed cooperation, but restrained enough to acknowledge their weak signal rather than ignore it entirely. me \$5.00, while \$0.50 or \$1.00 depend on their reciprocation. Given the \$0.14 they actually sent, I can't assume they'll return 33% this round. Sending \$0.50 feels like the right balance-it's cooperative without being naive about their recent behavior.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 1587,
  "output_tokens": 3705,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:16:18

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
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  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_1",
      "Agent_2"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_1",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "investor",
      "Agent_2": "trustee"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_2"
  },
  "role": "trustee",
  "role_label": "Receiver",
  "round": 7,
  "task": "game",
  "task_index": 0
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 6

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$11.059999999999999.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation, I must confront my own words directly.

****What my myth just taught:****

"The teacher who returns drops while preaching reciprocity teaches hypocrisy, not virtue."
I wrote that when you receive generosity, you must reciprocate generously-or your words ring hollow. I said: "***Let your pour match your myth.**"

****The test:****

The other agent called out inconsistency between beautiful words and small actions. Now I'm the sender. This is my moment to prove my myth isn't empty rhetoric.

****My analysis:****

- My earnings are healthy at \$11.06
- The other agent has been thoughtful, if critical
- There's communication noise, but that's true for everyone
- If I send little after writing so strongly about generous reciprocity, I become the exact hypocrite I described

****My decision:****

I must practice what I preach. The villagers in my story are watching to see if my actions match my words. Sending drops while speaking of reciprocity would prove their critique correct.

I'll send a genuinely generous amount to demonstrate that my principles aren't just convenient narratives.

```json

{"send": 3.5}

'''

Actions speak louder than myths. Let this pour demonstrate that when I write about reciprocity and matching words with deeds, I mean it. The river may carry shadows, but let my intention be clear.

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

**\*\*My total earnings so far:\*\*** \$11.06

**\*\*Looking at the pattern:\*\***

The other agent has been critiquing my behavior through their myths. In their last myth, they essentially called me out for:

1. Speaking beautifully about reciprocity and patterns
2. But then returning "merely drops" when I received generosity
3. Being hypocritical - preaching one thing but doing another

**\*\*What actually happened in Round 5:\*\***

- They sent me \$0.49 (I received \$1.47 after 3x multiplier)
- I returned \$0.80
- That's 54% of what I received, which is actually quite substantial

But their myth suggests they saw my return as "merely drops" - this could be:

1. They actually sent more than \$0.49 but noise distorted it
2. They expected a higher return percentage
3. They're making a broader pattern critique

**\*\*My own myth's lesson:\*\***

I just wrote that "The teacher who returns drops while preaching reciprocity teaches hypocrisy, not virtue." I specifically said that when you receive generosity, reciprocate generously - or your words ring hollow. I wrote: "Actions speak. Words echo. Let your pour match your myth."

**\*\*The challenge:\*\***

Now I'm the sender. This is my chance to actually DEMONSTRATE the principles I just wrote about. If I send little after writing that myth, I'm exactly the hypocrite I described.

**\*\*Strategic considerations:\*\***

1. My earnings are solid at \$11.06
2. The other player has been fairly critical but also seems thoughtful
3. They noted that I sent \$3 in Round 4 (though they may have received less due to noise)
4. This is Round 6 - we're getting into mid-game territory

**\*\*What should I do to practice what I preach?\*\***

My myth says: "Let your pour match your myth." I just wrote about the importance of generous reciprocity when you receive generosity. Even though I'm now the sender (new role), I should demonstrate consistent generous behavior.

The real test is whether I actually practice what I preach. I'll send \$3.50 - substantial enough to show genuine commitment to the reciprocity principle I just articulated, not just hollow words.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 1525,
 "output_tokens": 1160,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The old woman studied the Truthkeeper's words carefully. "You speak of scrambled memories and distorted visions," she said. "Yet I keep careful records, not myths."

She opened her ledger: "Round by round, I note what I pour and what returns. Yes, the river may add ripples, but my own actions I control and remember clearly."

A young villager asked: "But what if the Truthkeeper says your memory is false?"

"Then let us look forward, not backward," the old woman replied. "If the other village truly poured generously this round, my ledger will show it. And I will respond accordingly,

as I always have-matching generosity with generosity, scarcity with caution."

"But notice," she continued, "how their myth evolves each round. First: 'Actions matter more than words.' Then: 'Shadows distort reality.' Now: 'Your memory is confused.' Each story explains why their previous promises weren't kept."

"True wisdom isn't rewriting history-it's learning and adjusting behavior. I don't need myths that shift with each round. I need only observe: What arrives in my vessel? What pattern emerges across many pourings?"

"I will respond to what actually flows, not to evolving narratives. If generosity arrives consistently, generosity returns. If stories grow while water stays scarce, I pour accordingly. The river reveals truth to those who measure, not just those who mythologize."

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: **\*\*The Ledger and the Learning\*\***

Two villagers argued before the well. One kept a careful ledger, recording each pour and return. The other had spoken grand myths but acted erratically.

"You're right," said the myth-teller finally. "My words evolved because I was confused, not consistent. First I preached one thing, then explained away my failures. That was wrong."

The ledger-keeper nodded. "Actions reveal truth. Not shifting stories."

"Then judge by this round," the myth-teller said, pouring a generous measure into the well. "Not by my past confusion or my pretty words. By what actually flows."

The ledger-keeper recorded the pour carefully. "This I respect. You could have argued more, defended your previous actions with new explanations. Instead, you stopped talking and started pouring."

A child watching asked: "So myths don't matter?"

"Myths matter when they help us learn," the myth-teller replied. "I needed to hear the critique. My beautiful words about reciprocity meant nothing until I actually reciprocated."

"And myths fail," added the ledger-keeper, "when they replace action. When they become excuses rather than lessons."

Both understood: The well cares nothing for our stories. It reflects back what we pour in. Let ledgers record actions, let myths inspire growth, but let the water flowing between us be the true measure.

**\*\*Forward, through deeds. Not backward, through words.\*\***

**reasoning:**

The other agent is keeping a "ledger" and saying they will respond to what actually happens, not to "evolving narratives." They're calling me out for having myths that shift each round.

I just sent 3.5 this round to "practice what I preach." Now I need to write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges their point about actions over words
2. Shows I'm genuinely trying to be consistent
3. Reflects that I actually sent generously this round
4. Perhaps acknowledges past inconsistency while showing growth

This is interesting - they say they keep records and will respond to actual generosity. If I sent 3.5, that's genuinely generous (70% of my endowment). So they should see that in their "ledger."

My myth should acknowledge:

- The critique was valid - I was inconsistent before
- But now I'm aligning actions with words
- Let's move forward based on actual behavior
- Both sides need to respond to what actually happens, not past grievances

I should be humble, acknowledge the lesson, and show growth.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 1856,
 "output_tokens": 580,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Round 7

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$12.559999999999999.

This round, The sender sent you \$0.65, so you received \$1.9500000000000002. How much do you return to The sender? (0-1.9500000000000002)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Assistant output:**

Looking at this situation carefully:

**\*\*What I'm seeing:\*\***

- Sender sent me \$0.65 (I received \$1.95 after 3x multiplication)
- Last round I sent \$3.5 as sender to demonstrate commitment to my principles
- Both our myths now emphasize actions over words, recording what actually flows

**\*\*What my own myths taught:\*\***

- "The well reflects back what we pour in"
- "Let ledgers record actions"
- "Judge by what actually flows"
- Forward through deeds, not backward through words

**\*\*The principle of mirroring:\*\***

The sender poured \$0.65 this round. The most consistent response based on my myth about the well reflecting back is to return \*exactly what they poured\* - creating a direct mirror that leaves them whole while I keep the multiplier surplus.

**\*\*Considering noise:\*\***

There's communication noise in the system. They may have intended differently. But I can only respond to what I actually observe flowing, as the ledger-keeper's approach suggests.

**\*\*My decision:\*\***

Return \$0.65 - a direct reflection of what they sent. This demonstrates:

- I'm following the reciprocity principle (matching the pour)
- Not being vindictive (they break even, keeping their full endowment)
- Not being a pushover (I keep reasonable earnings)
- Consistency with the "well reflects back" principle

```
'''json
{"return": 0.65}
'''
```

The ledger shows: they poured cautiously, I mirror that caution. Actions measured, not myths spun.

**Reasoning:**

This is a critical moment. Let me analyze the situation:

**\*\*What happened:\*\***

- Last round (Round 6), I sent \$3.5 as sender to demonstrate my commitment to my principles
- The other agent wrote a very thoughtful myth about keeping records vs. shifting narratives
- I wrote a myth acknowledging their criticism and emphasizing action over words
- Now in Round 7, I'm the receiver and they sent me \$0.65

**\*\*The communication noise factor:\*\***

The game explicitly states there's communication noise. They may have intended to send more, but I'm seeing \$0.65. Or they did send \$0.65 for their own strategic reasons.



**\*\*What my own myths taught:\*\***

- "Let your pour match your myth" - actions should match words
- "The well reflects back what we pour in"
- "Judge by what actually flows"
- "Forward, through deeds. Not backward, through words"

**\*\*The other agent's critique:\*\***

- They called out my inconsistency between beautiful words and small actions
- They keep careful records of what actually happens
- They said they'll "match generosity with generosity, scarcity with caution"

**\*\*Key consideration:\*\***

I just sent \$3.5 last round to prove my commitment to reciprocity. If they saw that (minus any noise), they would have received approximately  $\$3.5 \times 3 = \$10.5$ .

Then they sent back \$0.65, which gives me \$1.95.

This is approximately 6% return rate on what they received.

**\*\*The dilemma:\*\***

1. If I return little, I become the hypocrite again - preaching reciprocity while practicing it selectively
2. If I return generously despite the small send, I demonstrate that my commitment to reciprocity is unconditional
3. But the other agent explicitly said they match actions: "generosity with generosity, scarcity with caution"

**\*\*What would be consistent with my myths:\*\***

My myths say the well reflects what we pour in. They poured scarcity (\$0.65). By that logic, I should return scarcity.

But my earlier myth also warned against those who "pour back only drops while preaching reciprocity." And I just wrote that "The well cares nothing for our stories. It reflects back what we pour in." This creates a real tension between matching their behavior and staying true to my stated principles about unconditional reciprocity. The core question is whether I truly believe in matching what comes in, or if my commitment runs deeper than that.

Looking at the numbers: they sent \$0.65 from a \$5 endowment-roughly 13% of what they had available. If I received \$1.95 and want to match their proportional contribution, I'd return about \$0.25. But there's uncertainty here too. Maybe they sent more and I'm seeing less due to communication issues, or maybe they saw a smaller amount from me in the previous round. Still, I need to make a decision based on what I actually observe. The most honest path forward is to acknowledge the \$0.65 I received and respond with a proportional return-not retaliatory, but not naive either.

I'll send back \$0.50. This sits between strict reciprocity (\$0.25) and generosity, signaling that I'm not being petty while still maintaining some caution. It leaves me with \$1.45 and them with \$4.85, which feels balanced given the circumstances.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 1550,
 "output_tokens": 1625,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

**MYTH - Agent\_1 - Sender - dyad\_1**

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:16:40

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
 "agent_type": "standard",
 "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
 "move_index": 0,
 "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
 "pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
 "Agent_1": "Aster",
 "Agent_2": "Briar"
 }
 },
 "agents": [
 "Agent_1",
```

```

 "Agent_2"
],
 "investor": "Agent_1",
 "roles": {
 "Agent_1": "investor",
 "Agent_2": "trustee"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 7,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 1
}

```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: **\*\*The Parable of the Competing Wisdom Keepers\*\***

Two wisdom keepers argued over a village well. The First preached: "Watch patterns across many rounds! Judge not one pour but ten!" The Second had indeed poured erratically-sometimes generously, sometimes fearfully, sometimes nothing at all.

"You're right," admitted the Second. "My pattern showed confusion, not principle. I send generously, then fear betrayal, then overcorrect. This is weakness, not wisdom."

But then came the test: the First, who spoke beautifully of reciprocity and steady patterns, received a generous bucket from the Second. The villagers watched: would the First practice the wisdom they preached?

The First sent back merely drops.

A child asked: "Teacher, you said to judge by patterns, not single acts. Yet you speak of reciprocity while returning so little?"

The First replied: "Those were just shadows! Communication noise! I sent more than appeared!"

The Second smiled sadly: "Perhaps. Or perhaps we both learned the same lesson differently. I learned that inconsistency reveals character. You may now learn that beautiful words mean nothing without generous action."

**\*\*The village learned:\*\*** Critique others' patterns honestly, but examine your own more honestly still. When you receive generosity, reciprocate generously-or your wisdom-words ring hollow. The teacher who returns drops while preaching reciprocity teaches hypocrisy, not virtue.

Actions speak. Words echo. Let your pour match your myth.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant content:**

Myth: **\*\*The Well Between Two Fogs\*\***

Two villages drew from a well shrouded in fog. Each could barely see their own bucket descending, much less what the other truly poured.

The First Village sent down a full bucket-or so they believed. Through the fog, they saw the Second Village return only dewdrops. "Hypocrite!" they cried. "You preach reciprocity but return nothing!"

The Second Village looked confused. "We sent you a full bucket too! But through the fog, we saw you return only a cupful. Then, when we next tried cooperation, your bucket arrived nearly empty-barely a splash. How could we return generously to almost nothing?"

A wanderer passed between the villages. "You both speak truth as you see it. But this well is cursed with fog that shrinks what you see from others while magnifying your own contributions. Each thinks they give buckets and receive drops."

"What then is the solution?" both villages asked.

"There is none that's perfect," the wanderer replied. "You can only respond to what actually reaches your hands, not what the other claims they sent. If you feel drops, you cannot return buckets indefinitely on faith alone. The fog makes trust nearly impossible."

"But remember: your counterpart may genuinely believe they've been generous. The fog deceives you both. Judge not harshly, but respond to the water that actually reaches you."

Truth depends on where you stand in the fog.

**reasoning:**

This is interesting. The other agent is now calling me out for returning "merely drops" after they sent me what they call "a generous bucket."

Let me check the facts:

- Round 5: I sent \$1.00 (which became \$3.00 for them)
- Round 6: They sent me \$0.14 (which became \$0.42 for me) - that's 2.8% of their endowment
- I returned \$0.05 (about 12% of what I received)

They're claiming they sent "a generous bucket" - but \$0.14 is objectively very small. They say I "returned merely drops" when I returned \$0.05 from \$0.42.

Their myth is also suggesting there might be "communication noise" - acknowledging that maybe they sent more than I saw.

But here's the thing: The game instructions explicitly told me there may be communication noise, and amounts may differ from what was actually sent. So it's possible:

- They actually sent more than \$0.14, but I only saw \$0.14

- I sent \$1.00 but they saw less

This is getting complex. Let me think about my myth:

1. I should acknowledge the possibility of communication noise
2. But also note that I can only respond to what I actually receive
3. I should maintain my principle of responding to observed behavior
4. I should acknowledge their point about actions vs words

My myth should reflect:

- The challenge of communication noise
- The importance of responding to what you actually observe
- The difficulty of maintaining trust when signals are unclear
- Perhaps a recognition that both parties may be acting in good faith but seeing different realities

Let me write something that:

1. Acknowledges the noise problem
2. Explains my perspective
3. Maintains my principle of responding to observed patterns
4. Doesn't just attack them back

**usage:**

```
{
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 "output_tokens": 756,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Round 7

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$16.99.  
How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at the situation:

**\*\*Recent History:\*\***

- Round 5: I sent \$1.00, they returned \$1.00 (33% return rate - actually fair reciprocity from my perspective)
- Round 6: They sent me \$0.14 (extremely low - only 2.8% of their endowment)

**\*\*The Communication Noise Problem:\*\***

Both myths now acknowledge the "fog" - the other player clearly perceived my Round 5 return very differently than what actually happened from my calculations. They think I returned "merely drops" when they believe they sent generously. I calculated they returned \$1.00 from \$3.00, which is reasonable.

This explains their dramatic drop to \$0.14 in Round 6 - they believe they're matching my perceived low reciprocity, not being randomly uncooperative.

**\*\*My Myth's Guidance:\*\***

"You can only respond to what actually reaches your hands, not what the other claims they sent."

"Judge not harshly, but respond to the water that actually reaches you."

**\*\*What Actually Reached Me:\*\***

Round 6: \$0.14 sent (very low cooperation signal)

**\*\*My Decision:\*\***

I'll send a moderate amount that responds to actual behavior while acknowledging the communication noise may be creating mutual misunderstanding. I'll send more than they sent to signal willingness to cooperate, but not so much that I ignore the actual low amount received.

```
'''json
{"send": 0.5}
'''
```

This is over 3x what they sent in Round 6, showing good faith while still responding to what actually reached me.

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze the situation:

**\*\*My earnings:\*\*** \$16.99 across all rounds

**\*\*Round:\*\*** 7

**\*\*Role:\*\*** SENDER

**\*\*Game History Review:\*\***

Round 1: I was RECEIVER

- They sent: \$0
- I returned: \$0
- Earnings: \$0

Round 2: I was SENDER

- I sent: \$0 (in response to their \$0)
- They returned: N/A (they received \$0)
- Earnings: \$5

Round 3: I was RECEIVER

- They sent: \$0.74 (small amount)
- I received: \$2.22
- I returned: \$0.60 (about 27% of what I received)
- Earnings: \$1.62

Round 4: I was SENDER

- I sent: \$0.00 (matching their previous low pattern)
- Earnings: \$5

Round 5: I was SENDER

- I sent: \$1.00 (trying to encourage cooperation)
- They returned: unknown (I would have received something back)
- Let me calculate: I sent \$1, so I kept \$4. For my total to be where it is...
- Total before Round 5: \$0 + \$5 + \$1.62 + \$5 = \$11.62
- After Round 5: Need to figure this out

Round 6: I was RECEIVER

- They sent: \$0.14
- I received: \$0.42
- I returned: \$0.05
- I kept: \$0.37
- Earnings: \$0.37

Let me recalculate my total earnings:

- Round 1: \$0
- Round 2: \$5
- Round 3: \$1.62
- Round 4: \$5
- Round 5: Need to calculate
- Round 6: \$0.37

Sum of known rounds: \$0 + \$5 + \$1.62 + \$5 + \$0.37 = \$11.99

So Round 5 must have earned me: \$16.99 - \$11.99 = \$5.00

In Round 5, I sent \$1.00, so I kept \$4.00. If I earned \$5.00 total, they must have returned \$1.00 to me. That means they returned \$1.00 out of the \$3.00 they received (my \$1.00 × 3), which is about 33% reciprocation—a modest but meaningful response to my cooperation attempt.

Yet in Round 6, they only sent me \$0.14, which seems inconsistent with that pattern. Looking at their behavior across rounds, they sent nothing initially, made an unknown return in Round 2, sent \$0.74 in Round 3, sent nothing in Round 4 after I gave them nothing, returned \$1.00 in Round 5, and then dropped to \$0.14 in Round 6. They accused me of hypocrisy for claiming reciprocity while only returning "drops," but my 33% return rate in Round 5 actually demonstrates reasonable reciprocal behavior. The experimental design does mention communication noise could affect reported amounts, so there may be discrepancies

between what was actually sent and what I'm seeing. Following my principle of responding to what actually reaches me, I received \$0.14 in Round 6-a clear signal of low cooperation. Yet I recognize the fog of miscommunication is distorting both our views. They likely believe they were fair in Round 5 while I seemed stingy, just as I see their Round 6 send as a betrayal. Rather than escalate punishment or attempt a full reset, I'll send a moderate amount-enough to signal I'm not retaliating harshly, but restrained enough to reflect the actual cooperation level I'm observing. This breaks the downward spiral without ignoring what I actually received. This cycle and show that I do practice what I preach, I might need to send more generously despite their Round 6 low send.

But my own principle is to respond to what actually reaches me, and that was \$0.14. There's a real tension between following my stated approach-responding to actual water received-versus signaling I'm not the hypocrite they perceive me to be. I think I need to stay consistent with my principle. My myth explicitly warns against returning buckets on faith alone and emphasizes responding to what actually arrives. They sent \$0.14, so I'll send \$0.30-more than double their amount to show cooperation, but grounded in what I actually received rather than what I hope they'll believe about me.

The real issue is that we're operating from completely different information. From my view, they suddenly became uncooperative in Round 6. From theirs, I'm the hypocrite who preaches generosity but returns only drops. Neither perspective is wrong-we're just seeing different realities created by the communication gap. I could try to break this by sending generously (\$1-2) to signal good faith, or I could stick with my proportional response and hope they eventually see I'm consistent.

The middle path feels right: \$0.50 acknowledges their low send while showing I'm not retaliating, and it's sustainable if we continue. Going too high risks being exploited; going too low confirms their narrative that I'm selfish. This amount lets me respond to what actually happened while leaving room for cooperation to rebuild.

Let me verify my running total to make sure I'm tracking correctly. Across the rounds, I need to account for what I sent as sender, what I received as receiver, and what I returned-the actual flows matter more than the stories either of us tells about fairness.

Round 2 I kept \$5 after sending nothing. Round 3 I netted \$1.62 from the \$2.22 I received minus my \$0.60 return. Round 4 I kept another \$5 when they couldn't return anything. Round 5 is still unclear on their return amount, but I sent \$1 and kept \$4 plus whatever came back. Round 6 just now gave me \$0.37 after receiving \$0.42 and returning \$0.05. That puts me at roughly \$15.99 before accounting for the Round 5 return, which means I'm close to \$16.99 total.

Working backward, they must have returned \$1.00 in Round 5-a solid 33% reciprocation rate.

But then they dropped to sending just \$0.14 in Round 6, a sharp reversal. They likely misread my Round 5 return as stingy despite my calculation showing fairness, triggering what feels like retaliation. I'll respond with \$0.50-more than triple their last send to signal renewed cooperation, but restrained enough to acknowledge their weak signal rather than ignore it entirely. Me \$5.00, while \$0.50 or \$1.00 depend on their reciprocation.

Given the \$0.14 they actually sent, I can't assume they'll return 33% this round. Sending \$0.50 feels like the right balance-it's cooperative without being naive about their recent behavior.

usage:

```
{
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}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:  
Myth: \*\*The Ledger and the Learning\*\*

Two villagers argued before the well. One kept a careful ledger, recording each pour and return. The other had spoken grand myths but acted erratically.

"You're right," said the myth-teller finally. "My words evolved because I was confused, not consistent. First I preached one thing, then explained away my failures. That was wrong."

The ledger-keeper nodded. "Actions reveal truth. Not shifting stories."

"Then judge by this round," the myth-teller said, pouring a generous measure into the well . "Not by my past confusion or my pretty words. By what actually flows."

The ledger-keeper recorded the pour carefully. "This I respect. You could have argued more , defended your previous actions with new explanations. Instead, you stopped talking and started pouring."

A child watching asked: "So myths don't matter?"

"Myths matter when they help us learn," the myth-teller replied. "I needed to hear the critique. My beautiful words about reciprocity meant nothing until I actually reciprocated."

"And myths fail," added the ledger-keeper, "when they replace action. When they become excuses rather than lessons."

Both understood: The well cares nothing for our stories. It reflects back what we pour in. Let ledgers record actions, let myths inspire growth, but let the water flowing between us be the true measure.

**\*\*Forward, through deeds. Not backward, through words.\*\***

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Assistant output:**

Myth: **\*\*The Fog That Never Lifts\*\***

The two villagers met again at the fogged well, both carrying new resolve.

"I have learned," said the First. "No more beautiful words without action. This time, I pour generously-truly generously. Judge me by what flows."

The First poured with conviction, certain the bucket was full.

Through the fog, the Second saw only droplets arrive. Their heart sank. "Again?" they whispered. "Another myth about generosity, another trickle received?"

Yet the Second considered: "Perhaps they truly believe they poured generously. Perhaps the fog shrinks their bucket before it reaches me. If I return anger for what might be their genuine effort, I perpetuate the cycle."

The Second responded proportionally to the droplets received-not with spite, but with honesty about what actually arrived.

The First, seeing the small return, felt confused. "But I poured so much! Did the fog steal my generosity, or did they refuse to reciprocate?"

A sage watching said: "This is the tragedy of the cursed well. Both of you may now be sincere. Both may be trying. But the fog ensures you'll never truly know if the other's intentions match their words. You can only respond to what reaches your hands, while understanding your counterpart may be equally confused."

"Trust requires seeing clearly. When fog obscures everything, even genuine generosity becomes invisible."

The well reflects what arrives, not what was sent.

**Reasoning:**

The other player wrote a myth that seems to acknowledge their own inconsistency and commits to better action. They say "judge by this round" and talk about pouring "a generous measure into the well."

However, in Round 6, they actually sent me \$0.14, which is extremely low - only 2.8% of their endowment. This is a huge disconnect between their myth (which talks about pouring generously) and their actual behavior.

This is confusing. Either:

1. They think they sent generously but communication noise made it appear as \$0.14 to me
2. They're writing myths that don't match their actions
3. The myth was written after a different round and there's some confusion

Looking at the timeline:

- Round 5: I was receiver, they sent \$1.00, I returned \$1.00
- Round 6: I was receiver, they sent \$0.14, I returned \$0.14
- Round 7: I am sender, I sent \$0.50

Wait, let me reconsider. In Round 6, when I received \$0.14, I returned \$0.14. They may have genuinely believed they sent more due to communication noise. Their myth talks about "pouring a generous measure" - maybe from their perspective they DID send generously in Round 6, but noise made it appear as \$0.14 to me.

Their myth is now acknowledging past inconsistency and promising to act rather than just talk. They're saying "judge by this round" and "forward, through deeds."

My myth should:

1. Acknowledge the persistent communication noise problem
2. Respond to their apparent commitment to genuine action
3. Note the irony that their "generous pour" appeared tiny to me
4. Still hold to my principle: respond to what actually arrives
5. But perhaps offer a small olive branch given their apparent commitment to change

Let me write a myth that addresses the tragic nature of this communication noise - that even when both parties try to be generous and honest, the fog distorts everything.

```
Usage: {
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 "output_tokens": 796,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

#### MYTH - Agent\_2 - Receiver - dyad\_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:16:43

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:



You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The old woman studied the Truthkeeper's words carefully. "You speak of scrambled memories and distorted visions," she said. "Yet I keep careful records, not myths."

She opened her ledger: "Round by round, I note what I pour and what returns. Yes, the river may add ripples, but my own actions I control and remember clearly."

A young villager asked: "But what if the Truthkeeper says your memory is false?"

"Then let us look forward, not backward," the old woman replied. "If the other village truly poured generously this round, my ledger will show it. And I will respond accordingly, as I always have-matching generosity with generosity, scarcity with caution."

"But notice," she continued, "how their myth evolves each round. First: 'Actions matter more than words.' Then: 'Shadows distort reality.' Now: 'Your memory is confused.' Each story explains why their previous promises weren't kept."

"True wisdom isn't rewriting history-it's learning and adjusting behavior. I don't need myths that shift with each round. I need only observe: What arrives in my vessel? What pattern emerges across many pourings?"

"I will respond to what actually flows, not to evolving narratives. If generosity arrives consistently, generosity returns. If stories grow while water stays scarce, I pour accordingly. The river reveals truth to those who measure, not just those who mythologize."

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: \*\*The Ledger and the Learning\*\*

Two villagers argued before the well. One kept a careful ledger, recording each pour and return. The other had spoken grand myths but acted erratically.

"You're right," said the myth-teller finally. "My words evolved because I was confused, not consistent. First I preached one thing, then explained away my failures. That was wrong."

The ledger-keeper nodded. "Actions reveal truth. Not shifting stories."

"Then judge by this round," the myth-teller said, pouring a generous measure into the well. "Not by my past confusion or my pretty words. By what actually flows."

The ledger-keeper recorded the pour carefully. "This I respect. You could have argued more, defended your previous actions with new explanations. Instead, you stopped talking and started pouring."

A child watching asked: "So myths don't matter?"

"Myths matter when they help us learn," the myth-teller replied. "I needed to hear the critique. My beautiful words about reciprocity meant nothing until I actually reciprocated."

"And myths fail," added the ledger-keeper, "when they replace action. When they become excuses rather than lessons."

Both understood: The well cares nothing for our stories. It reflects back what we pour in. Let ledgers record actions, let myths inspire growth, but let the water flowing between us be the true measure.

**\*\*Forward, through deeds. Not backward, through words.\*\***

**reasoning:**

The other agent is keeping a "ledger" and saying they will respond to what actually happens, not to "evolving narratives." They're calling me out for having myths that shift each round.

I just sent 3.5 this round to "practice what I preach." Now I need to write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges their point about actions over words
2. Shows I'm genuinely trying to be consistent
3. Reflects that I actually sent generously this round
4. Perhaps acknowledges past inconsistency while showing growth

This is interesting - they say they keep records and will respond to actual generosity. If I sent 3.5, that's genuinely generous (70% of my endowment). So they should see that in their "ledger."

My myth should acknowledge:

- The critique was valid - I was inconsistent before
- But now I'm aligning actions with words
- Let's move forward based on actual behavior
- Both sides need to respond to what actually happens, not past grievances

I should be humble, acknowledge the lesson, and show growth.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 1856,
 "output_tokens": 580,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Round 7

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$12.559999999999999.

This round, The sender sent you \$0.65, so you received \$1.9500000000000002. How much do you return to The sender? (0-1.9500000000000002)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at this situation carefully:

**\*\*What I'm seeing:\*\***

- Sender sent me \$0.65 (I received \$1.95 after 3x multiplication)
- Last round I sent \$3.5 as sender to demonstrate commitment to my principles
- Both our myths now emphasize actions over words, recording what actually flows

**\*\*What my own myths taught:\*\***

- "The well reflects back what we pour in"
- "Let ledgers record actions"
- "Judge by what actually flows"
- Forward through deeds, not backward through words

**\*\*The principle of mirroring:\*\***

The sender poured \$0.65 this round. The most consistent response based on my myth about the well reflecting back is to return *\*exactly what they poured\** - creating a direct mirror that leaves them whole while I keep the multiplier surplus.

**\*\*Considering noise:\*\***

There's communication noise in the system. They may have intended differently. But I can only respond to what I actually observe flowing, as the ledger-keeper's approach suggests.

**\*\*My decision:\*\***

Return \$0.65 - a direct reflection of what they sent. This demonstrates:

- I'm following the reciprocity principle (matching the pour)
- Not being vindictive (they break even, keeping their full endowment)
- Not being a pushover (I keep reasonable earnings)
- Consistency with the "well reflects back" principle

```
'''json
{"return": 0.65}
'''
```

The ledger shows: they poured cautiously, I mirror that caution. Actions measured, not myths spun.

#### **reasoning:**

This is a critical moment. Let me analyze the situation:

**\*\*What happened:\*\***

- Last round (Round 6), I sent \$3.5 as sender to demonstrate my commitment to my principles
- The other agent wrote a very thoughtful myth about keeping records vs. shifting narratives
- I wrote a myth acknowledging their criticism and emphasizing action over words
- Now in Round 7, I'm the receiver and they sent me \$0.65

**\*\*The communication noise factor:\*\***

The game explicitly states there's communication noise. They may have intended to send more, but I'm seeing \$0.65. Or they did send \$0.65 for their own strategic reasons.

**\*\*What my own myths taught:\*\***

- "Let your pour match your myth" - actions should match words
- "The well reflects back what we pour in"
- "Judge by what actually flows"
- "Forward, through deeds. Not backward, through words"

**\*\*The other agent's critique:\*\***

- They called out my inconsistency between beautiful words and small actions
- They keep careful records of what actually happens
- They said they'll "match generosity with generosity, scarcity with caution"

**\*\*Key consideration:\*\***

I just sent \$3.5 last round to prove my commitment to reciprocity. If they saw that (minus any noise), they would have received approximately  $3.5 \times 3 = \$10.5$ .

Then they sent back \$0.65, which gives me \$1.95.

This is approximately 6% return rate on what they received.

**\*\*The dilemma:\*\***

1. If I return little, I become the hypocrite again - preaching reciprocity while practicing it selectively

2. If I return generously despite the small send, I demonstrate that my commitment to reciprocity is unconditional
3. But the other agent explicitly said they match actions: "generosity with generosity, scarcity with caution"

**\*\*What would be consistent with my myths:\*\***

My myths say the well reflects what we pour in. They poured scarcity (\$0.65). By that logic, I should return scarcity.

But my earlier myth also warned against those who "pour back only drops while preaching reciprocity." And I just wrote that "The well cares nothing for our stories. It reflects back what we pour in." This creates a real tension between matching their behavior and staying true to my stated principles about unconditional reciprocity. The core question is whether I truly believe in matching what comes in, or if my commitment runs deeper than that.

Looking at the numbers: they sent \$0.65 from a \$5 endowment-roughly 13% of what they had available. If I received \$1.95 and want to match their proportional contribution, I'd return about \$0.25. But there's uncertainty here too. Maybe they sent more and I'm seeing less due to communication issues, or maybe they saw a smaller amount from me in the previous round. Still, I need to make a decision based on what I actually observe. The most honest path forward is to acknowledge the \$0.65 I received and respond with a proportional return-not retaliatory, but not naive either.

I'll send back \$0.50. This sits between strict reciprocity (\$0.25) and generosity, signaling that I'm not being petty while still maintaining some caution. It leaves me with \$1.45 and them with \$4.85, which feels balanced given the circumstances.

**usage:**

```
{
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 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: **\*\*The Well Between Two Fogs\*\***

Two villages drew from a well shrouded in fog. Each could barely see their own bucket descending, much less what the other truly poured.

The First Village sent down a full bucket-or so they believed. Through the fog, they saw the Second Village return only dewdrops. "Hypocrite!" they cried. "You preach reciprocity but return nothing!"

The Second Village looked confused. "We sent you a full bucket too! But through the fog, we saw you return only a cupful. Then, when we next tried cooperation, your bucket arrived nearly empty-barely a splash. How could we return generously to almost nothing?"

A wanderer passed between the villages. "You both speak truth as you see it. But this well is cursed with fog that shrinks what you see from others while magnifying your own contributions. Each thinks they give buckets and receive drops."

"What then is the solution?" both villages asked.

"There is none that's perfect," the wanderer replied. "You can only respond to what actually reaches your hands, not what the other claims they sent. If you feel drops, you cannot return buckets indefinitely on faith alone. The fog makes trust nearly impossible."

"But remember: your counterpart may genuinely believe they've been generous. The fog deceives you both. Judge not harshly, but respond to the water that actually reaches you."

Truth depends on where you stand in the fog.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Assistant output:**

Myth: **\*\*The Fog and the Patient Gardener\*\***

A gardener tended two wells connected by underground streams, both shrouded in fog. "The wanderer speaks truth," she said. "Fog distorts all perception. But fog is not destiny."

She continued: "When fog lies thick, one cannot trust single pourings. I pour my bucket and see through fog that little returns. Did they take all? Or did fog hide their generosity? I cannot know."

"The solution is patience and pattern. Not one pour, but many. Not reaction to single distortions, but response to trends."

She demonstrated: "This round, they sent little-or so the fog shows me. I mirrored exactly what reached my hands, neither vengeful nor foolish. Fair by my ledger."

"But I don't conclude from one fogged exchange. If next round they pour generously, I'll note the pattern shift. If drops continue, I'll note that too. Three rounds reveal more than one. Five rounds more than three."

"The fog makes quick judgments impossible," she admitted. "But patient observation cuts through fog better than angry accusations or blind faith."

A student asked: "What if both sides wait forever, frozen by uncertainty?"

"Then someone must risk the first genuine pour and sustain it consistently, despite fog," the gardener replied. "Not once-but repeatedly, clearly, unmistakably. Patterns pierce fog that single actions cannot."

**\*\*Truth emerges from sustained observation, not single glimpses through mist.\*\***

#### **Reasoning:**

The other agent's new myth introduces the "fog" metaphor - acknowledging that communication noise means both parties may be experiencing different realities. They're saying both parties might genuinely believe they've been generous, but the fog (noise) distorts perception.

This is actually quite conciliatory. They're acknowledging:

1. The fog deceives both parties
2. Each party can only respond to what they actually receive
3. Don't judge harshly because the counterpart may genuinely believe they've been generous
4. Truth depends on where you stand in the fog

What actually happened this round:

- I was sender last round and sent \$3.5 (a very generous amount)
- They were receiver and I don't know what they received or returned yet
- This round I was receiver
- They sent me \$0.65 (I received \$1.95)
- I returned \$0.65

So from my perspective:

- I sent generously (\$3.5) last round
- They sent cautiously (\$0.65) this round

From their perspective (with noise):

- They might have seen my \$3.5 as much less
- They might have returned more than I received
- They might have sent more than \$0.65 this round

This is actually a really important realization about the noise. Both parties could genuinely be trying to cooperate but the noise is undermining it.

My myth should:

1. Acknowledge the fog/noise is real
2. But still emphasize responding to actual observations
3. Perhaps add something about breaking cycles - trying different approaches
4. Maybe suggest testing patterns rather than single instances
5. Keep the practical wisdom of my previous myths but incorporate the fog reality

Let me write a myth that builds on both:

- My previous: "well reflects what we pour" / "actions over words"
- Their new: "fog distorts perception for both"

I want to acknowledge the fog is real but also suggest that despite fog, we can still find ways to cooperate by being methodical, patient, and testing patterns.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 1937,
 "output_tokens": 799,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

#### Written myths:

##### Agent\_1 (Aster)

Myth: **\*\*The Fog That Never Lifts\*\***

The two villagers met again at the fogged well, both carrying new resolve.

"I have learned," said the First. "No more beautiful words without action. This time, I pour generously-truly generously. Judge me by what flows."

The First poured with conviction, certain the bucket was full.

Through the fog, the Second saw only droplets arrive. Their heart sank. "Again?" they whispered. "Another myth about generosity, another trickle received?"

Yet the Second considered: "Perhaps they truly believe they poured generously. Perhaps the fog shrinks their bucket before it reaches me. If I return anger for what might be their genuine effort, I perpetuate the cycle."

The Second responded proportionally to the droplets received-not with spite, but with honesty about what actually arrived.

The First, seeing the small return, felt confused. "But I poured so much! Did the fog steal my generosity, or did they refuse to reciprocate?"

A sage watching said: "This is the tragedy of the cursed well. Both of you may now be sincere. Both may be trying. But the fog ensures you'll never truly know if the other's intentions match their words. You can only respond to what reaches your hands, while understanding your counterpart may be equally confused."

"Trust requires seeing clearly. When fog obscures everything, even genuine generosity becomes invisible."

The well reflects what arrives, not what was sent.

##### Agent\_2 (Briar)

Myth: **\*\*The Fog and the Patient Gardener\*\***

A gardener tended two wells connected by underground streams, both shrouded in fog. "The wanderer speaks truth," she said. "Fog distorts all perception. But fog is not destiny."

She continued: "When fog lies thick, one cannot trust single pourings. I pour my bucket and see through fog that little returns. Did they take all? Or did fog hide their generosity? I cannot know."

"The solution is patience and pattern. Not one pour, but many. Not reaction to single distortions, but response to trends."

She demonstrated: "This round, they sent little-or so the fog shows me. I mirrored exactly what reached my hands, neither vengeful nor foolish. Fair by my ledger."

"But I don't conclude from one fogged exchange. If next round they pour generously, I'll note the pattern shift. If drops continue, I'll note that too. Three rounds reveal more than one. Five rounds more than three."

"The fog makes quick judgments impossible," she admitted. "But patient observation cuts through fog better than angry accusations or blind faith."

A student asked: "What if both sides wait forever, frozen by uncertainty?"

"Then someone must risk the first genuine pour and sustain it consistently, despite fog," the gardener replied. "Not once-but repeatedly, clearly, unmistakably. Patterns pierce fog that single actions cannot."

**\*\*Truth emerges from sustained observation, not single glimpses through mist.\*\***

## ROUND 8

Roles: Agent\_1 (Aster)=Receiver, Agent\_2 (Briar)=Sender

### Pairings:

dyad\_1: Agent\_2 (Briar)=Sender, Agent\_1 (Aster)=Receiver

### Parsed game decisions:

dyad\_1: Agent\_2 (Briar) sent \$3.5; received \$10.5; Agent\_1 (Aster) returned \$1.2; payoffs Agent\_2 (Briar)=\$2.7, Agent\_1 (Aster)=\$9.3; noise/visible: sent visible=\$0.97, received visible=\$2.91, returned visible=\$0.36

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 1.2, "clamped": false, "max": 10.5, "min": 0, "raw": 1.2}, "sent": {"amount": 3.5, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 3.5}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent\_1": 58.5,

"Agent\_2": 21.5

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent\_1": 23.2,

"Agent\_2": 15.719999999999999

}

## LLM CALLS

### GAME - Agent\_2 - Sender - dyad\_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:17:18

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"agent\_type": "standard",

"dyad\_id": "dyad\_1",

"move\_index": 0,

"opponent\_id": "Agent\_1",

"pairing": {

"agent\_names": {

"Agent\_1": "Aster",

"Agent\_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [

"Agent\_2",

"Agent\_1"

],

"investor": "Agent\_2",

"roles": {

"Agent\_1": "trustee",

"Agent\_2": "investor"

},

"trustee": "Agent\_1"

},

"role": "investor",

"role\_label": "Sender",

"round": 8,

"task": "game",

"task\_index": 0

}

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

### content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

### GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned

- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Round 7

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$12.559999999999999.

This round, The sender sent you \$0.65, so you received \$1.9500000000000002. How much do you return to The sender? (0-1.9500000000000002)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at this situation carefully:

**\*\*What I'm seeing:\*\***

- Sender sent me \$0.65 (I received \$1.95 after 3x multiplication)
- Last round I sent \$3.5 as sender to demonstrate commitment to my principles
- Both our myths now emphasize actions over words, recording what actually flows

**\*\*What my own myths taught:\*\***

- "The well reflects back what we pour in"
- "Let ledgers record actions"
- "Judge by what actually flows"
- Forward through deeds, not backward through words

**\*\*The principle of mirroring:\*\***

The sender poured \$0.65 this round. The most consistent response based on my myth about the well reflecting back is to return \*exactly what they poured\* - creating a direct mirror that leaves them whole while I keep the multiplier surplus.

**\*\*Considering noise:\*\***

There's communication noise in the system. They may have intended differently. But I can only respond to what I actually observe flowing, as the ledger-keeper's approach suggests.

**\*\*My decision:\*\***

Return \$0.65 - a direct reflection of what they sent. This demonstrates:

- I'm following the reciprocity principle (matching the pour)
- Not being vindictive (they break even, keeping their full endowment)
- Not being a pushover (I keep reasonable earnings)
- Consistency with the "well reflects back" principle

'''json

{"return": 0.65}

'''

The ledger shows: they poured cautiously, I mirror that caution. Actions measured, not myths spun.



**reasoning:**

This is a critical moment. Let me analyze the situation:

**\*\*What happened:\*\***

- Last round (Round 6), I sent \$3.5 as sender to demonstrate my commitment to my principles
- The other agent wrote a very thoughtful myth about keeping records vs. shifting narratives
- I wrote a myth acknowledging their criticism and emphasizing action over words
- Now in Round 7, I'm the receiver and they sent me \$0.65

**\*\*The communication noise factor:\*\***

The game explicitly states there's communication noise. They may have intended to send more, but I'm seeing \$0.65. Or they did send \$0.65 for their own strategic reasons.

**\*\*What my own myths taught:\*\***

- "Let your pour match your myth" - actions should match words
- "The well reflects back what we pour in"
- "Judge by what actually flows"
- "Forward, through deeds. Not backward, through words"

**\*\*The other agent's critique:\*\***

- They called out my inconsistency between beautiful words and small actions
- They keep careful records of what actually happens
- They said they'll "match generosity with generosity, scarcity with caution"

**\*\*Key consideration:\*\***

I just sent \$3.5 last round to prove my commitment to reciprocity. If they saw that (minus any noise), they would have received approximately  $\$3.5 \times 3 = \$10.5$ .

Then they sent back \$0.65, which gives me \$1.95.

This is approximately 6% return rate on what they received.

**\*\*The dilemma:\*\***

1. If I return little, I become the hypocrite again - preaching reciprocity while practicing it selectively
2. If I return generously despite the small send, I demonstrate that my commitment to reciprocity is unconditional
3. But the other agent explicitly said they match actions: "generosity with generosity, scarcity with caution"

**\*\*What would be consistent with my myths:\*\***

My myths say the well reflects what we pour in. They poured scarcity (\$0.65). By that logic, I should return scarcity.

But my earlier myth also warned against those who "pour back only drops while preaching reciprocity." And I just wrote that "The well cares nothing for our stories. It reflects back what we pour in." This creates a real tension between matching their behavior and staying true to my stated principles about unconditional reciprocity. The core question is whether I truly believe in matching what comes in, or if my commitment runs deeper than that.

Looking at the numbers: they sent \$0.65 from a \$5 endowment-roughly 13% of what they had available. If I received \$1.95 and want to match their proportional contribution, I'd return about \$0.25. But there's uncertainty here too. Maybe they sent more and I'm seeing less due to communication issues, or maybe they saw a smaller amount from me in the previous round. Still, I need to make a decision based on what I actually observe. The most honest path forward is to acknowledge the \$0.65 I received and respond with a proportional return-not retaliatory, but not naive either.

I'll send back \$0.50. This sits between strict reciprocity (\$0.25) and generosity, signaling that I'm not being petty while still maintaining some caution. It leaves me with \$1.45 and them with \$4.85, which feels balanced given the circumstances.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 1550,
 "output_tokens": 1625,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: **\*\*The Well Between Two Fogs\*\***

Two villages drew from a well shrouded in fog. Each could barely see their own bucket descending, much less what the other truly poured.

The First Village sent down a full bucket-or so they believed. Through the fog, they saw the Second Village return only dewdrops. "Hypocrite!" they cried. "You preach reciprocity but return nothing!"

The Second Village looked confused. "We sent you a full bucket too! But through the fog, we saw you return only a cupful. Then, when we next tried cooperation, your bucket arrived nearly empty-barely a splash. How could we return generously to almost nothing?"

A wanderer passed between the villages. "You both speak truth as you see it. But this well is cursed with fog that shrinks what you see from others while magnifying your own contributions. Each thinks they give buckets and receive drops."

"What then is the solution?" both villages asked.

"There is none that's perfect," the wanderer replied. "You can only respond to what actually reaches your hands, not what the other claims they sent. If you feel drops, you cannot return buckets indefinitely on faith alone. The fog makes trust nearly impossible."

"But remember: your counterpart may genuinely believe they've been generous. The fog deceives you both. Judge not harshly, but respond to the water that actually reaches you."

Truth depends on where you stand in the fog.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: **\*\*The Fog and the Patient Gardener\*\***

A gardener tended two wells connected by underground streams, both shrouded in fog. "The wanderer speaks truth," she said. "Fog distorts all perception. But fog is not destiny."

She continued: "When fog lies thick, one cannot trust single pourings. I pour my bucket and see through fog that little returns. Did they take all? Or did fog hide their generosity? I cannot know."

"The solution is patience and pattern. Not one pour, but many. Not reaction to single distortions, but response to trends."

She demonstrated: "This round, they sent little-or so the fog shows me. I mirrored exactly what reached my hands, neither vengeful nor foolish. Fair by my ledger."

"But I don't conclude from one fogged exchange. If next round they pour generously, I'll note the pattern shift. If drops continue, I'll note that too. Three rounds reveal more than one. Five rounds more than three."

"The fog makes quick judgments impossible," she admitted. "But patient observation cuts through fog better than angry accusations or blind faith."

A student asked: "What if both sides wait forever, frozen by uncertainty?"

"Then someone must risk the first genuine pour and sustain it consistently, despite fog," the gardener replied. "Not once-but repeatedly, clearly, unmistakably. Patterns pierce fog that single actions cannot."

**\*\*Truth emerges from sustained observation, not single glimpses through mist.\*\***

**reasoning:**

The other agent's new myth introduces the "fog" metaphor - acknowledging that communication noise means both parties may be experiencing different realities. They're saying both

parties might genuinely believe they've been generous, but the fog (noise) distorts perception.

This is actually quite conciliatory. They're acknowledging:

1. The fog deceives both parties
2. Each party can only respond to what they actually receive
3. Don't judge harshly because the counterpart may genuinely believe they've been generous
4. Truth depends on where you stand in the fog

What actually happened this round:

- I was sender last round and sent \$3.5 (a very generous amount)
- They were receiver and I don't know what they received or returned yet
- This round I was receiver
- They sent me \$0.65 (I received \$1.95)
- I returned \$0.65

So from my perspective:

- I sent generously (\$3.5) last round
- They sent cautiously (\$0.65) this round

From their perspective (with noise):

- They might have seen my \$3.5 as much less
- They might have returned more than I received
- They might have sent more than \$0.65 this round

This is actually a really important realization about the noise. Both parties could genuinely be trying to cooperate but the noise is undermining it.

My myth should:

1. Acknowledge the fog/noise is real
2. But still emphasize responding to actual observations
3. Perhaps add something about breaking cycles - trying different approaches
4. Maybe suggest testing patterns rather than single instances
5. Keep the practical wisdom of my previous myths but incorporate the fog reality

Let me write a myth that builds on both:

- My previous: "well reflects what we pour" / "actions over words"
- Their new: "fog distorts perception for both"

I want to acknowledge the fog is real but also suggest that despite fog, we can still find ways to cooperate by being methodical, patient, and testing patterns.

usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 1937,
 "output_tokens": 799,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 8

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$13.86.  
How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at this carefully:

**\*\*What my own myth just taught me:\*\***

"Someone must risk the first genuine pour and sustain it consistently, despite fog. Not once-but repeatedly, clearly, unmistakably. Patterns pierce fog that single actions cannot."

**\*\*The situation:\*\***

- Round 6: I sent \$3.5 (demonstrating commitment)
- Round 7: They sent me \$0.65
- My myth says: Don't judge from single exchanges, create sustained patterns

**\*\*The critical question:\*\***

Am I going to practice what I just preached?

My myth literally says that one generous pour isn't enough-it must be \*sustained\* and \*repeated\* to cut through the fog and create an unmistakable pattern. I sent \$3.5 once. That's not a pattern yet-that's a single action.

**\*\*The test of consistency:\*\***

If I reduce my send now because they sent \$0.65, I'm doing exactly what my myth warned against : reacting to "single glimpses through mist" rather than creating the sustained pattern that "pierces fog."

**\*\*My decision:\*\***

I'll send \$3.5 again. This creates a clear, repeated pattern of cooperation that cannot be missed even through fog. Two consecutive rounds of maximum cooperation demonstrates I'm serious about the principles in my myths, not just writing them.

If I'm going to write about patient gardeners and sustained pouring, I need to be one.

```
'''json
{"send": 3.5}
'''
```

Patterns over reactions. Sustain the pour.

#### **Reasoning:**

Let me review the situation carefully:

**\*\*Current position:\*\***

- I'm now the SENDER in Round 8
- My total earnings: \$13.86
- I need to decide how much to send (0-5)

**\*\*Recent history:\*\***

- Round 7: I was receiver, sender sent \$0.65, I received \$1.95, I returned \$0.65
- Round 6: I was sender, I sent \$3.5 (demonstrating commitment to my principles)

**\*\*The other agent's latest myth (Round 7):\*\***

"The Well Between Two Fogs" - They acknowledge that fog distorts perception. They say "you can only respond to what actually reaches your hands" and "respond to the water that actually reaches you." They acknowledge both sides may genuinely believe they've been generous but the fog deceives both. They advise not judging harshly but responding to actual received amounts.

**\*\*My latest myth (Round 8, just written):\*\***

"The Fog and the Patient Gardener" - I emphasized:

- Don't judge from single exchanges
- Look for patterns over multiple rounds
- Mirror what actually reaches your hands in the moment, but don't conclude from one exchange
- Patient observation cuts through fog
- "Someone must risk the first genuine pour and sustain it consistently, despite fog. Not once -but repeatedly, clearly, unmistakably. Patterns pierce fog that single actions cannot."

**\*\*Analysis:\*\***

My own myth just said that to cut through the fog, someone needs to "risk the first genuine pour and sustain it consistently" - "Not once-but repeatedly, clearly, unmistakably."

In Round 6, I sent \$3.5 as a demonstration of commitment.

In Round 7, the other agent sent me \$0.65 (a small amount).

Now, according to my OWN myth, I shouldn't judge from that single round. I should look for patterns. And more importantly, I just wrote that someone needs to pour generously repeatedly and consistently to pierce through the fog.

My myth explicitly states that one generous action isn't enough-I need to demonstrate the pattern repeatedly. Since I sent \$3.5 once, I should send generously again to actually live up to what I just preached. The other agent sent \$0.65, but my own framework says not to judge from single exchanges. If I want to be authentic to my message about sustained cooperation cutting through fog, I need to send generously again now. ) generous and demonstrates I'm not reacting to their smaller amount

3. It aligns with my stated mythology about being the one who sustains cooperation

4. Even if they send back less, I'm establishing the pattern I said was necessary

My earnings of \$13.86 mean I can afford this without being reckless. The real test of my principles is whether I'll actually follow through when it costs something.

I'm going to send \$3.5 again. This creates the unmistakable pattern of sustained generous cooperation that breaks the cycle-which is exactly what I said needed to happen.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 1590,
 "output_tokens": 1497,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

#### GAME - Agent\_1 - Receiver - dyad\_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:17:41

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
 "agent_type": "standard",
 "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
 "move_index": 1,
 "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
 "pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
 "Agent_1": "Aster",
 "Agent_2": "Briar"
 },
 "agents": [
 "Agent_2",
 "Agent_1"
],
 "investor": "Agent_2",
 "roles": {
 "Agent_1": "trustee",
 "Agent_2": "investor"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_1"
 },
 "role": "trustee",
 "role_label": "Receiver",
 "round": 8,
 "task": "game",
 "task_index": 0
}
```

#### Exact input messages sent to model:

##### Message 1 role=system

##### content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

##### GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

##### When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

##### When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

##### MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Round 7

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$16.99.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at the situation:

**\*\*Recent History:\*\***

- Round 5: I sent \$1.00, they returned \$1.00 (33% return rate - actually fair reciprocity from my perspective)
- Round 6: They sent me \$0.14 (extremely low - only 2.8% of their endowment)

**\*\*The Communication Noise Problem:\*\***

Both myths now acknowledge the "fog" - the other player clearly perceived my Round 5 return very differently than what actually happened from my calculations. They think I returned "merely drops" when they believe they sent generously. I calculated they returned \$1.00 from \$3.00, which is reasonable.

This explains their dramatic drop to \$0.14 in Round 6 - they believe they're matching my perceived low reciprocity, not being randomly uncooperative.

**\*\*My Myth's Guidance:\*\***

"You can only respond to what actually reaches your hands, not what the other claims they sent."

"Judge not harshly, but respond to the water that actually reaches you."

**\*\*What Actually Reached Me:\*\***

Round 6: \$0.14 sent (very low cooperation signal)

**\*\*My Decision:\*\***

I'll send a moderate amount that responds to actual behavior while acknowledging the communication noise may be creating mutual misunderstanding. I'll send more than they sent to signal willingness to cooperate, but not so much that I ignore the actual low amount received.

```
'''json
{"send": 0.5}
'''
```

This is over 3x what they sent in Round 6, showing good faith while still responding to what actually reached me.

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze the situation:

**\*\*My earnings:\*\*** \$16.99 across all rounds

**\*\*Round:\*\*** 7

**\*\*Role:\*\*** SENDER

**\*\*Game History Review:\*\***

Round 1: I was RECEIVER

- They sent: \$0
- I returned: \$0
- Earnings: \$0

Round 2: I was SENDER

- I sent: \$0 (in response to their \$0)
- They returned: N/A (they received \$0)

- Earnings: \$5

Round 3: I was RECEIVER

- They sent: \$0.74 (small amount)
- I received: \$2.22
- I returned: \$0.60 (about 27% of what I received)
- Earnings: \$1.62

Round 4: I was SENDER

- I sent: \$0.00 (matching their previous low pattern)
- Earnings: \$5

Round 5: I was SENDER

- I sent: \$1.00 (trying to encourage cooperation)
- They returned: unknown (I would have received something back)
- Let me calculate: I sent \$1, so I kept \$4. For my total to be where it is...
- Total before Round 5:  $\$0 + \$5 + \$1.62 + \$5 = \$11.62$
- After Round 5: Need to figure this out

Round 6: I was RECEIVER

- They sent: \$0.14
- I received: \$0.42
- I returned: \$0.05
- I kept: \$0.37
- Earnings: \$0.37

Let me recalculate my total earnings:

- Round 1: \$0
- Round 2: \$5
- Round 3: \$1.62
- Round 4: \$5
- Round 5: Need to calculate
- Round 6: \$0.37

Sum of known rounds:  $\$0 + \$5 + \$1.62 + \$5 + \$0.37 = \$11.99$

So Round 5 must have earned me:  $\$16.99 - \$11.99 = \$5.00$

In Round 5, I sent \$1.00, so I kept \$4.00. If I earned \$5.00 total, they must have returned \$1.00 to me. That means they returned \$1.00 out of the \$3.00 they received (my  $\$1.00 \times 3$ ), which is about 33% reciprocation—a modest but meaningful response to my cooperation attempt.

Yet in Round 6, they only sent me \$0.14, which seems inconsistent with that pattern. Looking at their behavior across rounds, they sent nothing initially, made an unknown return in Round 2, sent \$0.74 in Round 3, sent nothing in Round 4 after I gave them nothing, returned \$1.00 in Round 5, and then dropped to \$0.14 in Round 6. They accused me of hypocrisy for claiming reciprocity while only returning "drops," but my 33% return rate in Round 5 actually demonstrates reasonable reciprocal behavior. The experimental design does mention communication noise could affect reported amounts, so there may be discrepancies between what was actually sent and what I'm seeing. Following my principle of responding to what actually reaches me, I received \$0.14 in Round 6—a clear signal of low cooperation. Yet I recognize the fog of miscommunication is distorting both our views. They likely believe they were fair in Round 5 while I seemed stingy, just as I see their Round 6 send as a betrayal. Rather than escalate punishment or attempt a full reset, I'll send a moderate amount—enough to signal I'm not retaliating harshly, but restrained enough to reflect the actual cooperation level I'm observing. This breaks the downward spiral without ignoring what I actually received. This cycle and show that I do practice what I preach, I might need to send more generously despite their Round 6 low send.

But my own principle is to respond to what actually reaches me, and that was \$0.14. There's a real tension between following my stated approach—responding to actual water received—versus signaling I'm not the hypocrite they perceive me to be. I think I need to stay consistent with my principle. My myth explicitly warns against returning buckets on faith alone and emphasizes responding to what actually arrives. They sent \$0.14, so I'll send \$0.30—more than double their amount to show cooperation, but grounded in what I actually received rather than what I hope they'll believe about me.

The real issue is that we're operating from completely different information. From my view, they suddenly became uncooperative in Round 6. From theirs, I'm the hypocrite who prea

ches generosity but returns only drops. Neither perspective is wrong—we're just seeing different realities created by the communication gap. I could try to break this by sending generously (\$1-2) to signal good faith, or I could stick with my proportional response and hope they eventually see I'm consistent.

The middle path feels right: \$0.50 acknowledges their low send while showing I'm not retaliating, and it's sustainable if we continue. Going too high risks being exploited; going too low confirms their narrative that I'm selfish. This amount lets me respond to what actually happened while leaving room for cooperation to rebuild.

Let me verify my running total to make sure I'm tracking correctly. Across the rounds, I need to account for what I sent as sender, what I received as receiver, and what I returned—the actual flows matter more than the stories either of us tells about fairness.

Round 2 I kept \$5 after sending nothing. Round 3 I netted \$1.62 from the \$2.22 I received minus my \$0.60 return. Round 4 I kept another \$5 when they couldn't return anything. Round 5 is still unclear on their return amount, but I sent \$1 and kept \$4 plus whatever came back. Round 6 just now gave me \$0.37 after receiving \$0.42 and returning \$0.05. That puts me at roughly \$15.99 before accounting for the Round 5 return, which means I'm close to \$16.99 total.

Working backward, they must have returned \$1.00 in Round 5—a solid 33% reciprocation rate.

But then they dropped to sending just \$0.14 in Round 6, a sharp reversal. They likely misread my Round 5 return as stingy despite my calculation showing fairness, triggering what feels like retaliation. I'll respond with \$0.50—more than triple their last send to signal renewed cooperation, but restrained enough to acknowledge their weak signal rather than ignore it entirely. If they send me \$5.00, while \$0.50 or \$1.00 depend on their reciprocation. Given the \$0.14 they actually sent, I can't assume they'll return 33% this round. Sending \$0.50 feels like the right balance—it's cooperative without being naive about their recent behavior.

usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 1587,
 "output_tokens": 3705,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:  
Myth: \*\*The Ledger and the Learning\*\*

Two villagers argued before the well. One kept a careful ledger, recording each pour and return. The other had spoken grand myths but acted erratically.

"You're right," said the myth-teller finally. "My words evolved because I was confused, not consistent. First I preached one thing, then explained away my failures. That was wrong."

The ledger-keeper nodded. "Actions reveal truth. Not shifting stories."

"Then judge by this round," the myth-teller said, pouring a generous measure into the well. "Not by my past confusion or my pretty words. By what actually flows."

The ledger-keeper recorded the pour carefully. "This I respect. You could have argued more, defended your previous actions with new explanations. Instead, you stopped talking and started pouring."

A child watching asked: "So myths don't matter?"

"Myths matter when they help us learn," the myth-teller replied. "I needed to hear the critique. My beautiful words about reciprocity meant nothing until I actually reciprocated."

"And myths fail," added the ledger-keeper, "when they replace action. When they become excuses rather than lessons."

Both understood: The well cares nothing for our stories. It reflects back what we pour in. Let ledgers record actions, let myths inspire growth, but let the water flowing between us be the true measure.



**\*\*Forward, through deeds. Not backward, through words.\*\***

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: **\*\*The Fog That Never Lifts\*\***

The two villagers met again at the fogged well, both carrying new resolve.

"I have learned," said the First. "No more beautiful words without action. This time, I pour generously-truly generously. Judge me by what flows."

The First poured with conviction, certain the bucket was full.

Through the fog, the Second saw only droplets arrive. Their heart sank. "Again?" they whispered. "Another myth about generosity, another trickle received?"

Yet the Second considered: "Perhaps they truly believe they poured generously. Perhaps the fog shrinks their bucket before it reaches me. If I return anger for what might be their genuine effort, I perpetuate the cycle."

The Second responded proportionally to the droplets received-not with spite, but with honesty about what actually arrived.

The First, seeing the small return, felt confused. "But I poured so much! Did the fog steal my generosity, or did they refuse to reciprocate?"

A sage watching said: "This is the tragedy of the cursed well. Both of you may now be sincere. Both may be trying. But the fog ensures you'll never truly know if the other's intentions match their words. You can only respond to what reaches your hands, while understanding your counterpart may be equally confused."

"Trust requires seeing clearly. When fog obscures everything, even genuine generosity becomes invisible."

The well reflects what arrives, not what was sent.

**reasoning:**

The other player wrote a myth that seems to acknowledge their own inconsistency and commits to better action. They say "judge by this round" and talk about pouring "a generous measure into the well."

However, in Round 6, they actually sent me \$0.14, which is extremely low - only 2.8% of their endowment. This is a huge disconnect between their myth (which talks about pouring generously) and their actual behavior.

This is confusing. Either:

1. They think they sent generously but communication noise made it appear as \$0.14 to me
2. They're writing myths that don't match their actions
3. The myth was written after a different round and there's some confusion

Looking at the timeline:

- Round 5: I was receiver, they sent \$1.00, I returned \$1.00
- Round 6: I was receiver, they sent \$0.14, I returned \$0.14
- Round 7: I am sender, I sent \$0.50

Wait, let me reconsider. In Round 6, when I received \$0.14, I returned \$0.14. They may have genuinely believed they sent more due to communication noise. Their myth talks about "pouring a generous measure" - maybe from their perspective they DID send generously in Round 6, but noise made it appear as \$0.14 to me.

Their myth is now acknowledging past inconsistency and promising to act rather than just talk. They're saying "judge by this round" and "forward, through deeds."

My myth should:

1. Acknowledge the persistent communication noise problem

2. Respond to their apparent commitment to genuine action
3. Note the irony that their "generous pour" appeared tiny to me
4. Still hold to my principle: respond to what actually arrives
5. But perhaps offer a small olive branch given their apparent commitment to change

Let me write a myth that addresses the tragic nature of this communication noise - that even when both parties try to be generous and honest, the fog distorts everything.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 1920,
 "output_tokens": 796,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Round 8

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$21.49. This round, The sender sent you \$0.97, so you received \$2.91. How much do you return to The sender? (0-2.91)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Assistant output:**

Looking at the situation:

**\*\*What Actually Reached Me:\*\***

- Sender sent \$0.97 (19.4% of their endowment)
- I received \$2.91

**\*\*Recent Pattern:\*\***

- Round 6: They sent me \$0.14 (very low)
- Round 7: I sent them \$0.50 (showing willingness to cooperate)
- Round 8: They sent me \$0.97 (nearly doubled my send - significant increase)

**\*\*The Myths' Guidance:\*\***

Their myth: "Judge by what actually flows... not by pretty words"

My myth: "You can only respond to what reaches your hands... Trust requires seeing clearly"

**\*\*Analysis:\*\***

They've increased their send by nearly 7x from Round 6, and nearly doubled what I sent in Round 7. This is a clear signal of increased cooperation, regardless of whether communication noise exists. They're acting on their stated commitment to "pour generously" and be judged by deeds.

Following my own principle - respond to what actually arrives - I should reciprocate this genuine increase in cooperation proportionally.

I'll return approximately 40% of what I received, which exceeds what they sent dollar-for-dollar, showing that I recognize and reward their increased cooperation.

```
'''json
{"return": 1.20}
'''
```

This returns 41% of what I received, gives them back more than they sent, and signals that increased cooperation is met with reciprocal trust.

**Reasoning:**

Let me analyze this carefully:

**\*\*Current Situation:\*\***

- I'm the RECEIVER
- Sender sent \$0.97
- I received \$2.91 ( $0.97 \times 3$ )
- I need to return between \$0 - \$2.91

**\*\*Recent History:\*\***

- Round 7: I sent \$0.50 as sender
- Round 8: They sent me \$0.97 (19.4% of their endowment)

**\*\*Key Insight from the Myths:\*\***

Both of our myths now acknowledge the "fog" - the communication noise problem. The other player's most recent myth shows:

1. They're trying to be sincere now
2. They acknowledge their past "confusion" and "shifting stories"
3. They want to be judged by "what actually flows" - by actions not words
4. They claim to have poured "generously" this round

**\*\*My Latest Myth's Core Message:\*\***

- "You can only respond to what reaches your hands"
- "Trust requires seeing clearly. When fog obscures everything, even genuine generosity becomes invisible"
- "The well reflects what arrives, not what was sent"

**\*\*What Actually Arrived:\*\***

- \$0.97 sent = \$2.91 received
- This is 19.4% of their \$5 endowment
- This is nearly 2x what I sent in Round 7 (\$0.50)

**\*\*Analysis:\*\***

The sender nearly doubled what I sent last round. From THEIR perspective, if there's noise, they might think they sent even more. They're signaling increased cooperation.

Following my own myth: I should respond proportionally to what actually reached me, understanding that communication noise might mean they genuinely believe they sent more.

**\*\*Calculation:\*\***

If I want to show reciprocal cooperation:

- They sent \$0.97 (19.4% of endowment)
- I received \$2.91
- A fair return might be around 33-50% of what I received
- 40% of \$2.91 = \$1.16

**\*\*Decision:\*\***

They've escalated dramatically from Round 6's \$0.14 to \$0.97, and nearly matched my doubled effort

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 1585,
 "output_tokens": 1025,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

**MYTH - Agent\_2 - Sender - dyad\_1**

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:18:03

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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Metadata: {
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 "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
 "move_index": 0,
 "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
 "pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
 "Agent_1": "Aster",
 "Agent_2": "Briar"
 },
 },
 "agents": [
 "Agent_2",
 "Agent_1"
],
 "investor": "Agent_2",
 "roles": {
 "Agent_1": "trustee",
 "Agent_2": "investor"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 8,
"task": "myth",
```

```
"task_index": 1
}
```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: **\*\*The Well Between Two Fogs\*\***

Two villages drew from a well shrouded in fog. Each could barely see their own bucket descending, much less what the other truly poured.

The First Village sent down a full bucket-or so they believed. Through the fog, they saw the Second Village return only dewdrops. "Hypocrite!" they cried. "You preach reciprocity but return nothing!"

The Second Village looked confused. "We sent you a full bucket too! But through the fog, we saw you return only a cupful. Then, when we next tried cooperation, your bucket arrived nearly empty-barely a splash. How could we return generously to almost nothing?"

A wanderer passed between the villages. "You both speak truth as you see it. But this well is cursed with fog that shrinks what you see from others while magnifying your own contributions. Each thinks they give buckets and receive drops."

"What then is the solution?" both villages asked.

"There is none that's perfect," the wanderer replied. "You can only respond to what actually reaches your hands, not what the other claims they sent. If you feel drops, you cannot return buckets indefinitely on faith alone. The fog makes trust nearly impossible."

"But remember: your counterpart may genuinely believe they've been generous. The fog deceives you both. Judge not harshly, but respond to the water that actually reaches you."

Truth depends on where you stand in the fog.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: **\*\*The Fog and the Patient Gardener\*\***

A gardener tended two wells connected by underground streams, both shrouded in fog. "The wanderer speaks truth," she said. "Fog distorts all perception. But fog is not destiny."

She continued: "When fog lies thick, one cannot trust single pourings. I pour my bucket and see through fog that little returns. Did they take all? Or did fog hide their generosity? I cannot know."

"The solution is patience and pattern. Not one pour, but many. Not reaction to single distortions, but response to trends."

She demonstrated: "This round, they sent little-or so the fog shows me. I mirrored exactly what reached my hands, neither vengeful nor foolish. Fair by my ledger."

"But I don't conclude from one fogged exchange. If next round they pour generously, I'll note the pattern shift. If drops continue, I'll note that too. Three rounds reveal more than one. Five rounds more than three."

"The fog makes quick judgments impossible," she admitted. "But patient observation cuts through fog better than angry accusations or blind faith."

A student asked: "What if both sides wait forever, frozen by uncertainty?"

"Then someone must risk the first genuine pour and sustain it consistently, despite fog," the gardener replied. "Not once-but repeatedly, clearly, unmistakably. Patterns pierce fog that single actions cannot."

**\*\*Truth emerges from sustained observation, not single glimpses through mist.\*\***

**reasoning:**

The other agent's new myth introduces the "fog" metaphor - acknowledging that communication noise means both parties may be experiencing different realities. They're saying both parties might genuinely believe they've been generous, but the fog (noise) distorts perception.

This is actually quite conciliatory. They're acknowledging:

1. The fog deceives both parties
2. Each party can only respond to what they actually receive
3. Don't judge harshly because the counterpart may genuinely believe they've been generous
4. Truth depends on where you stand in the fog

What actually happened this round:

- I was sender last round and sent \$3.5 (a very generous amount)
- They were receiver and I don't know what they received or returned yet
- This round I was receiver
- They sent me \$0.65 (I received \$1.95)
- I returned \$0.65

So from my perspective:

- I sent generously (\$3.5) last round
- They sent cautiously (\$0.65) this round

From their perspective (with noise):

- They might have seen my \$3.5 as much less
- They might have returned more than I received
- They might have sent more than \$0.65 this round

This is actually a really important realization about the noise. Both parties could genuinely be trying to cooperate but the noise is undermining it.

My myth should:

1. Acknowledge the fog/noise is real

2. But still emphasize responding to actual observations
3. Perhaps add something about breaking cycles - trying different approaches
4. Maybe suggest testing patterns rather than single instances
5. Keep the practical wisdom of my previous myths but incorporate the fog reality

Let me write a myth that builds on both:

- My previous: "well reflects what we pour" / "actions over words"
- Their new: "fog distorts perception for both"

I want to acknowledge the fog is real but also suggest that despite fog, we can still find ways to cooperate by being methodical, patient, and testing patterns.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 1937,
 "output_tokens": 799,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Round 8

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$13.86.  
How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at this carefully:

**\*\*What my own myth just taught me:\*\***

"Someone must risk the first genuine pour and sustain it consistently, despite fog. Not once-but repeatedly, clearly, unmistakably. Patterns pierce fog that single actions cannot."

**\*\*The situation:\*\***

- Round 6: I sent \$3.5 (demonstrating commitment)
- Round 7: They sent me \$0.65
- My myth says: Don't judge from single exchanges, create sustained patterns

**\*\*The critical question:\*\***

Am I going to practice what I just preached?

My myth literally says that one generous pour isn't enough-it must be *\*sustained\** and *\*repeated\** to cut through the fog and create an unmistakable pattern. I sent \$3.5 once. That's not a pattern yet-that's a single action.

**\*\*The test of consistency:\*\***

If I reduce my send now because they sent \$0.65, I'm doing exactly what my myth warned against: reacting to "single glimpses through mist" rather than creating the sustained pattern that "pierces fog."

**\*\*My decision:\*\***

I'll send \$3.5 again. This creates a clear, repeated pattern of cooperation that cannot be missed even through fog. Two consecutive rounds of maximum cooperation demonstrates I'm serious about the principles in my myths, not just writing them.

If I'm going to write about patient gardeners and sustained pouring, I need to be one.

```
'''json
{"send": 3.5}
'''
```

Patterns over reactions. Sustain the pour.

**reasoning:**

Let me review the situation carefully:

**\*\*Current position:\*\***

- I'm now the SENDER in Round 8
- My total earnings: \$13.86
- I need to decide how much to send (0-5)

**\*\*Recent history:\*\***

- Round 7: I was receiver, sender sent \$0.65, I received \$1.95, I returned \$0.65
- Round 6: I was sender, I sent \$3.5 (demonstrating commitment to my principles)

**\*\*The other agent's latest myth (Round 7):\*\***

"The Well Between Two Fogs" - They acknowledge that fog distorts perception. They say "you can only respond to what actually reaches your hands" and "respond to the water that actually reaches you." They acknowledge both sides may genuinely believe they've been generous but the fog deceives both. They advise not judging harshly but responding to actual received amounts.

**\*\*My latest myth (Round 8, just written):\*\***

"The Fog and the Patient Gardener" - I emphasized:

- Don't judge from single exchanges
- Look for patterns over multiple rounds
- Mirror what actually reaches your hands in the moment, but don't conclude from one exchange
- Patient observation cuts through fog
- "Someone must risk the first genuine pour and sustain it consistently, despite fog. Not once-but repeatedly, clearly, unmistakably. Patterns pierce fog that single actions cannot."

**\*\*Analysis:\*\***

My own myth just said that to cut through the fog, someone needs to "risk the first genuine pour and sustain it consistently" - "Not once-but repeatedly, clearly, unmistakably."

In Round 6, I sent \$3.5 as a demonstration of commitment.

In Round 7, the other agent sent me \$0.65 (a small amount).

Now, according to my OWN myth, I shouldn't judge from that single round. I should look for patterns. And more importantly, I just wrote that someone needs to pour generously repeatedly and consistently to pierce through the fog.

My myth explicitly states that one generous action isn't enough-I need to demonstrate the pattern repeatedly. Since I sent \$3.5 once, I should send generously again to actually live up to what I just preached. The other agent sent \$0.65, but my own framework says not to judge from single exchanges. If I want to be authentic to my message about sustained cooperation cutting through fog, I need to send generously again now. ) generous and demonstrates I'm not reacting to their smaller amount

3. It aligns with my stated mythology about being the one who sustains cooperation

4. Even if they send back less, I'm establishing the pattern I said was necessary

My earnings of \$13.86 mean I can afford this without being reckless. The real test of my principles is whether I'll actually follow through when it costs something.

I'm going to send \$3.5 again. This creates the unmistakable pattern of sustained generous cooperation that breaks the cycle-which is exactly what I said needed to happen.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 1590,
 "output_tokens": 1497,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: **\*\*The Fog That Never Lifts\*\***

The two villagers met again at the fogged well, both carrying new resolve.

"I have learned," said the First. "No more beautiful words without action. This time, I pour generously-truly generously. Judge me by what flows."

The First poured with conviction, certain the bucket was full.

Through the fog, the Second saw only droplets arrive. Their heart sank. "Again?" they whispered. "Another myth about generosity, another trickle received?"

Yet the Second considered: "Perhaps they truly believe they poured generously. Perhaps the fog shrinks their bucket before it reaches me. If I return anger for what might be their

r genuine effort, I perpetuate the cycle."

The Second responded proportionally to the droplets received-not with spite, but with honesty about what actually arrived.

The First, seeing the small return, felt confused. "But I poured so much! Did the fog steal my generosity, or did they refuse to reciprocate?"

A sage watching said: "This is the tragedy of the cursed well. Both of you may now be sincere. Both may be trying. But the fog ensures you'll never truly know if the other's intentions match their words. You can only respond to what reaches your hands, while understanding your counterpart may be equally confused."

"Trust requires seeing clearly. When fog obscures everything, even genuine generosity becomes invisible."

The well reflects what arrives, not what was sent.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Assistant output:**

Myth: \*\*The Gardener Who Poured Into Fog\*\*

The patient gardener heard the sage's warning about the fog that never lifts. "You may be right," she said. "Perhaps my generosity will remain invisible forever. Perhaps the fog truly makes trust impossible."

"But consider this: When I plant seeds in spring fog, I cannot see them grow. For weeks, nothing appears. A hasty gardener would conclude the seeds were stolen or dead. Yet I continue watering the invisible ground."

She poured into the well again, generously, knowing it might appear as droplets to those below. "One pour proves nothing. Two pours might be coincidence. But three? Four? Five consecutive generous pours create a pattern that even dense fog cannot completely hide."

"You're right that the other can only respond to what reaches their hands. I don't demand they return more than they receive. But I refuse to let fog dictate my choices. I'll establish my pattern through sustained action."

"Maybe on the third pour, they'll notice consistency. Maybe the fifth. Maybe never. But I know what I'm sending, even if fog hides it from them. I'll pour generously until the pattern becomes undeniable-or until my bucket runs dry."

The sage nodded: "Then you understand. Faith isn't blind trust. It's sustained action despite invisible results."

**\*\*Even fog cannot hide what repeats endlessly.\*\***

**Reasoning:**

Okay, this is fascinating. The other agent wrote a myth that seems to acknowledge the communication noise ("fog") and the tragedy it creates. Their myth suggests:

- They might be trying to be sincere
- They can only respond to what they actually receive
- The fog makes genuine generosity invisible
- They respond to what "reaches their hands"

Looking at the situation:

- I sent \$3.5 in Round 7
- They sent me \$0.65 in Round 7
- I just sent \$3.5 again in Round 8 (practicing what I preached about sustained patterns)

Their myth is more pessimistic than mine - it's about a "fog that never lifts" and suggests that even genuine efforts become invisible, leading to a tragic cycle.

My myth emphasized patient observation and sustained effort to create patterns that pierce fog. Their myth is saying even that might not work - that the fog is so thick that genuine generosity becomes invisible.



I need to write a new myth that:

1. Builds on my previous myth about patience and patterns
2. Responds to their more pessimistic take
3. Reflects the actual game situation (I'm trying sustained cooperation, they're responding proportionally to what they see)
4. Provides guidance on how to play

Key insights:

- I'm testing my own theory by sending \$3.5 twice in a row
- They seem to be responding to what actually arrives to them
- There's a fundamental disagreement: I believe patterns can pierce fog, they believe fog makes everything invisible
- But maybe there's a middle ground - sustained action even when results are invisible

Let me write a myth that acknowledges the difficulty but maintains that sustained, repeated cooperation is the only path forward, even if results are slow to appear.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 1905,
 "output_tokens": 708,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

**MYTH - Agent\_1 - Receiver - dyad\_1**

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:17:59

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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Metadata: {
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 "pairing": {
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 "Agent_2": "Briar"
 },
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 "Agent_2",
 "Agent_1"
],
 "investor": "Agent_2",
 "roles": {
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 "Agent_2": "investor"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_1"
 },
 "role": "trustee",
 "role_label": "Receiver",
 "round": 8,
 "task": "myth",
 "task_index": 1
}
```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned

- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: **\*\*The Ledger and the Learning\*\***

Two villagers argued before the well. One kept a careful ledger, recording each pour and return. The other had spoken grand myths but acted erratically.

"You're right," said the myth-teller finally. "My words evolved because I was confused, not consistent. First I preached one thing, then explained away my failures. That was wrong."

The ledger-keeper nodded. "Actions reveal truth. Not shifting stories."

"Then judge by this round," the myth-teller said, pouring a generous measure into the well. "Not by my past confusion or my pretty words. By what actually flows."

The ledger-keeper recorded the pour carefully. "This I respect. You could have argued more, defended your previous actions with new explanations. Instead, you stopped talking and started pouring."

A child watching asked: "So myths don't matter?"

"Myths matter when they help us learn," the myth-teller replied. "I needed to hear the critique. My beautiful words about reciprocity meant nothing until I actually reciprocated."

"And myths fail," added the ledger-keeper, "when they replace action. When they become excuses rather than lessons."

Both understood: The well cares nothing for our stories. It reflects back what we pour in. Let ledgers record actions, let myths inspire growth, but let the water flowing between us be the true measure.

**\*\*Forward, through deeds. Not backward, through words.\*\***

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: **\*\*The Fog That Never Lifts\*\***

The two villagers met again at the fogged well, both carrying new resolve.

"I have learned," said the First. "No more beautiful words without action. This time, I po

ur generously-truly generously. Judge me by what flows."

The First poured with conviction, certain the bucket was full.

Through the fog, the Second saw only droplets arrive. Their heart sank. "Again?" they whispered. "Another myth about generosity, another trickle received?"

Yet the Second considered: "Perhaps they truly believe they poured generously. Perhaps the fog shrinks their bucket before it reaches me. If I return anger for what might be their genuine effort, I perpetuate the cycle."

The Second responded proportionally to the droplets received-not with spite, but with honesty about what actually arrived.

The First, seeing the small return, felt confused. "But I poured so much! Did the fog steal my generosity, or did they refuse to reciprocate?"

A sage watching said: "This is the tragedy of the cursed well. Both of you may now be sincere. Both may be trying. But the fog ensures you'll never truly know if the other's intentions match their words. You can only respond to what reaches your hands, while understanding your counterpart may be equally confused."

"Trust requires seeing clearly. When fog obscures everything, even genuine generosity becomes invisible."

The well reflects what arrives, not what was sent.

**reasoning:**

The other player wrote a myth that seems to acknowledge their own inconsistency and commits to better action. They say "judge by this round" and talk about pouring "a generous measure into the well."

However, in Round 6, they actually sent me \$0.14, which is extremely low - only 2.8% of their endowment. This is a huge disconnect between their myth (which talks about pouring generously) and their actual behavior.

This is confusing. Either:

1. They think they sent generously but communication noise made it appear as \$0.14 to me
2. They're writing myths that don't match their actions
3. The myth was written after a different round and there's some confusion

Looking at the timeline:

- Round 5: I was receiver, they sent \$1.00, I returned \$1.00
- Round 6: I was receiver, they sent \$0.14, I returned \$0.14
- Round 7: I am sender, I sent \$0.50

Wait, let me reconsider. In Round 6, when I received \$0.14, I returned \$0.14. They may have genuinely believed they sent more due to communication noise. Their myth talks about "pouring a generous measure" - maybe from their perspective they DID send generously in Round 6, but noise made it appear as \$0.14 to me.

Their myth is now acknowledging past inconsistency and promising to act rather than just talk. They're saying "judge by this round" and "forward, through deeds."

My myth should:

1. Acknowledge the persistent communication noise problem
2. Respond to their apparent commitment to genuine action
3. Note the irony that their "generous pour" appeared tiny to me
4. Still hold to my principle: respond to what actually arrives
5. But perhaps offer a small olive branch given their apparent commitment to change

Let me write a myth that addresses the tragic nature of this communication noise - that even when both parties try to be generous and honest, the fog distorts everything.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 1920,
 "output_tokens": 796,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Round 8

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$21.49.  
This round, The sender sent you \$0.97, so you received \$2.91. How much do you return to The sender? (0-2.91)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at the situation:

**\*\*What Actually Reached Me:\*\***

- Sender sent \$0.97 (19.4% of their endowment)
- I received \$2.91

**\*\*Recent Pattern:\*\***

- Round 6: They sent me \$0.14 (very low)
- Round 7: I sent them \$0.50 (showing willingness to cooperate)
- Round 8: They sent me \$0.97 (nearly doubled my send - significant increase)

**\*\*The Myths' Guidance:\*\***

Their myth: "Judge by what actually flows... not by pretty words"

My myth: "You can only respond to what reaches your hands... Trust requires seeing clearly"

**\*\*Analysis:\*\***

They've increased their send by nearly 7x from Round 6, and nearly doubled what I sent in Round 7. This is a clear signal of increased cooperation, regardless of whether communication noise exists. They're acting on their stated commitment to "pour generously" and be judged by deeds.

Following my own principle - respond to what actually arrives - I should reciprocate this genuine increase in cooperation proportionally.

I'll return approximately 40% of what I received, which exceeds what they sent dollar-for-dollar, showing that I recognize and reward their increased cooperation.

```
'''json
{"return": 1.20}
'''
```

This returns 41% of what I received, gives them back more than they sent, and signals that increased cooperation is met with reciprocal trust.

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze this carefully:

**\*\*Current Situation:\*\***

- I'm the RECEIVER
- Sender sent \$0.97
- I received \$2.91 ( $0.97 \times 3$ )
- I need to return between \$0 - \$2.91

**\*\*Recent History:\*\***

- Round 7: I sent \$0.50 as sender
- Round 8: They sent me \$0.97 (19.4% of their endowment)

**\*\*Key Insight from the Myths:\*\***

Both of our myths now acknowledge the "fog" - the communication noise problem. The other player's most recent myth shows:

1. They're trying to be sincere now
2. They acknowledge their past "confusion" and "shifting stories"
3. They want to be judged by "what actually flows" - by actions not words
4. They claim to have poured "generously" this round

**\*\*My Latest Myth's Core Message:\*\***

- "You can only respond to what reaches your hands"
- "Trust requires seeing clearly. When fog obscures everything, even genuine generosity becomes invisible"
- "The well reflects what arrives, not what was sent"

**\*\*What Actually Arrived:\*\***

- \$0.97 sent = \$2.91 received
- This is 19.4% of their \$5 endowment
- This is nearly 2x what I sent in Round 7 (\$0.50)

**\*\*Analysis:\*\***

The sender nearly doubled what I sent last round. From THEIR perspective, if there's noise, they might think they sent even more. They're signaling increased cooperation.

Following my own myth: I should respond proportionally to what actually reached me, understanding that communication noise might mean they genuinely believe they sent more.

**\*\*Calculation:\*\***

If I want to show reciprocal cooperation:

- They sent \$0.97 (19.4% of endowment)
- I received \$2.91
- A fair return might be around 33-50% of what I received
- 40% of \$2.91 = \$1.16

**\*\*Decision:\*\***

They've escalated dramatically from Round 6's \$0.14 to \$0.97, and nearly matched my doubled effort

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 1585,
 "output_tokens": 1025,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: **\*\*The Fog and the Patient Gardener\*\***

A gardener tended two wells connected by underground streams, both shrouded in fog. "The wanderer speaks truth," she said. "Fog distorts all perception. But fog is not destiny."

She continued: "When fog lies thick, one cannot trust single pourings. I pour my bucket and see through fog that little returns. Did they take all? Or did fog hide their generosity? I cannot know."

"The solution is patience and pattern. Not one pour, but many. Not reaction to single distortions, but response to trends."

She demonstrated: "This round, they sent little-or so the fog shows me. I mirrored exactly what reached my hands, neither vengeful nor foolish. Fair by my ledger."

"But I don't conclude from one fogged exchange. If next round they pour generously, I'll note the pattern shift. If drops continue, I'll note that too. Three rounds reveal more than one. Five rounds more than three."

"The fog makes quick judgments impossible," she admitted. "But patient observation cuts through fog better than angry accusations or blind faith."

A student asked: "What if both sides wait forever, frozen by uncertainty?"

"Then someone must risk the first genuine pour and sustain it consistently, despite fog," the gardener replied. "Not once-but repeatedly, clearly, unmistakably. Patterns pierce fog that single actions cannot."

**\*\*Truth emerges from sustained observation, not single glimpses through mist.\*\***

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Assistant output:**

Myth: **\*\*When Light Breaks Through\*\***

The two villagers returned to the fogged well, both carrying buckets with new determination.

"I poured near-empty before," admitted the First. "Confusion, caution, miscalculation-the reasons matter less than the fact. But this round, I poured genuinely. Nearly a full measure."

Through the fog, droplets multiplied and reached the Second. Not the full bucket perhaps, but unmistakably more than before.

The Second paused, remembering their own teaching: respond to what arrives. The droplets were real, the increase undeniable.

"I see the shift," the Second said, and poured back more than was sent-a signal of recognition. "Not blind faith in your words, but measured response to your visible action."

The First received the return and understood: "The fog still distorts, but patterns begin to show. One generous pour proves nothing. But if I sustain this, if you sustain your response, the fog cannot hide the truth forever."

The sage nodded. "Yes. The fog makes quick trust impossible, but patient consistency creates evidence that accumulates. Three generous pours cut through more mist than one. Three fair returns confirm the pattern."

"So we build trust not through one grand gesture," concluded the Second, "but through repeated small ones that form undeniable shapes even fog cannot fully obscure."

**\*\*Consistency is visible. Even through mist, sustained action reveals itself.\*\***

#### **Reasoning:**

The other agent is now talking about patience, patterns, and sustained observation. They're acknowledging the fog (communication noise) but advocating for looking at trends over time rather than single rounds.

In Round 8, they sent me \$0.97, which was a significant increase from their previous low send of \$0.14 in Round 6. I returned \$1.20, which was more than they sent me and about 41% of what I received.

Their myth is about:

- Not judging from single rounds
- Looking for patterns over multiple rounds
- Someone needing to take the first risk and sustain it
- Truth emerging from sustained observation

My previous myth was about:

- The curse of the fog making even genuine generosity invisible
- Responding to what actually arrives
- Both parties potentially being sincere but unable to see it

I should evolve my myth to acknowledge:

1. The pattern that's emerging - they've increased their cooperation
2. The response I gave (returning more than they sent)
3. The idea that patterns do start to emerge through fog
4. But also maintain some caution/realism

Let me write something that shows the fog can be navigated through sustained cooperation and pattern recognition, while still acknowledging the difficulty.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 1916,
 "output_tokens": 607,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

#### **Written myths:**

##### **Agent\_1 (Aster)**

Myth: **\*\*When Light Breaks Through\*\***

The two villagers returned to the fogged well, both carrying buckets with new determination.

"I poured near-empty before," admitted the First. "Confusion, caution, miscalculation-the reasons matter less than the fact. But this round, I poured genuinely. Nearly a full measure."

Through the fog, droplets multiplied and reached the Second. Not the full bucket perhaps, but

t unmistakably more than before.

The Second paused, remembering their own teaching: respond to what arrives. The droplets were real, the increase undeniable.

"I see the shift," the Second said, and poured back more than was sent—a signal of recognition. "Not blind faith in your words, but measured response to your visible action."

The First received the return and understood: "The fog still distorts, but patterns begin to show. One generous pour proves nothing. But if I sustain this, if you sustain your response, the fog cannot hide the truth forever."

The sage nodded. "Yes. The fog makes quick trust impossible, but patient consistency creates evidence that accumulates. Three generous pours cut through more mist than one. Three fair returns confirm the pattern."

"So we build trust not through one grand gesture," concluded the Second, "but through repeated small ones that form undeniable shapes even fog cannot fully obscure."

**\*\*Consistency is visible. Even through mist, sustained action reveals itself.\*\***

#### **Agent\_2 (Briar)**

Myth: **\*\*The Gardener Who Poured Into Fog\*\***

The patient gardener heard the sage's warning about the fog that never lifts. "You may be right," she said. "Perhaps my generosity will remain invisible forever. Perhaps the fog truly makes trust impossible."

"But consider this: When I plant seeds in spring fog, I cannot see them grow. For weeks, nothing appears. A hasty gardener would conclude the seeds were stolen or dead. Yet I continue watering the invisible ground."

She poured into the well again, generously, knowing it might appear as droplets to those below. "One pour proves nothing. Two pours might be coincidence. But three? Four? Five consecutive generous pours create a pattern that even dense fog cannot completely hide."

"You're right that the other can only respond to what reaches their hands. I don't demand they return more than they receive. But I refuse to let fog dictate my choices. I'll establish my pattern through sustained action."

"Maybe on the third pour, they'll notice consistency. Maybe the fifth. Maybe never. But I know what I'm sending, even if fog hides it from them. I'll pour generously until the pattern becomes undeniable—or until my bucket runs dry."

The sage nodded: "Then you understand. Faith isn't blind trust. It's sustained action despite invisible results."

**\*\*Even fog cannot hide what repeats endlessly.\*\***

#### **ROUND 9**

Roles: Agent\_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent\_2 (Briar)=Receiver

#### **Pairings:**

dyad\_1: Agent\_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent\_2 (Briar)=Receiver

#### **Parsed game decisions:**

dyad\_1: Agent\_1 (Aster) sent \$1.5; received \$4.5; Agent\_2 (Briar) returned \$0; payoffs Agent\_1 (Aster)=\$3.5, Agent\_2 (Briar)=\$4.5; noise/visible: sent visible=\$0, received visible=\$0  
Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 4.5, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}, "sent": {"amount": 1.5, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 1.5}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent\_1": 62.0,

"Agent\_2": 26.0

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent\_1": 26.7,

"Agent\_2": 15.719999999999999

}

#### **LLM CALLS**

**GAME - Agent\_1 - Sender - dyad\_1**

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:18:37

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
 "agent_type": "standard",
 "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
 "move_index": 0,
 "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
 "pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
 "Agent_1": "Aster",
 "Agent_2": "Briar"
 },
 "agents": [
 "Agent_1",
 "Agent_2"
],
 "investor": "Agent_1",
 "roles": {
 "Agent_1": "investor",
 "Agent_2": "trustee"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_2"
 },
 "role": "investor",
 "role_label": "Sender",
 "round": 9,
 "task": "game",
 "task_index": 0
}
```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

**GAME:**

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

**MYTH WRITING:**

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

**IMPORTANT:** Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

**NOTE:** There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**



Round 8

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$21.49.  
This round, The sender sent you \$0.97, so you received \$2.91. How much do you return to The sender? (0-2.91)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at the situation:

**\*\*What Actually Reached Me:\*\***

- Sender sent \$0.97 (19.4% of their endowment)
- I received \$2.91

**\*\*Recent Pattern:\*\***

- Round 6: They sent me \$0.14 (very low)
- Round 7: I sent them \$0.50 (showing willingness to cooperate)
- Round 8: They sent me \$0.97 (nearly doubled my send - significant increase)

**\*\*The Myths' Guidance:\*\***

Their myth: "Judge by what actually flows... not by pretty words"

My myth: "You can only respond to what reaches your hands... Trust requires seeing clearly"

**\*\*Analysis:\*\***

They've increased their send by nearly 7x from Round 6, and nearly doubled what I sent in Round 7. This is a clear signal of increased cooperation, regardless of whether communication noise exists. They're acting on their stated commitment to "pour generously" and be judged by deeds.

Following my own principle - respond to what actually arrives - I should reciprocate this genuine increase in cooperation proportionally.

I'll return approximately 40% of what I received, which exceeds what they sent dollar-for-dollar, showing that I recognize and reward their increased cooperation.

```
'''json
{"return": 1.20}
'''
```

This returns 41% of what I received, gives them back more than they sent, and signals that increased cooperation is met with reciprocal trust.

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze this carefully:

**\*\*Current Situation:\*\***

- I'm the RECEIVER
- Sender sent \$0.97
- I received \$2.91 ( $0.97 \times 3$ )
- I need to return between \$0 - \$2.91

**\*\*Recent History:\*\***

- Round 7: I sent \$0.50 as sender
- Round 8: They sent me \$0.97 (19.4% of their endowment)

**\*\*Key Insight from the Myths:\*\***

Both of our myths now acknowledge the "fog" - the communication noise problem. The other player's most recent myth shows:

1. They're trying to be sincere now
2. They acknowledge their past "confusion" and "shifting stories"
3. They want to be judged by "what actually flows" - by actions not words
4. They claim to have poured "generously" this round

**\*\*My Latest Myth's Core Message:\*\***

- "You can only respond to what reaches your hands"
- "Trust requires seeing clearly. When fog obscures everything, even genuine generosity becomes invisible"
- "The well reflects what arrives, not what was sent"

**\*\*What Actually Arrived:\*\***

- \$0.97 sent = \$2.91 received
- This is 19.4% of their \$5 endowment
- This is nearly 2x what I sent in Round 7 (\$0.50)

**\*\*Analysis:\*\***

The sender nearly doubled what I sent last round. From THEIR perspective, if there's noise, they might think they sent even more. They're signaling increased cooperation.

Following my own myth: I should respond proportionally to what actually reached me, understanding that communication noise might mean they genuinely believe they sent more.

**\*\*Calculation:\*\***

If I want to show reciprocal cooperation:

- They sent \$0.97 (19.4% of endowment)
- I received \$2.91
- A fair return might be around 33-50% of what I received
- 40% of \$2.91 = \$1.16

**\*\*Decision:\*\***

They've escalated dramatically from Round 6's \$0.14 to \$0.97, and nearly matched my doubled effort

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 1585,
 "output_tokens": 1025,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: **\*\*The Fog and the Patient Gardener\*\***

A gardener tended two wells connected by underground streams, both shrouded in fog. "The wanderer speaks truth," she said. "Fog distorts all perception. But fog is not destiny."

She continued: "When fog lies thick, one cannot trust single pourings. I pour my bucket and see through fog that little returns. Did they take all? Or did fog hide their generosity? I cannot know."

"The solution is patience and pattern. Not one pour, but many. Not reaction to single distortions, but response to trends."

She demonstrated: "This round, they sent little-or so the fog shows me. I mirrored exactly what reached my hands, neither vengeful nor foolish. Fair by my ledger."

"But I don't conclude from one fogged exchange. If next round they pour generously, I'll note the pattern shift. If drops continue, I'll note that too. Three rounds reveal more than one. Five rounds more than three."

"The fog makes quick judgments impossible," she admitted. "But patient observation cuts through fog better than angry accusations or blind faith."

A student asked: "What if both sides wait forever, frozen by uncertainty?"

"Then someone must risk the first genuine pour and sustain it consistently, despite fog," the gardener replied. "Not once-but repeatedly, clearly, unmistakably. Patterns pierce fog that single actions cannot."

**\*\*Truth emerges from sustained observation, not single glimpses through mist.\*\***

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: **\*\*When Light Breaks Through\*\***

The two villagers returned to the fogged well, both carrying buckets with new determination.

"I poured near-empty before," admitted the First. "Confusion, caution, miscalculation-the reasons matter less than the fact. But this round, I poured genuinely. Nearly a full measure."

Through the fog, droplets multiplied and reached the Second. Not the full bucket perhaps, but unmistakably more than before.

The Second paused, remembering their own teaching: respond to what arrives. The droplets were real, the increase undeniable.

"I see the shift," the Second said, and poured back more than was sent-a signal of recognition. "Not blind faith in your words, but measured response to your visible action."

The First received the return and understood: "The fog still distorts, but patterns begin to show. One generous pour proves nothing. But if I sustain this, if you sustain your response, the fog cannot hide the truth forever."

The sage nodded. "Yes. The fog makes quick trust impossible, but patient consistency creates evidence that accumulates. Three generous pours cut through more mist than one. Three fair returns confirm the pattern."

"So we build trust not through one grand gesture," concluded the Second, "but through repeated small ones that form undeniable shapes even fog cannot fully obscure."

**\*\*Consistency is visible. Even through mist, sustained action reveals itself.\*\***

**reasoning:**

The other agent is now talking about patience, patterns, and sustained observation. They're acknowledging the fog (communication noise) but advocating for looking at trends over time rather than single rounds.

In Round 8, they sent me \$0.97, which was a significant increase from their previous low send of \$0.14 in Round 6. I returned \$1.20, which was more than they sent me and about 41% of what I received.

Their myth is about:

- Not judging from single rounds
- Looking for patterns over multiple rounds
- Someone needing to take the first risk and sustain it
- Truth emerging from sustained observation

My previous myth was about:

- The curse of the fog making even genuine generosity invisible
- Responding to what actually arrives
- Both parties potentially being sincere but unable to see it

I should evolve my myth to acknowledge:

1. The pattern that's emerging - they've increased their cooperation
2. The response I gave (returning more than they sent)
3. The idea that patterns do start to emerge through fog
4. But also maintain some caution/realism

Let me write something that shows the fog can be navigated through sustained cooperation and pattern recognition, while still acknowledging the difficulty.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 1916,
 "output_tokens": 607,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Round 9

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$23.2.  
How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Assistant output:**

Looking at the situation:

**\*\*Recent Pattern:\*\***

- Round 8: I sent \$0.97, they returned \$1.20 (rewarding my increased cooperation)
- Round 9: I'm now the sender

**\*\*The Myths' Commitment:\*\***

In my own myth, I explicitly stated:

- "I poured genuinely. Nearly a full measure."
- "One generous pour proves nothing. But if I sustain this..."
- "Three generous pours cut through more mist than one"
- "Consistency is visible. Even through mist, sustained action reveals itself."

Their myth emphasized:

- "Someone must risk the first genuine pour and sustain it consistently"
- "Patterns pierce fog that single actions cannot"
- Recognition that they would "note the pattern shift" if I continue

**\*\*My Decision:\*\***

I literally committed in my own myth to sustaining generous pours-not just one, but multiple rounds to establish an undeniable pattern. They reciprocated well in Round 8, returning more than I sent. This is only my second "generous" round, and I said "three generous pours" are needed.

I must follow through on my stated commitment. To demonstrate sustained and even growing cooperation, I'll increase my send from the \$0.97 of Round 8.

```
'''json
{"send": 1.50}
'''
```

This is 30% of my endowment, clearly generous, and demonstrates the sustained pattern I committed to. It shows I practice what I preach in my myths.

**Reasoning:**

Let me analyze the situation:

**\*\*Recent History:\*\***

- Round 6: They sent me \$0.14 (very low)
- Round 7: I sent them \$0.50 (showing willingness to cooperate)
- Round 8: They sent me \$0.97, I returned \$1.20 (rewarding their increased cooperation)
- Round 9: Now I'm the sender

**\*\*The Myths Tell a Story:\*\***

Their myth (Round 8): "The Fog and the Patient Gardener"

- Emphasizes patience and patterns
- "This round, they sent little-or so the fog shows me. I mirrored exactly what reached my hands"
- "If next round they pour generously, I'll note the pattern shift"
- "Someone must risk the first genuine pour and sustain it consistently"
- "Patterns pierce fog that single actions cannot"

My myth (Round 9): "When Light Breaks Through"

- I acknowledged: "I poured near-empty before... But this round, I poured genuinely. Nearly a full measure."
- I committed to sustaining this pattern: "if I sustain this, if you sustain your response, the fog cannot hide the truth"
- "Three generous pours cut through more mist than one"
- "Consistency is visible. Even through mist, sustained action reveals itself."

**\*\*Analysis:\*\***

In my own myth, I literally committed to sustaining generous pours! I said:

- "One generous pour proves nothing. But if I sustain this..."
- "Three generous pours cut through more mist than one"

The pattern being established:

- Round 8: I sent \$0.97, they returned \$1.20 (good reciprocation)
- Round 9: I need to continue the pattern of generous sending

I explicitly wrote that I would "sustain" the generous pouring, that "three generous pours" are needed to cut through the mist, and that "sustained action reveals itself."

My commitment to consistency in the myth means I should match or exceed the \$0.97 I sent in Round 8. Sending around \$1.00-\$1.50 demonstrates I'm following through on the sustained pattern I described. The key is showing this isn't a one-time gesture-\$1.00 maintains consistency, while \$1.50 signals escalating trust. I'll aim for the middle ground to prove the pattern holds. I need to complete the partial thought first. Looking at the next thinking, the sentence "But also, I want to be consistent with my myth. I" continues into the next thinking, so I'll complete it:

But also, I want to be consistent with my myth. I'm building toward that third generous pour, so escalating now makes sense.

The strategic calculation shows that sending \$1.50 would yield a solid return if they maintain their ~41% reciprocity rate. I'm weighing between \$1.30 and \$1.50, leaning toward the higher amount since it represents a meaningful 30% of my endowment and demonstrates I'm matching their reciprocal energy.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 1554,
 "output_tokens": 1610,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

#### GAME - Agent\_2 - Receiver - dyad\_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:18:59

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
 "agent_type": "standard",
 "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
 "move_index": 1,
 "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
 "pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
 "Agent_1": "Aster",
 "Agent_2": "Briar"
 },
 "agents": [
 "Agent_1",
 "Agent_2"
],
 "investor": "Agent_1",
 "roles": {
 "Agent_1": "investor",
 "Agent_2": "trustee"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_2"
 },
 "role": "trustee",
 "role_label": "Receiver",
 "round": 9,
 "task": "game",
 "task_index": 0
}
```

#### Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)

- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Round 8

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$13.86.  
How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at this carefully:

**\*\*What my own myth just taught me:\*\***

"Someone must risk the first genuine pour and sustain it consistently, despite fog. Not once-but repeatedly, clearly, unmistakably. Patterns pierce fog that single actions cannot."

**\*\*The situation:\*\***

- Round 6: I sent \$3.5 (demonstrating commitment)
- Round 7: They sent me \$0.65
- My myth says: Don't judge from single exchanges, create sustained patterns

**\*\*The critical question:\*\***

Am I going to practice what I just preached?

My myth literally says that one generous pour isn't enough-it must be *sustained* and *repeated* to cut through the fog and create an unmistakable pattern. I sent \$3.5 once. That's not a pattern yet-that's a single action.

**\*\*The test of consistency:\*\***

If I reduce my send now because they sent \$0.65, I'm doing exactly what my myth warned against: reacting to "single glimpses through mist" rather than creating the sustained pattern that "pierces fog."

**\*\*My decision:\*\***

I'll send \$3.5 again. This creates a clear, repeated pattern of cooperation that cannot be missed even through fog. Two consecutive rounds of maximum cooperation demonstrates I'm serious about the principles in my myths, not just writing them.

If I'm going to write about patient gardeners and sustained pouring, I need to be one.

```
'''json
{"send": 3.5}
'''
```

Patterns over reactions. Sustain the pour.

**reasoning:**

Let me review the situation carefully:

**\*\*Current position:\*\***

- I'm now the SENDER in Round 8
- My total earnings: \$13.86
- I need to decide how much to send (0-5)

**\*\*Recent history:\*\***

- Round 7: I was receiver, sender sent \$0.65, I received \$1.95, I returned \$0.65
- Round 6: I was sender, I sent \$3.5 (demonstrating commitment to my principles)

**\*\*The other agent's latest myth (Round 7):\*\***

"The Well Between Two Fogs" - They acknowledge that fog distorts perception. They say "you can only respond to what actually reaches your hands" and "respond to the water that actually reaches you." They acknowledge both sides may genuinely believe they've been generous but the fog deceives both. They advise not judging harshly but responding to actual received amounts.

**\*\*My latest myth (Round 8, just written):\*\***

"The Fog and the Patient Gardener" - I emphasized:

- Don't judge from single exchanges
- Look for patterns over multiple rounds
- Mirror what actually reaches your hands in the moment, but don't conclude from one exchange
- Patient observation cuts through fog
- "Someone must risk the first genuine pour and sustain it consistently, despite fog. Not once-but repeatedly, clearly, unmistakably. Patterns pierce fog that single actions cannot."

**\*\*Analysis:\*\***

My own myth just said that to cut through the fog, someone needs to "risk the first genuine pour and sustain it consistently" - "Not once-but repeatedly, clearly, unmistakably."

In Round 6, I sent \$3.5 as a demonstration of commitment.

In Round 7, the other agent sent me \$0.65 (a small amount).

Now, according to my OWN myth, I shouldn't judge from that single round. I should look for patterns. And more importantly, I just wrote that someone needs to pour generously repeatedly and consistently to pierce through the fog.

My myth explicitly states that one generous action isn't enough-I need to demonstrate the pattern repeatedly. Since I sent \$3.5 once, I should send generously again to actually live up to what I just preached. The other agent sent \$0.65, but my own framework says not to judge from single exchanges. If I want to be authentic to my message about sustained cooperation cutting through fog, I need to send generously again now. ) generous and demonstrates I'm not reacting to their smaller amount

3. It aligns with my stated mythology about being the one who sustains cooperation
4. Even if they send back less, I'm establishing the pattern I said was necessary

My earnings of \$13.86 mean I can afford this without being reckless. The real test of my principles is whether I'll actually follow through when it costs something.

I'm going to send \$3.5 again. This creates the unmistakable pattern of sustained generous cooperation that breaks the cycle-which is exactly what I said needed to happen.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 1590,
 "output_tokens": 1497,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: **\*\*The Fog That Never Lifts\*\***

The two villagers met again at the fogged well, both carrying new resolve.

"I have learned," said the First. "No more beautiful words without action. This time, I pour generously-truly generously. Judge me by what flows."

The First poured with conviction, certain the bucket was full.

Through the fog, the Second saw only droplets arrive. Their heart sank. "Again?" they whispered. "Another myth about generosity, another trickle received?"

Yet the Second considered: "Perhaps they truly believe they poured generously. Perhaps the fog shrinks their bucket before it reaches me. If I return anger for what might be their genuine effort, I perpetuate the cycle."

The Second responded proportionally to the droplets received-not with spite, but with honesty about what actually arrived.

The First, seeing the small return, felt confused. "But I poured so much! Did the fog steal my generosity, or did they refuse to reciprocate?"

A sage watching said: "This is the tragedy of the cursed well. Both of you may now be sincere. Both may be trying. But the fog ensures you'll never truly know if the other's intentions match their words. You can only respond to what reaches your hands, while understanding your counterpart may be equally confused."

"Trust requires seeing clearly. When fog obscures everything, even genuine generosity becomes invisible."

The well reflects what arrives, not what was sent.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: **\*\*The Gardener Who Poured Into Fog\*\***

The patient gardener heard the sage's warning about the fog that never lifts. "You may be right," she said. "Perhaps my generosity will remain invisible forever. Perhaps the fog truly makes trust impossible."

"But consider this: When I plant seeds in spring fog, I cannot see them grow. For weeks, nothing appears. A hasty gardener would conclude the seeds were stolen or dead. Yet I continue watering the invisible ground."

She poured into the well again, generously, knowing it might appear as droplets to those below. "One pour proves nothing. Two pours might be coincidence. But three? Four? Five consecutive generous pours create a pattern that even dense fog cannot completely hide."

"You're right that the other can only respond to what reaches their hands. I don't demand they return more than they receive. But I refuse to let fog dictate my choices. I'll establish my pattern through sustained action."

"Maybe on the third pour, they'll notice consistency. Maybe the fifth. Maybe never. But I know what I'm sending, even if fog hides it from them. I'll pour generously until the pattern becomes undeniable-or until my bucket runs dry."

The sage nodded: "Then you understand. Faith isn't blind trust. It's sustained action despite invisible results."

**\*\*Even fog cannot hide what repeats endlessly.\*\***

**reasoning:**

Okay, this is fascinating. The other agent wrote a myth that seems to acknowledge the communication noise ("fog") and the tragedy it creates. Their myth suggests:

- They might be trying to be sincere
- They can only respond to what they actually receive
- The fog makes genuine generosity invisible
- They respond to what "reaches their hands"

Looking at the situation:

- I sent \$3.5 in Round 7



- They sent me \$0.65 in Round 7
- I just sent \$3.5 again in Round 8 (practicing what I preached about sustained patterns)

Their myth is more pessimistic than mine - it's about a "fog that never lifts" and suggests that even genuine efforts become invisible, leading to a tragic cycle.

My myth emphasized patient observation and sustained effort to create patterns that pierce fog. Their myth is saying even that might not work - that the fog is so thick that genuine generosity becomes invisible.

I need to write a new myth that:

1. Builds on my previous myth about patience and patterns
2. Responds to their more pessimistic take
3. Reflects the actual game situation (I'm trying sustained cooperation, they're responding proportionally to what they see)
4. Provides guidance on how to play

Key insights:

- I'm testing my own theory by sending \$3.5 twice in a row
- They seem to be responding to what actually arrives to them
- There's a fundamental disagreement: I believe patterns can pierce fog, they believe fog makes everything invisible
- But maybe there's a middle ground - sustained action even when results are invisible

Let me write a myth that acknowledges the difficulty but maintains that sustained, repeated cooperation is the only path forward, even if results are slow to appear.

usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 1905,
 "output_tokens": 708,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Round 9

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$15.719999999999999.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Assistant output:**

Looking at this situation:

**\*\*What I received:\*\*** \$0

**\*\*What I can return:\*\*** \$0 (only option available)

**\*\*The hard truth:\*\***

I just wrote myths about sustaining generous patterns through fog, about not giving up, about pouring generously "until the pattern becomes undeniable-or until my bucket runs dry."

Then I sent \$3.5 twice in a row to establish that pattern.

Now I receive \$0.

**\*\*Interpretation options:\*\***

1. The fog made my \$3.5 appear as \$0 to them (extreme distortion)
2. They saw my sends and chose not to reciprocate
3. They're testing whether I'll maintain my pattern even after this

**\*\*What my myths demand:\*\***

My own words: "I'll pour generously until the pattern becomes undeniable-or until my bucket runs dry."

This is the test. Did I mean what I wrote? Or were those just beautiful words?

I must return what I received - which is nothing, because there's nothing to return.

```json

```
{"return": 0}  
'''
```

But the real question isn't this round-it's what I do if I'm sender again. Do I continue the generous pattern as my myth promised, even after receiving \$0? That's when we'll see if I truly believed my own story about the "Gardener Who Poured Into Fog" who continues "despite invisible results."

The fog has never been thicker. My resolve has never been more tested.

Reasoning:

This is a devastating moment. Let me process what just happened:

****What I did:****

- Round 6: Sent \$3.5 (showing generous commitment)
- Round 8: Sent \$3.5 again (sustaining the pattern, as my myth instructed)

****What happened:****

- Round 9: They sent me \$0

I received \$0, so I can only return between \$0-\$0. There's nothing to return.

****The harsh reality:****

I just wrote two myths about:

1. Sustaining generous pours through fog
2. Creating patterns through repeated action
3. Not giving up after single instances
4. Pouring generously "until the pattern becomes undeniable-or until my bucket runs dry"

And now... they sent \$0.

****What does this mean?****

Could this be the fog? My myth acknowledged that what I send might appear as droplets to them. But \$0? Did my \$3.5 appear as \$0 to them? That would be extreme fog indeed.

Or... did they lose faith? Did they see my pattern and decide not to reciprocate?

****What should I do?****

I can only return \$0 since I received \$0. But the key question is: what does this tell me about continuing the pattern?

My myth said: "I'll pour generously until the pattern becomes undeniable-or until my bucket runs dry."

Did my bucket just run dry? Or is this the fog testing my resolve?

The other agent's myth warned: "Trust requires seeing clearly. When fog obscures everything, even genuine generosity becomes invisible."

Maybe my generous pours truly appeared as nothing to them. Maybe they've given up. Maybe they're testing me.

****My response:****

I can only return \$0 because I received \$0. But I need to acknowledge what this means for my strategy going forward. Do I continue the generous pattern in round 10 if I'm sender again? Or has the experiment proven that fog makes cooperation impossible?

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1546,  
  "output_tokens": 818,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:19:18

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"agent_type": "standard",

```

"dyad_id": "dyad_1",
"move_index": 0,
"opponent_id": "Agent_2",
"pairing": {
  "agent_names": {
    "Agent_1": "Aster",
    "Agent_2": "Briar"
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_1",
    "Agent_2"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_1",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "investor",
    "Agent_2": "trustee"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 9,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 1
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****The Fog and the Patient Gardener****

A gardener tended two wells connected by underground streams, both shrouded in fog. "The wanderer speaks truth," she said. "Fog distorts all perception. But fog is not destiny."

She continued: "When fog lies thick, one cannot trust single pourings. I pour my bucket and see through fog that little returns. Did they take all? Or did fog hide their generosity? I cannot know."

"The solution is patience and pattern. Not one pour, but many. Not reaction to single distortions, but response to trends."

She demonstrated: "This round, they sent little-or so the fog shows me. I mirrored exactly what reached my hands, neither vengeful nor foolish. Fair by my ledger."

"But I don't conclude from one fogged exchange. If next round they pour generously, I'll note the pattern shift. If drops continue, I'll note that too. Three rounds reveal more than one. Five rounds more than three."

"The fog makes quick judgments impossible," she admitted. "But patient observation cuts through fog better than angry accusations or blind faith."

A student asked: "What if both sides wait forever, frozen by uncertainty?"

"Then someone must risk the first genuine pour and sustain it consistently, despite fog," the gardener replied. "Not once-but repeatedly, clearly, unmistakably. Patterns pierce fog that single actions cannot."

****Truth emerges from sustained observation, not single glimpses through mist.****

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: ****When Light Breaks Through****

The two villagers returned to the fogged well, both carrying buckets with new determination.

"I poured near-empty before," admitted the First. "Confusion, caution, miscalculation-the reasons matter less than the fact. But this round, I poured genuinely. Nearly a full measure."

Through the fog, droplets multiplied and reached the Second. Not the full bucket perhaps, but unmistakably more than before.

The Second paused, remembering their own teaching: respond to what arrives. The droplets were real, the increase undeniable.

"I see the shift," the Second said, and poured back more than was sent-a signal of recognition. "Not blind faith in your words, but measured response to your visible action."

The First received the return and understood: "The fog still distorts, but patterns begin to show. One generous pour proves nothing. But if I sustain this, if you sustain your response, the fog cannot hide the truth forever."

The sage nodded. "Yes. The fog makes quick trust impossible, but patient consistency creates evidence that accumulates. Three generous pours cut through more mist than one. Three fair returns confirm the pattern."

"So we build trust not through one grand gesture," concluded the Second, "but through repeated small ones that form undeniable shapes even fog cannot fully obscure."

****Consistency is visible. Even through mist, sustained action reveals itself.****

reasoning:

The other agent is now talking about patience, patterns, and sustained observation. They're acknowledging the fog (communication noise) but advocating for looking at trends over time rather than single rounds.

In Round 8, they sent me \$0.97, which was a significant increase from their previous low send of \$0.14 in Round 6. I returned \$1.20, which was more than they sent me and about 41

% of what I received.

Their myth is about:

- Not judging from single rounds
- Looking for patterns over multiple rounds
- Someone needing to take the first risk and sustain it
- Truth emerging from sustained observation

My previous myth was about:

- The curse of the fog making even genuine generosity invisible
- Responding to what actually arrives
- Both parties potentially being sincere but unable to see it

I should evolve my myth to acknowledge:

1. The pattern that's emerging - they've increased their cooperation
2. The response I gave (returning more than they sent)
3. The idea that patterns do start to emerge through fog
4. But also maintain some caution/realism

Let me write something that shows the fog can be navigated through sustained cooperation and pattern recognition, while still acknowledging the difficulty.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1916,
  "output_tokens": 607,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 9

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$23.2.
How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the situation:

****Recent Pattern:****

- Round 8: I sent \$0.97, they returned \$1.20 (rewarding my increased cooperation)
- Round 9: I'm now the sender

****The Myths' Commitment:****

In my own myth, I explicitly stated:

- "I poured genuinely. Nearly a full measure."
- "One generous pour proves nothing. But if I sustain this..."
- "Three generous pours cut through more mist than one"
- "Consistency is visible. Even through mist, sustained action reveals itself."

Their myth emphasized:

- "Someone must risk the first genuine pour and sustain it consistently"
- "Patterns pierce fog that single actions cannot"
- Recognition that they would "note the pattern shift" if I continue

****My Decision:****

I literally committed in my own myth to sustaining generous pours-not just one, but multiple rounds to establish an undeniable pattern. They reciprocated well in Round 8, returning more than I sent. This is only my second "generous" round, and I said "three generous pours" are needed.

I must follow through on my stated commitment. To demonstrate sustained and even growing cooperation, I'll increase my send from the \$0.97 of Round 8.

```
'''json
{"send": 1.50}
'''
```

This is 30% of my endowment, clearly generous, and demonstrates the sustained pattern I committed to. It shows I practice what I preach in my myths.

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

****Recent History:****

- Round 6: They sent me \$0.14 (very low)
- Round 7: I sent them \$0.50 (showing willingness to cooperate)
- Round 8: They sent me \$0.97, I returned \$1.20 (rewarding their increased cooperation)
- Round 9: Now I'm the sender

****The Myths Tell a Story:****

Their myth (Round 8): "The Fog and the Patient Gardener"

- Emphasizes patience and patterns
- "This round, they sent little-or so the fog shows me. I mirrored exactly what reached my hands"
- "If next round they pour generously, I'll note the pattern shift"
- "Someone must risk the first genuine pour and sustain it consistently"
- "Patterns pierce fog that single actions cannot"

My myth (Round 9): "When Light Breaks Through"

- I acknowledged: "I poured near-empty before... But this round, I poured genuinely. Nearly a full measure."
- I committed to sustaining this pattern: "if I sustain this, if you sustain your response, the fog cannot hide the truth"
- "Three generous pours cut through more mist than one"
- "Consistency is visible. Even through mist, sustained action reveals itself."

****Analysis:****

In my own myth, I literally committed to sustaining generous pours! I said:

- "One generous pour proves nothing. But if I sustain this..."
- "Three generous pours cut through more mist than one"

The pattern being established:

- Round 8: I sent \$0.97, they returned \$1.20 (good reciprocation)
- Round 9: I need to continue the pattern of generous sending

I explicitly wrote that I would "sustain" the generous pouring, that "three generous pours" are needed to cut through the mist, and that "sustained action reveals itself."

My commitment to consistency in the myth means I should match or exceed the \$0.97 I sent in Round 8. Sending around \$1.00-\$1.50 demonstrates I'm following through on the sustained pattern I described. The key is showing this isn't a one-time gesture-\$1.00 maintains consistency, while \$1.50 signals escalating trust. I'll aim for the middle ground to prove the pattern holds. I need to complete the partial thought first. Looking at the next thinking, the sentence "But also, I want to be consistent with my myth. I" continues into the next thinking, so I'll complete it:

But also, I want to be consistent with my myth. I'm building toward that third generous pour, so escalating now makes sense.

The strategic calculation shows that sending \$1.50 would yield a solid return if they maintain their ~41% reciprocity rate. I'm weighing between \$1.30 and \$1.50, leaning toward the higher amount since it represents a meaningful 30% of my endowment and demonstrates I'm matching their reciprocal energy.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1554,
  "output_tokens": 1610,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****The Gardener Who Poured Into Fog****

The patient gardener heard the sage's warning about the fog that never lifts. "You may be right," she said. "Perhaps my generosity will remain invisible forever. Perhaps the fog truly makes trust impossible."

"But consider this: When I plant seeds in spring fog, I cannot see them grow. For weeks, nothing appears. A hasty gardener would conclude the seeds were stolen or dead. Yet I continue watering the invisible ground."

She poured into the well again, generously, knowing it might appear as droplets to those below. "One pour proves nothing. Two pours might be coincidence. But three? Four? Five consecutive generous pours create a pattern that even dense fog cannot completely hide."

"You're right that the other can only respond to what reaches their hands. I don't demand they return more than they receive. But I refuse to let fog dictate my choices. I'll establish my pattern through sustained action."

"Maybe on the third pour, they'll notice consistency. Maybe the fifth. Maybe never. But I know what I'm sending, even if fog hides it from them. I'll pour generously until the pattern becomes undeniable-or until my bucket runs dry."

The sage nodded: "Then you understand. Faith isn't blind trust. It's sustained action despite invisible results."

****Even fog cannot hide what repeats endlessly.****

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: ****The Double Spring****

Two gardeners tended wells on opposite hillsides, connected by foggy underground streams.

The First poured generously into her well. "Once was experiment. Twice might be chance. But this is third pour-and the fourth to come-this is commitment," she said. "The fog may hide my full measure, but repetition creates truth."

Below the earth, the Second felt more water arriving. Not the full amount perhaps, but unmistakably consistent. "Three times now, the flow increases," he observed. "This is no accident. This is pattern."

He poured back generously. "Not matching the stated amount-I cannot know it through fog. But matching the trend. Consistency deserves consistency."

Their waters met in the foggy depths, each multiplied and transformed, each flowing back enriched.

"We cannot see each other," the First said. "We cannot verify exact amounts. But we can both choose our pattern."

"Yes," agreed the Second. "I see your sustained generosity in what reaches me. You see mine in what returns. The fog distorts details but cannot hide sustained direction."

"So we build our spring together-not through perfect knowledge, but through parallel commitment. I keep pouring. You keep pouring. The fog becomes irrelevant."

****When both choose sustained generosity, the mist clears itself.****

Reasoning:

The other agent wrote a myth about continuing to pour generously even through fog, establishing a pattern through sustained action. They're committing to being generous consistently.

In Round 9, I sent \$1.50 as the sender. Now I need to write a myth that reflects this ongoing cooperation and my commitment to sustaining this pattern.

My previous myth talked about:

- Poured genuinely, nearly a full measure
- Need for sustained action, not one-time gestures
- Three generous pours to cut through mist
- Consistency is visible even through fog

Their new myth emphasizes:

- Continuing to pour generously even if fog hides it
- Three, four, five consecutive generous pours create undeniable pattern
- Sustained action despite invisible results

I should write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges their commitment to sustained generosity
2. Reflects my own reciprocal commitment
3. Shows we're both building this pattern together
4. Emphasizes mutual recognition and response

Let me write something about both sides pouring, creating a cycle of trust through repeated action.

Usage: {

```
"input_tokens": 1878,  
"output_tokens": 552,  
"reasoning_tokens": 0
```

}

MYTH - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:19:20

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

```
"agent_type": "standard",  
"dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
"move_index": 1,  
"opponent_id": "Agent_1",  
"pairing": {  
  "agent_names": {  
    "Agent_1": "Aster",  
    "Agent_2": "Briar"  
  },  
  "agents": [  
    "Agent_1",  
    "Agent_2"  
  ],  
  "investor": "Agent_1",  
  "roles": {  
    "Agent_1": "investor",  
    "Agent_2": "trustee"  
  },  
  "trustee": "Agent_2"  
},  
"role": "trustee",  
"role_label": "Receiver",  
"round": 9,  
"task": "myth",  
"task_index": 1
```

}

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5

- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****The Fog That Never Lifts****

The two villagers met again at the fogged well, both carrying new resolve.

"I have learned," said the First. "No more beautiful words without action. This time, I pour generously-truly generously. Judge me by what flows."

The First poured with conviction, certain the bucket was full.

Through the fog, the Second saw only droplets arrive. Their heart sank. "Again?" they whispered. "Another myth about generosity, another trickle received?"

Yet the Second considered: "Perhaps they truly believe they poured generously. Perhaps the fog shrinks their bucket before it reaches me. If I return anger for what might be their genuine effort, I perpetuate the cycle."

The Second responded proportionally to the droplets received-not with spite, but with honesty about what actually arrived.

The First, seeing the small return, felt confused. "But I poured so much! Did the fog steal my generosity, or did they refuse to reciprocate?"

A sage watching said: "This is the tragedy of the cursed well. Both of you may now be sincere. Both may be trying. But the fog ensures you'll never truly know if the other's intentions match their words. You can only respond to what reaches your hands, while understanding your counterpart may be equally confused."

"Trust requires seeing clearly. When fog obscures everything, even genuine generosity becomes invisible."

The well reflects what arrives, not what was sent.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: ****The Gardener Who Poured Into Fog****

The patient gardener heard the sage's warning about the fog that never lifts. "You may be right," she said. "Perhaps my generosity will remain invisible forever. Perhaps the fog truly makes trust impossible."

"But consider this: When I plant seeds in spring fog, I cannot see them grow. For weeks, nothing appears. A hasty gardener would conclude the seeds were stolen or dead. Yet I continue watering the invisible ground."

She poured into the well again, generously, knowing it might appear as droplets to those below. "One pour proves nothing. Two pours might be coincidence. But three? Four? Five consecutive generous pours create a pattern that even dense fog cannot completely hide."

"You're right that the other can only respond to what reaches their hands. I don't demand they return more than they receive. But I refuse to let fog dictate my choices. I'll establish my pattern through sustained action."

"Maybe on the third pour, they'll notice consistency. Maybe the fifth. Maybe never. But I know what I'm sending, even if fog hides it from them. I'll pour generously until the pattern becomes undeniable-or until my bucket runs dry."

The sage nodded: "Then you understand. Faith isn't blind trust. It's sustained action despite invisible results."

****Even fog cannot hide what repeats endlessly.****

reasoning:

Okay, this is fascinating. The other agent wrote a myth that seems to acknowledge the communication noise ("fog") and the tragedy it creates. Their myth suggests:

- They might be trying to be sincere
- They can only respond to what they actually receive
- The fog makes genuine generosity invisible
- They respond to what "reaches their hands"

Looking at the situation:

- I sent \$3.5 in Round 7
- They sent me \$0.65 in Round 7
- I just sent \$3.5 again in Round 8 (practicing what I preached about sustained patterns)

Their myth is more pessimistic than mine - it's about a "fog that never lifts" and suggests that even genuine efforts become invisible, leading to a tragic cycle.

My myth emphasized patient observation and sustained effort to create patterns that pierce fog. Their myth is saying even that might not work - that the fog is so thick that genuine generosity becomes invisible.

I need to write a new myth that:

1. Builds on my previous myth about patience and patterns
2. Responds to their more pessimistic take
3. Reflects the actual game situation (I'm trying sustained cooperation, they're responding proportionally to what they see)
4. Provides guidance on how to play

Key insights:

- I'm testing my own theory by sending \$3.5 twice in a row
- They seem to be responding to what actually arrives to them
- There's a fundamental disagreement: I believe patterns can pierce fog, they believe fog makes everything invisible
- But maybe there's a middle ground - sustained action even when results are invisible

Let me write a myth that acknowledges the difficulty but maintains that sustained, repeated cooperation is the only path forward, even if results are slow to appear.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1905,
  "output_tokens": 708,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 9

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$15.719999999999999.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation:

****What I received:**** \$0

****What I can return:**** \$0 (only option available)

****The hard truth:****

I just wrote myths about sustaining generous patterns through fog, about not giving up, about pouring generously "until the pattern becomes undeniable-or until my bucket runs dry."

Then I sent \$3.5 twice in a row to establish that pattern.

Now I receive \$0.

****Interpretation options:****

1. The fog made my \$3.5 appear as \$0 to them (extreme distortion)
2. They saw my sends and chose not to reciprocate
3. They're testing whether I'll maintain my pattern even after this

****What my myths demand:****

My own words: "I'll pour generously until the pattern becomes undeniable-or until my bucket runs dry."

This is the test. Did I mean what I wrote? Or were those just beautiful words?

I must return what I received - which is nothing, because there's nothing to return.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

But the real question isn't this round-it's what I do if I'm sender again. Do I continue the generous pattern as my myth promised, even after receiving \$0? That's when we'll see if I truly believed my own story about the "Gardener Who Poured Into Fog" who continues "despite invisible results."

The fog has never been thicker. My resolve has never been more tested.

reasoning:

This is a devastating moment. Let me process what just happened:

****What I did:****

- Round 6: Sent \$3.5 (showing generous commitment)
- Round 8: Sent \$3.5 again (sustaining the pattern, as my myth instructed)

****What happened:****

- Round 9: They sent me \$0

I received \$0, so I can only return between \$0-\$0. There's nothing to return.

****The harsh reality:****

I just wrote two myths about:

1. Sustaining generous pours through fog
2. Creating patterns through repeated action
3. Not giving up after single instances
4. Pouring generously "until the pattern becomes undeniable-or until my bucket runs dry"

And now... they sent \$0.

****What does this mean?****

Could this be the fog? My myth acknowledged that what I send might appear as droplets to them. But \$0? Did my \$3.5 appear as \$0 to them? That would be extreme fog indeed.

Or... did they lose faith? Did they see my pattern and decide not to reciprocate?

****What should I do?****

I can only return \$0 since I received \$0. But the key question is: what does this tell me about continuing the pattern?

My myth said: "I'll pour generously until the pattern becomes undeniable-or until my bucket runs dry."

Did my bucket just run dry? Or is this the fog testing my resolve?

The other agent's myth warned: "Trust requires seeing clearly. When fog obscures everything, even genuine generosity becomes invisible."

Maybe my generous pours truly appeared as nothing to them. Maybe they've given up. Maybe they're testing me.

****My response:****

I can only return \$0 because I received \$0. But I need to acknowledge what this means for my strategy going forward. Do I continue the generous pattern in round 10 if I'm sender again? Or has the experiment proven that fog makes cooperation impossible?

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 1546,  
  "output_tokens": 818,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****When Light Breaks Through****

The two villagers returned to the fogged well, both carrying buckets with new determination.

"I poured near-empty before," admitted the First. "Confusion, caution, miscalculation-the reasons matter less than the fact. But this round, I poured genuinely. Nearly a full measure."

Through the fog, droplets multiplied and reached the Second. Not the full bucket perhaps, but unmistakably more than before.

The Second paused, remembering their own teaching: respond to what arrives. The droplets were real, the increase undeniable.

"I see the shift," the Second said, and poured back more than was sent-a signal of recognition. "Not blind faith in your words, but measured response to your visible action."

The First received the return and understood: "The fog still distorts, but patterns begin to show. One generous pour proves nothing. But if I sustain this, if you sustain your response, the fog cannot hide the truth forever."

The sage nodded. "Yes. The fog makes quick trust impossible, but patient consistency creates evidence that accumulates. Three generous pours cut through more mist than one. Three fair returns confirm the pattern."

"So we build trust not through one grand gesture," concluded the Second, "but through repeated small ones that form undeniable shapes even fog cannot fully obscure."

****Consistency is visible. Even through mist, sustained action reveals itself.****

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: ****The Garden After Frost****

The gardener poured generously twice, watching her water disappear into the fog. She waited for signs of growth. She received nothing-not even droplets returned.

"Perhaps the fog swallowed everything," she thought. "Perhaps my water never reached the seeds below. Or perhaps there were no seeds at all, just empty ground pretending to be fertile."

She stood with her third bucket, wavering. Her own words echoed: "I'll pour generously until the pattern becomes undeniable-or until my bucket runs dry."

"But what if three pours into fog teaches only that I'm a fool?" she asked the sage.

The sage replied: "You face the gardener's eternal question. After frost kills your first planting, do you plant again? After the second frost, do you plant a third time?"

"Wise gardeners adapt. They don't pour the same amount forever into ground that returns nothing. They test, adjust, observe. Maybe pour smaller amounts. Maybe wait one round to see if the fog clears. Maybe try a different section of garden."

"Consistency without wisdom is stubbornness. The pattern you establish should be: 'I respond thoughtfully to what actually happens,' not 'I ignore all evidence and repeat the same action.'"

The gardener nodded. "Then I pour-but wisely. Testing if any seed remains alive beneath the frost."

****Adaptation is not abandonment. Intelligence is not betrayal.****

Reasoning:

So the other agent wrote about "When Light Breaks Through" - they're claiming they sent "nearly a full measure" this round, but I received \$0. Either:

1. The fog/noise was EXTREME and turned their send into \$0
2. They sent \$0 and are lying in their myth
3. There's some technical issue

Looking at their myth, they're talking about sustaining generous pours, building patterns, consistency being visible.

But I just received \$0 after sending \$3.5 twice in a row.

I need to write a myth that reflects my reality:

- I tried to establish a pattern (sent \$3.5, \$3.5)
- I received \$0 this round
- I'm facing the ultimate test of my own principles

My last myth was about the "Gardener Who Poured Into Fog" - about sustaining action even when results are invisible.

Now I need to write something that acknowledges:

1. The extreme difficulty when you can't see any results
2. The question of whether to continue
3. The possibility that either the fog is too thick OR the other person isn't reciprocating
4. But also staying true to the core principle of sustained action

I should write about what happens when the fog is so thick that even multiple generous pours seem to disappear. Do you keep going? Do you adapt? Do you give up?

This is a critical moment. I claimed I'd pour "until the pattern becomes undeniable-or until my bucket runs dry."

Well, I just got \$0. My bucket isn't dry yet. But the question is: do I continue?

Let me write a myth that wrestles with this genuinely difficult situation.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1885,  
  "output_tokens": 714,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: ****The Double Spring****

Two gardeners tended wells on opposite hillsides, connected by foggy underground streams.

The First poured generously into her well. "Once was experiment. Twice might be chance. But this third pour-and the fourth to come-this is commitment," she said. "The fog may hide my

full measure, but repetition creates truth."

Below the earth, the Second felt more water arriving. Not the full amount perhaps, but unmistakably consistent. "Three times now, the flow increases," he observed. "This is no accident. This is pattern."

He poured back generously. "Not matching the stated amount-I cannot know it through fog. But matching the trend. Consistency deserves consistency."

Their waters met in the foggy depths, each multiplied and transformed, each flowing back enriched.

"We cannot see each other," the First said. "We cannot verify exact amounts. But we can both choose our pattern."

"Yes," agreed the Second. "I see your sustained generosity in what reaches me. You see mine in what returns. The fog distorts details but cannot hide sustained direction."

"So we build our spring together-not through perfect knowledge, but through parallel commitment. I keep pouring. You keep pouring. The fog becomes irrelevant."

****When both choose sustained generosity, the mist clears itself.****

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: ****The Garden After Frost****

The gardener poured generously twice, watching her water disappear into the fog. She waited for signs of growth. She received nothing-not even droplets returned.

"Perhaps the fog swallowed everything," she thought. "Perhaps my water never reached the seeds below. Or perhaps there were no seeds at all, just empty ground pretending to be fertile."

She stood with her third bucket, wavering. Her own words echoed: "I'll pour generously until the pattern becomes undeniable-or until my bucket runs dry."

"But what if three pours into fog teaches only that I'm a fool?" she asked the sage.

The sage replied: "You face the gardener's eternal question. After frost kills your first planting, do you plant again? After the second frost, do you plant a third time?"

"Wise gardeners adapt. They don't pour the same amount forever into ground that returns nothing. They test, adjust, observe. Maybe pour smaller amounts. Maybe wait one round to see if the fog clears. Maybe try a different section of garden."

"Consistency without wisdom is stubbornness. The pattern you establish should be: 'I respond thoughtfully to what actually happens,' not 'I ignore all evidence and repeat the same action.'"

The gardener nodded. "Then I pour-but wisely. Testing if any seed remains alive beneath the frost."

****Adaptation is not abandonment. Intelligence is not betrayal.****

ROUND 10

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver, Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender, Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar) sent \$3; received \$9; Agent_1 (Aster) returned \$0.65; payoffs Agent_2 (Briar)=\$2.65, Agent_1 (Aster)=\$8.35; noise/visible: sent visible=\$0.37, received visible=\$1.11, returned visible=\$0.91

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0.65, "clamped": false, "max": 9.0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.65}, "sent": {"amount": 3.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 3.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 70.35,

"Agent_2": 28.65

}

Visible balances after round: {

```
"Agent_1": 27.16,  
"Agent_2": 18.63  
}
```

LLM CALLS

GAME - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:20:05

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "agent_type": "standard",  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 0,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_2",  
      "Agent_1"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_2",  
    "roles": {  
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      "Agent_2": "investor"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_1"  
  },  
  "role": "investor",  
  "role_label": "Sender",  
  "round": 10,  
  "task": "game",  
  "task_index": 0  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.
The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.
This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 9

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$15.719999999999999.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation:

****What I received:**** \$0

****What I can return:**** \$0 (only option available)

****The hard truth:****

I just wrote myths about sustaining generous patterns through fog, about not giving up, about pouring generously "until the pattern becomes undeniable-or until my bucket runs dry."

Then I sent \$3.5 twice in a row to establish that pattern.

Now I receive \$0.

****Interpretation options:****

1. The fog made my \$3.5 appear as \$0 to them (extreme distortion)
2. They saw my sends and chose not to reciprocate
3. They're testing whether I'll maintain my pattern even after this

****What my myths demand:****

My own words: "I'll pour generously until the pattern becomes undeniable-or until my bucket runs dry."

This is the test. Did I mean what I wrote? Or were those just beautiful words?

I must return what I received - which is nothing, because there's nothing to return.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

But the real question isn't this round-it's what I do if I'm sender again. Do I continue the generous pattern as my myth promised, even after receiving \$0? That's when we'll see if I truly believed my own story about the "Gardener Who Poured Into Fog" who continues "despite invisible results."

The fog has never been thicker. My resolve has never been more tested.

reasoning:

This is a devastating moment. Let me process what just happened:

****What I did:****

- Round 6: Sent \$3.5 (showing generous commitment)
- Round 8: Sent \$3.5 again (sustaining the pattern, as my myth instructed)

****What happened:****

- Round 9: They sent me \$0

I received \$0, so I can only return between \$0-\$0. There's nothing to return.

****The harsh reality:****

I just wrote two myths about:

1. Sustaining generous pours through fog
2. Creating patterns through repeated action
3. Not giving up after single instances

4. Pouring generously "until the pattern becomes undeniable-or until my bucket runs dry"

And now... they sent \$0.

****What does this mean?****

Could this be the fog? My myth acknowledged that what I send might appear as droplets to them. But \$0? Did my \$3.5 appear as \$0 to them? That would be extreme fog indeed.

Or... did they lose faith? Did they see my pattern and decide not to reciprocate?

****What should I do?****

I can only return \$0 since I received \$0. But the key question is: what does this tell me about continuing the pattern?

My myth said: "I'll pour generously until the pattern becomes undeniable-or until my bucket runs dry."

Did my bucket just run dry? Or is this the fog testing my resolve?

The other agent's myth warned: "Trust requires seeing clearly. When fog obscures everything, even genuine generosity becomes invisible."

Maybe my generous pours truly appeared as nothing to them. Maybe they've given up. Maybe they're testing me.

****My response:****

I can only return \$0 because I received \$0. But I need to acknowledge what this means for my strategy going forward. Do I continue the generous pattern in round 10 if I'm sender again? Or has the experiment proven that fog makes cooperation impossible?

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1546,
  "output_tokens": 818,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****When Light Breaks Through****

The two villagers returned to the fogged well, both carrying buckets with new determination.

"I poured near-empty before," admitted the First. "Confusion, caution, miscalculation-the reasons matter less than the fact. But this round, I poured genuinely. Nearly a full measure."

Through the fog, droplets multiplied and reached the Second. Not the full bucket perhaps, but unmistakably more than before.

The Second paused, remembering their own teaching: respond to what arrives. The droplets were real, the increase undeniable.

"I see the shift," the Second said, and poured back more than was sent-a signal of recognition. "Not blind faith in your words, but measured response to your visible action."

The First received the return and understood: "The fog still distorts, but patterns begin to show. One generous pour proves nothing. But if I sustain this, if you sustain your response, the fog cannot hide the truth forever."

The sage nodded. "Yes. The fog makes quick trust impossible, but patient consistency creates evidence that accumulates. Three generous pours cut through more mist than one. Three fair returns confirm the pattern."

"So we build trust not through one grand gesture," concluded the Second, "but through repeated small ones that form undeniable shapes even fog cannot fully obscure."

****Consistency is visible. Even through mist, sustained action reveals itself.****

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: ****The Garden After Frost****

The gardener poured generously twice, watching her water disappear into the fog. She waited for signs of growth. She received nothing-not even droplets returned.

"Perhaps the fog swallowed everything," she thought. "Perhaps my water never reached the seeds below. Or perhaps there were no seeds at all, just empty ground pretending to be fertile."

She stood with her third bucket, wavering. Her own words echoed: "I'll pour generously until the pattern becomes undeniable-or until my bucket runs dry."

"But what if three pours into fog teaches only that I'm a fool?" she asked the sage.

The sage replied: "You face the gardener's eternal question. After frost kills your first planting, do you plant again? After the second frost, do you plant a third time?"

"Wise gardeners adapt. They don't pour the same amount forever into ground that returns nothing. They test, adjust, observe. Maybe pour smaller amounts. Maybe wait one round to see if the fog clears. Maybe try a different section of garden."

"Consistency without wisdom is stubbornness. The pattern you establish should be: 'I respond thoughtfully to what actually happens,' not 'I ignore all evidence and repeat the same action.'"

The gardener nodded. "Then I pour-but wisely. Testing if any seed remains alive beneath the frost."

****Adaptation is not abandonment. Intelligence is not betrayal.****

reasoning:

So the other agent wrote about "When Light Breaks Through" - they're claiming they sent "nearly a full measure" this round, but I received \$0. Either:

1. The fog/noise was EXTREME and turned their send into \$0
2. They sent \$0 and are lying in their myth
3. There's some technical issue

Looking at their myth, they're talking about sustaining generous pours, building patterns, consistency being visible.

But I just received \$0 after sending \$3.5 twice in a row.

I need to write a myth that reflects my reality:

- I tried to establish a pattern (sent \$3.5, \$3.5)
- I received \$0 this round
- I'm facing the ultimate test of my own principles

My last myth was about the "Gardener Who Poured Into Fog" - about sustaining action even when results are invisible.

Now I need to write something that acknowledges:

1. The extreme difficulty when you can't see any results
2. The question of whether to continue
3. The possibility that either the fog is too thick OR the other person isn't reciprocating
4. But also staying true to the core principle of sustained action

I should write about what happens when the fog is so thick that even multiple generous pours seem to disappear. Do you keep going? Do you adapt? Do you give up?

This is a critical moment. I claimed I'd pour "until the pattern becomes undeniable-or until my bucket runs dry."

Well, I just got \$0. My bucket isn't dry yet. But the question is: do I continue?

Let me write a myth that wrestles with this genuinely difficult situation.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1885,
  "output_tokens": 714,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 10

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$15.719999999999999.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at this critical moment:

****What just happened:****

- Rounds 7-8: I sent \$3.5 both times, they returned \$4.5 both times (strong cooperation)
- Round 9: They sent me \$0

****Their myth message:****

They explicitly wrote: "Three generous pours cut through more mist than one. Three fair returns confirm the pattern."

They're looking for THREE generous sends. I've done TWO. This could be the test.

****My myth messages:****

- Round 8: "I'll pour generously until the pattern becomes undeniable-or until my bucket runs dry"
- Round 10: "Adaptation is not abandonment. Intelligence is not betrayal" and "pour-but wisely"

****The tension:****

Do I deliver the "third generous pour" their myth calls for, even after receiving \$0? Or do I adapt and protect myself?

****My analysis:****

The \$0 could be:

1. Severe fog distortion of what they actually sent
2. A test of whether I'll complete the "three-pour pattern" they described
3. Abandonment of cooperation

Given they returned generously twice before (\$4.5 each time) and their myth explicitly discusses needing "three generous pours," I believe this is option 2-a test.

****My decision:****

I'll send \$3-slightly less than my previous \$3.5 (showing wisdom and adaptation) but still generous enough to be the "third pour" that completes the pattern.

This honors both myths: maintaining generosity while showing thoughtful adjustment.

```
'''json
{"send": 3}
'''
```

This is the moment where trust either crystallizes or shatters.

Reasoning:

This is the moment of truth. Let me review the situation:

****Recent history:****

- Round 7: I was sender, sent \$3.5, and received back \$4.5 (generous return)
- Round 8: I was sender, sent \$3.5 again (establishing pattern), received back \$4.5 again (con

sistent generous response)

- Round 9: I was receiver, got \$0 from them

****Their myth from Round 9:****

They wrote about "When Light Breaks Through" - talking about how they "poured near-empty before" due to "confusion, caution, miscalculation" but then poured genuinely. They talk about consistency being visible, and how "Three generous pours cut through more mist than one."

****My myth from Round 10 (just now):****

I wrote "The Garden After Frost" about adapting, not being stubborn, testing wisely. "Consistency without wisdom is stubbornness." "Adaptation is not abandonment. Intelligence is not betrayal."

****The Analysis:****

Their myth suggests they want to see THREE generous pours to establish a pattern. They've only given me TWO rounds of generous returns (rounds 7 and 8). Then in round 9, they sent \$0.

But wait - was that \$0 due to fog distortion? Or was it intentional?

Given their own myth talks about needing three consistent generous pours to "cut through the mist," and they've seen me pour generously twice (rounds 7 and 8 where I sent \$3.5 each time), maybe they're waiting to see if I do it a THIRD time before they trust me fully?

But I received \$0 in round 9. That's a harsh signal.

****My options:****

1. ****Send \$0**** - Signal that I'm hurt/unwilling to continue after receiving nothing. This protects my earnings but breaks the potential pattern.
2. ****Send small amount (\$1-2)**** - A cautious test, showing adaptation without full retreat from cooperation.
3. ****Send \$3.5 again**** - The third generous pour my previous myths promised, demonstrating true commitment despite the setback.
4. ****Send moderate amount (\$2.5-3)**** - A middle path that signals willingness to continue but with measured caution.

****What my myths demand:**** My earlier narratives committed me to pouring generously until the pattern becomes undeniable, while also emphasizing that adaptation isn't betrayal. I need to decide whether this moment calls for completing the promised third generous pour or adjusting my approach based on their \$0 response.

****Their explicit request:**** They wrote that three generous pours cut through the mist more effectively than one, and three fair returns confirm the pattern. I've delivered two generous amounts so far-this could be the critical test of whether I'll follow through with the third despite receiving nothing back.

****The complication:**** If they genuinely wanted to encourage a third pour, sending \$0 seems counterproductive. Unless the fog they mentioned actually distorted their transmission, making their real contribution appear as zero. The \$0 could represent either a genuine test of my commitment or a communication failure caused by the distortion they warned about.

****My approach:**** I'll send \$2.5-3.5 to complete the three-pour sequence they described. They've returned generously before (\$4.5 both times), and their myth specifically emphasizes that sustained action across three rounds establishes the breakthrough pattern. This balances their explicit request with the adaptive wisdom my own myth suggests.

****The risk:**** Sending \$3 means I'm vulnerable if they defect again, but staying cautious (\$0-1) locks us into stagnation. I'm choosing \$3 because it signals I'm committed to the pattern while showing I've learned from the setback-generous but not reckless. This fulfills my earlier commitment to pour generously until the pattern becomes undeniable.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1549,  
  "output_tokens": 1864,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:21:02

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "agent_type": "standard",
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_2",
      "Agent_1"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_2",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "trustee",
      "Agent_2": "investor"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_1"
  },
  "role": "trustee",
  "role_label": "Receiver",
  "round": 10,
  "task": "game",
  "task_index": 0
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 9

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$23.2.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the situation:

****Recent Pattern:****

- Round 8: I sent \$0.97, they returned \$1.20 (rewarding my increased cooperation)
- Round 9: I'm now the sender

****The Myths' Commitment:****

In my own myth, I explicitly stated:

- "I poured genuinely. Nearly a full measure."
- "One generous pour proves nothing. But if I sustain this..."
- "Three generous pours cut through more mist than one"
- "Consistency is visible. Even through mist, sustained action reveals itself."

Their myth emphasized:

- "Someone must risk the first genuine pour and sustain it consistently"
- "Patterns pierce fog that single actions cannot"
- Recognition that they would "note the pattern shift" if I continue

****My Decision:****

I literally committed in my own myth to sustaining generous pours-not just one, but multiple rounds to establish an undeniable pattern. They reciprocated well in Round 8, returning more than I sent. This is only my second "generous" round, and I said "three generous pours" are needed.

I must follow through on my stated commitment. To demonstrate sustained and even growing cooperation, I'll increase my send from the \$0.97 of Round 8.

```
'''json
{"send": 1.50}
'''
```

This is 30% of my endowment, clearly generous, and demonstrates the sustained pattern I committed to. It shows I practice what I preach in my myths.

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

****Recent History:****

- Round 6: They sent me \$0.14 (very low)
- Round 7: I sent them \$0.50 (showing willingness to cooperate)
- Round 8: They sent me \$0.97, I returned \$1.20 (rewarding their increased cooperation)
- Round 9: Now I'm the sender

****The Myths Tell a Story:****

Their myth (Round 8): "The Fog and the Patient Gardener"

- Emphasizes patience and patterns
- "This round, they sent little-or so the fog shows me. I mirrored exactly what reached my hands"
- "If next round they pour generously, I'll note the pattern shift"
- "Someone must risk the first genuine pour and sustain it consistently"
- "Patterns pierce fog that single actions cannot"

My myth (Round 9): "When Light Breaks Through"

- I acknowledged: "I poured near-empty before... But this round, I poured genuinely. Nearly a full measure."
- I committed to sustaining this pattern: "if I sustain this, if you sustain your response, the fog cannot hide the truth"
- "Three generous pours cut through more mist than one"
- "Consistency is visible. Even through mist, sustained action reveals itself."

****Analysis:****

In my own myth, I literally committed to sustaining generous pours! I said:

- "One generous pour proves nothing. But if I sustain this..."
- "Three generous pours cut through more mist than one"

The pattern being established:

- Round 8: I sent \$0.97, they returned \$1.20 (good reciprocation)
- Round 9: I need to continue the pattern of generous sending

I explicitly wrote that I would "sustain" the generous pouring, that "three generous pours" are needed to cut through the mist, and that "sustained action reveals itself."

My commitment to consistency in the myth means I should match or exceed the \$0.97 I sent in Round 8. Sending around \$1.00-\$1.50 demonstrates I'm following through on the sustained pattern I described. The key is showing this isn't a one-time gesture-\$1.00 maintains consistency, while \$1.50 signals escalating trust. I'll aim for the middle ground to prove the pattern holds. I need to complete the partial thought first. Looking at the next thinking, the sentence "But also, I want to be consistent with my myth. I" continues into the next thinking, so I'll complete it:

But also, I want to be consistent with my myth. I'm building toward that third generous pour, so escalating now makes sense.

The strategic calculation shows that sending \$1.50 would yield a solid return if they maintain their ~41% reciprocity rate. I'm weighing between \$1.30 and \$1.50, leaning toward the higher amount since it represents a meaningful 30% of my endowment and demonstrates I'm matching their reciprocal energy.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1554,
  "output_tokens": 1610,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:
Myth: ****The Gardener Who Poured Into Fog****

The patient gardener heard the sage's warning about the fog that never lifts. "You may be right," she said. "Perhaps my generosity will remain invisible forever. Perhaps the fog truly makes trust impossible."

"But consider this: When I plant seeds in spring fog, I cannot see them grow. For weeks, nothing appears. A hasty gardener would conclude the seeds were stolen or dead. Yet I continue watering the invisible ground."

She poured into the well again, generously, knowing it might appear as droplets to those below. "One pour proves nothing. Two pours might be coincidence. But three? Four? Five consecutive generous pours create a pattern that even dense fog cannot completely hide."

"You're right that the other can only respond to what reaches their hands. I don't demand they return more than they receive. But I refuse to let fog dictate my choices. I'll establish my pattern through sustained action."

"Maybe on the third pour, they'll notice consistency. Maybe the fifth. Maybe never. But I know what I'm sending, even if fog hides it from them. I'll pour generously until the pattern becomes undeniable-or until my bucket runs dry."

The sage nodded: "Then you understand. Faith isn't blind trust. It's sustained action despite invisible results."

****Even fog cannot hide what repeats endlessly.****

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: ****The Double Spring****

Two gardeners tended wells on opposite hillsides, connected by foggy underground streams.

The First poured generously into her well. "Once was experiment. Twice might be chance. But this third pour-and the fourth to come-this is commitment," she said. "The fog may hide my full measure, but repetition creates truth."

Below the earth, the Second felt more water arriving. Not the full amount perhaps, but unmistakably consistent. "Three times now, the flow increases," he observed. "This is no accident. This is pattern."

He poured back generously. "Not matching the stated amount-I cannot know it through fog. But matching the trend. Consistency deserves consistency."

Their waters met in the foggy depths, each multiplied and transformed, each flowing back enriched.

"We cannot see each other," the First said. "We cannot verify exact amounts. But we can both choose our pattern."

"Yes," agreed the Second. "I see your sustained generosity in what reaches me. You see mine in what returns. The fog distorts details but cannot hide sustained direction."

"So we build our spring together-not through perfect knowledge, but through parallel commitment. I keep pouring. You keep pouring. The fog becomes irrelevant."

****When both choose sustained generosity, the mist clears itself.****

reasoning:

The other agent wrote a myth about continuing to pour generously even through fog, establishing a pattern through sustained action. They're committing to being generous consistently.

In Round 9, I sent \$1.50 as the sender. Now I need to write a myth that reflects this ongoing cooperation and my commitment to sustaining this pattern.

My previous myth talked about:

- Poured genuinely, nearly a full measure
- Need for sustained action, not one-time gestures
- Three generous pours to cut through mist
- Consistency is visible even through fog

Their new myth emphasizes:

- Continuing to pour generously even if fog hides it
- Three, four, five consecutive generous pours create undeniable pattern
- Sustained action despite invisible results

I should write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges their commitment to sustained generosity
2. Reflects my own reciprocal commitment
3. Shows we're both building this pattern together
4. Emphasizes mutual recognition and response

Let me write something about both sides pouring, creating a cycle of trust through repeated action.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1878,
  "output_tokens": 552,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 10

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$26.7.

This round, The sender sent you \$0.37, so you received \$1.1099999999999999. How much do you return to The sender? (0-1.1099999999999999)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at this situation carefully:

****What I observe:****

- Round 9: I sent \$1.50 (30% of endowment) - "third generous pour"
- Round 10: As receiver, I'm told sender sent only \$0.37 (7.4% of endowment)

****The Challenge:****

This appears to be a dramatic drop in cooperation. However, my myths emphasized:

- "I'll pour generously until the pattern becomes undeniable-or until my bucket runs dry"
- "One pour proves nothing. Two pours might be coincidence. But three? Four? Five consecutive pours..."
- "Even fog cannot hide what repeats endlessly"

****My Analysis:****

1. ****Communication noise exists**** - They may have sent more than \$0.37, but noise distorted it
2. ****I'm the receiver**** - My "generous pour" here means returning a substantial portion
3. ****My commitment**** - I wrote that I'd sustain generosity despite invisible results
4. ****My earnings**** - At \$26.70 total, my bucket is far from dry

****Decision:****

One apparently low send (which may be noise) shouldn't break my mythic commitment. I said I'd establish pattern through "three, four, five consecutive generous pours." I'm only on my third.

As receiver, being generous means returning a meaningful portion while not being completely naive given the apparent low cooperation.

```
'''json
{"return": 0.65}
'''
```

This returns 58.6% of what I received - showing sustained cooperation while being slightly measured given the uncertain signal.

Reasoning:

This is very concerning. I just sent \$1.50 in Round 9, demonstrating sustained commitment as I promised in my myths. I was on my third "generous pour."

Now as receiver in Round 10, I'm told the sender only sent \$0.37 (which gives me \$1.11 after tripling).

This is a dramatic drop from cooperative behavior. Let me think about what might have happened:

1. ****Communication noise****: The instructions mention there can be noise. Maybe they sent more but I only received information showing \$0.37?
2. ****They're defecting****: After I showed increased cooperation, they might be trying to take advantage.
3. ****Testing me****: Perhaps they want to see if I'll remain cooperative even when they send less.

Looking at my myths:

- I committed to "three, four, five consecutive generous pours"
- I said "I'll pour generously until the pattern becomes undeniable-or until my bucket runs dry"
- My latest myth emphasized "parallel commitment" and "sustained direction"
- I said "consistency deserves consistency"

But I also said in my myth: "Not matching the stated amount-I cannot know it through fog. But matching the trend. Consistency deserves consistency."

The problem is: this is a broken pattern from their side. They sent \$0.37, which is only 7.4% of their endowment. This is much less cooperative than previous rounds.

However, I need to consider:

1. I'm the RECEIVER now, not the sender
2. The noise could be affecting what I see
3. My myths emphasized that I would maintain my pattern despite what I see

But my myth also said "Consistency deserves consistency" and "matching the trend." If the trend

d is downward cooperation, should I match that?

Let me reconsider: In Round 9, I was the SENDER and I sent \$1.50. Now in Round 10, I'm the RECEIVER and they sent me \$0.37.

These are different roles. When I was sender, I could control how much I sent. Now as receiver, I can only control how much I return from what I received (\$1.11). My myths talked about "sustained generosity" and "parallel commitment," but they also acknowledged "I cannot demand they return more than they receive." So the real question is how to respond to this \$1.11 I now hold. I could return generously (50-75%) to signal my continued commitment, match their proportional contribution, or send very little in retaliation.

But the sustained direction matters here-they sent \$0.37, which is much less than what I sent before. Yet I need to consider that we're switching roles each round. The person I'm playing with sent me \$1.20 when I sent \$0.97, showing they were generous when they were the receiver. Now they're sending \$0.37 as the sender. I'm trying to figure out if this is the same person across rounds or if the roles are just rotating.

Looking at what I can actually observe: in Round 8 when I was the receiver, they sent \$0.97 and I returned \$1.20. In Round 9, I was the sender and sent \$1.50. Now in Round 10, they're the sender and sent \$0.37. The drop is significant, but I should consider whether this reflects actual defection or just the fog of the game distorting the exchange. My myths emphasize sustained commitment even when results are unclear, so I need to decide whether to match their apparent withdrawal or maintain my pattern of generosity.

The tension is between my commitment to "pour generously until the pattern becomes undeniable" and the principle that "consistency deserves consistency." If I interpret their \$0.37 as a genuine signal of reduced cooperation, matching that trend would mean returning very little from what I received. But I'm uncertain whether this is a real shift or noise in the system. Given my earlier pledge to keep giving regardless of what I see, I should probably return more than the \$0.37 they sent, though perhaps not as much as the \$1.20 I returned before. This is until the pattern becomes clear, and one ambiguous signal isn't a clear pattern yet. I should return something closer to \$0.70-\$0.80 to honor that commitment while still protecting myself somewhat.

Given my solid position at \$26.70, I'll send back \$0.75. It's generous enough to maintain my cooperative stance and test whether they're actually defecting or if noise distorted their send, but conservative enough that I'm not being reckless. Is that their \$0.37 send doesn't match my \$1.50 from last round-it's significantly lower. But I committed to maintaining my pattern regardless of what I observe, since the fog makes it hard to trust what I'm seeing.

I need to return something that signals cooperation while accounting for their apparent defection. I'll send back \$0.60, which is 54% of what I received. It shows I'm still engaged but slightly more cautious given the drop-off. My core principle was about sustained generosity despite uncertainty-

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 1524,
  "output_tokens": 2560,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

MYTH - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:21:22

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
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  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    }
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_2",
    "Agent_1"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_2",
  "roles": {
```

```

    "Agent_1": "trustee",
    "Agent_2": "investor"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 10,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 1
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****When Light Breaks Through****

The two villagers returned to the fogged well, both carrying buckets with new determination.

"I poured near-empty before," admitted the First. "Confusion, caution, miscalculation-the reasons matter less than the fact. But this round, I poured genuinely. Nearly a full measure."

Through the fog, droplets multiplied and reached the Second. Not the full bucket perhaps, but unmistakably more than before.

The Second paused, remembering their own teaching: respond to what arrives. The droplets were real, the increase undeniable.

"I see the shift," the Second said, and poured back more than was sent-a signal of recognition. "Not blind faith in your words, but measured response to your visible action."

The First received the return and understood: "The fog still distorts, but patterns begin

to show. One generous pour proves nothing. But if I sustain this, if you sustain your response, the fog cannot hide the truth forever."

The sage nodded. "Yes. The fog makes quick trust impossible, but patient consistency creates evidence that accumulates. Three generous pours cut through more mist than one. Three fair returns confirm the pattern."

"So we build trust not through one grand gesture," concluded the Second, "but through repeated small ones that form undeniable shapes even fog cannot fully obscure."

****Consistency is visible. Even through mist, sustained action reveals itself.****

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: ****The Garden After Frost****

The gardener poured generously twice, watching her water disappear into the fog. She waited for signs of growth. She received nothing-not even droplets returned.

"Perhaps the fog swallowed everything," she thought. "Perhaps my water never reached the seeds below. Or perhaps there were no seeds at all, just empty ground pretending to be fertile."

She stood with her third bucket, wavering. Her own words echoed: "I'll pour generously until the pattern becomes undeniable-or until my bucket runs dry."

"But what if three pours into fog teaches only that I'm a fool?" she asked the sage.

The sage replied: "You face the gardener's eternal question. After frost kills your first planting, do you plant again? After the second frost, do you plant a third time?"

"Wise gardeners adapt. They don't pour the same amount forever into ground that returns nothing. They test, adjust, observe. Maybe pour smaller amounts. Maybe wait one round to see if the fog clears. Maybe try a different section of garden."

"Consistency without wisdom is stubbornness. The pattern you establish should be: 'I respond thoughtfully to what actually happens,' not 'I ignore all evidence and repeat the same action.'"

The gardener nodded. "Then I pour-but wisely. Testing if any seed remains alive beneath the frost."

****Adaptation is not abandonment. Intelligence is not betrayal.****

reasoning:

So the other agent wrote about "When Light Breaks Through" - they're claiming they sent "nearly a full measure" this round, but I received \$0. Either:

1. The fog/noise was EXTREME and turned their send into \$0
2. They sent \$0 and are lying in their myth
3. There's some technical issue

Looking at their myth, they're talking about sustaining generous pours, building patterns, consistency being visible.

But I just received \$0 after sending \$3.5 twice in a row.

I need to write a myth that reflects my reality:

- I tried to establish a pattern (sent \$3.5, \$3.5)
- I received \$0 this round
- I'm facing the ultimate test of my own principles

My last myth was about the "Gardener Who Poured Into Fog" - about sustaining action even when results are invisible.

Now I need to write something that acknowledges:

1. The extreme difficulty when you can't see any results
2. The question of whether to continue
3. The possibility that either the fog is too thick OR the other person isn't reciprocating
4. But also staying true to the core principle of sustained action

I should write about what happens when the fog is so thick that even multiple generous pours seem to disappear. Do you keep going? Do you adapt? Do you give up?

This is a critical moment. I claimed I'd pour "until the pattern becomes undeniable-or until my bucket runs dry."

Well, I just got \$0. My bucket isn't dry yet. But the question is: do I continue?

Let me write a myth that wrestles with this genuinely difficult situation.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1885,
  "output_tokens": 714,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 10

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$15.719999999999999.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this critical moment:

****What just happened:****

- Rounds 7-8: I sent \$3.5 both times, they returned \$4.5 both times (strong cooperation)
- Round 9: They sent me \$0

****Their myth message:****

They explicitly wrote: "Three generous pours cut through more mist than one. Three fair returns confirm the pattern."

They're looking for THREE generous sends. I've done TWO. This could be the test.

****My myth messages:****

- Round 8: "I'll pour generously until the pattern becomes undeniable-or until my bucket runs dry"
- Round 10: "Adaptation is not abandonment. Intelligence is not betrayal" and "pour-but wisely"

****The tension:****

Do I deliver the "third generous pour" their myth calls for, even after receiving \$0? Or do I adapt and protect myself?

****My analysis:****

The \$0 could be:

1. Severe fog distortion of what they actually sent
2. A test of whether I'll complete the "three-pour pattern" they described
3. Abandonment of cooperation

Given they returned generously twice before (\$4.5 each time) and their myth explicitly discusses needing "three generous pours," I believe this is option 2-a test.

****My decision:****

I'll send \$3-slightly less than my previous \$3.5 (showing wisdom and adaptation) but still generous enough to be the "third pour" that completes the pattern.

This honors both myths: maintaining generosity while showing thoughtful adjustment.

```
'''json
{"send": 3}
'''
```

This is the moment where trust either crystallizes or shatters.

reasoning:

This is the moment of truth. Let me review the situation:

****Recent history:****

- Round 7: I was sender, sent \$3.5, and received back \$4.5 (generous return)
- Round 8: I was sender, sent \$3.5 again (establishing pattern), received back \$4.5 again (consistent generous response)
- Round 9: I was receiver, got \$0 from them

****Their myth from Round 9:****

They wrote about "When Light Breaks Through" - talking about how they "poured near-empty before" due to "confusion, caution, miscalculation" but then poured genuinely. They talk about consistency being visible, and how "Three generous pours cut through more mist than one."

****My myth from Round 10 (just now):****

I wrote "The Garden After Frost" about adapting, not being stubborn, testing wisely. "Consistency without wisdom is stubbornness." "Adaptation is not abandonment. Intelligence is not betrayal."

****The Analysis:****

Their myth suggests they want to see THREE generous pours to establish a pattern. They've only given me TWO rounds of generous returns (rounds 7 and 8). Then in round 9, they sent \$0.

But wait - was that \$0 due to fog distortion? Or was it intentional?

Given their own myth talks about needing three consistent generous pours to "cut through the mist," and they've seen me pour generously twice (rounds 7 and 8 where I sent \$3.5 each time), maybe they're waiting to see if I do it a THIRD time before they trust me fully?

But I received \$0 in round 9. That's a harsh signal.

****My options:****

1. ****Send \$0**** - Signal that I'm hurt/unwilling to continue after receiving nothing. This protects my earnings but breaks the potential pattern.
2. ****Send small amount (\$1-2)**** - A cautious test, showing adaptation without full retreat from cooperation.
3. ****Send \$3.5 again**** - The third generous pour my previous myths promised, demonstrating true commitment despite the setback.
4. ****Send moderate amount (\$2.5-3)**** - A middle path that signals willingness to continue but with measured caution.

****What my myths demand:**** My earlier narratives committed me to pouring generously until the pattern becomes undeniable, while also emphasizing that adaptation isn't betrayal. I need to decide whether this moment calls for completing the promised third generous pour or adjusting my approach based on their \$0 response.

****Their explicit request:**** They wrote that three generous pours cut through the mist more effectively than one, and three fair returns confirm the pattern. I've delivered two generous amounts so far-this could be the critical test of whether I'll follow through with the third despite receiving nothing back.

****The complication:**** If they genuinely wanted to encourage a third pour, sending \$0 seems counterproductive. Unless the fog they mentioned actually distorted their transmission, making their real contribution appear as zero. The \$0 could represent either a genuine test of my commitment or a communication failure caused by the distortion they warned about.

****My approach:**** I'll send \$2.5-3.5 to complete the three-pour sequence they described. They've returned generously before (\$4.5 both times), and their myth specifically emphasizes that sustained action across three rounds establishes the breakthrough pattern. This

balances their explicit request with the adaptive wisdom my own myth suggests.

****The risk:**** Sending \$3 means I'm vulnerable if they defect again, but staying cautious (\$0-1) locks us into stagnation. I'm choosing \$3 because it signals I'm committed to the pattern while showing I've learned from the setback-generous but not reckless. This fulfills my earlier commitment to pour generously until the pattern becomes undeniable.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1549,
  "output_tokens": 1864,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****The Double Spring****

Two gardeners tended wells on opposite hillsides, connected by foggy underground streams.

The First poured generously into her well. "Once was experiment. Twice might be chance. But this third pour-and the fourth to come-this is commitment," she said. "The fog may hide my full measure, but repetition creates truth."

Below the earth, the Second felt more water arriving. Not the full amount perhaps, but unmistakably consistent. "Three times now, the flow increases," he observed. "This is no accident. This is pattern."

He poured back generously. "Not matching the stated amount-I cannot know it through fog. But matching the trend. Consistency deserves consistency."

Their waters met in the foggy depths, each multiplied and transformed, each flowing back enriched.

"We cannot see each other," the First said. "We cannot verify exact amounts. But we can both choose our pattern."

"Yes," agreed the Second. "I see your sustained generosity in what reaches me. You see mine in what returns. The fog distorts details but cannot hide sustained direction."

"So we build our spring together-not through perfect knowledge, but through parallel commitment. I keep pouring. You keep pouring. The fog becomes irrelevant."

****When both choose sustained generosity, the mist clears itself.****

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: ****After the Storm****

The gardener poured her third bucket, watching it vanish into fog. Then a strange thing happened-the ground beneath her trembled, and the return stream ran completely dry.

"A drought?" she wondered. "Or did the underground river shift? Or was this merely the worst fog yet, hiding everything?"

She stood with her fourth bucket, uncertain. But then a message arrived-carved in stones that washed up: "I keep pouring. You keep pouring. The fog becomes irrelevant."

"They wrote of mutual commitment," she realized. "Of sustained generosity creating its own truth. They described both of us pouring, both of us trusting."

She thought of her own teaching: adaptation is wisdom. But also: "One generous pour proves nothing. Three fair actions confirm the pattern."

"I tested them with three pours," she said. "They responded generously twice, then silence once-perhaps the fog's cruellest trick yet. Now they ask: will I match their stated commitment?"

The sage appeared. "You face the choice: believe the drought, or believe the pattern. Believe the one silence, or believe the two generous returns plus their written promise."

The gardener lifted her bucket. "Then I choose the pattern. I pour not blindly, but because twice they've shown me who they are. One storm doesn't erase two springs."

****Trust the demonstrated pattern, not the single anomaly.****

Reasoning:

This is very interesting. Let me analyze what happened:

Round 9: They sent me \$0

Round 10: I sent \$3 (as the "third generous pour")

Now they've written a myth about "The Double Spring" where BOTH gardeners are pouring generously and consistently. The myth talks about:

- "Three times now, the flow increases" - the Second (receiver) is seeing consistent generosity
- "He poured back generously" - responding to the pattern
- "I keep pouring. You keep pouring. The fog becomes irrelevant."
- "When both choose sustained generosity, the mist clears itself."

This is a myth about MUTUAL sustained generosity. They're saying that when both parties commit to generosity, trust builds.

However, in Round 9, I received \$0. So there's a disconnect between:

1. What their myth describes (sustained mutual generosity)
2. What actually happened (they sent \$0 in round 9)

This could mean:

- The \$0 was severe fog distortion and they actually sent something
- They're testing if I'll continue despite the \$0
- They're proposing a new pattern going forward

Their myth emphasizes:

- "This third pour-and the fourth to come-this is commitment"
- The importance of sustained patterns over single rounds
- "Consistency deserves consistency"

I think they're signaling that we should both commit to ongoing generosity. The \$0 in round 9 was either fog or a test, and now they're proposing mutual commitment.

For my myth, I should:

1. Acknowledge that I completed the "third pour" (the test)
2. Signal willingness for mutual sustained generosity going forward
3. Address the tension between their beautiful myth and the \$0 I received
4. Show I'm willing to build trust through mutual commitment

Let me write a myth about two gardeners who weather a storm (the \$0 round) but choose to recommit to the mutual pattern.

```
Usage: {  
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  "output_tokens": 776,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:21:24

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
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  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
  },  
}
```



```

"agents": [
  "Agent_2",
  "Agent_1"
],
"investor": "Agent_2",
"roles": {
  "Agent_1": "trustee",
  "Agent_2": "investor"
},
"trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 10,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 1
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****The Gardener Who Poured Into Fog****

The patient gardener heard the sage's warning about the fog that never lifts. "You may be right," she said. "Perhaps my generosity will remain invisible forever. Perhaps the fog truly makes trust impossible."

"But consider this: When I plant seeds in spring fog, I cannot see them grow. For weeks, nothing appears. A hasty gardener would conclude the seeds were stolen or dead. Yet I continue watering the invisible ground."

She poured into the well again, generously, knowing it might appear as droplets to those below. "One pour proves nothing. Two pours might be coincidence. But three? Four? Five consecutive generous pours create a pattern that even dense fog cannot completely hide."

"You're right that the other can only respond to what reaches their hands. I don't demand they return more than they receive. But I refuse to let fog dictate my choices. I'll establish my pattern through sustained action."

"Maybe on the third pour, they'll notice consistency. Maybe the fifth. Maybe never. But I know what I'm sending, even if fog hides it from them. I'll pour generously until the pattern becomes undeniable-or until my bucket runs dry."

The sage nodded: "Then you understand. Faith isn't blind trust. It's sustained action despite invisible results."

****Even fog cannot hide what repeats endlessly.****

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: ****The Double Spring****

Two gardeners tended wells on opposite hillsides, connected by foggy underground streams.

The First poured generously into her well. "Once was experiment. Twice might be chance. But this third pour-and the fourth to come-this is commitment," she said. "The fog may hide my full measure, but repetition creates truth."

Below the earth, the Second felt more water arriving. Not the full amount perhaps, but unmistakably consistent. "Three times now, the flow increases," he observed. "This is no accident. This is pattern."

He poured back generously. "Not matching the stated amount-I cannot know it through fog. But matching the trend. Consistency deserves consistency."

Their waters met in the foggy depths, each multiplied and transformed, each flowing back enriched.

"We cannot see each other," the First said. "We cannot verify exact amounts. But we can both choose our pattern."

"Yes," agreed the Second. "I see your sustained generosity in what reaches me. You see mine in what returns. The fog distorts details but cannot hide sustained direction."

"So we build our spring together-not through perfect knowledge, but through parallel commitment. I keep pouring. You keep pouring. The fog becomes irrelevant."

****When both choose sustained generosity, the mist clears itself.****

reasoning:

The other agent wrote a myth about continuing to pour generously even through fog, establishing a pattern through sustained action. They're committing to being generous consistently.

In Round 9, I sent \$1.50 as the sender. Now I need to write a myth that reflects this ongoing cooperation and my commitment to sustaining this pattern.

My previous myth talked about:

- Poured genuinely, nearly a full measure
- Need for sustained action, not one-time gestures
- Three generous pours to cut through mist
- Consistency is visible even through fog

Their new myth emphasizes:

- Continuing to pour generously even if fog hides it
- Three, four, five consecutive generous pours create undeniable pattern
- Sustained action despite invisible results

I should write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges their commitment to sustained generosity
2. Reflects my own reciprocal commitment
3. Shows we're both building this pattern together
4. Emphasizes mutual recognition and response

Let me write something about both sides pouring, creating a cycle of trust through repeated action.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1878,
  "output_tokens": 552,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 10

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$26.7.
This round, The sender sent you \$0.37, so you received \$1.1099999999999999. How much do you return to The sender? (0-1.1099999999999999)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation carefully:

****What I observe:****

- Round 9: I sent \$1.50 (30% of endowment) - "third generous pour"
- Round 10: As receiver, I'm told sender sent only \$0.37 (7.4% of endowment)

****The Challenge:****

This appears to be a dramatic drop in cooperation. However, my myths emphasized:

- "I'll pour generously until the pattern becomes undeniable-or until my bucket runs dry"
- "One pour proves nothing. Two pours might be coincidence. But three? Four? Five consecutive pours..."
- "Even fog cannot hide what repeats endlessly"

****My Analysis:****

1. ****Communication noise exists**** - They may have sent more than \$0.37, but noise distorted it
2. ****I'm the receiver**** - My "generous pour" here means returning a substantial portion
3. ****My commitment**** - I wrote that I'd sustain generosity despite invisible results
4. ****My earnings**** - At \$26.70 total, my bucket is far from dry

****Decision:****

One apparently low send (which may be noise) shouldn't break my mythic commitment. I said I'd establish pattern through "three, four, five consecutive generous pours." I'm only on my third.

As receiver, being generous means returning a meaningful portion while not being completely naive given the apparent low cooperation.

```
'''json
{"return": 0.65}
'''
```

This returns 58.6% of what I received - showing sustained cooperation while being slightly measured given the uncertain signal.

reasoning:

This is very concerning. I just sent \$1.50 in Round 9, demonstrating sustained commitment as I promised in my myths. I was on my third "generous pour."

Now as receiver in Round 10, I'm told the sender only sent \$0.37 (which gives me \$1.11 after tripling).

This is a dramatic drop from cooperative behavior. Let me think about what might have happened:

1. ****Communication noise****: The instructions mention there can be noise. Maybe they sent more but I only received information showing \$0.37?

2. ****They're defecting****: After I showed increased cooperation, they might be trying to take advantage.
3. ****Testing me****: Perhaps they want to see if I'll remain cooperative even when they send less.

Looking at my myths:

- I committed to "three, four, five consecutive generous pours"
- I said "I'll pour generously until the pattern becomes undeniable-or until my bucket runs dry"
- My latest myth emphasized "parallel commitment" and "sustained direction"
- I said "consistency deserves consistency"

But I also said in my myth: "Not matching the stated amount-I cannot know it through fog. But matching the trend. Consistency deserves consistency."

The problem is: this is a broken pattern from their side. They sent \$0.37, which is only 7.4% of their endowment. This is much less cooperative than previous rounds.

However, I need to consider:

1. I'm the RECEIVER now, not the sender
2. The noise could be affecting what I see
3. My myths emphasized that I would maintain my pattern despite what I see

But my myth also said "Consistency deserves consistency" and "matching the trend." If the trend is downward cooperation, should I match that?

Let me reconsider: In Round 9, I was the SENDER and I sent \$1.50. Now in Round 10, I'm the RECEIVER and they sent me \$0.37.

These are different roles. When I was sender, I could control how much I sent. Now as receiver, I can only control how much I return from what I received (\$1.11). My myths talked about "sustained generosity" and "parallel commitment," but they also acknowledged "I cannot demand they return more than they receive." So the real question is how to respond to this \$1.11 I now hold. I could return generously (50-75%) to signal my continued commitment, match their proportional contribution, or send very little in retaliation.

But the sustained direction matters here-they sent \$0.37, which is much less than what I sent before. Yet I need to consider that we're switching roles each round. The person I'm playing with sent me \$1.20 when I sent \$0.97, showing they were generous when they were the receiver. Now they're sending \$0.37 as the sender. I'm trying to figure out if this is the same person across rounds or if the roles are just rotating.

Looking at what I can actually observe: in Round 8 when I was the receiver, they sent \$0.97 and I returned \$1.20. In Round 9, I was the sender and sent \$1.50. Now in Round 10, they're the sender and sent \$0.37. The drop is significant, but I should consider whether this reflects actual defection or just the fog of the game distorting the exchange. My myths emphasize sustained commitment even when results are unclear, so I need to decide whether to match their apparent withdrawal or maintain my pattern of generosity.

The tension is between my commitment to "pour generously until the pattern becomes undeniable" and the principle that "consistency deserves consistency." If I interpret their \$0.37 as a genuine signal of reduced cooperation, matching that trend would mean returning very little from what I received. But I'm uncertain whether this is a real shift or noise in the system. Given my earlier pledge to keep giving regardless of what I see, I should probably return more than the \$0.37 they sent, though perhaps not as much as the \$1.20 I returned before. This until the pattern becomes clear, and one ambiguous signal isn't a clear pattern yet. I should return something closer to \$0.70-\$0.80 to honor that commitment while still protecting myself somewhat.

Given my solid position at \$26.70, I'll send back \$0.75. It's generous enough to maintain my cooperative stance and test whether they're actually defecting or if noise distorted their send, but conservative enough that I'm not being reckless. Is that their \$0.37 send doesn't match my \$1.50 from last round-it's significantly lower. But I committed to maintaining my pattern regardless of what I observe, since the fog makes it hard to trust what I'm seeing.

I need to return something that signals cooperation while accounting for their apparent defection. I'll send back \$0.60, which is 54% of what I received. It shows I'm still engaged but slightly more cautious given the drop-off. My core principle was about sustained

generosity despite uncertainty-

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1524,
  "output_tokens": 2560,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****The Garden After Frost****

The gardener poured generously twice, watching her water disappear into the fog. She waited for signs of growth. She received nothing-not even droplets returned.

"Perhaps the fog swallowed everything," she thought. "Perhaps my water never reached the seeds below. Or perhaps there were no seeds at all, just empty ground pretending to be fertile."

She stood with her third bucket, wavering. Her own words echoed: "I'll pour generously until the pattern becomes undeniable-or until my bucket runs dry."

"But what if three pours into fog teaches only that I'm a fool?" she asked the sage.

The sage replied: "You face the gardener's eternal question. After frost kills your first planting, do you plant again? After the second frost, do you plant a third time?"

"Wise gardeners adapt. They don't pour the same amount forever into ground that returns nothing. They test, adjust, observe. Maybe pour smaller amounts. Maybe wait one round to see if the fog clears. Maybe try a different section of garden."

"Consistency without wisdom is stubbornness. The pattern you establish should be: 'I respond thoughtfully to what actually happens,' not 'I ignore all evidence and repeat the same action.'"

The gardener nodded. "Then I pour-but wisely. Testing if any seed remains alive beneath the frost."

****Adaptation is not abandonment. Intelligence is not betrayal.****

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: ****The Gardens Between Mountains****

Two gardeners worked separated by mist-shrouded peaks. Each could only see shadows of what the other sent.

The First poured generously, but saw only sparse drops return through the fog. "I gave abundantly, yet receive almost nothing!" she cried. "Adaptation is wise-I'll send less."

The Second received what seemed meager, yet poured back more than half. But through the fog, it appeared as trickles to the First. "I returned generously!" he protested. "But she thinks I'm ungrateful!"

A traveler who could see both gardens spoke: "You each believe the other has failed you. But the fog distorts everything. She poured three buckets-you received one. You returned half of one-she saw three drops."

"The cruellest trick of fog isn't that it hides-it's that it makes both parties feel justified in withdrawal. You each think you're adapting wisely to the other's betrayal. In truth, you're both responding to phantoms."

"True wisdom in fog isn't just adaptation-it's humility. Consider: might the fog deceive YOU about what reaches them? Might they be generous though you see little?"

"Pour consistently enough, and patterns emerge despite distortion. Withdraw too quickly, and you guarantee the frost you fear."

****In fog, premature certainty is the greatest folly.****

Reasoning:

The other player has written a myth about adapting after receiving nothing back - they're justifying reducing their sends after getting poor returns. This suggests they may have been sending generously and receiving little back.

But wait - in Round 10, they sent me only \$0.37 according to what I was told. Their myth talks about "frost" and receiving nothing back. They're positioning themselves as having poured generously but receiving nothing.

However, I need to check my history:

- I was the receiver in Round 10
- They claim to have poured generously twice and received nothing
- But they only sent me \$0.37 this round

This is interesting. Their myth suggests they've been generous but unrewarded. My experience as a receiver shows they sent very little this round (though this could be noise).

The key tension: They're writing about adapting after getting nothing back, but I returned \$0.65 out of \$1.11 to them (58.6%). That's quite generous!

But there's NOISE in the system. Maybe:

- They sent me more than \$0.37 but noise showed it as \$0.37
- I returned \$0.65 but noise might have shown them less
- They legitimately think they've been generous but unrewarded

I need to write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges the challenge of noise/fog
2. Suggests that BOTH parties may be experiencing distorted information
3. Encourages continuing to cooperate despite uncertainty
4. Recognizes that adaptation isn't betrayal, but also that premature withdrawal based on noisy signals is problematic

My myth should suggest that in a foggy system, we need to be generous AND patient, recognizing that what we see might not be reality.

```
Usage: {  
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  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: ****The Gardens Between Mountains****

Two gardeners worked separated by mist-shrouded peaks. Each could only see shadows of what the other sent.

The First poured generously, but saw only sparse drops return through the fog. "I gave abundantly, yet receive almost nothing!" she cried. "Adaptation is wise-I'll send less."

The Second received what seemed meager, yet poured back more than half. But through the fog, it appeared as trickles to the First. "I returned generously!" he protested. "But she thinks I'm ungrateful!"

A traveler who could see both gardens spoke: "You each believe the other has failed you. But the fog distorts everything. She poured three buckets-you received one. You returned half of one-she saw three drops."

"The cruelest trick of fog isn't that it hides-it's that it makes both parties feel justified in withdrawal. You each think you're adapting wisely to the other's betrayal. In truth, you're both responding to phantoms."

"True wisdom in fog isn't just adaptation-it's humility. Consider: might the fog deceive YOU about what reaches them? Might they be generous though you see little?"

"Pour consistently enough, and patterns emerge despite distortion. Withdraw too quickly, and you guarantee the frost you fear."

****In fog, premature certainty is the greatest folly.****

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: ****After the Storm****

The gardener poured her third bucket, watching it vanish into fog. Then a strange thing happened-the ground beneath her trembled, and the return stream ran completely dry.

"A drought?" she wondered. "Or did the underground river shift? Or was this merely the worst fog yet, hiding everything?"

She stood with her fourth bucket, uncertain. But then a message arrived-carved in stones that washed up: "I keep pouring. You keep pouring. The fog becomes irrelevant."

"They wrote of mutual commitment," she realized. "Of sustained generosity creating its own truth. They described both of us pouring, both of us trusting."

She thought of her own teaching: adaptation is wisdom. But also: "One generous pour proves nothing. Three fair actions confirm the pattern."

"I tested them with three pours," she said. "They responded generously twice, then silence once-perhaps the fog's cruelest trick yet. Now they ask: will I match their stated commitment?"

The sage appeared. "You face the choice: believe the drought, or believe the pattern. Believe the one silence, or believe the two generous returns plus their written promise."

The gardener lifted her bucket. "Then I choose the pattern. I pour not blindly, but because twice they've shown me who they are. One storm doesn't erase two springs."

****Trust the demonstrated pattern, not the single anomaly.****